THE GHISSU MODEL ANSWER SERIES



With a foreword by Bhargava V

IRMS, UPSC CSE 2024 · FORMER ASST. COMMISSIONER, APPSC GROUP-I 2023

APPSC GROUP-I MAINS

Paper II

History, Culture and Geography of India and Andhra Pradesh

MODEL ANSWERS TO PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTIONS

2008 *to* 2025

187 questions · in handwriting style

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

FOUNDER · GHISSU.COM

FOREWORD

When I sat for APPSC Group-I Mains, I noticed that most aspirants in the hall knew the content. What separated the final list was how each answer met the exact demand of the question within the time and the pages available. That is why understanding the syllabus, analysing previous year questions (PYQs) and following the trends in the pattern matter so much.

During my own preparation, I worked extensively with the APPSC Mains PYQs. I answered each question myself, working on how I presented the answer and on the value additions I could bring to it. This improved the presentation of my content, and with it, my confidence. Technology gave me an extra edge as well: I used AI to refine my answers.

This book brings together previous year questions with model answers written to the demand of the exam. It analyses the examination from every angle, which makes the aspirant's journey simpler and more focused. Attempt each question yourself before you read the model answer, and then compare. You can also get your written answer evaluated on ghissu.com. Practicing these questions year by year will sharpen your sense of the demand, the structure and the depth that score marks.

I hope this book helps aspirants prepare with clarity and confidence, and succeed in realising their goals.

All the best,

BHARGAVA V
Indian Railway Management Service (IRMS)
UPSC Civil Services Examination 2024
Former Assistant Commissioner of State Tax, Andhra Pradesh
(APPSC Group-I, 2023)

A FREE RESOURCE FROM GHISSU

Preface

APPSC Group-I Mains is a writing exam. The syllabus tells you what to study. The previous papers show you what the commission actually asks, how it words each question and how much it expects for ten marks. This book gives you every question from eight sittings, 2008 to 2025, each with an answer written the way an aspirant can write it in the exam hall.

How this book is arranged

Each paper is a separate book. Inside it, the questions run year by year, newest first, with the same order and numbering as the official question papers. The arrangement follows the latest APPSC syllabus. Questions from the older sittings, when the papers were organised differently, are placed in the paper they belong to today, and their label shows where they were first printed. Every answer fits in three pages, the space the 44-page answer booklet allows per question. The answers are drafted with Ghissu's Model Answer engine, then checked and edited, and set in a handwriting style so you can see exactly what three pages in the exam hall look like.

Why this book

After graduating in Mathematics and Computing Engineering from DTU, New Delhi, I spent years as an aspirant myself. I wrote two UPSC Civil Services Mains, two APPSC Group-I Mains and one APPSC Group-II Mains. I am still a learner, walking the same path as you.

Then, for nearly two years, I worked on the other side as Mentor-cum-Head Reviewer at Vajiram & Ravi, New Delhi, where I headed the evaluation of its Mains Test Series. I reviewed more than 10,000 answer copies, trained over 600 evaluators and mentored more than 100 aspirants. One lesson stayed with me: marks are rarely lost because of too little reading. They are lost when the demand is only half answered, the structure wanders or the conclusion says nothing. These are habits, and habits change only through writing and honest feedback.

This book is half of the method

A model answer shows you where to reach. It cannot show you how far your own answer is from it. That is what ghissu.com is for. There you will find the same questions arranged subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise. Alongside them are UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 that match the APPSC syllabus, and more practice questions that cover each topic fully. You can write an answer, get it evaluated within minutes, and compare it with the exam-hall thinking, toppers' answers and value additions for that question.

> **To use the topic-wise PYQs and resources:** sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist. Requests are usually approved within one or two days. The next pages explain how to use this book and the website together.

An apology, in advance

Every question and every answer has been checked with care. Even so, some errors may remain. If you find anything that could be clearer or more accurate, please write to **hello@ghissu.com**. Every correction makes the book better for the next reader.

With best wishes,

SRI CHARAN VEGIREDDI

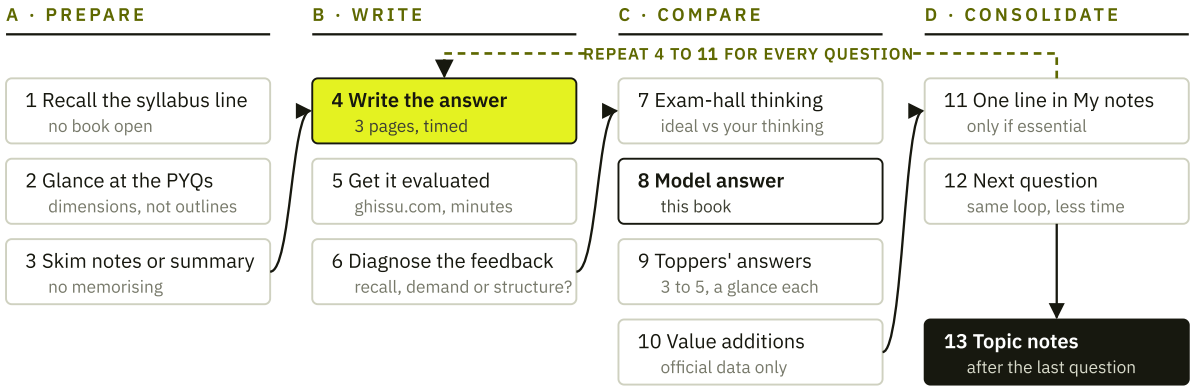
Founder, ghissu.com

READ THIS BEFORE THE FIRST QUESTION

How to use this book with ghissu.com

Keeping a book of model answers open in front of you feels like preparation, but it is passive reading, and passive reading fades. The method below keeps you active at every stage: you recall before you read, you write before you compare, and you compare in order to find the half mark you left behind in each part of the answer, from the introduction to the conclusion.

It assumes you have covered the syllabus once from a standard book or a coaching programme. Work topic by topic, using the topic-wise view of these questions on ghissu.com, and keep a time limit for every step.



Where the website comes in. Every answer page in this book carries a QR code at the bottom right, and every question in the index has a Practice link. Both open that exact question on ghissu.com, where you can upload a handwritten answer, type it against a running timer, or dictate it by voice.

SUGGESTED TIME FOR THE FIRST QUESTIONS OF A TOPIC	MINUTES
Recall, glance at the PYQs and skim your notes (steps 1 to 3, once per topic)	10 to 15
Write the answer at exam pace (step 4)	12
Read the feedback and the exam-hall thinking (steps 5 to 7)	8 to 10
Model answer, toppers' answers and value additions (steps 8 to 10)	8 to 10

A beginner may need 30 to 45 minutes for each of the first one to three questions of a sub-topic. That is expected. The time falls with every question, and what you gain is the confidence to attempt any question from the topic, at any time.

PHASE A Prepare, without opening the answers

1 **Recall the syllabus line.** Read the line from the syllabus and brainstorm everything you remember about it, on paper.

2 **Glance at the previous questions.** See which questions were asked and along which dimensions. Do not outline or think deeply yet. This shows the gaps in what you recalled and where the marks in this topic usually lie.

3 **Skim your notes.** If you have notes, skim them without trying to memorise. If not, read the summary, strategy, value addition and toppers' answers for the topic on ghissu.com, just enough to attempt the first question with confidence.

PHASE B Write and get feedback

4 **Write the first question.** Do not wait for the perfect moment; there is none. Answer writing is the skill the examiner tests most, more than reading or revision. If the topic has few APPSC questions, ghissu.com adds the related UPSC questions and practice questions.

5 **Get it evaluated.** Submit a full answer, or only a quick outline, on ghissu.com. Feedback returns in two to three minutes. Upload a handwritten page, type with the timer running, or dictate, whichever suits your day.

6 **Diagnose before you read further.** Find the one major issue. If it is only recall, move on; it disappears as you finish the topic. If it is a missed demand or a weak structure, slow down and understand it with the exam-hall thinking for that question. Ask Ghissu and the Ghissu bull can explain further, in your own language.

PHASE C Compare with the ideal

7 **Exam-hall thinking.** See how the question is broken down: its demand and structure, how to open the introduction, how to generate points, which frameworks and value additions to use and how to conclude. Measure the distance between your thinking and the ideal. By the end of a topic, your own thinking will often go further.

8 **The model answer in this book.** Note new terms, data and value additions, and see how a complete answer fits three pages. Do not memorise it.

9 **Toppers' answers.** Glance through three to five toppers' answers on ghissu.com, drawn from more than 1.5 lakh answers, mostly by UPSC toppers. The APPSC syllabus overlaps heavily with UPSC, so they apply directly. Spend little time on each. Your mind will start to notice how they earn the extra half mark in each part, and their keywords will come back to you in the hall.

10 **Value additions.** For the latest figures and data, use the value additions on the question or the topic. They are taken from official government sources, ready to quote in an answer.

PHASE D Consolidate

11 **Hold back the notes.** Do not write short notes after a single question; you will end up copying everything. If something is essential, add it to My notes on that question. Your notes collect topic by topic on their own, so nothing is written twice.

12 **Next question, same loop.** Repeat steps 4 to 11 for every question in the topic, keeping to the time limits so that no step runs away with your day.

13 **Write your topic notes last.** When every question is done, write one to three ways to open and close an answer on this topic, a few multi-dimensional points each for positives, negatives and the way forward, and the keywords and frameworks you will break a question into. Fifteen to twenty points and a diagram are enough to reproduce in the exam. The strategy section of each topic on ghissu.com helps, but your own versions matter more.

APPSC Group-I Mains · Paper II

Model answers in handwriting style, 2008 to 2025, numbered as in the official papers · latest-syllabus arrangement

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).
Click a question to open its model answer. "Practice" opens the same question on ghissu.com.

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
2025	30 answers		
1(a)	Discuss the origin and expansion of the Indus Valley Civilization.	18	Practice →
1(b)	Briefly analyze the teachings of Buddha and Mahavira.	21	Practice →
2(a)	Describe the contributions of the Chalukya rulers of Kalyani in the fields of sculpture, architecture, and literature.	24	Practice →
2(b)	Describe the characteristics of the Sufi movement and assess its impact on Indian culture.	27	Practice →
3(a)	Discuss the establishment of the East India Company and its early operations in India.	30	Practice →
3(b)	What impact did the activities of Christian missionaries have on Indian society and culture?	33	Practice →
4(a)	What do you understand by the Permanent Settlement, and what impact did it have on Indian society? Comment.	36	Practice →
4(b)	What do you understand by the 'safety valve' theory? Explain it in the context of the Indian National Congress?	39	Practice →
5(a)	Discuss the role and contributions of the moderate leaders of Congress from 1885 to 1905.	42	Practice →
5(b)	Describe the major movements led by Mahatma Gandhi between 1920 and 1947.	45	Practice →
6(a)	Examine the impact of the loss of Hyderabad as the capital city on post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh. How did this transition affect the state's administrative, economic, an...	48	Practice →
6(b)	Discuss the vision behind building a new capital for Andhra Pradesh after the bifurcation in 2014. Critically assess the financial implications involved in the planning,...	51	Practice →
7(a)	What are the various stories about the origins of Andhra people and the Andhra language?	54	Practice →
7(b)	How did far trade routes contribute to the exchange of Buddhist ideas in ancient Andhra?	57	Practice →
8(a)	Discuss the growth of various Saivite sects during the Kakatiya rule.	60	Practice →
8(b)	Discuss the significance of the Warangal Fort complex as a historical monument.	63	Practice →
9(a)	Discuss the role of missionaries in the growth and spread of education in Andhra region.	66	Practice →
9(b)	What factors contributed to the process of social awakening in the Andhra region in the second half of the 19th century?	69	Practice →
10(a)	What were the provisions of the Gentlemen's Agreement of 1956? How far could they satisfy apprehensions of the Telangana region?	72	Practice →
10(b)	Outline the role of the students in raising major issues in the 1969 Telangana agitation.	75	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
11(a)	Explain the physical features of India and Andhra Pradesh, especially the major landforms and geographical characteristics.	78	Practice →
11(b)	Examine the features and importance of the major landforms of Andhra Pradesh with special reference to the Coastal Plains, Eastern Ghats, and Deccan Plateau.	81	Practice →
12(a)	Discuss the background of agriculture in Andhra Pradesh and critically examine how key agricultural inputs such as rainfall, temperature, irrigation and power are likely to b...	84	Practice →
12(b)	Highlight the industrial importance and major manufacturing sectors of Andhra Pradesh.	87	Practice →
13(a)	Discuss the spatial patterns of population distribution and urbanisation in Andhra Pradesh.	90	Practice →
13(b)	Analyse the composition and spatial distribution of Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and religious communities in Andhra Pradesh, as per Census 2011.	93	Practice →
14(a)	Discuss the key aspects of wildlife conservation and biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.	96	Practice →
14(b)	Discuss the vulnerability of Andhra Pradesh to cyclones and floods, highlighting the causes, regional patterns, and impacts.	99	Practice →
15(a)	Analyse the disaster vulnerability of Rayalaseema region in Andhra Pradesh with respect to droughts. Discuss the socio-economic consequences.	102	Practice →
15(b)	Assess the role of the Andhra Pradesh Pollution Control Board (APPCB) in post-disaster pollution management.	105	Practice →
2023	33 answers		
1(a)	Examine the survival and continuity of Harappan culture in the present times.	109	Practice →
1(b)	Examine the socio-religious life and administration of early India with respect to the writings of Chinese travellers such as Fa-Hien, Hiuen-Tsang and I-Tsang.	112	Practice →
2(a)	Examine the manner in which the Chola village administration had contributed to the growth of village autonomy as indicated by the Uttaramerur/Uttaramallur inscriptions.	115	Practice →
2(b)	Explain Alauddin Khilji's market regulations and discuss their impact.	118	Practice →
3(a)	Discuss the features of Mughal architecture and examine the influence of Hindu elements on Mughal architecture.	121	Practice →
3(b)	The state that was created by Shivaji was not only egalitarian in conception but also a welfare state in nature.' Examine.	124	Practice →
4(a)	Explain the land revenue systems that were introduced by the British. Assess the impact of these revenue systems on the Indian economy.	127	Practice →
4(b)	Assess the socio-religious reform movements in the Muslim community during the 19th century. Discuss the contributions made by Sayyid Ahmad Khan towards the upliftme...	130	Practice →
5(a)	Explain the factors that led to the peasant movement in India and examine its impact on the national movement in India.	133	Practice →
5(b)	Has communalism indirectly helped the British to perpetuate their control over India ? Examine the indicative traits of the Communalists and assess their impact on India's...	136	Practice →
6(a)	Discuss the socio-religious conditions during the Satavahana period with special reference to prominence bestowed on women.	139	Practice →
6(b)	Explain the re-structuring of the socio-religious life of the Eastern Chalukyas with reference to the impact caused by immigrations, caste mobility and social awakening.	142	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
7(a)	Examine the socio-religious and cultural life of the Vijayanagara kingdom with respect to the writings of foreign travellers such as Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzak, Duarte Barbos...	145	Practice →
7(b)	Examine the socio-cultural and religious conditions of the Reddi kingdoms with specific reference to the development of Telugu literature.	148	Practice →
8(a)(i)	Write a short note on the following : (i) Gurujada Apparao's contribution to social reform through the medium of literature	151	Practice →
8(a)(ii)	Write a short note on the following : (ii) Gidugu Ramamurthy's pioneering efforts to strengthen the Vyavaharika Bhasha movement	154	Practice →
8(b)(i)	Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (i) Sir Thomas Munro	157	Practice →
8(b)(ii)	Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (ii) Sir Arthur Cotton	160	Practice →
8(b)(iii)	Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (iii) Charles Phillip Brown	163	Practice →
9(a)	Examine the role of Alluri Sitarama Raju as the leader of Rampa Rebellion.	166	Practice →
9(b)	The evolution of Telugu Dalit literature has led an ideological narrative against caste discrimination, and for a just and equal society with focus on self-respect and dignity. I...	169	Practice →
10(a)	Explain the inconsistencies of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014 that had adversely affected the residuary state of Andhra Pradesh with regards to...	172	Practice →
10(b)	Examine the principles envisaged under Schedule Eleven of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014, with reference to the functioning of the river management...	175	Practice →
11(a)	What are the climatic controls? How do they influence India's climate ?	178	Practice →
11(b)	Describe the characteristic features of Black and Alluvial soils of Andhra Pradesh.	181	Practice →
12(a)	What are the objectives and key features of Sagarmala Project ? Why is it important ?	184	Practice →
12(b)	Discuss the role of sea-ports in the economic development of Andhra Pradesh.	187	Practice →
13(a)	Give a description of the 'demographic dividend' in the Indian context.	190	Practice →
13(b)	What are different types of rural settlements and factors affecting them ? Add a note on rural settlement patterns in India.	193	Practice →
14(a)	Discuss the various forest conservation programmes in India.	196	Practice →
14(b)	Discuss various in situ conservation strategies of biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.	199	Practice →
15(a)	What is meant by Environment Impact Assessment ? Evaluate it. Also give suggestions to make it effective.	202	Practice →
15(b)	Define 'Drought'. What are its different types ? Add a note on drought prone areas in India.	205	Practice →
2020	30 answers		
1(a)	Critically explain the salient features of urban planning of Harappan Civilization.	209	Practice →
1(b)	Critically explain the causes of the emergence of Buddhism in ancient India.	212	Practice →
2(a)	Draw an outline of society under the Eastern Chalukyas.	215	Practice →
2(b)	Vividly examine the impact of Bhakti Movement during medieval India.	218	Practice →
3(a)	Critically evaluate the central administration under Akbar.	221	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
3(b)	Draw an outline of the rise of Maratha Empire with special reference to Shivaji's contribution.	224	Practice →
4(a)	Critically explain the role of Subsidiary Alliance system in the rise and expansion of British Raj in India.	227	Practice →
4(b)	Delineate the contribution of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar with special reference to the conditions of untouchables and labourers in colonial India?	230	Practice →
5(a)	Examine the recommendations of the Cabinet Mission plan.	233	Practice →
5(b)	Critically evaluate the impact of Quit India Movement of 1942.	236	Practice →
6(a)	Discuss salient features of the Agrarian system under the Satavahanas.	239	Practice →
6(b)	Write a note on art and architecture under the Pallavas.	242	Practice →
7(a)	Write a brief note on the architecture during the period of Vijayanagar Empire.	245	Practice →
7(b)	"The foundation of Vijayanagara Empire coincided in point of time with the outburst of a momentous literary movement in South India." Discuss it.	248	Practice →
8(a)	Write a brief account of library movement in Andhra Pradesh.	251	Practice →
8(b)	Critically evaluate the contribution of Kandukari Veeresalingam in the light of social reform movement in Andhra Pradesh.	254	Practice →
9(a)	Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Justice Party.	257	Practice →
9(b)	Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1950s.	260	Practice →
10(a)	Discuss the revenue and infrastructural challenges for new Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation in 2014.	263	Practice →
10(b)	Discuss the impact of bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh (2014) on trade and commerce.	266	Practice →
11(a)	Give a brief account of geographical features of Andhra Pradesh.	269	Practice →
11(b)	Give a brief account of the drainage system of Andhra Pradesh.	272	Practice →
12(a)	Critically analyse the components and impacts of the Green Revolution in India.	275	Practice →
12(b)	Give a concise description of fisheries management and development in India?	278	Practice →
13(a)	Write a brief note on the rural and urban population of Andhra Pradesh in the light of the census of India 2011.	281	Practice →
13(b)	Write a brief note on tribal population of Andhra Pradesh in the context of census report of 2011.	284	Practice →
14(a)	In the light of the All India Tiger Estimation Report 2018, critically evaluate the Project Tiger.	287	Practice →
14(b)	Briefly describe the flora and fauna of National Parks in Andhra Pradesh.	290	Practice →
15(a)	Give a brief account of factors responsible for environmental pollution.	293	Practice →
15(b)	Give a brief account of the concept and importance of Sustainable Development.	296	Practice →
2017	20 answers		
P-II 1(a) old P-II	Explain in what respects the Harappan civilization differed from that of the later Vedic civilization.	300	Practice →

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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 1(b) old P-II	What do you know about Sangam age ? How does Sangam age literature help us in knowing the political and cultural life of that age ?	303	Practice →
P-II 2(a) old P-II	Analyse the cultural contribution of Cholas and explain their contribution for the cultural expansion in South East Asia.	306	Practice →
P-II 2(b) old P-II	Explain Sufism and discuss its main principles, important orders and their influence on the Indian society.	309	Practice →
P-II 3(a) old P-II	State the reasons for the rise of Chhatrapati Shivaji and also describe the administrative, military and land revenue systems of his empire.	312	Practice →
P-II 3(b) old P-II	Describe the impact of the Revolt of 1857 on British Rule in India. What were the major changes in the British policies and rule after the revolt ?	315	Practice →
P-II 4(a) old P-II	Describe the impact of the teachings of Swami Vivekananda in arousing nationalistic feeling and the spirit of service in Indians.	318	Practice →
P-II 4(b) old P-II	Describe the contribution of Narayana Guru in social awakening and the result of his teachings on society.	321	Practice →
P-II 5(a) old P-II	Discuss the contribution of the Revolutionary Nationalists to the Freedom Movement and their impact on the British Rule.	324	Practice →
P-II 5(b) old P-II	"Gandhi was a politician among saints and a saint among politicians." Discuss.	327	Practice →
P-II 6(a) old P-II	Trace the origin and expansion of the Satavahana power and describe their contribution to religion and literature.	330	Practice →
P-II 6(b) old P-II	Explain the political significance of Vengi Chalukyas and describe their role in moulding the culture of the Andhra.	333	Practice →
P-II 7(a) old P-II	Critically analyse the growth of Telugu language and literature between 1000 AD and 1500 AD.	336	Practice →
P-II 7(b) old P-II	Describe the characteristics of Vijayanagara architecture.	339	Practice →
P-II 8(a) old P-II	State the influence of Brahma Samaj Movement on the social reformers of Andhra and highlight how that ideology is reflected in their writings.	342	Practice →
P-II 8(b) old P-II	Assess the role of Western education and contribution of Christian Missionaries in the socio-cultural awakening in Andhra.	345	Practice →
P-II 9(a) old P-II	Critically examine the objectives and results of the movement of Tripuraneni Ramaswamy Chowdary.	348	Practice →
P-II 9(b) old P-II	Describe the reasons and state the important events that led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh State in 1956.	351	Practice →
P-II 10(a) old P-II	Evaluate the seriousness of the problems in reorganisation of Andhra Pradesh with reference to the financial position of the State of Andhra Pradesh immediately after...	354	Practice →
P-II 10(b) old P-II	Explain the problems encountered till now in bifurcation of assets of institutions mentioned in Schedule IX and Schedule X of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act,...	357	Practice →
2016	20 answers		
P-II 1(a) old P-II	Compare Hinayana and Mahayana Buddhism. Why did Buddhism become popular and decline subsequently?	361	Practice →
P-II 1(b) old P-II	What are the important features of major schools of art that flourished during post Mauryan period?	364	Practice →
2(a)	Describe major contributions of Great Mughals to Indian Architecture.	367	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 2(b) old P-II	What is the cultural contribution of Vijayanagar Empire?	370	Practice →
P-II 3(a) old P-II	"The period between 1885-1905 is the period of moderates in Indian freedom struggle" In light of the above statement, describe the contribution of early nationalists...	373	Practice →
P-II 3(b) old P-II	Describe the nature and significance of revolt of 1857? Explain whether it can be termed as "First War of Independence"?	376	Practice →
P-II 4(a) old P-II	Comment on the effectiveness of the methods employed by Mahatma Gandhi to mobilize masses?	379	Practice →
P-II 4(b) old P-II	"We must hold fast to constitutional methods for achieving our social and economical objectives". Briefly explain the significance of this statement of Dr B. R. Ambedkar with...	382	Practice →
P-II 5(a) old P-II	Comment on the contribution of peasant movements in freedom struggle.	385	Practice →
P-II 5(b) old P-II	Analyze the role of communalism in the partition of the country.	388	Practice →
P-II 6(a) old P-II	Briefly describe political fortunes and cultural contribution of Ikshvakus?	391	Practice →
P-II 6(b) old P-II	Describe the contribution of Eastern Chalukyas to literature, art and architecture.	394	Practice →
P-II 7(a) old P-II	Comment on the contribution of Qutubshahis to Telugu language and literature.	397	Practice →
P-II 7(b) old P-II	Write about poet Molla, her work and style.	400	Practice →
P-II 8(a) old P-II	Comment on the contribution of literary works of Gurram Jashuva in social reform.	403	Practice →
P-II 8(b) old P-II	Illustrate the salient features of literary works of Dr Boyi Bhimana.	406	Practice →
P-II 9(a) old P-II	Describe the contribution of Andhra Mahasabha in socio cultural development.	409	Practice →
P-II 9(b) old P-II	Describe Vandemataram movement and its impact on freedom struggle in Andhra Pradesh?	412	Practice →
P-II 10(a) old P-II	Trace the reasons for success and subsequent failure of Telangana people's armed struggle.	415	Practice →
P-II 10(b) old P-II	Who are Razakars and what was their role in resisting integration of Hyderabad State in the Indian union?	418	Practice →
2012	17 answers		
P-II 1(a) old P-II	Give a detailed account of Harappans' town planning and evaluate the various reasons for its decline.	422	Practice →
P-II 1(b) old P-II	Describe the similarities and differences of Buddhism and Ashoka's 'Dhamma'. Discuss the impact of the both on ancient Indian Society.	425	Practice →
P-II 2(a) old P-II	What are the medieval Indian Temple construction styles? Discuss with suitable examples.	428	Practice →
P-II 2(b) old P-II	Examine the factors behind the rise of Shivaji. Do you feel that he was a nationalist leader? support.	431	Practice →
3(a)	Discuss about the various stages of British colonialism and its impact on Indian Society.	434	Practice →
3(b)	What was the impact of the First and Second World Wars on the Indian National Movement?	437	Practice →
P-II 4(a) old P-II	Explain the main features of the religious and social reform movements and evaluate their role in the making of Modern India.	440	Practice →
4(b)	How far have the oppressed caste movements and their leaders helped the downtrodden people for their upliftment?	443	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
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No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 5(a) old P-II	Estimate the role of women in the National Movement. Do you consider that their participation was an indication for the women empowerment in those days?	446	Practice →
P-II 5(b) old P-II	What was the role of Socialists and the influence of Socialistic ideas on the Pre and Post Independence India?	449	Practice →
P-II 6(a) old P-II	Explain the social structure during the Satavahana period and also discuss the contribution of Satavahanas to the society.	452	Practice →
6(b)	Give an account of the socio-cultural and religious conditions of the people after the down fall of Satavahana dynasty.	455	Practice →
P-II 7(a) old P-II	Describe the Kakatiya Style of architecture and discuss how the Agriculture and Irrigation systems was developed during that period.	458	Practice →
P-II 7(b) old P-II	Evaluate the development of Telugu Language and Literature between 1000 A.D. and 1565 A.D. with special reference to women poets.	461	Practice →
P-II 8(a) old P-II	Discuss about the role of the Andhras during different phases of National Movement.	464	Practice →
P-II 8(b) old P-II	Examine the growth and development of Communist ideology and literary contributions of the great poet Sri-Sri and others in Andhra.	467	Practice →
P-II 10(b) old P-II	Critically examine the situations that led to integration of Hyderabad State into the Indian Union and later formation of Andhra Pradesh.	470	Practice →
2011	17 answers		
P-II 1(a) old P-II	Bring out the salient features of the Indus and Vedic Civilizations in a comparative perspective.	474	Practice →
P-II 1(b) old P-II	Examine the factors responsible for the rise and growth of Jainism and Buddhism.	477	Practice →
P-II 2(a) old P-II	Discuss the impact of Islam on Indian culture, with special reference to the Bhakti movements.	480	Practice →
P-II 2(b) old P-II	Assess the contribution of Mughals to Indian Art and Architecture with examples.	483	Practice →
P-II 3(a) old P-II	Critically examine the Economic, Political and Administrative reforms introduced by the British in Modern India.	486	Practice →
P-II 3(b) old P-II	Trace the evolution of Indian Nationalism with reference to the three phases of the Freedom Struggle between the years 1885-1947.	489	Practice →
4(a)	Describe the rise and growth of socio-religious reform movements in Modern India with special reference to Rajarammohan Roy, Jyotiba Phule and Narayana Guru.	492	Practice →
P-II 4(b) old P-II	Compare and contrast the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Ambedkar with regard to the abolition of untouchability and Harijan upliftment.	495	Practice →
P-II 5(a) old P-II	Account for the rise and growth of peasant and working class movements and their contribution in anti-feudal and anti-colonial struggles.	498	Practice →
P-II 5(b) old P-II	Trace the course of events leading to the Partition of India in 1947.	501	Practice →
P-II 6(a) old P-II	Discuss the socio-economic and religious conditions during the period of Satavahanas in Ancient Andhra Desha.	504	Practice →
P-II 6(b) old P-II	Write an essay on the growth of Buddhism in Ancient Andhra Desha and the salient features of Buddhist Art and Architecture with examples.	507	Practice →
P-II 7(a) old P-II	Describe the socio-economic conditions in Medieval Andhra Desha with special reference to the Kakatiyas.	510	Practice →
P-II 7(b) old P-II	Evaluate the contribution of Qutub Shahis to the Telugu language and literature.	513	Practice →

No.	Question	Page	Practice online
P-II 8(a) old P-II	Trace the origin and growth of Adi-Andhra Movement in Modern Andhra Desha and examine the role of Gurram Jashuva and Boyi Bheemanna in the growth of Dalit...	516	Practice →
8(b)	Critically examine the role of Socialists and Communists in the Freedom Movements in Andhra Desha between the years 1935-1947.	519	Practice →
10(b)	Trace the course of events leading to the formation of Andhra Pradesh.	522	Practice →
2008	20 answers		
P-II 1(a) old P-II	Compare and contrast the salient features of Early Vedic and Later Vedic civilisations in political, social, economic and religious fields.	526	Practice →
P-II 1(b) old P-II	Analyse the factors that contributed for the growth of Magadhan imperialism.	529	Practice →
P-II 2(a) old P-II	Bring out the nature and significance of Bhakti Movements in Medieval India.	532	Practice →
P-II 2(b) old P-II	Discuss the social and economic conditions under the Vijayanagar rulers.	535	Practice →
P-II 3(a) old P-II	Critically examine the impact of British colonial rule on the Indian economy.	538	Practice →
3(b)	Examine the objectives, methods and the impact of the Moderates vis-a-vis the Extremists during the course of the Indian Freedom Struggle from 1885 to 1920.	541	Practice →
P-II 4(a) old P-II	What was the contribution of the Socio-religious Reform Movements of the 19th century for the upliftment of women in Modern India ?	544	Practice →
P-II 4(b) old P-II	Bring out the nature and characteristic features of the anti-Brahmin movements in Modern India.	547	Practice →
P-II 5(a) old P-II	Trace the important Peasant Movements in Modern India and their characteristic features.	550	Practice →
P-II 5(b) old P-II	Examine the salient features of the Indian Foreign Policy during the post-Independence period upto 1989.	553	Practice →
P-II 6(a) old P-II	Discuss the socio-religious conditions and the development of Telugu language and literature during the Satavahana period.	556	Practice →
P-II 6(b) old P-II	Explain the contributions of Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi in the fields of education, culture and Telugu language and literature.	559	Practice →
P-II 7(a) old P-II	Give an account of the socio-religious and cultural conditions in Andhra desha during the years 1000 - 1565 A.D.	562	Practice →
P-II 7(b) old P-II	Estimate the contribution of the poet Nannaya for the development of Telugu language and literature.	565	Practice →
8(a)	What are the factors that led to the rise and growth of socio-cultural awakening in Andhra during the 20th century?	568	Practice →
P-II 8(b) old P-II	Describe the causes and results of the Vandemataram Movement in Andhra.	571	Practice →
P-II 9(a) old P-II	Briefly explain what are the circumstances that led to the establishment of Asafjahi dynasty and the role played by Nizam-ul-Mulk.	574	Practice →
9(b)	Estimate the significance of Library Movement in Telangana.	577	Practice →
P-II 10(a) old P-II	Critically examine the role played by Ittehadul Muslimeen, during the rule of the VIIth Nizam of Hyderabad.	580	Practice →
10(b)	Assess the circumstances that led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh.	583	Practice →

To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together,
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PAPER II AT A GLANCE

Trend analysis

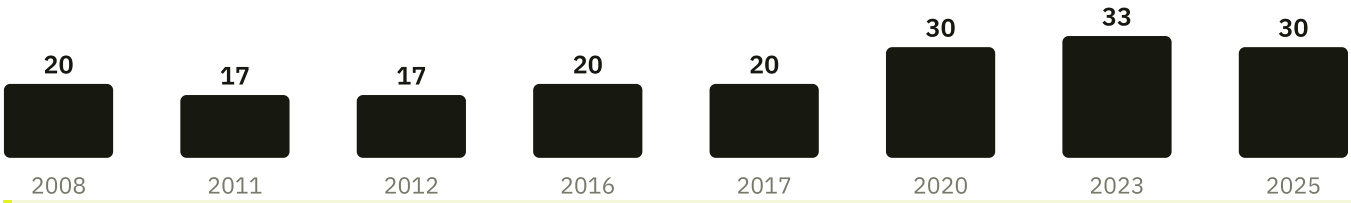
187
APPSC QUESTIONS

8
SITTINGS, 2008 TO 2025

15
CHAPTERS

74
SUB-TOPICS ASKED

QUESTIONS BY SITTING



Darker cells mark the sub-topics the commission returns to most. Older sittings (2008 to 2017) are counted under today's syllabus.
To practice any sub-topic with all its past questions together, sign in at ghissu.com and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
1. Ancient India - Pre-history, IVC, Vedic, Mauryas, Kushans, Satavahanas, Sangam,...	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**16**
1.2 Indus Valley Civilization	·	·	1	·	·	1	1	1	4
1.3 Vedic culture	1	1	·	·	1	·	·	·	3
1.4 Mahajanapadas; emergence of new religions - Jainism, Buddhism	·	1	·	1	·	1	·	1	4
1.5 Rise of Magadha and the Age of the Mauryas; Ashoka Dharma	1	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	2
1.6 Foreign invasions on India; the Kushans	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	1
1.7 The Satavahanas, the Sangam Age in South India, the Sungas	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	1
1.9 Historical accounts of foreign travellers	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
2. Early Medieval & Medieval India - Pallavas to Cholas, Delhi Sultanate, Bhakti & S...	**2**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**13**
2.1 Pallavas, Badami & Eastern Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Kalyani Chalukyas, Chol...	·	·	1	·	1	1	1	1	5
2.2 Delhi Sultanates; advent of Islam and its impact	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
2.3 Religious movements - Bhakti and Sufi and their influence	1	1	·	·	1	1	·	1	5
2.5 Socio-cultural conditions of the Kakatiyas, Vijayanagaras, Bahmanis, Qutubsh...	1	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	2
3. The Mughals, the Marathas & the Advent of Europeans	**·**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**1**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**10**
3.1 Mughal administration, socio-religious life and cultural developments	·	1	·	1	·	1	1	·	4
3.2 Shivaji and the rise of the Maratha Empire	·	·	1	·	1	1	1	·	4
3.4 Rise of the East India Company and its hegemony	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
3.5 Changes in administration, social and cultural spheres; role of Christian missi...	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
4. British Rule 1757-1856, the 1857 Revolt, Socio-Religious Reform & the Rise of N...	**3**	**3**	**3**	**2**	**3**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**20**
4.1 Rise of British rule in India from 1757 to 1856	1	1	1	·	·	1	·	·	4
4.2 Land revenue settlement - Permanent, Ryotwari and Mahalwari	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	2
4.3 The 1857 Revolt and its impact	·	·	·	1	1	·	·	·	2
4.5 Socio-religious reform movements of the 19th century - Roy, Dayananda, Vive...	1	1	1	·	1	·	1	·	5
4.6 Rise of Indian nationalism; activities of the INC; Vandemataram and Home Ru...	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
4.7 Self-Respect Movement - Jyotiba Phule, Narayana Guru, Periyar Ramaswamy ...	1	·	1	·	1	·	·	·	3
4.9 Dr B. R. Ambedkar and his contributions	·	1	·	1	·	1	·	·	3
5. Indian Nationalism in Three Phases; Independence, Partition and After	**3**	**3**	**3**	**5**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**22**
5.1 Freedom Struggle 1885-1905 (Moderates)	1	1	·	1	·	·	·	1	4
5.2 Freedom Struggle 1905-1920 (Extremists, revolutionaries)	·	·	1	·	1	·	·	·	2

PAPER II TREND ANALYSIS, CONTINUED

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
5.3 Gandhi phase 1920-1947	·	·	·	1	1	1	·	1	4
5.4 Peasant, women, tribal and workers' movements	1	1	1	1	·	·	1	·	5
5.5 Role of different parties in the freedom struggle; local and regional movements	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	1
5.6 Inter-religious unity and communalism	·	·	·	1	·	·	1	·	2
5.7 Independence and Partition of India; rehabilitation after partition	·	1	·	·	·	1	·	·	2
5.8 Linguistic re-organization of states; integration of the Indian States	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	·	1
5.9 India after Independence - Indian Constitution, economic policies, foreign pol...	1	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1
6. Andhra - Ancient	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	16
6.1 Satavahanas, Ikshvakus, Salankayanas, Pallavas, Vishnukundins - social and ...	1	1	2	1	1	1	1	·	8
6.2 Religion in early Andhra; Jainism and Buddhism in Andhra	·	1	·	·	·	·	·	1	2
6.3 Eastern Chalukyas, Rashtrakutas, Renati Cholas and others - socio-cultural lif...	1	·	·	1	1	·	1	·	4
6.4 Telugu script, language and literature (ancient)	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
6.5 Art and architecture of ancient Andhra	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
7. Andhra - Medieval	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	2	16
7.1 Socio-cultural and religious conditions in Andhradesa, 1000-1565 A.D.	1	1	·	·	·	·	1	1	4
7.2 Antiquity, origin and growth of Telugu language and literature (Kavitraya, Asht...	1	·	1	1	1	1	1	·	6
7.3 Fine arts, art & architecture under the Kakatiyas, Reddis, Gajapatis, Vijayanag...	·	·	1	·	1	1	·	·	3
7.4 Historical monuments and their significance	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
7.5 Contribution of the Qutubshahis to Andhra history and culture	·	1	·	1	·	·	·	·	2
8. Andhra - Modern	3	·	·	·	2	2	5	2	14
8.2 Role of Christian missionaries; socio-cultural and literary awakening	1	·	·	·	1	·	·	2	4
8.3 C. P. Brown, Thomas Munro, Mackenzie	·	·	·	·	·	·	3	·	3
8.4 Zamindari and Polegary systems; Native States and Little Kings	2	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	2
8.5 Social reformers - Gurajada Apparao, Kandukuri Veeresalingam, Raghupati Ve...	·	·	·	·	1	1	2	·	4
8.6 Library Movement in Andhra Pradesh; role of newspapers	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
9. Andhra - Nationalist Movement and Formation of the State	3	3	3	5	2	2	2	2	22
9.1 Role of Andhra leaders; Justice Party; non-Brahmin movement	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
9.2 Nationalist and revolutionary literature - Jashuva, Boyi Bheemanna, Sri Sri, Ga...	·	1	1	2	1	·	1	·	6
9.3 Andhra Mahasabhas and the Andhra Movement; prominent leaders - Alluri, D...	1	1	1	2	·	·	1	·	6
9.4 Grandhalaya (library) Movement - Ayyanki Venkataratnam, Gadicherla Harisar...	1	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1
9.5 Potti Sreeramulu; formation of Andhra State 1953; emergence of Andhra Prad...	1	1	1	·	1	1	·	·	5
9.6 Andhra Pradesh 1956 to 2014; causes for bifurcation; 2nd June 2014 and its ...	·	·	·	1	·	·	·	2	3
10. Andhra Pradesh - Bifurcation and its Impact	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	2	8
10.2 Loss of capital city; building of the new capital and its financial implications	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	2	2
10.4 Effect of bifurcation on trade, commerce and industry; financial resources of ...	·	·	·	·	1	2	·	·	3
10.6 Impact on river water sharing and other link issues	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
10.7 A.P. Reorganization Act 2014 - provisions and the arbitrariness of certain pro...	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	·	2
11. Physical Features and Resources	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
11.1 Major landforms of India and Andhra Pradesh	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	2	3
11.2 Climate and climatic changes	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
11.3 Soil types	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1
11.4 Rivers, water, streams; reservoirs and dams	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
12. Economic Geography	·	·	·	·	·	2	2	2	6
12.1 Agriculture and livestock	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	2
12.2 Forestry and fishery	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	1
12.4 Household manufacturing and industries - agro, mineral, forest, fuel and ma...	·	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	1
12.5 Trade and commerce	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1

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PAPER II TREND ANALYSIS, CONTINUED

CHAPTER AND SUB-TOPIC (LATEST SYLLABUS)	2008	2011	2012	2016	2017	2020	2023	2025	TOTAL
12.6 Communication, road transport, storage and others	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
13. Social Geography	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**6**
13.2 Human habitations - rural and urban settlements (Population Distribution)	·	·	·	·	·	1	1	1	**3**
13.3 Age and sex composition	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
13.4 Race, caste, tribe, religion and linguistic composition	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	**2**
14. Fauna and Floral Geography	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**2**	**2**	**1**	**5**
14.1 Wild animals, birds, reptiles, mammals	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	**2**
14.2 Trees and plants and others	·	·	·	·	·	1	**2**	·	**3**
15. Environmental Geography	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**·**	**2**	**2**	**3**	**7**
15.1 Sustainable development and globalization	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	·	**1**
15.3 Natural hazards - earthquakes, landslides, floods, cyclones, cloud burst	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	**2**	**3**
15.4 Disaster management and impact assessment	·	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	**1**
15.5 Environmental pollution and pollution management	·	·	·	·	·	1	·	1	**2**
Paper II total	**20**	**17**	**17**	**20**	**20**	**30**	**33**	**30**	**187**

1 question 2 3 or more · not asked that year

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APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2025

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

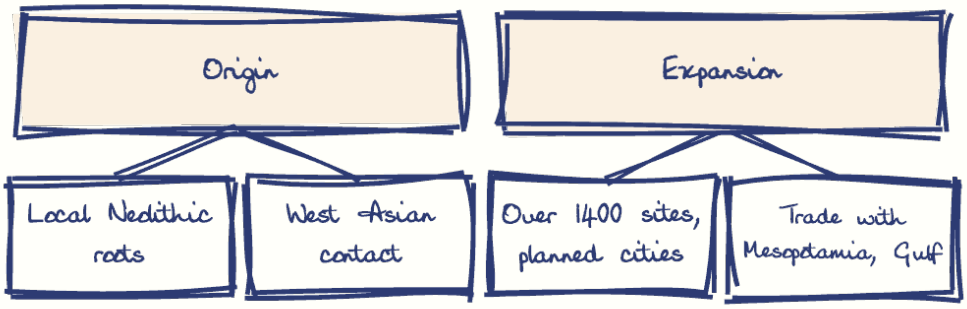
1(a) Discuss the origin and expansion of the Indus Valley Civilization.

10

Introduction

The Indus Valley Civilization (IVC), also called the Harappan Civilization, was one of the earliest urban cultures of South Asia, flourishing around 2500 BCE. Its discovery in the early 20th century revealed a vast, sophisticated society that extended far beyond the Indus valley.

Indus Civilization: origin and expansion



Origin of the Civilization

1. Indigenous roots: The IVC likely emerged from local Neolithic cultures in the Ghaggar-Hakra region.

2. West Asian influence: Similarities with Mesopotamian urban models and artifacts suggest external contact. Mortimer Wheeler argued for a migration of ideas rather than people, a diffusion

of urban concepts.

3. Debate on Aryans: Recent scholarship stresses cultural assimilation rather than conquest, highlighting the civilization's indigenous roots.

Expansion of the Civilization

1. Geographical spread: It covered about (1) to (1.5) million sq. km across present-day Pakistan, northwest India and parts of Afghanistan. Over (1400) sites are known, including Harappa, Mohenjodaro, Lothal and Kalibangan.
2. Urban design and governance: Grid-pattern cities with citadel and lower town, standardised baked bricks and advanced drainage show centralised civic management.
3. Economic institutions: Granaries, the dockyard at Lothal and standardised weights and measures point to a regulated economy trading with Mesopotamia and the Persian Gulf, which sustained expansion.
4. Social integration: Skeletal remains reveal Proto-Australoid, Mediterranean, Alpine and Mongoloid elements, a multi-ethnic society that eased cultural exchange.

Limits to Expansion

1. **Decline:** Drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra river system and possible socio-political disruptions led to decline around 1700 BCE, though its cultural and technological legacies persisted.
2. **Knowledge systems:** The undeciphered script, advanced sanitation and water management show a knowledge system comparable to Egypt and Mesopotamia, which later shaped Indian traditions.

Way Forward

1. **Deeper research:** Wider excavations along the Ghaggar-Hakra and interdisciplinary genetic, linguistic and environmental studies can clarify its origin and regional variations.

Conclusion

The IVC arose from a fusion of indigenous and external impulses and spread into a vast, well-governed urban network. Its study, along with efforts to decipher the script, enriches our understanding of India's civilizational roots.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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SCAN

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Scan to practice

1(b) Briefly analyze the teachings of Buddha and Mahavira.

10

Introduction

The teachings of Buddha and Mahavira emerged in the 6th century BCE as responses to the social, religious and philosophical challenges of their time. Both offered paths to liberation from suffering and rebirth through ethical living and spiritual discipline.

Core Teachings

1. Buddha's path: The Four Noble Truths diagnose suffering (dukkha), its cause (samudaya), its cessation (nirodha) and the path through the Noble Eightfold Path, a middle way between indulgence and asceticism.
2. Mahavira's path: The Triratna of right faith, right knowledge and right conduct, anchored in strict non-violence (ahimsa) and self-discipline, purifies the soul from karmic bondage.

Shared Features

1. Rejection of Vedic authority and caste: Both denied the infallibility of the Vedas and rejected caste distinctions, promoting spiritual equality. They preached in vernacular languages, reaching beyond Brahmanical elites, and built monastic

Practice 1(b) on Ghissu →
Exam-hall thinking for this question · relevant toppers' answers · related questions from other Mains exams
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Scan to practice

Buddha and Mahavira

Buddha	Mahavira
Four Noble Truths	Triratna
Middle way	Strict asceticism
No eternal soul (anatman)	Eternal soul bound by karma
Moderate non-violence	Extreme ahimsa

orders (sangha) to institutionalise their paths.

2. Ethical emphasis: Non-violence was paramount. Jainism took extreme care to avoid harm to any being, while Buddhism advocated compassion balanced with engagement in the world.

Differences and Outcomes

1. Soul and salvation: Buddhism denied an eternal soul (anatman) and stressed meditation for nirvana; Jainism held the soul eternal, freed by asceticism.

2. Social application: Jain ahimsa limited economic activity, linking it to urban mercantile communities, while Buddhism's moderation aided its spread across Asia.

3. Historical impact: Royal patronage and Nagarjuna's Mahayana philosophy helped Buddhism flourish in India and beyond, influencing art, literature and diplomacy. Jainism stayed concentrated in trade networks and urban centres, preserving its distinct identity and ethical rigour.

Relevance Today

1. Ethical education: Their teachings of non-violence and compassion can foster social harmony and environmental consciousness.
2. Interfaith dialogue: Buddhist and Jain principles can inform modern debates on ethics, sustainability and social justice.
3. Social welfare: Gandhi's trusteeship concept, inspired by the ideal of non-possession, encourages responsible wealth distribution.

Conclusion

Rooted in non-violence, self-realisation and rejection of social hierarchies, these teachings transcend their origins. They continue to inspire efforts toward peace, justice and inclusive human progress.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
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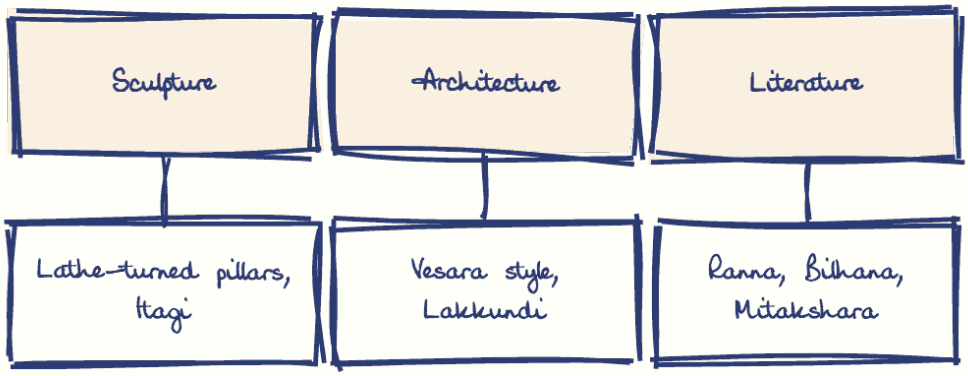
2(a) Describe the contributions of the Chalukya rulers of Kalyani in the fields of sculpture, architecture, and literature.

10

Introduction

The Chalukyas of Kalyani, also called the Western Chalukyas (973–1189 CE), shaped the cultural and artistic landscape of the Deccan. Their reign bridged early medieval traditions with later developments such as the Hoysala style, and synthesised northern and southern elements.

Kalyani Chalukya contributions



Sculpture

1. Intricate stone carving: Refined sculptures depict mythology and everyday life, as in the Ramayana scenes at the Trikuteshwara Temple in Gadag.
2. Iconographic richness: Images of Shiva and Vishnu reflect religious pluralism and patronage of

Shaivism, Vaishnavism and Jainism.

3. Lathe-turned pillars: Polished lathe-turned pillars, as in the Mahadeva Temple at Itagi, show advanced craftsmanship.

4. Integration with architecture: Ornate doorframes and reliefs, as at the Siddhesvara Temple in Haveri, enriched temple spaces.

Architecture

1. Vesara style: They pioneered the Vesara style, a hybrid of northern Nagara and southern Dravida elements, a transition in Deccan temple building.

2. Notable temples: The Kasivisvesvara Temple at Lakkundi and the Mahadeva Temple at Itagi feature complex plans, stepped tanks and lathe-turned pillars that influenced later regional styles.

3. Ornate doorways: Richly carved doorframes narrate religious stories and symbolise cosmic principles.

4. Temple-centred urbanism: Temple complexes became cultural hubs with theatres and spaces for performing arts.

Literature

1. Kannada: Royal patronage produced a golden age of

Kannada literature, with poets like Ranna, author of Saahasabheema Vijayam, and schdars who advanced grammar and lexicons.

2. Sanskrit: Bilhana's Vikramankadeva Charita chronicled the exploits of Chalukya rulers.
3. Schdarly treatises: Vijnaneswara's Mitakshara influenced Indian jurisprudence, and the Jainendra Vyakarana advanced linguistics.
4. Diverse themes: Devotional and secular works reflected the court's religious tolerance and intellectual diversity.

Way Forward

1. Heritage conservation: Stronger restoration and funding can protect Western Chalukya temples and sculptures, while tourism circuits around Lakkundi and Gadag can raise awareness.

Conclusion

The Chalukyas of Kalyani enriched Deccan sculpture, architecture and literature, synthesising northern and southern traditions. Their achievements influenced the Hoysalas and later regional styles.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

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SCAN

2(b) Describe the characteristics of the Sufi movement and assess its impact on Indian culture.

10

Introduction

The Sufi movement emerged in medieval India as a mystical and reformist strand of Islam, emphasising love, devotion and spiritual union with God. Its lasting influence on India's pluralistic culture, interfaith harmony, vernacular literature and music makes it central to our composite heritage.

Core Characteristics

1. Mystical union with God: Sufism centred on direct, personal experience of God through love, transcending formal ritual, expressed through poetry and music in the Chishti and Suhrawardi orders.
2. Universal brotherhood: Saints such as Khwaja Mainuddin Chishti and Baba Farid rejected caste and creed, welcoming followers of every background.
3. Vernacular languages: Teachings in Punjabi, Hindi, Bengali and Awadhi made spirituality accessible; Amir Khusrau blended Indian themes into Persian, and Bulleh Shah's Kafis spread Sufi ideals.

4. Silsilas and rituals: Disciples (murids) pledged devotion to pirs, and dhikr and sama used remembrance and music to reach ecstatic states.

Sufi traits and their impact

Characteristic	Impact on culture
Mystical union with God	Shared shrines, Ganga–Jamuni Tehzeeb
Egalitarian brotherhood	Influenced Akbar's tolerance
Vernacular poetry	Richer regional literature
Sama, music	Qawwali tradition

Impact on Indian Culture

1. Religious harmony: Shrines where Hindus and Muslims worshipped together fostered the Ganga–Jamuni Tehzeeb, eased tensions and influenced Akbar's religious tolerance.
2. Literature and music: Devotional poetry enriched regional literatures, and Khusrau's qawwali remains popular across religious lines.
3. Architectural heritage: Dargahs such as Ajmer Sharif and Nizamuddin Auliya's shrine are hubs of art and charity, built in a Persian–Indian blend.

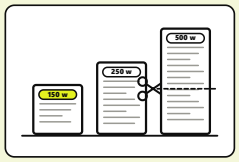
4. Spiritual reform: Stressing inner spirituality over rigid orthodoxy, Sufism bridged communities and, through interest in Yoga, widened spiritual exchange.

Way Forward

1. Heritage and education: Develop Sufi shrines for heritage tourism and include Sufi poetry in curricula.
2. Preservation: Digitally archive Sufi manuscripts, music and oral histories.

Conclusion

With its mystical devotion and egalitarianism, the Sufi movement became a pillar of India's composite culture, and its message of harmony remains relevant today.



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SCAN

3(a) Discuss the establishment of the East India Company and its early operations in India.

10

Introduction

The establishment of the East India Company in 1600 began a new phase of European engagement with India. Nationalists stress its exploitative impact, while economic historians note its role in linking India to global commerce. Its origins and early operations reveal the foundations of British rule.

Establishment of the Company

1. **Royal charter and monopoly:** On 31 December 1600, Queen Elizabeth I chartered London merchants with a 15-year monopoly of trade between the Cape of Good Hope and the Magellan Straits, to counter Iberian dominance.

2. **Motivations:** Rivalry with Spain and Portugal, better shipping, the 1588 defeat of the Spanish Armada and Ralph Fitch's reports spurred direct entry into Asia.

3. **Organisation:** A Governor and a Committee of twenty-four, elected by shareholders and overseen by a General Court of Proprietors,

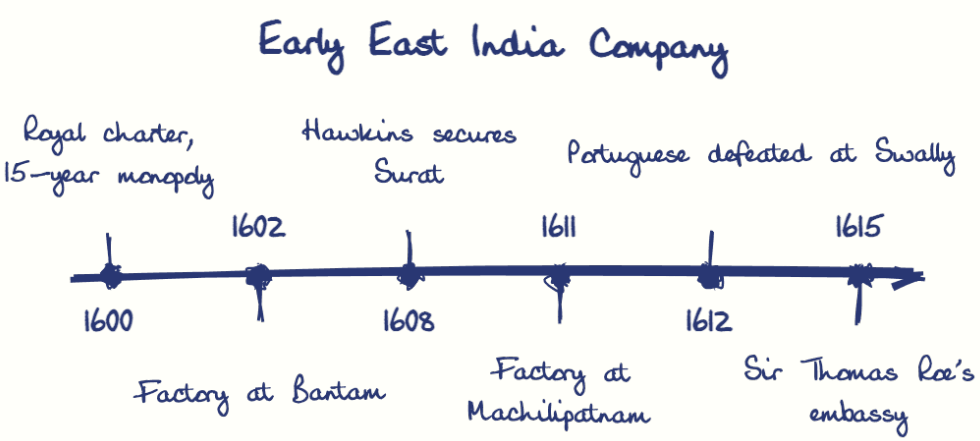
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made it an early joint-stock company.

4. Early challenges: Dutch and Portuguese control of routes and ports forced diplomatic and military effort.

Early Operations in India



1. From spices to textiles: After a factory at Bantam in 1602, weak demand for woollens turned it to prized Indian textiles.

2. Surat: In 1608 Captain Hawkins won Jahangir's permission for a factory, and the 1612 naval victory near Swally weakened the Portuguese.

3. Coromandel coast: The Globe's 1611 voyage set up a factory at Machilipatnam on the Andhra coast with Golconda's consent, opening trade with Siam and Burma.

4. Political engagement: Sir Thomas Roe's

embassy to Jahangir in 1615 sought a firman for trade privileges.

Significance

1. Economy: Textile trade integrated India into world markets but disrupted artisan production.
2. Politics: Exploiting Mughal and Golconda rivalries and weakening the Portuguese set a precedent for territorial expansion.
3. Society: Factories at Surat and Machilipatnam spurred urban growth and cultural exchange.

Conclusion

The Company began as a trading body, but its diplomacy and military strength slowly blurred commerce and governance, laying the base of colonial dominance.

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SCAN

3(b) What impact did the activities of Christian missionaries have on Indian society and culture?

10

Introduction

The impact of Christian missionaries is debated by nationalist, Marxist and subaltern scholars. After the Charter Act of 1813 allowed their work, missions expanded under British rule, especially in tribal and marginalised regions, shaping debates on identity, reform and pluralism.

Impact on Indian Society

1. **Education:** Schools and colleges, such as the Church Missionary Society's institutions in Andhra Pradesh, gave free education and vocational training to the poor and women, creating a new class of reformers and nationalists.
2. **Social reform:** Missionaries campaigned against sati, child marriage and female infanticide alongside Raja Ram Mohan Roy aiding legislative reform.
3. **Gender equality:** Zenana classes, widow remarriage and female education challenged patriarchy; early women graduates were mostly Christians.
4. **Medical aid and relief:** Dispensaries, hospitals and famine and epidemic relief served the needy.

5. Tribal transformation: Conversion among the Oraons, North Eastern tribes and Mahars brought self-respect and mobility but eroded institutions like youth dormitories.

Impact on Indian Culture

1. Hybridisation: Western dress, language and art fused with Indian traditions in architecture and literature, especially among the young.
2. Languages and literature: Translations enriched vernaculars, while English education spread global ideas and nationalist awakening.
3. Identity challenges: Association with colonialism and conversion created identity conflicts for converts, who sometimes faced exclusion, worsened by rising intolerance today.

Missionary impact: a balance sheet

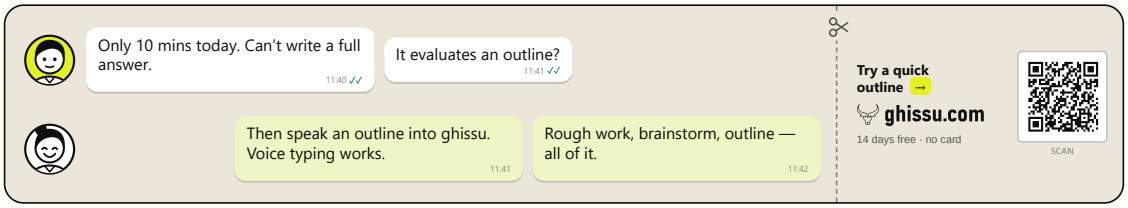
Gains	Costs
Literacy, women's education	Cultural alienation
Sati, child marriage opposed	Tribal customs disrupted
Vernaculars, nationalist awakening	Identity conflicts

Way Forward

1. Inclusive cultural dialogue: Respectful exchange that recognises India's composite culture while preserving indigenous traditions.
2. Secular education: Balance modern knowledge with cultural sensitivity to reduce alienation among minorities.
3. Legal protection: Enforce constitutional safeguards so religious minorities face no discrimination.
4. Community empowerment: Participatory welfare in tribal and marginalised areas that respects cultural autonomy.

Conclusion

Missionaries advanced education, women's status and reform, yet also caused cultural alienation and tensions. Inclusive dialogue and constitutional safeguards for minorities can preserve the gains while respecting indigenous traditions.



4(a) What do you understand by the Permanent Settlement, and what impact did it have on Indian society? Comment.

10

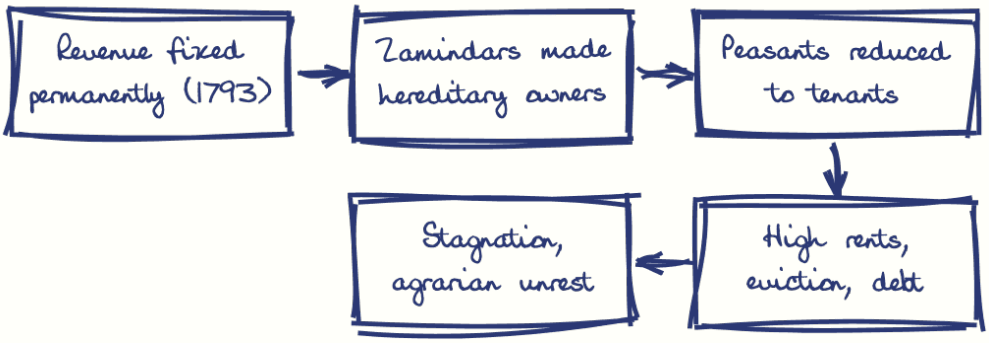
Introduction

The Permanent Settlement of 1793, introduced by Lord Cornwallis in Bengal, Bihar and Orissa, fixed land tax permanently with zamindars, making them hereditary landowners. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians see it as exploitative with deep social consequences.

Meaning and Features

1. Fixed revenue demand: The tax zamindars paid was fixed forever, giving the colonial state revenue stability.
2. Zamindars as landowners: Collectors became hereditary landowners, collecting rent from peasants and paying a fixed sum.
3. Peasants as tenants: Ryots lost traditional land rights and became tenants liable to eviction for non-payment.
4. Revenue pressure: Zamindars kept any surplus, but failure to pay meant their estates were auctioned to new landlords.

Logic of the Permanent Settlement



Impact on Indian Society

1. **New landlord class:** Hereditary zamindars entrenched feudal structures, exploiting peasants through high rents and forced labour.
2. **Peasant distress:** Loss of rights and heavy rents caused indebtedness, poverty and eviction, fuelling agrarian unrest.
3. **Agricultural stagnation:** Zamindars focused on extraction rather than improvement, so output stagnated and declined.
4. **Social disruption and resistance:** Traditional village communities were disrupted, provoking peasant uprisings and anti-zamindari agitations that later shaped the freedom struggle.

Comment

It succeeded in its colonial aim of stable revenue, but at the cost of peasant welfare. It froze a hierarchy of landlord over tenant that outlasted

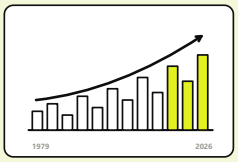
British rule.

Way Forward

1. Land reforms: Dismantle landlordism and secure cultivators' tenure.
2. Tenant protection: Enforce laws against eviction and exploitation.
3. Rural investment: Infrastructure and technology to raise productivity.

Conclusion

The Permanent Settlement institutionalised a landlord-based system that sowed seeds of resistance. Addressing its legacy through land reforms and rural empowerment remains essential for inclusive agrarian development.



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4(b) What do you understand by the 'safety valve' theory? Explain it in the context of the Indian National Congress?

10

Introduction

The 'safety valve' theory is an interpretation of the origins of the Indian National Congress (INC). It suggests that the British administration supported the INC as a controlled outlet to channel Indian political discontent and so prevent more radical upheavals.

Meaning of the 'Safety Valve' Theory

1. Conceptual Origin: The theory rests on secret reports read by A.O. Hume, founder of the INC, in 1878, and was popularised in William Wedderburn's 1913 biography of Hume.
2. Mechanism of Control: Under Lord Dufferin, the British allowed moderate elites to express grievances through petitions and resolutions instead of violent rebellion, safeguarding colonial rule.
3. Critical Interpretation: Extremists like Lala Lajpat Rai and Marxist historians like R.P. Dutt viewed the INC as a colonial conspiracy to abort popular uprisings by co-opting Indian leaders into a controlled political dialogue,

thereby neutralising revolutionary potential.

4. Modern Nuance: Bipan Chandra argues the safety valve was only part of the story; Indian leaders used Hume strategically to organise nationalist forces under colonial constraints.

Safety valve: theory and critique

Safety valve view	Counter view
Hume, Dufferin: controlled outlet	Genuine reform demands
Petitions, controlled dissent	Leaders used Hume strategically
Lajpat Rai, Dutt: conspiracy	Bipan Chandra: partial truth
Explains early Congress	Became mass freedom vehicle

The Theory in the Context of the INC

1. Channelling Discontent: The early INC gave educated Indians a non-violent forum to criticise British policies, as in the 1896 resolution blaming British rule for famines. This helped prevent spontaneous violent uprisings.

2. Moderate Leadership: Dadabhai Naoroji, Gopal Krishna Gokhale and Dinshaw

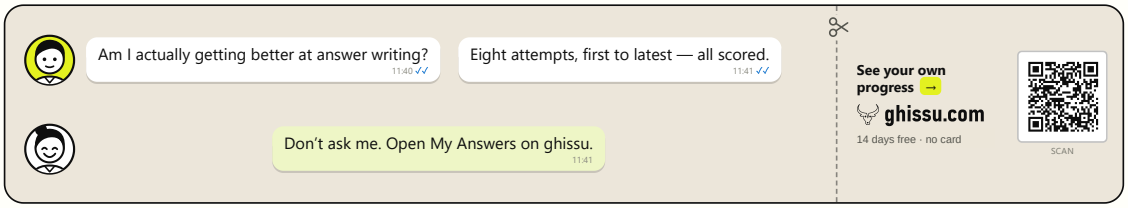
Wacha worked within the framework the British allowed, focusing on petitions and reforms. This matched the idea of controlled dissent.

3. Limits and Transition: After the partition of Bengal in 1905 and failed reforms, leaders like Bal Gangadhar Tilak rejected the safety valve role.

4. Catalyst for Nationalism: Despite its origins, the INC evolved into the principal vehicle of the freedom struggle, mobilising the masses through the Swadeshi and Quit India movements. This shows the theory explains only its initial phase.

Conclusion

The theory captures the British strategy of managing dissent in the Congress's formative years. Yet the INC transcended that role to become a genuine expression of Indian nationalism and the main vehicle of independence. Recognising this duality gives a balanced understanding of India's freedom struggle.



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5(a) Discuss the role and contributions of the moderate leaders of Congress from 1885 to 1905.

10

Introduction

The period 1885–1905 was the formative phase of the Indian National Congress, dominated by moderate leaders who believed in constitutional methods and gradual reform. Nationalist schdars praise their foundational rde, while Marxist and subattern historians criticise their elitism.

Rde of the Moderates

1. Constitutional Nationalism: Dadabhai Naorji, Pherozeshah Mehta and Gopal Krishna Gokhale used petitions, speeches and resdutions to influence British pdicy within legal frameworks.
2. Bridge to the British: As English-educated professionals and property owners, they trusted British liberalism and sought cooperation.
3. Pditical Educators: They fostered national unity across regions and communities and built a pdblic opinion that could gradually compel the British to concede reforms.
4. Elitist Limits: Their social composition made the Congress an annual gathering of elites, not a mass movement able to address grassroots grievances.

Moderates: contributions and limits

Contributions	Limitations
Congress as all-India forum	Annual elite gathering
Drain Theory exposed exploitation	Ignored peasants, labour
Indian Councils Act 1892	Only slight reform
Political awareness, unity	Slow pace bred Extremists

Contributions to the Freedom Struggle

1. **Institutionalising Nationalism:** They made the Congress the first all-India political forum, articulating Indian aspirations on a national scale.

2. **Exposing Economic Exploitation:** Naoroji's Drain Theory exposed British policies that impoverished India, linking political demands with economic justice.

3. **Legislative Reforms:** They secured the Indian Councils Act of 1892, expanding Indian representation.

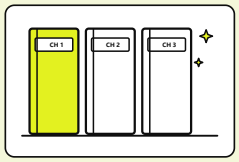
4. **Political Awareness:** Political education nurtured consciousness among the educated classes, preparing the ground for future mass movements.

Impact and Limitations

1. Pan-Indian Identity: Their efforts laid the ground for a pan-Indian political identity and a culture of constitutional agitation.
2. Catalyst for Radicalisation: Limited success, slow reforms and neglect of peasant and labour distress led to the rise of Extremists like Bal Gangadhar Tilak, who demanded more assertive action.
3. Elitist Disconnect: Their failure to engage the masses exposed the limits of elite-led nationalism.

Conclusion

The moderates laid the foundation of organised nationalism. Their faith in dialogue set a precedent for constitutional politics, while their limits showed the need to combine constitutional methods with mass mobilisation.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

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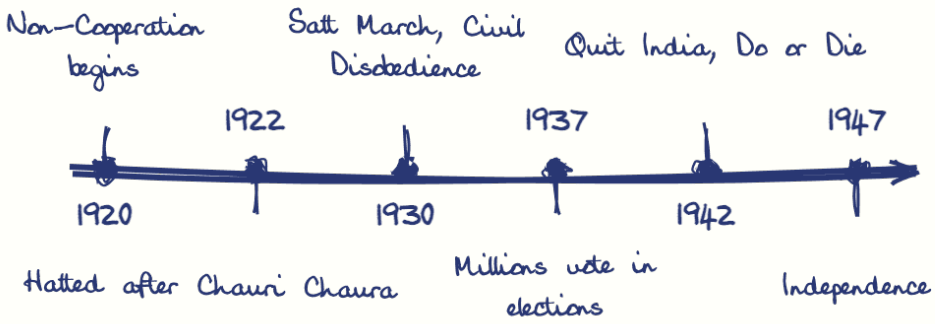
5(b) Describe the major movements led by Mahatma Gandhi between 1920 and 1947.

10

Introduction

The period 1920–1947 saw mass movements led by Mahatma Gandhi that transformed the freedom struggle from elite politics into a national campaign. Through non-violent resistance and civil disobedience he mobilised millions, and his movements also sought social reform and communal harmony.

Gandhi's mass movements



Non-Cooperation Movement (1920–1922)

1. Cause: It responded to the Rowlatt Act and the Jallianwala Bagh massacre and was Gandhi's first large-scale mass movement in India.

2. Methods: Stressing non-violence and moral resistance, it aimed to delegitimise British rule

by boycotting foreign goods, schools, courts and titles. It promoted Khadi and village industries for self-reliance.

3. Participation: It sought Hindu-Muslim unity and drew in peasants, workers, women and students.

4. Outcome: It made the Congress a mass organisation and promoted reforms like eradicating untouchability. Though it ended after the Chauri Chaura incident, it laid the foundation for future mass mobilisation.

Civil Disobedience Movement (1930-1934)

1. Cause and Method: Sparked by the Salt March in 1930, it involved peaceful law-breaking, such as the symbolic making of salt at Dandi, and refusal to pay taxes, asserting India's right to self-rule.

2. Participation: Women and peasants took part actively, and parallel national schools and panchayats were set up.

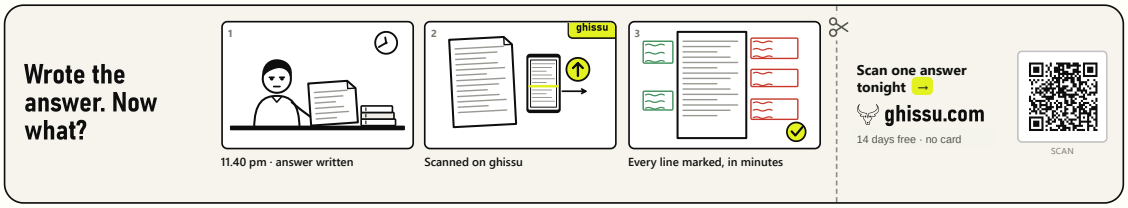
3. Outcome: It revitalised the struggle, drew international attention and forced the British to negotiate the Gandhi-Irwin Pact. Millions later voted in the 1937 elections under the Government of India Act.

Quit India Movement (1942–1945)

1. **Demand:** Launched during World War II, it called for immediate British withdrawal with the slogan "Do or Die".
2. **Methods:** Mass protests, strikes and sabotage marked it. Despite Gandhi's insistence on non-violence, it met brutal repression and the imprisonment of leaders.
3. **Outcome:** Though suppressed, it was the final mass upsurge against British rule, uniting diverse groups and weakening British authority.

Conclusion

Gandhi's movements integrated political resistance with social reform and mass participation. Each movement widened participation and raised the intensity of the struggle, from boycott to law-breaking to a direct call to quit. Together they challenged colonial rule and laid the groundwork for a democratic and inclusive India.



6(a) Examine the impact of the loss of Hyderabad as the capital city on post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh. How did this transition affect the state's administrative, economic, and socio-cultural landscape?

10

Introduction

The 2014 bifurcation created Telangana with Hyderabad as its capital, which served as a joint capital for ten years. Losing this economic and administrative hub deeply influenced the administrative structure, economic prospects and socio-cultural fabric of post-bifurcation Andhra Pradesh.

Andhra Pradesh after losing Hyderabad



New capital, coast and Pdavaram as growth anchors

Administrative Challenges

1. **Loss of infrastructure:** Key government offices, the common High Court and institutions stayed in Hyderabad, forcing AP to build a capital from scratch and causing service delays.
2. **Joint capital ambiguity:** Under the Reorganisation Act, 2014, law and order in Hyderabad stayed with Telangana's Governor, limiting AP's autonomy.
3. **Amaravati:** The 2026 amendment finalised Amaravati as capital, but required massive investment, straining finances and capacity.
4. **e-Governance:** Initiatives like e-Seva maintained continuity despite relocation.

Economic Consequences

1. **Revenue loss:** Telangana retained Hyderabad's IT and pharmaceutical tax base, and the CAG noted a quadrupling of AP's revenue deficit.
2. **New industrial base:** AP focused on corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai, though early growth slowed without a major city.
3. **Coastal and agrarian focus:** The 974 km coastline, aquaculture, horticulture and the Polavaram project became central.

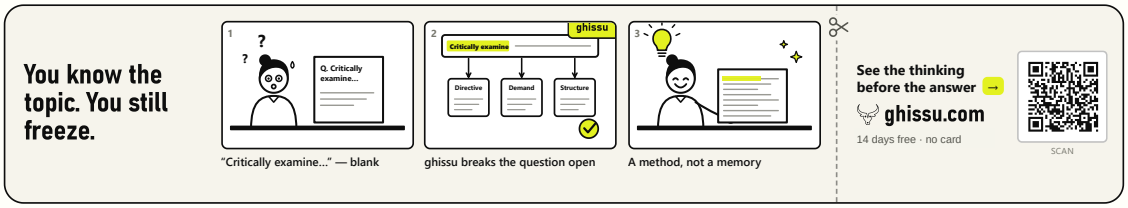
4. Fiscal stress: High deficits limit capital spending despite projected GSDP growth of 9.24% in 2024–25.

Socio-Cultural Changes

1. Identity: Amaravati's historical and Buddhist heritage symbolises a distinct Andhra identity.
2. Migration: Employees and professionals moved to the capital region, creating urbanisation challenges.
3. Integration: Diverse groups from coastal and Rayalaseema regions had to be integrated while managing community aspirations in the new capital zone.
4. Heritage: Amaravati's planning seeks to balance historical legacy with modern urban design.

Conclusion

Losing Hyderabad strained Andhra Pradesh's administration and finances, but it also pushed the state to build a new capital, economy and identity.



6(b) Discuss the vision behind building a new capital for Andhra Pradesh after the bifurcation in 2014. Critically assess the financial implications involved in the planning, development, and partial execution of Amaravati as the capital city.

10

Introduction

The 2014 bifurcation left Andhra Pradesh without a capital after it lost Hyderabad to Telangana. The capital was to be a seat of governance and a symbol of unity, so Amaravati was envisioned as a modern, inclusive and strategically located city to drive growth and regional integration.

Amaravati at the centre of the state



On the Krishna, to unite all three regions

Vision Behind the New Capital

1. Governance autonomy: It would let the state govern itself, ending the humiliation of administering it from another state's capital.
2. Historical significance: Located on the right bank of the Krishna in Guntur district, it was the ancient Satavahana capital, symbolising cultural continuity.
3. Regional integration and water: The site aimed to unite Rayalaseema, Coastal and North Andhra, with Krishna water to avoid failures like Fatehpur Sikri.
4. Legal finality: The Reorganisation (Amendment) Bill, 2026 finalised Amaravati as capital after a decade of uncertainty.

Financial Implications: A Critical Assessment

1. Fiscal stress: Large capital outlays added to stress, with capital expenditure at a five-year low of 0.55% of GSDP in 2022–23 amid rising deficits.
2. Land pooling controversies: Allegations of insider trading and corruption brought judicial scrutiny, delays and loss of trust.
3. Partial execution: Development remains incomplete,

with offices functioning temporarily from Velagapudi.

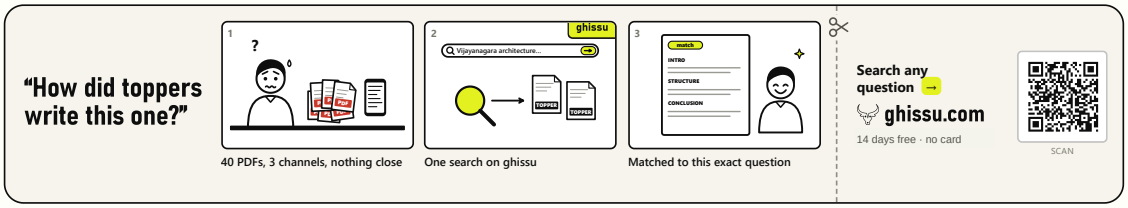
4. Competing priorities: Its burden, with rising committed spending and subsidies, squeezed projects like Polavaram.

Way Forward

1. Fiscal discipline: Efficient capital spending and contrd of committed expenditure can finance the capital sustainably.
2. Transparent land governance: Stronger legal frameworks for land poding can restore public confidence.
3. Phased development: Balancing Amaravati with regional development and using multilateral support can spread benefits.

Conclusion

Amaravati embodies aspirations of self-governance, cultural pride and growth, but its planning and partial execution have strained state finances. Disciplined, inclusive execution can realise the goal of "Swarna Andhra Pradesh".



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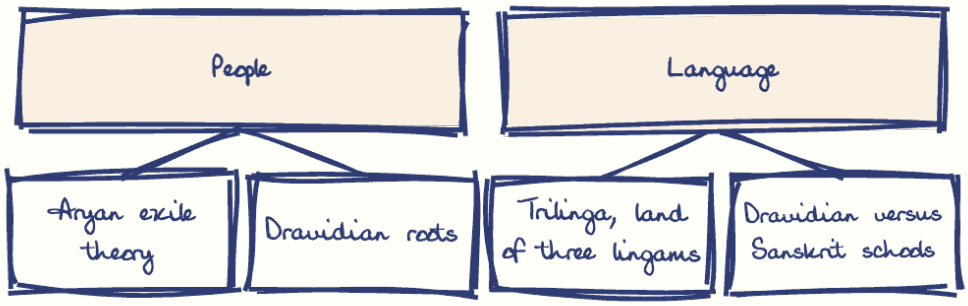
7(a) What are the various stories about the origins of Andhra people and the Andhra language?

10

Introduction

The origins of the Andhra people and their language, Telugu, have long been debated. The varied narratives show intersections of Aryan, Dravidian and tribal influences and help explain Telugu's evolution as a classical language.

Stories of Andhra origins



Stories of the Andhra People

1. **Aryan Exile Theory:** The Aitareya Brahmana and Mahabharata place the Andhras as a northern Aryan tribe expelled for cultural deviation, such as opposing human sacrifice, who migrated south of the Vindhyas.
2. **Dravidian Roots:** Some scholars see them as a Dravidian-speaking southern tribe that moved north temporarily and returned home, stressing a

deep indigenous origin.

3. Syncretic Assimilation: A third view holds they were a non-Aryan northern tribe that gradually absorbed Aryan culture, explaining their mixed traits.

4. Early Political History: The Andhras are linked to the Satavahanas, among the earliest Deccan powers, and later the Kakatiyas and Vijayanagara consolidated Telugu identity through literature, temple art and administration.

Stories of the Andhra Language

1. Folk Etymologies: Andhra Basha is linked to King Agnimitra regaining sight and learning a new language from the Sun God, while Telugu is said to derive from Trilinga, the land of three lingams.

2. Dravidian versus Sanskrit Schools: Bishop Caldwell championed the Dravidian school, while others stressed Sanskrit's role in Telugu vocabulary and grammar.

3. Gradual Formation: Telugu emerged only after the 6th century AD, as early Andhras likely spoke Prakrits such as Paisachi before local dialects merged.

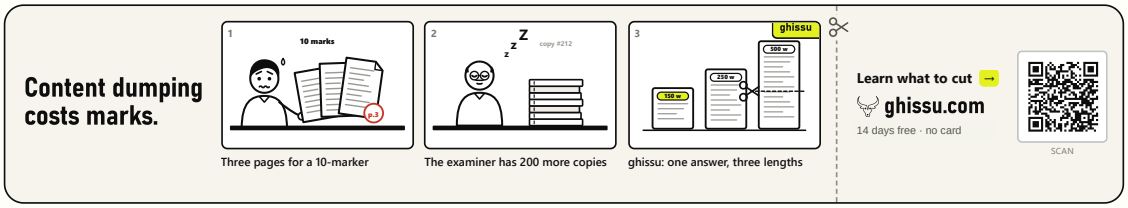
4. Political Role: Journals like Deshabhimani and the Andhra Mahasabha fostered pride, leading to Andhra Pradesh as the first linguistic state in 1956.

Ethnic Diversity

1. Tribal Layers: Tribes like the Chenchu, Konda Reddi and Gonds, speaking Dravidian, Austric and Indo-European languages, add depth to Andhra identity.
2. Intermixture: Migrations and cultural contact over centuries produced linguistic and ethnic intermixture.

Conclusion

The many stories of Andhra origins reveal an identity built from Aryan, Dravidian and tribal strands, unified over centuries by the Telugu language and asserted anew after the state's bifurcation in 2014.



7(b) How did far trade routes contribute to the exchange of Buddhist ideas in ancient Andhra?

10

Introduction

Ancient Andhra was a vibrant hub strategically placed on trade routes that linked the subcontinent with distant lands. These routes carried not only goods but also ideas, and Buddhism found fertile ground in Andhra's prosperous society.

Trade routes and Buddhist centres of ancient Andhra



Trade Routes of Ancient Andhra

1. **Strategic Network:** An east-west corridor from Machilipatnam and Vinukonda, converging near

Hyderabad, linked the coast to the Deccan interior and major urban centres.

2. Maritime and Inland Links: Krishna delta ports like Machilipatnam traded with Southeast Asia and the Roman world, while the Krishna and Tungabhadra valleys gave safe inland routes.
3. Merchant Patronage: Trade enriched Gahapatis and Setthis, who funded stupas and monasteries at Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda.
4. Security: Merchants travelled in caravans, and rulers built rest-houses and ferries, which also eased the movement of monks.

Mechanisms of Exchange

1. Monks and Merchants: Monks travelled with traders on the same routes, and merchants acted as conduits for teachings through contact and patronage.
2. Monastic Centres: Monasteries at Amaravati, Nagarjunakonda and Bhattiprolu became centres of learning where ideas were exchanged and preserved.
3. Texts and Iconography: Pali and Sanskrit texts travelled along the routes, and Andhra-style Buddha images at Dong-duong in Vietnam show

this diffusion.

4. Local Synthesis: Buddhism absorbed local animistic and tribal beliefs, widening its acceptance.

Impact

1. Missionary Reach: Andhra became a launch pad for missions to Ceylon, Burma and Southeast Asia.

2. Scholarship and Art: Trade wealth supported Buddhaghosa, who composed the Visuddhimagga at Nagarjunakonda, and monuments like the Amaravati Stupa.

3. Limits: Political change and the rise of Brahmanical traditions later overshadowed Buddhism, and disruptions on the routes sometimes broke the flow of exchange.

Conclusion

For trade routes made Andhra a crossroads of commerce and Buddhist thought. Merchant wealth, travelling monks and thriving monasteries together carried Andhra's Buddhist culture across Asia, a legacy worth preserving at Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda.

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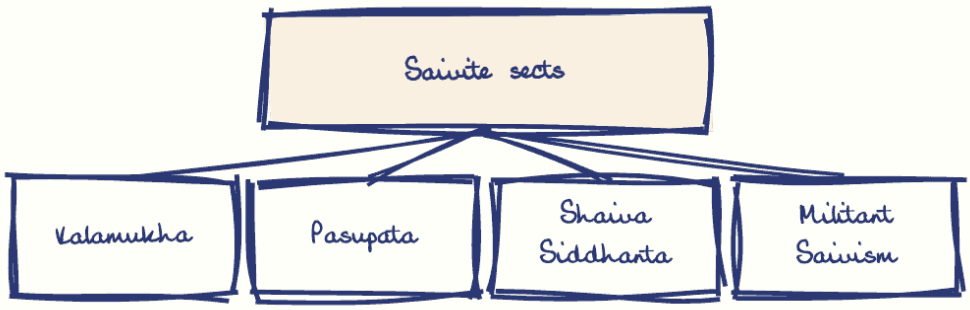
8(a) Discuss the growth of various Saivite sects during the Kakatiya rule.

10

Introduction

The Kakatiya dynasty ruled the Telugu regions, including Warangal, from the 12th to the 14th century. Jainism declined while various Saivite sects flourished, shaping both the spiritual landscape and the social fabric of medieval Andhra.

Saivism under the Kakatiyas



Saivite Sects under the Kakatiyas

1. **Kalamukha Sect:** Known for a liberal stance on caste and devotion to Shiva, it initiated early Kakatiyas like Rudradeva and popularised Saivism.
2. **Pasupata Sect:** This ascetic sect, known for rigorous practice and temple building, is linked to the Rudreswara temple at Anamakonda.

3. Shaiva Siddhanta: Stressing ritual worship and Shiva as supreme, it gained royal patronage and consdidated Saivism.
4. Militant Saivism: ~~After~~ Prda II, a staunch Saivite identity sometimes led to clashes with Jain communities.

Factors behind Their Grouth

1. Royal Patronage: Rudradeva and Ganapati Deva gave land grants and resources for Saivite temples.
2. Decline of Jainism: Jain temples were converted into Saivite shrines, such as the Padmashi temple at Anamakonda.
3. Local Integration: Sects absorbed tribal and lower-caste groups, and the Sudra-origin Kakatiyas symbolised this inclusive trend.
4. Temples and Rituals: The Ramappa temple and Warangal fort gateways became centres of Saivite worship and cutture.

Impact of Saivite Sects

1. Social Integration: The adoption of Dalits by figures like Brahma Nayudu challenged rigid caste and fostered mobility.

2. Arts: The sects patronised temple arts like the Madanikas (dancing figurines) of Ramappa and performing arts like Perini Shivatandavam, hallmarks of Kakatiya identity.

3. Conflict: Militancy led to clashes with Jains, the decline of Jainism and the transformation of religious spaces, showing the interplay of tolerance and conflict.

4. Literature: Saivite poets like Palkurki Somanatha enriched Telugu literature with the Panditaradhya Charitra.

Way Forward

1. Heritage: Conserving Ramappa and Rudreswara and reviving Perini Shivatandavam can sustain this legacy.

Conclusion

The growth of Saivite sects followed a clear chain: royal patronage led to temple building, temples drew in diverse groups, and this integration made Saivism dominant. Saivism thus shaped Kakatiya Andhra's art, literature and social order.

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8(b) Discuss the significance of the Warangal Fort complex as a historical monument.

10

Introduction

The Warangal Fort complex is a monumental testament to the Kakatiya dynasty 's architectural ingenuity and political power in medieval South India. It remains a symbol of the regional identity of Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, and its preservation links past legacies with present cultural consciousness.

Historical and Cultural Significance

1. Kakatiya Legacy: It was the capital stronghold under Ganapati Deva and Rudrama Devi, a golden era of literature, art and governance.
2. Cultural Syncretism: Temples and shrines within its walls were centres of spiritual and social life.
3. Regional Identity: The fort connects Telugu society with its roots, fostering pride and continuity.

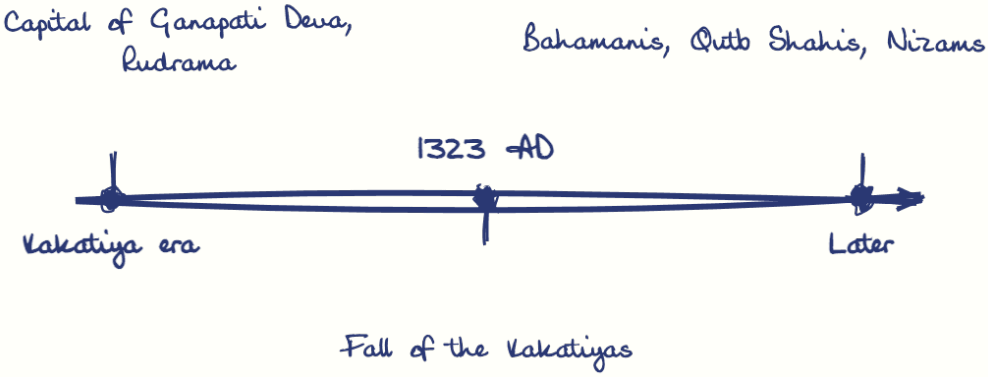
Architectural and Urban Features

1. Concentric Fortifications: An inner granite wall of 1.2 km diameter with 45 bastions and an outer mud fortification of 2.4 km

diameter show advanced defensive planning.

2. Engineering Excellence: Rows of steps along the walls gave easy access to ramparts, and a security tower stood atop Ekasila Hill.
3. Water Management: Tanks and reservoirs inside reflect integrated urban planning.
4. Architectural Relics: The Swayambhu temple complex and the four toranas mark the zenith of Kakatiya craftsmanship.

Layers of Warangal Fort



Role in Regional History

1. Political Centre: The fort was the hub of the kingdom and resisted invasions until the 14th century.
2. Heritage Layering: Bahamanis, Qutb Shahis and Nizams later ruled it, each adding

layers.

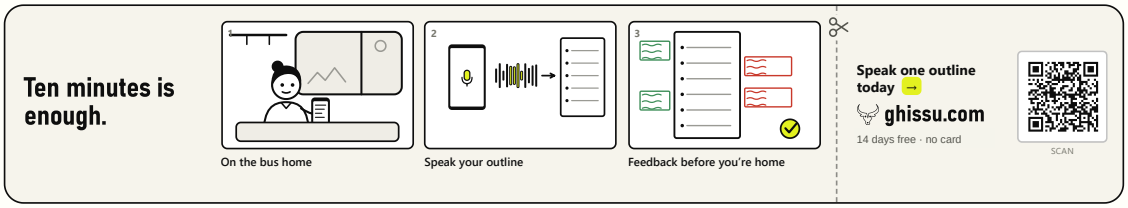
3. Neglect: After the fall of the Kakatiyas in 1323 AD, damage left it partly in ruin.

Way Forward

1. Conservation: Structural stabilisation under the ASI's National Mission on Monuments and Antiquities.
2. Heritage Circuit: Linking it with Bhongir and Golconda, with better interpretation facilities, can boost cultural tourism in Telangana.
3. Community and Digital Effort: Awareness drives in Warangal district and digital documentation can build stewardship and public access.

Conclusion

Warangal Fort is not merely a relic of the past but a living heritage that embodies the cultural ethos and historical resilience of Telangana and Andhra Pradesh. Conserving it keeps the Kakatiya legacy visible to future generations.



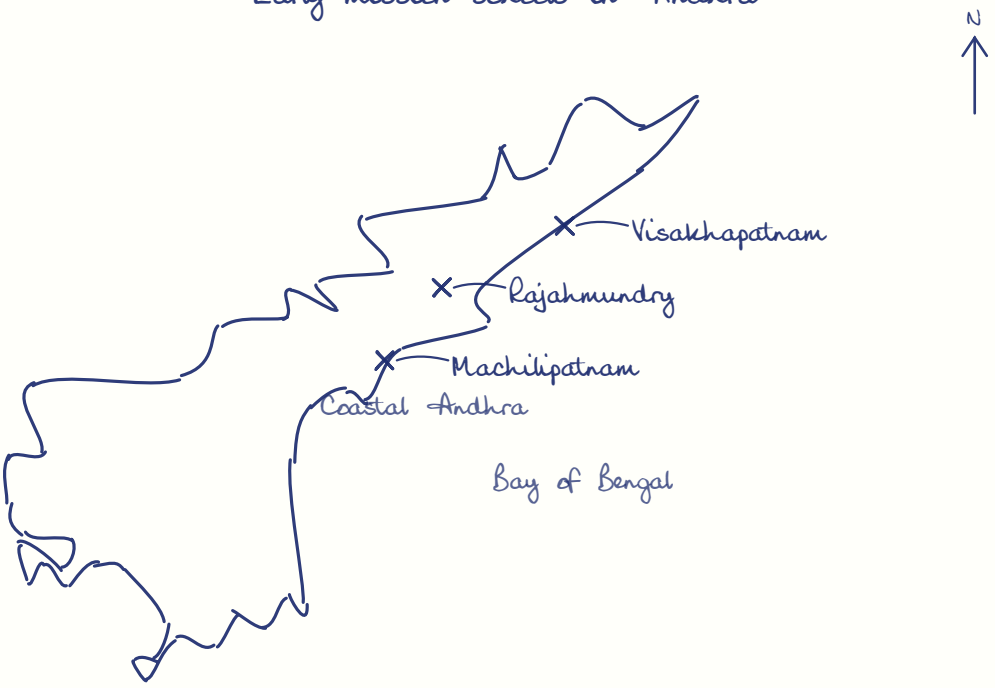
9(a) Discuss the role of missionaries in the growth and spread of education in Andhra region.

10

Introduction

Christian missionaries played a significant role in Andhra's educational development from the early 19th century. Their work coincided with the rise of Western education under British rule and helped shape the region's modern educational landscape.

Early mission schools in Andhra



CMS school at Machilipatnam, 1843

Contribution to Educational Growth

1. **Educational Institutions:** The Church Missionary Society's school at Machilipatnam in 1843 later

became a college, and secondary and technical schools followed in Rajahmundry and Visakhapatnam.

2. Curriculum Innovation: History, geography and grammar were taught with religious instruction, and English education created a Western-educated elite.

3. Female Education: Girls' schools and zenana classes were a pioneering effort, and early women graduates in Andhra were mostly Christians.

4. Welfare with Education: Free medical aid and famine relief made institutions centres of community support.

Social and Cultural Impact

1. Social Reform: With local reformers, missionaries challenged child marriage, female infanticide and the devadasi system.

2. New Social Elite: Their students led Andhra's reform and nationalist movements.

3. Telugu Literacy: Translations and primers promoted Telugu alongside English.

4. Cultural Tensions: Proselytisation alienated some communities, though there was no compulsion to convert and Hindu scriptures were taught alongside

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the Bible.

Spread of Education

1. Grants-in-Aid: The British supported mission schools through grants-in-aid, spreading schooling in coastal and tribal areas.
2. Filling Gaps: Missions reached remote regions where public education was absent.
3. Legacy: Many mission institutions still operate, and their focus on girls echoes Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive Education: Building on this legacy, targeted schemes and public-private partnerships can widen quality education for marginalised communities.
2. Cultural Sensitivity: Curricula should respect local traditions while keeping modern values.

Conclusion

Missionaries pioneered modern, female and vernacular education in Andhra. Despite criticism of proselytisation and cultural imperialism, they laid lasting foundations of schooling in the region and shaped the elite that led its awakening.

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9(b) What factors contributed to the process of social awakening in the Andhra region in the second half of the 19th century?

10

Introduction

The social awakening in Andhra in the second half of the 19th century laid the foundation for modern socio-political consciousness. It was part of the broader Indian renaissance shaped by Western education, missionary activity and nationalist ideas, as Andhra moved from tradition towards reform.

Key Factors

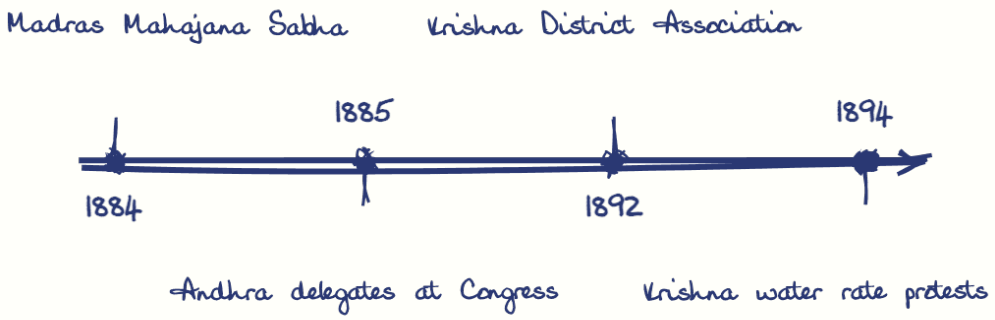
1. **Socio-Religious Reform:** The Brahmo Samaj, with branches in Rajahmundry, Masulipatnam and Kakinada, challenged orthodoxy and superstition. Kandukuri Veeresalingam championed widow remarriage and women's education.
2. **Education and Print Culture:** English education and Telugu journalism raised awareness. Andhra Prakasika and Krishna Patrika boldly criticised government policies and social evils.
3. **Personalities and Organisations:** P. Rangaiah Naidu and P. Anandacharyulu led mobilisation, while the Madras Mahajana Sabha (1884) and the Krishna District Association (1892) gave platforms for dialogue.

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These factors were interlinked: reform inspired education, which empowered leaders and associations.

Organised awakening in Andhra



Resulting Social Changes

1. Erosion of Social Evils: Caste orthodoxy and superstition weakened, and rationalism and women's rights gained ground.
2. Political Consciousness: Andhra delegates attended Indian National Congress sessions from (1885), linking reform with nationalism.
3. Mobilisation: Protests against the water rate hike in Krishna district in (1894) showed the political agency of peasants and the middle class, setting the stage for later mass movements.
4. Cultural Renaissance: Modern Telugu literature became a vehicle of reform, from Veeresalingam's novel Rajasekhara Charitramu (1878) to Gurajada

Apparao's play Kanyasulkam (1892), which satirised bride-price and orthodoxy.

Way Forward

1. Education and Inclusion: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan, Mission Shakti and ICDS can carry this reformist legacy to rural Andhra and address gender and caste gaps.

Conclusion

Reform movements, education and visionary leadership together dismantled regressive norms in Andhra and sowed the seeds of the political consciousness that fed India's freedom struggle, creating a society more rooted in equality and knowledge.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TREND ANALYSIS, PER SUB-TOPIC

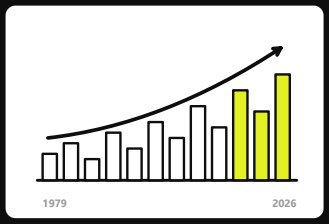
Read a chapter's past before its pages

Twenty minutes of this before a new chapter tells you where to spend the next twenty hours.

1. **List** — Every question asked from the chapter in the last ten years.
2. **Circle** — Sub-topics asked twice or more.
3. **Notice the shift** — Facts to analysis? National to State? Old to current?
4. **Read** — The circled sub-topics first; the rest second.

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Every syllabus topic already has its trend analysis: direction of travel, most tested sub-topic, probable next theme.



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SCAN

10(a) What were the provisions of the Gentlemen's Agreement of 1956? How far could they satisfy apprehensions of the Telangana region?

10

Introduction

The Gentlemen's Agreement of 1956 was a pivotal accord to address Telangana's concerns during the formation of Andhra Pradesh. Signed by leaders of both regions, it sought to ease fears of economic and political domination by the more developed Andhra region, balancing regional interests within a newly merged state.

Key Provisions

1. Proportional finance: Central and general administration expenses were to be shared on a pro-rata basis.
2. Telangana surplus: Any surplus revenue from Telangana was reserved for its own development.
3. Review mechanism: The arrangement was to be reviewed after five years, at the demand of Telangana legislators.
4. Prohibition: The liquor ban in Telangana was to follow its legislators' preferences.
5. Education: Admissions were either restricted

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to Telangana students or one-third of technical seats reserved for them.

6. Jobs: Retrenchment was to be proportional and recruitment based on the population ratio of the two regions.
7. Urdu: Urdu was to continue as an administrative and judicial language for five years, with a regional council to review it.

Promise and practice

Provision	Outcome
Telangana surplus reserved	Funds diverted to Andhra
Jobs by population ratio	Andhra personnel dominated
Urdu and regional council	Temporary, insufficient
Five-year review	Weak enforcement, 1969 agitation

How Far Apprehensions Were Satisfied

1. Partial economic safeguards: Despite the reserved surplus, Telangana felt its funds were diverted to Andhra projects, fuelling grievances of neglect.
2. Employment and education: Implementation fattered,

many alleged discrimination and the dominance of Andhra personnel in government jobs.

3. Cultural autonomy: Urdu's continuation and the regional council helped preserve identity, but were temporary and insufficient.

4. Political review: The five-year review was a democratic safeguard, but limited political influence and weak enforcement culminated in the 1969 Telangana agitation.

Way Forward

Genuine regional autonomy, transparent audits of regional funds and legally backed local job safeguards can build the trust the agreement lacked.

Conclusion

The Gentlemen's Agreement was a well-intentioned effort to harmonise Telangana's interests within Andhra Pradesh, but partial implementation left many fears unresolved. Equitable development and political inclusion remain the lesson.



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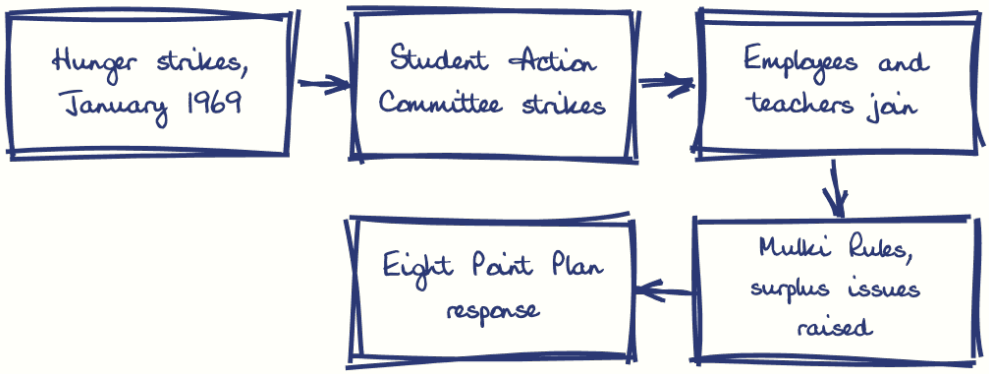
10(b) Outline the role of the students in raising major issues in the 1969 Telangana agitation.

10

Introduction

The 1969 Telangana agitation was a critical juncture in Telangana's political history, reflecting deep discontent over perceived injustices after the formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1956. Students emerged as its pivotal force, channelling grievances into organised protest and political action, and their role shaped the course of the whole movement.

Students in the 1969 agitation



Contributions and Actions of Students

1. **Vanguard of the movement:** Students began hunger strikes and class boycotts in January 1969, which spread rapidly across districts like Khammam and Hyderabad.
2. **Student Action Committee:** The Telangana

Student Action Committee coordinated strikes and the closure of educational institutions for nearly nine months, amplifying the movement.

3. Alliance with political leaders: Leaders such as former Deputy Chief Minister K. V. Ranga Reddy supported them, bridging youth activism and formal politics.

4. Catalyst for wider participation: Non-gazetted employees, teachers and middle-class professionals joined the strikes, broadening the movement's social base.

How Students Raised the Major Issues

1. Employment grievances: Students highlighted the violation of the Mulki Rules, which guaranteed local jobs, by protesting the influx of Andhra personnel into Telangana posts.

2. Economic disparities: Through demonstrations and public meetings they exposed the diversion of Telangana's surplus revenues to Andhra and demanded fair allocation.

3. Symbolic protest and media: Hunger strikes, mass rallies and "Telangana Safeguards Day" kept issues in public discourse and forced responses like the Prime Minister's Eight Point Plan.

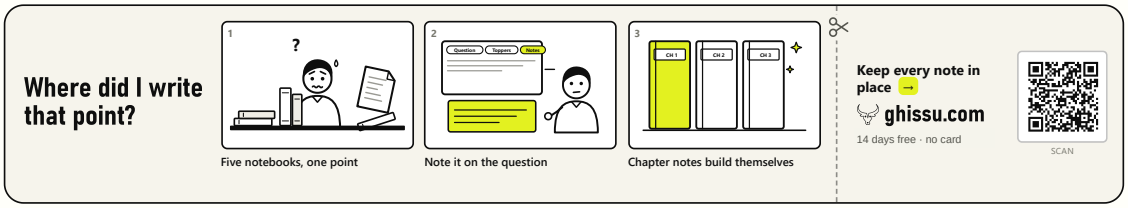
4. Sustained momentum: Even after police firing on students in January 1969, they kept protesting for separate statehood or effective safeguards.

Way Forward

1. Student representation: Formal channels for students in institutional governance can address concerns early.
2. Statutory safeguards: Empowering bodies like the Telangana Development Committee can enforce job and development safeguards.
3. Dialogue: Regular talks between student leaders and government can preempt conflict.

Conclusion

The students of 1969 articulated and amplified regional grievances, turning local discontent into a sustained political movement. Their activism showed youth as agents of social change and political accountability, and constructively channelled, such engagement strengthens democratic processes.



11(a) Explain the physical features of India and Andhra Pradesh, especially the major landforms and geographical characteristics.

10

Introduction

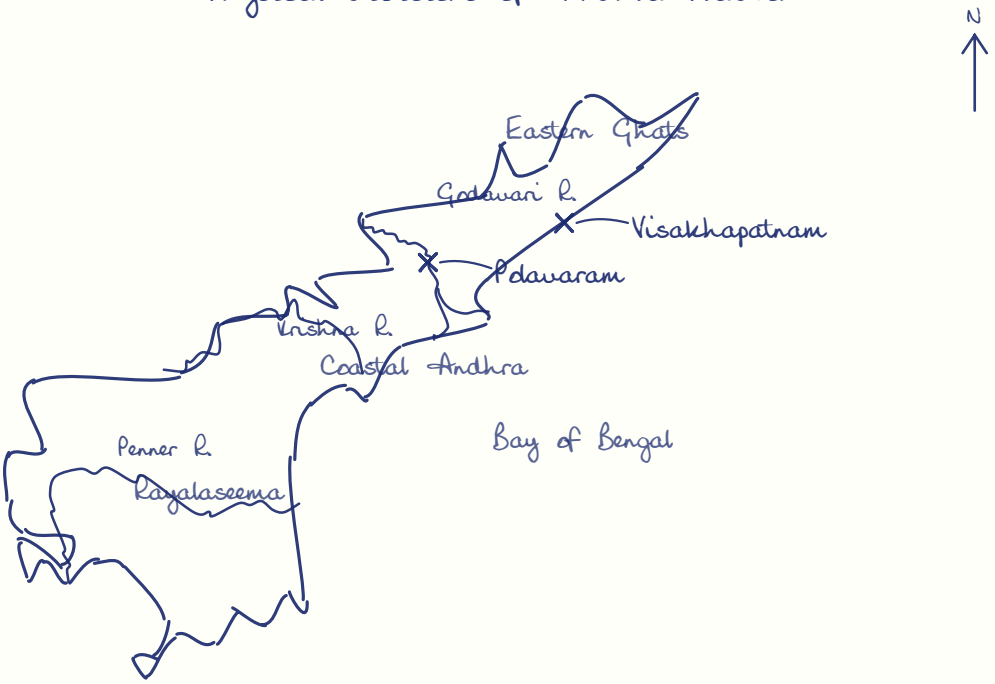
India's vast and diverse physical landscape shapes its climate, agriculture, culture and economy. Andhra Pradesh's varied geography, from its extensive coastline to its plateau and hill regions, similarly shapes its socio-economic profile and resource distribution.

Major Physical Features of India

1. Himalayan Mountain System: The youngest and loftiest fold mountains stretch over 2,400 km along the northern border. They were formed by the collision of the Indian and Eurasian plates.
2. Indo-Gangetic Plains: Formed by alluvium of the Ganga, Yamuna and Brahmaputra, this is one of the world's most extensive agricultural regions.
3. Peninsular Plateau: One of the oldest and most stable landmasses, of igneous and metamorphic rocks, divided into the Central Highlands and Deccan Plateau, the core of India's mineral economy.

4. Coastal Plains and Islands: A coastline over 7,500 km, with Western and Eastern Coastal Plains and island groups like Andaman and Nicobar and Lakshadweep.

Physical divisions of Andhra Pradesh



Major Physical Features of Andhra Pradesh

1. Eastern Ghats: Rugged, forested hills parallel to the coast, source of the Gostani and Machkund.

2. Deccan Plateau: Undulating terrain with fertile valleys and dry deciduous forests; chilli and horticulture thrive in Rayalaseema.

3. Coastal Plains: The second-longest coastline in

India (about 974 km), with fertile Godavari and Krishna deltas supporting aquaculture and agriculture.

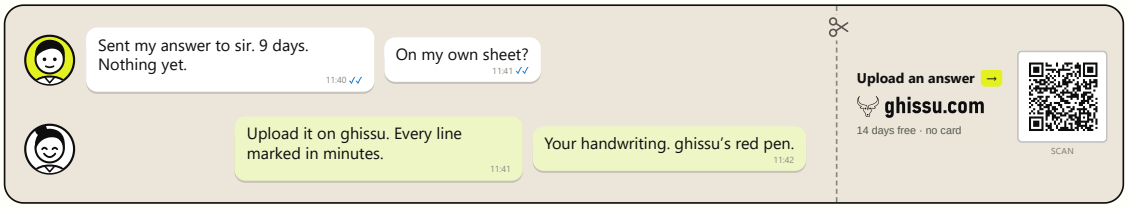
4. River Systems: East-flowing Godavari, Krishna and Penneru drain into the Bay of Bengal and feed projects like the Polavaram Project.

Geographical Characteristics

1. Climate: India spans six climatic zones; Andhra Pradesh has a tropical climate with about 911 mm rainfall, erratic enough to cause droughts in Rayalaseema.
2. Soils: India ranges from alluvial soils in the plains to red and black soils on the plateau; in Andhra Pradesh soils follow climate and topography.

Conclusion

From the Himalaya to the Andhra coast, these diverse landforms shape agriculture, resources and development in both India and Andhra Pradesh.



11(b) Examine the features and importance of the major landforms of Andhra Pradesh with special reference to the Coastal Plains, Eastern Ghats, and Deccan Plateau.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh, lying between 12°41' and 22°N latitude, is endowed with diverse landforms. Its major physiographic features, the Coastal Plains, Eastern Ghats and Deccan Plateau, shape its climate, agriculture, mineral wealth and economy.

Major landforms of Andhra Pradesh



Coastal Plains

1. Extent and composition: The plains stretch about 974 km along the Bay of Bengal, the

second-longest coastline in India, built of alluvium from the Godavari and Krishna.

2. Soil and agriculture: Flat terrain with silt-enriched soils supports paddy, horticulture and aquaculture, with the Krishna and Godavari deltas as hubs.

3. Economic importance: Ports like Visakhapatnam and Kakinada and the Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor drive trade, while marine fisheries thrive.

4. Challenges: Cyclones, saltwater intrusion and erosion threaten livelihoods, while erratic monsoons strain water resources.

Eastern Ghats

1. Relief: Discontinuous hills of 600 to 1,600 m, with peaks like Arma Konda (1,680 m) and Mahendragiri (1,501 m) and ranges like Nallamalai and Palkonda.

2. Geology: Charnockites, khondalites and quartzites give rugged slopes and deep valleys, dissected by the Gostani and Machkund, which originate here.

3. Biodiversity: Dry deciduous forests hold endemic species like Cycas beddomei and

Pterocarpus santalinus, and the Forest Department manages a 22,862 km^2 forest area.

4. Socio-economic role: They support tribal communities with timber and forest produce, but rugged terrain limits agriculture and connectivity.

Deccan Plateau

1. Topography: Part of the larger peninsular plateau, it has undulating terrain, broad valleys and rounded hills of ancient crystalline and metamorphic rocks, sloping gently eastwards.
2. Soil and minerals: Black regur soil supports cotton, and the region holds barytes (86.11% of India's reserves) and limestone.
3. Importance: It supports dryland agriculture of millets and pulses in Rayalaseema, and its minerals underpin industry.
4. Limitations: A semi-arid climate and erratic rainfall bring frequent droughts, while soil erosion and deforestation pose ecological challenges.

Conclusion

These three landforms together form the resource base of Andhra Pradesh; region-specific planning can maximise their benefits while addressing their risks.

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Index · page 6

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12(a) Discuss the background of agriculture in Andhra Pradesh and critically examine how key agricultural inputs such as rainfall, temperature, irrigation and power are likely to be affected by climate change.

10

Introduction

Agriculture in Andhra Pradesh is a vital livelihood, predominantly rainfed and spread across arid, semi-arid and sub-humid zones. Average annual rainfall is about (911) mm, mostly from the southwest monsoon, but its erratic distribution causes frequent droughts, especially in Rayalaseema.

Climate-sensitive farm regions of Andhra Pradesh



Rayalaseema averages only 520 mm rainfall

Background of Agriculture

1. Irrigation base: Irrigation covers about (50%) of the area, with Polavaram meant to raise it, though fiscal limits and Krishna–Godavari disputes constrain expansion.

2. Groundwater stress: Watersheds are graded safe to over-exploited, with (41) mandals over-exploited.

3. Power dependence: Irrigation pumps rely on farm power, which faces deficits and subsidy burdens.

Climate Change and Key Inputs

1. Rainfall: The southwest monsoon is becoming increasingly unpredictable, reducing kharif reliability, especially in Rayalaseema, which gets only (520) mm.

2. Temperature: Summer temperatures up to 45°C in coastal areas raise evapotranspiration, heat stress and pest proliferation, cutting yields.

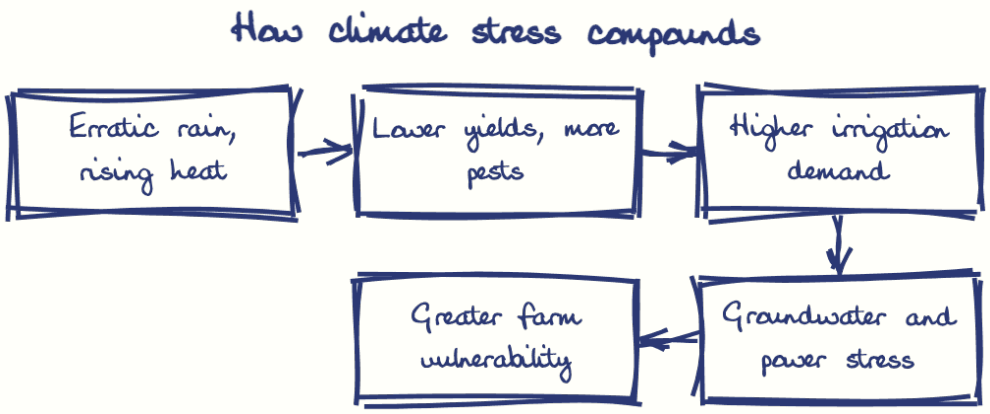
3. Irrigation: Groundwater depletion in several mandals limits irrigation and raises dependence on erratic rainfall.

4. Power: Power shortages and subsidy burdens make electric pumps unreliable, hurting smallholders most.

Critical Examination

Because most farming is rainfed, these inputs form one

chain of agricultural vulnerability.



Way Forward

1. Resilient irrigation: Micro-irrigation prioritised in over-exploited mandals.
2. Power reform: Renewable energy and subsidy rationalisation for reliable supply.
3. Climate-smart agriculture: Resilient varieties, integrated pest management and agroforestry suited to each zone.

Conclusion

Since rainfall, temperature, irrigation and power are all climate-sensitive, Andhra Pradesh must strengthen institutional capacity, adopt climate-smart technology and manage resources sustainably to safeguard farm productivity and livelihoods.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
ghissu.com →

12(b) Highlight the industrial importance and major manufacturing sectors of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

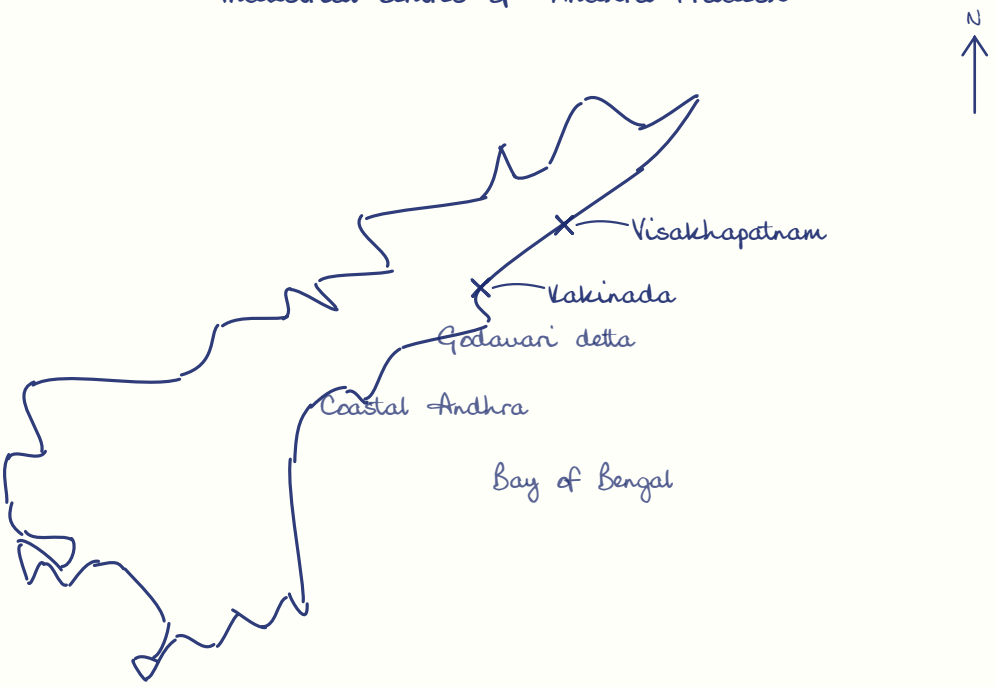
Andhra Pradesh holds a strategic position in India's industrial landscape owing to its rich natural resources, extensive coastline and evolving infrastructure. Since bifurcation in 2014, it has focused on expanding manufacturing and exports.

Industrial Importance

1. **Strategic coastal advantage:** A coastline of about 960 km with Visakhapatnam port supports trade and port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai.
2. **Economic contribution:** GSDP at constant prices for 2024–25 is estimated at 8.73 lakh crore with 9.24% growth, outpacing the national average.
3. **Infrastructure:** Better power, rail and road networks and an international airport at Visakhapatnam aid industry.
4. **Export ecosystem:** Exports exceeded US$ 19 billion in FY22, with Visakhapatnam and East Godavari as hubs for engineering goods, pharmaceuticals and marine products.

5. Challenges: Power deficits, infrastructure gaps and the decline of handlooms limit growth and FDI.

Industrial centres of Andhra Pradesh



Steel at Vizag, fertilisers at Kakinada

Major Manufacturing Sectors

1. Steel and heavy engineering: Visakhapatnam hosts one of India's most modern steel plants along with BHEL and HMT units.
2. Pharmaceuticals and chemicals: A growing sector producing synthetic drugs and organic chemicals, backed by testing labs.
3. Fertilisers and mining: Nagarjuna Fertilizers in Kakinada and Godavari Fertilizers, with barytes reserves supporting mining.

4. Agro-based industries: Rice milling in East Godavari and cashew processing draw on farm strengths.
5. Electronics: Mobile, telecom and medical device manufacturing is emerging under the PLI scheme.

Way Forward

1. Power infrastructure: Renewable energy projects and efficient use of natural gas reserves for reliable industrial power.
2. Export promotion: Capacity building for exporters and certification agencies to widen the export base.
3. Traditional sectors: Technology and market links to revive handlooms and agro-industries.
4. Business climate: Simpler land acquisition, fewer regulatory bottlenecks and better ease of doing business.

Conclusion

Its strategic coastal location, diversified manufacturing base and growing export potential make Andhra Pradesh an industrial engine for the region. Addressing infrastructure and policy gaps will help it grow further, in line with Swarna Andhra Vision 2047.

Write your own answer to 12(b) and get it evaluated →
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Scan to practice

13(a) Discuss the spatial patterns of population distribution and urbanisation in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

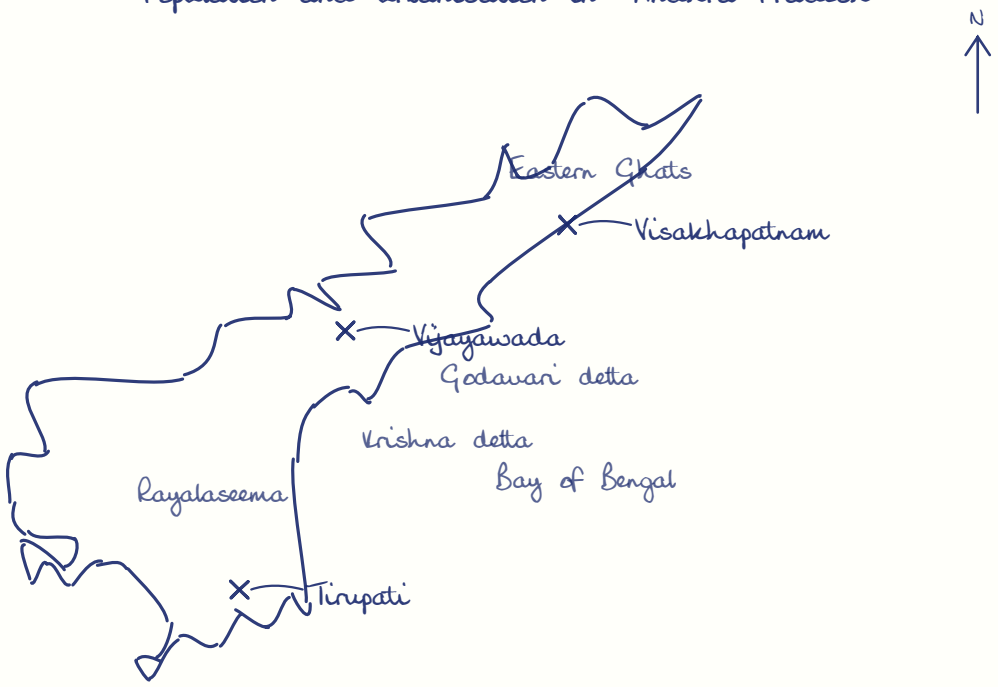
According to Census 2011, the present Andhra Pradesh had about 4.94 crore people. Population and towns are unevenly spread, following water, fertile soil and the coastline, with nearly 30% of people living in urban areas.

Population Distribution

1. Dense deltas: The Krishna–Godavari delta districts of Krishna, West Godavari, East Godavari and Guntur are the most densely settled, thanks to canal irrigation and paddy farming. Krishna district had over 500 persons per sq km in 2011.
2. Sparse interior: Dry, rain-fed districts such as Kadapa, Anantapur, Kurnool and Prakasam have much lower densities, under 200 per sq km in Kadapa and Prakasam.
3. Thin hill areas: The forested Agency areas of the Eastern Ghats and the Nallamala hills carry sparse, largely tribal populations.
4. Coastal pull: Ports and fisheries draw people to the long coastal belt from Srikakulam to

Nellore.

Population and urbanisation in Andhra Pradesh



dense deltas, dry and thin interior

Patterns of Urbanisation

1. Level: About 30% of the state is urban, slightly below the national average of 31.2%.
2. Primate city: Visakhapatnam is the largest city and makes its district the most urbanised in the state.
3. Central cluster: Vijayawada, Guntur and the Amaravati capital region form a growing urban core.
4. Corridor growth: Towns are expanding along

the Visakhapatnam–Chennai Industrial Corridor, with Tirupati and Sri City in the south.

5. Lagging districts: Srikakulam, Prakasam and Vizianagaram were among the least urbanised districts in 2011 (these are the 13 districts of 2011; the state was reorganised into 26 districts in 2022, now 28 after Polavaram and Markapuram were added in December 2025).

Concerns and Way Forward

1. Imbalance: A few cities absorb most migrants, while small towns lack jobs and services.
2. Planning: The Smart Cities Mission (2015–2025) upgraded Visakhapatnam, Kakinada, Tirupati and Amaravati; the next step is balanced regional development of smaller towns.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's people crowd the fertile deltas and coast, and its cities cluster along the coastal corridor. Decentralised urban growth can spread opportunity to Rayalaseema and the north.

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Scan to practice

13(b) Analyse the composition and spatial distribution of Scheduled Castes (SCs), Scheduled Tribes (STs), and religious communities in Andhra Pradesh, as per Census 2011.

10

Introduction

As per Census 2011, Andhra Pradesh had nearly 4.96 crore people. The composition and spatial distribution of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and religious communities matter for targeted welfare, regional balance and the constitutional goal of social justice.

Scheduled Castes: Composition

1. Population share: SCs form 17.08% of the state's population, a substantial segment needing focused welfare.
2. Socio-economic profile: Most are landless agricultural labourers and small artisans, shaped by the agrarian patterns of coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema.
3. Sex ratio and literacy: A favourable 1007 females per 1000 males, above the state average, but literacy below the general population.

Scheduled Castes: Distribution

1. Coastal concentration: Highest in the fertile

districts of East Godavari (9.57 lakh), West Godavari and Guntur, where farm labour is in demand.

2. Lower presence: Vizianagaram has the lowest SC population, and Rayalaseema shows lower densities.

3. Urban growth: Migration for employment is raising SC numbers in Greater Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada, changing spatial dynamics.

Where SCs, STs and minorities live in Andhra Pradesh



SCs on fertile coast, STs in Agency Areas

Scheduled Tribes

1. Share: STs form 5.53% of the population, over 27 lakh people.

2. Agency and plains: Most live in the hilly, forested Agency Areas of Visakhapatnam, Srikakulam and East Godavari, with groups like Konda Dora, Koya and Yerukala.
3. Language and religion: Mainly Dravidian speakers, and about 98.9% identify as Hindus.

Religious Communities

1. Hindu majority: Hindus form the overwhelming majority, including among SCs and STs.
2. Minorities: Muslims and Christians concentrate in urban centres like Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada, while rural areas remain largely Hindu, which shapes social dynamics and resource allocation.
3. Coexistence: Saivite, Vaishnavite and Dwaita traditions coexist with other faiths in a pluralistic society.

Conclusion

SCs cluster in the fertile coast, STs in the forested Agency Areas and minorities in cities. This uneven distribution calls for region-specific welfare and inclusive planning across Andhra Pradesh.

How did toppers write this one?
1.5 lakh+ topper answers, matched to each question.
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Scan to practice

14(a) Discuss the key aspects of wildlife conservation and biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Wildlife conservation and biodiversity are vital for ecological balance. With the Eastern Ghats, Deccan Plateau and a 974 km coastline, Andhra Pradesh harbours rich biodiversity, now pressured by agricultural expansion, industrialisation and urbanisation.

Key Aspects of Wildlife Conservation

1. **Protected areas:** National parks, sanctuaries and conservation reserves protect tigers, panthers and sea turtles, in line with the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972 and the National Wildlife Action Plan (2017–2031).
2. **Habitat development:** The Integrated Development of Wildlife Habitats scheme supports restoration, anti-poaching and community participation.
3. **Conflict management:** Compensation, awareness and mitigation reduce crop damage and animal deaths in Visakhapatnam and East Godavari.
4. **Institutions:** The Forest Department enforces laws and works with the National Board for Wildlife.

Biodiversity Characteristics

1. **Floral endemism:** Rare species like Cycas beddomei,



mangroves and estuaries shelter fishing cats and otters

Pterocarpus santalinus and Syzygium alternifolium grow in the Eastern Ghats and coastal mangroves, supporting livelihoods through non-timber forest products.

2. Faunal richness: Tigers, blackbucks and birds, with fishing cats and otters in the Godavari and Krishna estuaries.

3. Ecosystem variety: From tropical dry deciduous forests to mangrove wetlands, supporting complex food webs and genetic diversity.

4. Economic value: Biodiversity sustains agriculture, fisheries and ecotourism, supporting rural livelihoods and significant fish production.

Interlinkages and Challenges

1. Mutual reinforcement: Protected habitats sustain biodiversity, which in turn keeps ecosystems functioning for wildlife.
2. Habitat fragmentation: Rapid agricultural and infrastructure expansion in Guntur and Krishna fragments habitats and threatens species.
3. Community role: Local traditional knowledge helps balance human needs with conservation.
4. Climate change: Policies now add climate resilience measures.

Way Forward

1. Protected areas: More funds and trained staff for surveillance, restoration and monitoring.
2. Communities: Community-based conservation with benefit-sharing to reduce conflict.
3. Planning: GIS-based spatial planning to limit fragmentation from projects.

Conclusion

Wildlife conservation and biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh reinforce each other and need inclusive, climate-resilient management.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
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Scan to practice

14(b) Discuss the vulnerability of Andhra Pradesh to cyclones and floods, highlighting the causes, regional patterns, and impacts.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh, with a 974 km coastline along the Bay of Bengal, is highly vulnerable to cyclones and floods. Its location between 13°N and 19°N exposes it to tropical cyclones, while extensive deltas and flat terrain raise flood risk.

Causes

1. Geographical location: Warm surface waters make the Bay of Bengal a breeding ground for cyclones that move westward, especially in May, October and November.
2. Topography and rivers: The flat Krishna and Godavari deltas allow cyclonic winds and storm surges to penetrate inland, and the rivers overflow during heavy rain.
3. Monsoon variability: Erratic rain from the southwest monsoon and the northeast monsoon in October brings sudden downpours.
4. Climate change: Rising sea surface temperatures have increased cyclone frequency and intensity, as with Cyclone Hudhud (2014).

Cyclone and flood-prone belt of Andhra Pradesh



Hudhud (2014) devastated Visakhapatnam

Regional Patterns

1. **Coastal districts:** Nine districts from Srikakulam to Nellore are most susceptible.
2. **Deltaic regions:** Low-lying Krishna and Godavari deltas flood frequently.
3. **Northern landfall:** Srikakulam and Vizianagaram often see first landfall, as in Hudhud.
4. **Inland basins:** Floods also inundate farmland in East and West Godavari.

Impacts

1. **Human loss:** Coastal communities in thatched

houses suffer deaths and displacement, Hudhud killed over (100) people.

2. Infrastructure damage: Power, communication and transport break down, as in Visakhapatnam.
3. Agricultural losses: Floods destroy delta crops, hurting food security and incomes in rainfed farming.
4. Response gaps: Early warning by IMD has cut casualties, but resilience and rehabilitation lag.

Way Forward

1. Early warning: More accurate cyclone and flood forecasting, building on IMD systems that have already reduced casualties.
2. Community preparedness: Regular drills and awareness in vulnerable coastal districts.
3. Resilient infrastructure: Stronger housing, power and transport, and faster completion of flood-mitigating projects like Polavaram.

Conclusion

Location, flat deltas, erratic monsoons and warming seas make Andhra Pradesh highly vulnerable, these measures can reduce its disaster vulnerability.

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see page 4

Index · page 6

Write your own answer to 14(b) and get it evaluated →
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Scan to practice

15(a) Analyse the disaster vulnerability of Rayalaseema region in Andhra Pradesh with respect to droughts. Discuss the socio-economic consequences.

10

Introduction

The Rayalaseema region is historically and geographically one of the most drought-prone regions of Andhra Pradesh. Its vulnerability is worsened by erratic monsoons, poor irrigation infrastructure and socio-economic fragility.

Factors of Drought Vulnerability

1. Climatic constraints: Rayalaseema lies in the rain shadow of the Western Ghats and receives less than 750 mm of highly erratic rainfall, while agriculture depends heavily on the monsoon.
2. Inadequate irrigation: Despite rivers like the Penna and Tungabhadra, irrigation is limited and poorly maintained. The Polavaram Project had only 82% physical progress by March 2023, so most farmers remain rainfed.
3. Soil and land use: Red and black soils have low water retention; deforestation and over-extraction of groundwater further reduce the land's natural resilience.
4. Historical policies: The legacy of the Ryotwari

system, with heavy revenue demands and poor land records, left farmers unable to invest in sustainable agriculture.

Socio-Economic Consequences

1. Agricultural distress: Crop failures cause food scarcity and income loss; small and marginal farmers fall into indebtedness and distress sale of land or assets.
2. Migration and social disruption: Prolonged droughts push people to cities or other states, raising urban poverty. Historical famines depopulated villages.
3. Health and nutrition: Water scarcity leads to malnutrition and waterborne diseases, with women and children suffering most.
4. Inequality and exploitation: Landlords and moneylenders charge high interest, creating a vicious cycle of poverty linked to farmer suicides.

Rayalaseema's drought-poverty cycle

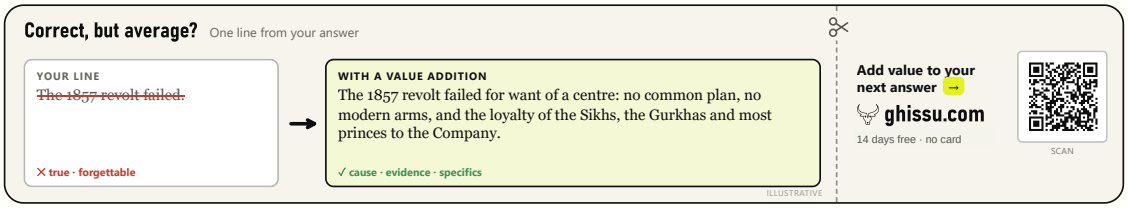


Way Forward

1. Irrigation: Expedite projects like Polavaram to reduce dependence on rainfall.
2. Water conservation: Promote watershed management and rainwater harvesting for groundwater recharge.
3. Agricultural support: Timely crop insurance, affordable credit and extension services to absorb drought losses.
4. Safety nets: Expand employment guarantee schemes and nutritional support for vulnerable groups.

Conclusion

Rayalaseema's drought vulnerability is rooted in its climate, geography and history, with severe consequences for its agrarian society. A multi-pronged approach can make it resilient and advance the SDGs of zero hunger and poverty alleviation.



15(b) Assess the role of the Andhra Pradesh Pollution Control Board (APPCB) in post-disaster pollution management.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh's long coastline, industrial hubs like Visakhapatnam and vulnerability to cyclones and floods make post-disaster pollution management critical. The Andhra Pradesh Pollution Control Board (APPCB) plays a pivotal role in protecting public health and ecology.

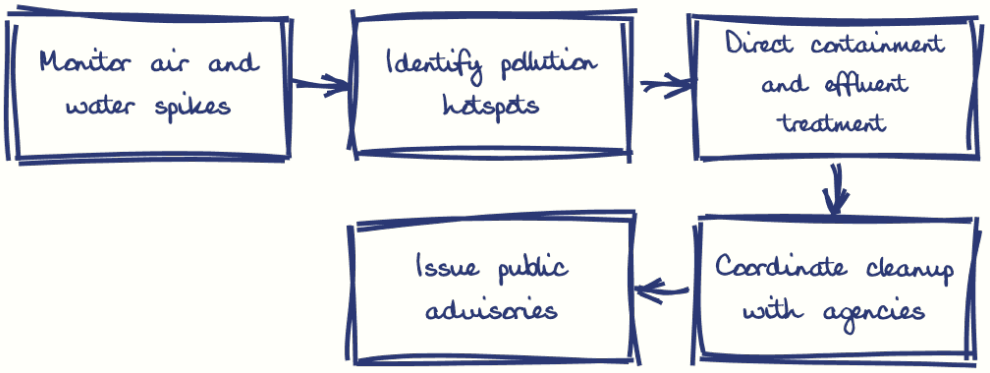
Functions of APPCB after Disasters

1. Regulatory oversight: It grants consents under the Water and Air Acts, keeping industries compliant when disasters disrupt operations and preventing secondary pollution.
2. Monitoring: Stations linked to NAMP and NWMP detect pollution spikes and guide timely advisories.
3. Emergency coordination: With disaster authorities, it identifies hotspots from chemical spills or sewage overflows and directs cleanup.

Interventions

1. Cyclone Hudhud (2014): In Visakhapatnam it monitored air and water and directed industries

APPCB post-disaster response



to treat effluents, preventing toxic releases into the Bay of Bengal.

2. Krishna Delta floods: It tracked pesticide runoff and sewage contamination, advising local authorities on water treatment and waste disposal.

3. Polavaram Project: It monitored sediment and pollutant levels in the Godavari basin during construction and submergence.

APPCB post-disaster interventions



Hudhud cleanup at Vizag, flood runoff in the delta

Challenges

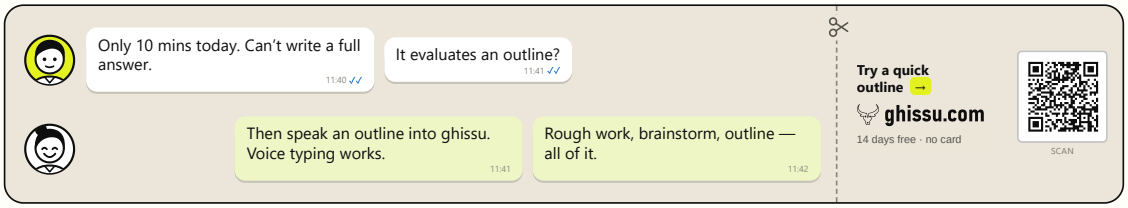
1. Capacity constraints: High vacancies and few trained personnel slow action.
2. Coordination gaps: Overlapping jurisdictions delay information sharing.
3. Infrastructure: Despite NCAP funds, labs and equipment are outdated, the CAG found waste processing gaps in 123 ULBs.

Way Forward

Fill vacancies and train staff for disaster-specific pollution management with central support. Set formal inter-agency protocols with real-time data sharing.

Conclusion

APPCB is central to sustainable disaster recovery in Andhra Pradesh. Its monitoring and regulatory roles are strong, but closing its staffing, infrastructure and coordination gaps will decide its effectiveness.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2023

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1(a) Examine the survival and continuity of Harappan culture in the present times.

10

Introduction

The Harappan civilization, flourishing around 2600 to 1900 BCE, was one of the world's earliest urban cultures. Despite its decline over 3,500 years ago, many of its elements have persisted or transformed, influencing contemporary Indian society.

Harappan roots, living traditions

Harappan element	Living today
Pashupati, Mother Goddess	Shiva and goddess worship
Swastika, sacred trees	Hindu iconography
Beads, faience, terracotta	Traditional crafts
Grid, covered drains	Public health infrastructure

Elements Surviving Today

1. Religious symbols and practices: Worship of Pashupati (proto-Shiva), the Lingam, Mother Goddess, sacred trees and serpents, and the Swastika symbol remain integral to Hindu worship.

2. Urban planning and sanitation: Grid layouts,

standardised bricks and drainage laid foundations still relevant in Indian architecture and public health infrastructure.

3. Craftsmanship: Bead-making, pottery, faience and metallurgy continue in traditional Indian crafts, passed down through generations.

4. Numerical and trade systems: Harappan decimal systems influenced later Vedic mathematics, while punch-marked coins echo ancient trade practices.

Transformation Over Time

1. Evolution of religion: Harappan elements were assimilated into Vedic and later Hindu frameworks, moving from localised cults to pan-Indian traditions with symbolic continuity.

2. Adaptation of urban concepts: Though the cities declined, their planning ideas influenced later settlements, evolving with new conditions but keeping the principle of organised habitation.

3. Craft adaptation: Crafts blended with regional influences and new materials yet preserved core techniques such as bead-making and terracotta figurines.

4. Script legacy: The undeciphered script's motifs influenced later iconography and possibly contributed to Brahmi and other scripts.

Significance for Contemporary Culture

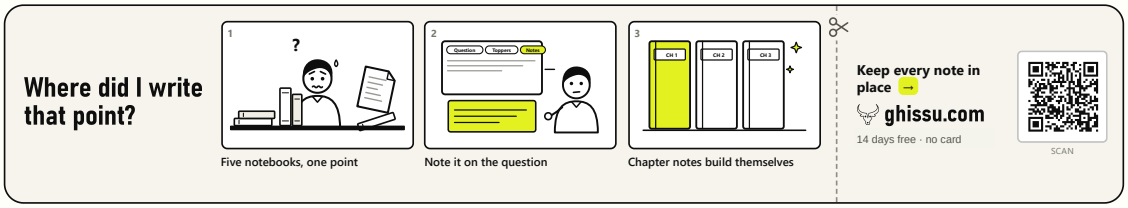
1. **Identity and cohesion:** Shared symbols like the Swastika and reverence for nature and fertility deities reinforce India as a continuous civilization and link diverse communities.
2. **Sustainable lessons:** Harappan sanitation and planning offer lessons for modern public health and sustainable development.
3. **Global recognition:** UNESCO listings and cultural programmes encourage preservation that sustains living traditions.

Way Forward

1. **Sustain the legacy:** Using technology to decipher the script and supporting artisans of Harappan-derived crafts through GI tags can keep this heritage alive.

Conclusion

The continuity of Harappan culture shows India's living heritage, where ancient traditions are not relics but dynamic elements of identity. Anchored in Article 51A(f), it enriches India's pluralistic fabric.



1(b) Examine the socio-religious life and administration of early India with respect to the writings of Chinese travellers such as Fa-Hien, Hiuen-Tsang and I-Tsang.

10

Introduction

The accounts of Chinese travellers Fa-Hien, Hiuen-Tsang and I-Tsang offer windows into the socio-religious and administrative fabric of early India. Their Buddhist pilgrimages coincided with the Gupta and Harsha eras, and their records are crucial where indigenous sources are scarce.

Socio-Religious Life

1. Religious pluralism: Buddhism, Hinduism and Jainism coexisted. Buddhism was prominent in Punjab and Bengal in Fa-Hien's time, but in the 7th century Hiuen-Tsang noted the ascendancy of Hinduism and waning royal patronage for Buddhism.
2. Social structure: Society followed the varna system, with Brahmins and learned men highly respected, while groups like Boyas and Savaras formed lower strata.
3. Cultural life: Temple worship, music and dance flourished, and Hiuen-Tsang described temples in Andhra and the popularity of Saivism and Vaishnavism. He also noted moral decline in

Buddhist monasteries.

4. Economy and religion: Flourishing trade guilds like the nakara in the Telugu region and merchants who endowed temples show how prosperity supported religious institutions.

Administration

1. Centralised monarchy: Hiuen-Tsang portrays Harsha's empire with its grand capital Kanauj and a bureaucracy of learned civil and military officers.
2. Revenue and military: Fa-Hien noted that farmers paid a share of produce as tax, while the army let adventurers rise to local chieftaincies, a sign of decentralisation.
3. Social control: Fa-Hien saw no strict household registration or frequent magistrates, suggesting informal control balanced by dharma.
4. Religious patronage: Tax-free lands to Brahmins and temple building reinforced legitimacy.

Reliability

1. Firsthand scholarship: Religious and scholarly motives led them to record monasteries, practices and customs in detail, making their accounts rich primary sources.

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Candidates must not write on this margin

India through two travellers

Fa-Hien (Gupta era)	Hiuen-Tsang (Harsha era)
Buddhism prominent	Buddhism declining
Scholars highly respected	Saivism, Vaishnavism rising
Farmers paid produce tax	Grand capital at Kanauj
Idyllic portrayal	Stress on Hindu resurgence

2. Bias: Their Buddhist backgrounds produced Fa-Hien's idyllic picture of Gupta society and Hiuen-Tsang's stress on Buddhist decline and Hindu resurgence, which may reflect subjective views.

Conclusion

Read critically alongside other sources, these writings remain invaluable for reconstructing early India's pluralistic society, religious life and governance. They capture a shift from Buddhist prominence to Hindu ascendancy, with temples and guilds at the heart of social life.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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Scan to practice

2(a) Examine the manner in which the Chola village administration had contributed to the growth of village autonomy as indicated by the Uttaramerur/Uttaramallur inscriptions.

10

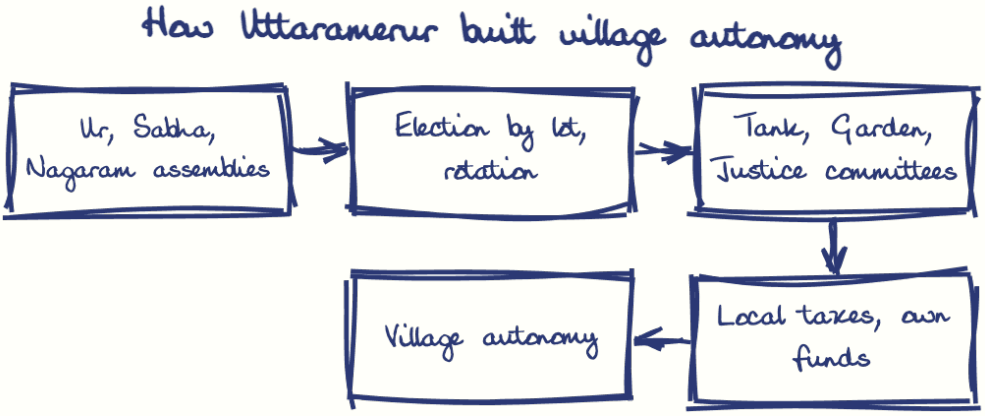
Introduction

The Chola period (9th to 13th century CE) marks a significant phase in local self-government in South India. The Uttaramerur inscriptions of Parantaka I's reign give a rare, detailed record of village assemblies and their participatory functioning.

Features of Chola Village Administration

1. Multiple assemblies: The Ur (general assembly), the Sabha (Brahmin assembly in agraharams) and the Nagaram (merchant assembly) represented different groups.
2. Election by lot and rotation: Officials were chosen by lot or rotation from qualified, property-owning and educated men, with fixed three-year terms.
3. Committee governance: Annual, Tank Committee, Garden and Justice Committees handled irrigation, disputes and resources.
4. Temple as hub: Temples hosted meetings and kept records, integrating religious, economic and political life and lending legitimacy to assemblies.

Contribution to Village Autonomy



1. Decentralised decisions: Assemblies and committees let villages manage land distribution, local taxes and dispute settlement, reducing dependence on the central state and enhancing self-rule.
2. Checks on power: Selection by lot and rotation prevented elite capture and factionalism.
3. Resource control: Committees controlling tanks and land made villages economically self-reliant.
4. State without interference: Royal officials attended only as advisers, so villages kept autonomy within the Chola polity.

Evidence from the Inscriptions

1. Electoral rules: They detail candidate qualifications, drawing of lots and tenure, a well-established democratic process.
2. Committee work: The Tank Committee managed

irrigation vital to agriculture, while the Justice Committee settled disputes.

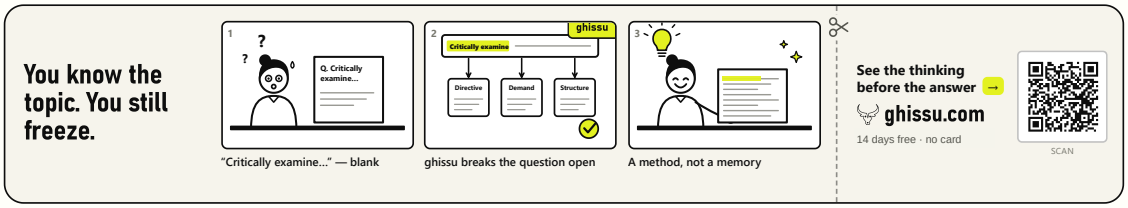
3. Rule-making: Assemblies could amend rules to suit local needs and curb factions.

4. Fiscal independence: Villages levied local taxes and raised loans for tanks, with funds kept separate from state revenue.

Conclusion

The Uttaramerur inscriptions show a mature, decentralised governance that nurtured village autonomy through participation, specialised committees and fiscal independence, lessons relevant to Panchayati Raj today.

Rotational leadership, specialised committees and greater village control over local resources and finances, drawn from this model, can strengthen grassroots democracy and accountability in India today.



2(b) Explain Alauddin Khilji's market regulations and discuss their impact.

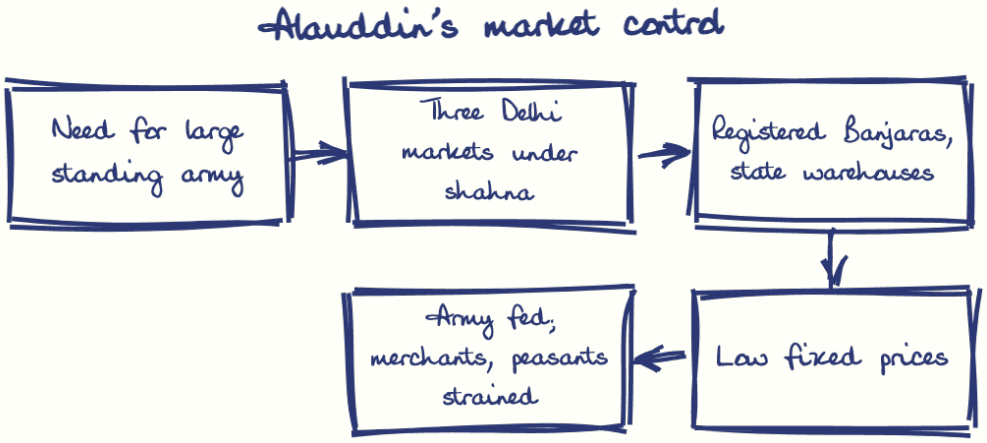
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Introduction

Alauddin Khilji's market regulations of the early 14th century were a pioneering attempt to control prices. They were driven by the need to maintain a large standing army and stabilise the economy amid Mongol invasions.

The Market Regulations

1. **Centralised markets:** Delhi had three markets, for foodgrains, costly cloth, and horses, slaves and cattle, each supervised by a **shahna** who kept merchant registers and enforced prices.
2. **Direct revenue collection:** In the doab, the state collected revenue directly, assessed by **land measurement**, stopping local elites from passing burdens to peasants.
3. **Oversight of officials:** Amils got adequate salaries but faced rigorous audits and harsh punishments for corruption.
4. **Anti-hoarding measures:** Banjaras were registered and held collectively responsible for violations, and **state warehouses** released grain during shortages.



Impact

1. **Benefits to army and public:** Affordable food and goods supported soldiers and citizens, though merchants, especially Hindu traders, resented the controls, a trade-off between commerce and welfare.
2. **Decline of village elites:** Khuts and muqaddams lost privileges and illegal levies, changing rural power and reducing exploitation.
3. **Strain on peasants:** Revenue of up to half the produce and forced cash payments made peasants sell grain cheaply.
4. **Uneven reach:** Barani suggests other towns were affected, but enforcement beyond Delhi remains unclear.

Long-Term Significance

1. **State intervention:** The reforms were an early

precedent of state intervention balancing military needs and welfare.

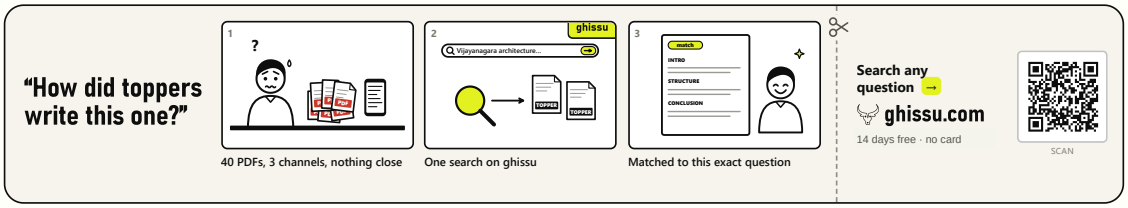
2. Social redistribution: Curbing elite privileges and controlling prices made the economy more equitable, despite the strain on peasants and traders.

3. Administrative rationalisation: Measurement-based taxation and official accountability foreshadowed modern revenue practices.

4. Debate on intent: Some historians say the policies targeted Hindu merchants, while others note their impact on Muslim traders too.

Conclusion

Alauddin's regulations were a landmark in medieval economic governance, showing the state's capacity to regulate markets for social and military goals, though at a cost to peasants and traders.



3(a) Discuss the features of Mughal architecture and examine the influence of Hindu elements on Mughal architecture.

10

Introduction

Mughal architecture, flourishing from the 16th to 18th centuries, was a synthesis of Persian, Turkish, Arabic and indigenous styles. It expressed imperial power and the cultural pluralism of medieval India. Sohel Hashmi's (2025) critique stresses its syncretic nature over a purely 'Islamic' label.

Key Features

1. Symmetry and geometry: Perfect bilateral symmetry and the charbagh layout of four quadrants symbolising paradise, as at the Taj Mahal.
2. Materials and ornamentation: Early red sandstone with marble inlay gave way to pure white marble under Shah Jahan, adorned with pietra dura, jali screens and Quranic calligraphy.
3. Architectural elements: Bulbous double domes, slender minarets, iwans, pointed arches and gateways like the Buland Darwaza.
4. Gardens and water: Flowing channels at Humayun's Tomb and Shalimar Bagh blend nature with architecture.

Mughal synthesis of two traditions

Persian–Islamic	Hindu
Double domes, iwans	Chhatris, jharokhas
Arches (arcuate)	Trabeate beams
Calligraphy, pietra dura	Lotus, elephant brackets
Charbagh gardens	Temple-style carved panels

Influence of Hindu Elements

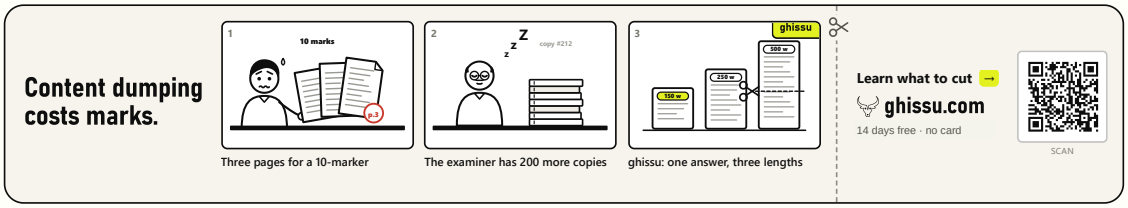
1. **Structural adaptations:** Rajput chhatris and jharokhas were built into Agra Fort and Fatehpur Sikri.
2. **Decorative motifs:** Lotus buds, bell and chain designs, elephant brackets and floral panels drew from Hindu temples.
3. **Construction techniques:** Indian masons combined trabeate construction with Islamic arches and domes, creating a hybrid vocabulary.
4. **Urban planning:** Fatehpur Sikri fused trabeate and arcuate principles, reflecting Akbar's cultural inclusiveness.

Way Forward

1. Conservation: Restoration projects should preserve both Islamic and Hindu elements of Mughal monuments.
2. Research and education: Interdisciplinary study of this syncretism, taught in curricula, fosters appreciation of composite culture.
3. Digital documentation: 3D scanning and digital archiving can record intricate details for future generations.

Conclusion

Mughal architecture stands as a testament to India's composite culture, and preserving its syncretic monuments keeps this shared heritage alive.



3(b) The state that was created by Shivaji was not only egalitarian in conception but also a welfare state in nature.' Examine.

10

Introduction

The legacy of Chhatrapati Shivaji, the 17th-century Maratha ruler, still evokes admiration and debate. Historians often see his state as a pioneering model that combined egalitarian ideals with welfare-oriented governance, a dual character with lessons for governance today.

Egalitarian Aspects

1. Inclusive social vision: He disavowed imposing religious beliefs and ensured equal protection under law irrespective of caste or creed.
2. Local leadership: Empowering chieftains and village assemblies decentralised authority and reduced elite monopolies.
3. Meritocratic recruitment: Ability and loyalty, not birth, decided promotion, so lower castes could rise in the army and administration.

Welfare Nature

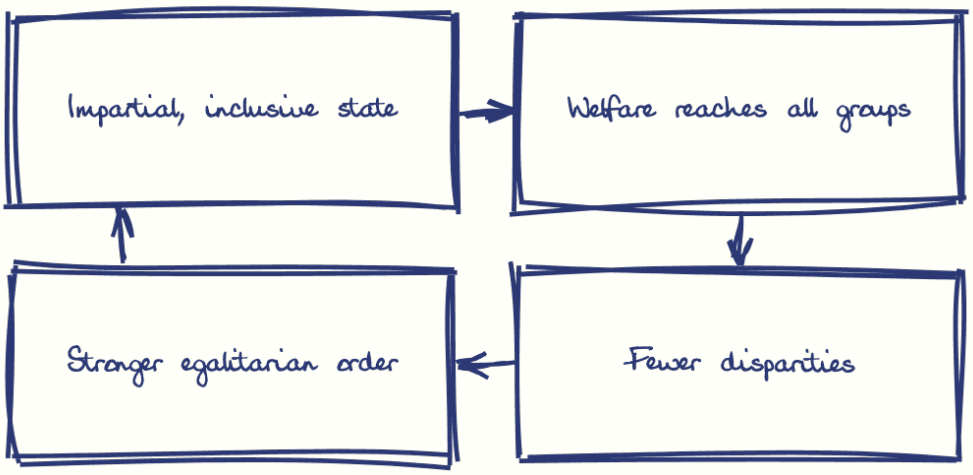
1. Public works: Forts, irrigation and roads strengthened defence and also supported agrarian productivity and trade.

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2. Protection of the vulnerable: The state guarded the health and strength of workers and children to prevent exploitation.
3. Revenue reforms: Reorganised finances ensured fair taxation and prevented excessive burdens on peasants.
4. Religious tolerance: Neutrality and the discouragement of persecution sustained peace and collective well-being.

Equality and welfare reinforce each other



How the Two Interrelate

1. Equality enabling welfare: Commitment to impartiality and inclusion let welfare policies reach diverse social groups without discrimination.
2. Welfare reinforcing equality: Economic security and protection of the vulnerable narrowed social

disparities, so all subjects could thrive.

3. Modern relevance: The model prefigured welfare principles of social justice and equitable distribution of resources.

Critical Appraisal

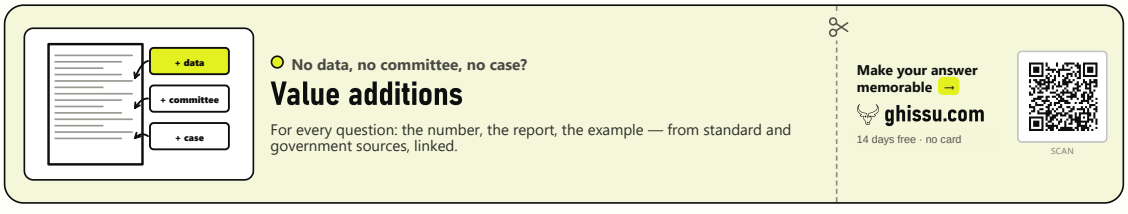
Caste hierarchies, political contestation and charges of Brahmanical appropriation show these ideals were never fully realised in a stratified society.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive narratives: Present his pluralistic, welfare-oriented state while engaging critically with caste and identity contestations.
2. Decentralised governance: Empower local self-government, as he empowered village assemblies, to improve welfare delivery.

Conclusion

Shivaji's state was a pioneering experiment that joined equality with welfare and prefigured the Directive Principles of our Constitution, even though its ideals met the limits of its age.



4(a) Explain the land revenue systems that were introduced by the British. Assess the impact of these revenue systems on the Indian economy.

10

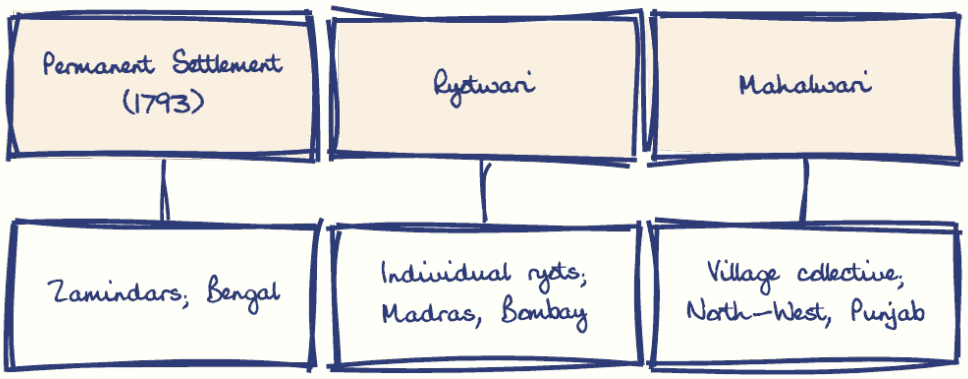
Introduction

The British introduced distinct land revenue systems to maximise agricultural revenue, the backbone of the colonial economy. The Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari, Mahalwari and the earlier Jjaradari varied by region but all transformed land ownership and agrarian relations.

Land Revenue Systems

1. Permanent Settlement: Introduced in Bengal in 1793, it fixed revenue permanently and made zamindars hereditary landowners, who exploited peasants rather than invest.
2. Ryotwari: In Madras and Bombay, revenue was collected directly from ryots as owners, but frequent revisions raised burdens and insecurity.
3. Mahalwari: In North-Western India and Punjab, village heads paid on collective settlements, preserving community structure but with heavy, fluctuating demands.
4. Jjaradari: Collection rights were auctioned to contractors for short terms, causing exploitation until replaced.

British land revenue systems



Impact on the Indian Economy

1. Peasant exploitation: High, rigid demands caused indebtedness, land alienation and impoverishment in Bengal and Madras.
2. Agricultural stagnation: Insecure tenure, heavy taxes and no incentive for zamindars or ryots to invest led to low productivity and frequent famines like the Madras famine of 1877.
3. Disintegration of village economy: Private property and commercialisation of land broke the artisan-village nexus.
4. Instability and neglect: Ijaradari caused fluctuating demands, corrupt intermediaries worsened distress, and a fixation on revenue crowded out irrigation and agricultural development.
5. Inequitable ownership: Zamindari entrenched landlord power, while other systems failed to

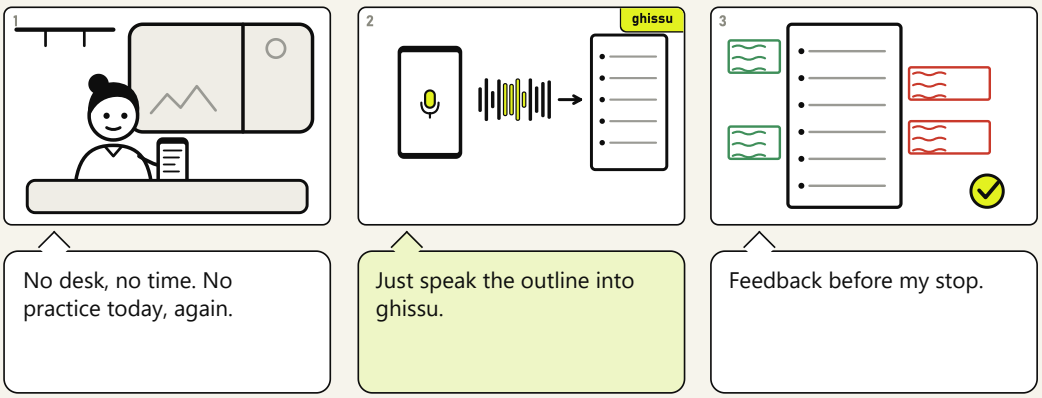
protect small cultivators, perpetuating caste and class inequality.

Conclusion

These systems put colonial revenue above welfare and left fragmented tenures, so states after independence achieved land ceilings, redistribution and tenancy reform only unevenly, leaving exploitation, indebtedness and entrenched inequality. Digitised records like Karnataka's Bhoomi Project and strong tenancy laws, backed by public investment in irrigation, can address this legacy.

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4(b) Assess the socio-religious reform movements in the Muslim community during the 19th century. Discuss the contributions made by Sayyid Ahmad Khan towards the upliftment of the Muslim community.

10

Introduction

The 19th century was critical for Indian Muslims, as reform movements sought to address colonial rule and internal stagnation. Nationalists credit them with awakening Muslim society, while others criticise their limited reach and political consequences.

Assessment of Muslim Reform Movements

1. **Late emergence:** They appeared mainly after the 1857 Revolt, which brought repression and marginalisation, because the elite first resisted Western education after losing status.
2. **Rationalism and education:** Reformers reconciled Islam with modern science, challenged blind adherence to tradition and promoted critical thinking to uplift the community.
3. **Social reform:** Campaigns against purdah, polygamy and child marriage, and for women's education, slowly changed attitudes despite orthodox resistance.
4. **Political caution:** Avoiding confrontation with the colonial state sometimes encouraged communal

separatism, complicating Hindu–Muslim relations.

Sayyid Ahmad Khan: gains and limits

Contribution	Limitation
M-AO College, modern education	Limited reach
Reason and science in Islam	Orthodox resistance
Against purdah, polygamy	Attitudes changed slowly
Avoid political agitation	Encouraged separatism

Contributions of Sayyid Ahmad Khan

1. **Modern education:** He founded the Muhammadan Anglo-Oriental College, later Aligarh Muslim University, a centre of modern learning that produced a new Muslim intelligentsia.
2. **Rational interpretation of Islam:** Treating the Quran as the sole authority, he read it in the light of reason and science to counter superstition and fanaticism.
3. **Social reform:** He campaigned against purdah and polygamy and supported women's education, seeking to modernise Muslim social life while preserving Islamic identity.

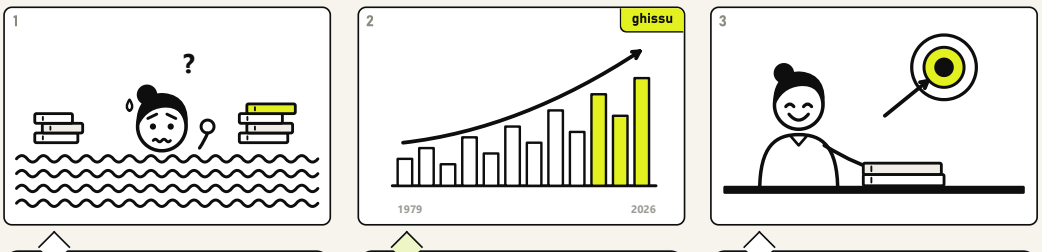
4. Political moderation: He advised Muslims to avoid agitation and focus on education, believing rights would follow; critics say this encouraged separatism and delayed nationalist participation.

Conclusion

The movements began an intellectual awakening, though unevenly. Sayyid Ahmad Khan's work was foundational for modern education and rational Islam, yet his political moderation had mixed consequences. Inclusive education, interfaith dialogue and active democratic participation can complete the upliftment these reformers began.

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5(a) Explain the factors that led to the peasant movement in India and examine its impact on the national movement in India.

10

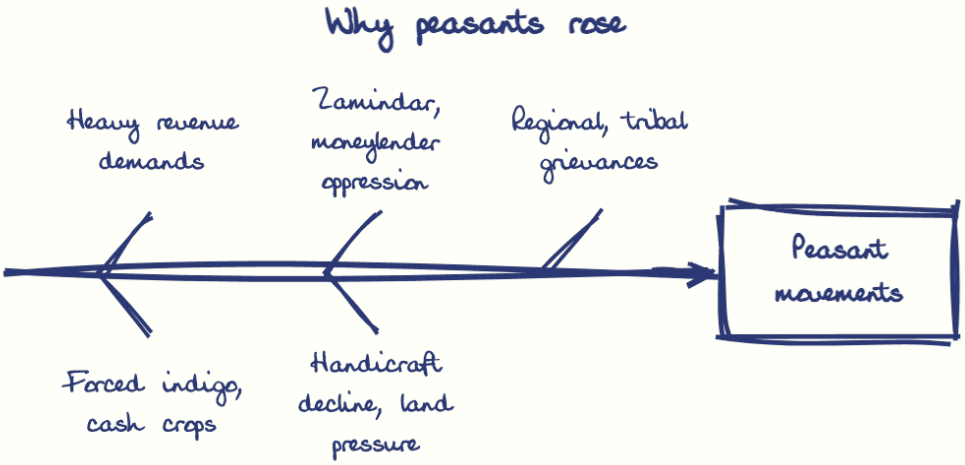
Introduction

Peasant movements in India emerged as a response to the exploitative colonial agrarian system and rural distress. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians debate their nature, but all agree they shaped rural political consciousness and fed the wider freedom struggle.

Factors Behind Peasant Movements

1. **Exploitative Land Revenue:** Permanent Settlement, Ryotwari and Mahalwari imposed taxes beyond peasants' capacity, causing indebtedness and poverty.
2. **Commercialisation of Agriculture:** Cash crops exposed peasants to market swings and planters; the Indigo Revolt (1859–60) resisted forced indigo cultivation.
3. **Zamindar and Moneylender Oppression:** High rents, illegal levies, evictions and unpaid labour, often protected by colonial authorities, provoked movements like the Eka Movement in Awadh.
4. **Decline of Handicrafts:** Unemployment pushed people into farming, worsening land fragmentation.

5. Regional and Tribal Grievances: The Mappila Rebellion and the Santhal Uprising combined economic and social issues.



Impact on the National Movement

1. Integration with Nationalism: Gandhi and Sardar Patel supported peasants in the Champaran and Kheda Satyagrahas, joining economic grievances with the demand for freedom.
2. Mass Mobilisation: Kisan Sabhas affiliated with the Congress expanded the struggle beyond urban elites.
3. Agrarian Agenda: Peasant struggles exposed colonial exploitation and the need for agrarian reform, shaping the national agenda, though the focus often stayed on immediate economic demands.

4. Limitations: Movements were often regional, lacked continuity and unified leadership, and targeted local landlords rather than colonialism, limiting the threat to British rule.

5. Legacy: They laid the ground for the post-independence abolition of zamindari.

Conclusion

Peasant movements turned rural distress into political energy. They broadened the freedom struggle into a mass movement and placed agrarian justice on the national agenda. In this way the peasant question became a lasting part of India's national movement and of its democracy after independence.

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Measure progress, don't guess it

Writing more is not the same as writing better. This is how to know which one you're doing.

1. **Score everything** — Even a rough attempt gets a number.
2. **Rewrite** — The same question, one week later.
3. **Compare** — Intro, dimensions, conclusion — side by side.
4. **One fix at a time** — Track a single weakness until it's gone.

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5(b) Has communalism indirectly helped the British to perpetuate their control over India ? Examine the indicative traits of the Communalists and assess their impact on India's modern history.

10

Introduction

Communalism emerged as a divisive political ideology during colonial rule and deeply shaped the freedom struggle. Many historians agree that British policies deliberately nurtured communal divisions to weaken nationalist unity, so communalism did indirectly help the British perpetuate their control.

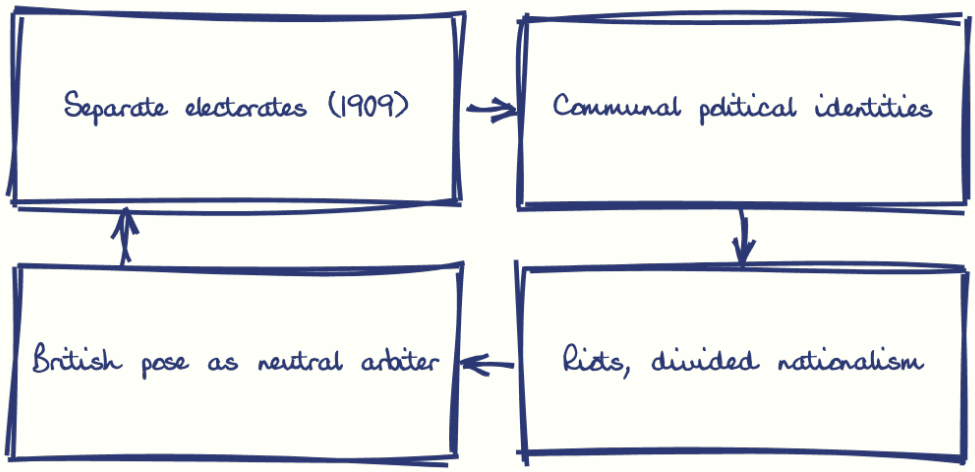
Indicative Traits of Communalists

1. Religious Exclusivism: They placed religious identity above national unity and saw other communities as adversaries, undermining secular nationalism.
2. Political Opportunism: They exploited religious sentiments in elections and campaigns, sidelining socio-economic issues.
3. Alignment with Colonial Interests: Leaders like Sir Syed Ahmed Khan supported British policies and separate electorates that institutionalised communal identities.
4. Socio-economic Rivalries: Competition between Hindu and Muslim middle classes over jobs, trade and influence was manipulated by communal leaders.

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How communalism served the Raj



How Communalism Helped British Control

1. **Divide and Rule:** Separate electorates under the Government of India Act 1909 and communal awards deepened fissures and prevented a united front.
2. **Weakening Nationalism:** Inter-community conflict diverted attention from the anti-colonial struggle of the Congress.
3. **Legitimising Colonial Rule:** Portraying India as irreconcilable communities let the British justify their rule as necessary for order.
4. **Backlash:** It also sowed long-term instability and riots, complicating the colonial exit.

Impact on Modern Indian History

1. **Fragmented Movement:** The Muslim League's demand

for Pakistan altered the course of nationalism.

2. Partition: The partition of 1947 caused massive displacement, vidence and lasting communal tension.

3. Challenge to Secularism: Independent India needed constitutional safeguards for communal harmony.

4. Contemporary Legacy: Communal appeals persist in electoral politics.

Way Forward

1. Socio-economic equity: Reducing disparities among communities removes the ground for communal exploitation.

2. Legal measures: Rigorous enforcement of laws against hate speech curbs divisive opportunism.

Conclusion

Communalism served British interests by dividing the national movement, but its price was partition. Secular education and interfaith dialogue remain the answer.

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Write the note against the question that taught it. That is the only place revision will look for it.

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6(a) Discuss the socio-religious conditions during the Satavahana period with special reference to prominence bestowed on women.

10

Introduction

The Satavahana period (circa 1st century BCE to 3rd century CE) was a key phase in the socio-religious history of the Deccan, where diverse traditions coexisted. It is notable for a relatively progressive outlook towards women, unlike the more restrictive periods before and after.

Socio-Religious Conditions

1. **Religious Pluralism:** Gautamiputra Satakarni defended Vedic Brahmanism with sacrifices like Ashvamedha, while royal women like Naganika supported Buddhist chaityas and viharas.
2. **Guilds and Mobility:** Society was ordered by varnas and occupational guilds (srenis), yet foreign tribes were integrated, as in Sivasri's marriage to the Saka Satrap's daughter.
3. **Open Public Life:** Men and women took part freely in music, dance and festivals, as Amaravati sculptures and Ajanta paintings show.
4. **Ritual Reform:** Vedic ritual gave way to more accessible Puranic forms as heterodox faiths

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grew, while elaborate sacrifices by kings and queens legitimised political power and social order.

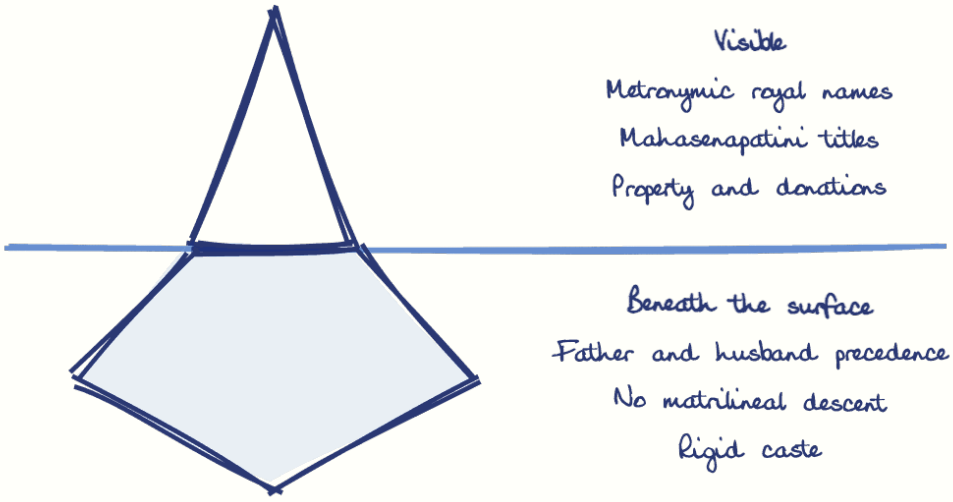
Prominence Bestowed on Women

1. **Political Influence:** Royal ladies like Nagapika and Balasri shaped state affairs, and metronymic names such as Gautamiputra and Vasisthiputra honoured mothers.
2. **Property and Office:** Inscriptions show women owned property and made donations independently, and titles like Mahasenapatini and Maharathini suggest administrative or military roles.
3. **Religious Patronage:** Women worshipped Buddhist emblems and joined assemblies, and royal women endowed monasteries and supported Vedic sacrifices, gaining visibility in spiritual life.
4. **Intellectual Recognition:** Women poets among the composers of the Gathas of the Saptasati and female scholars in disputations show respect for their learning.
5. **Social Freedom:** Art at Amaravati, Ellora and Ajanta shows their fondness for hairstyles and jewellery and their free part in entertainments.

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Women in Satavahana society

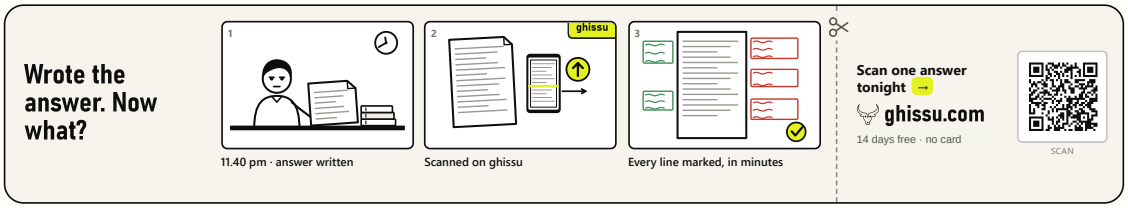


Limitations

1. Patriarchal Norms: The father and husband held precedence in family and society, metronymics did not mean matrilineal descent, and an increasingly rigid caste system limited flexibility.

Conclusion

Satavahana society gave women rare prominence in religion, culture and polity, though always within a patriarchal framework. This balance of freedom and constraint makes the period distinctive in ancient Indian history.

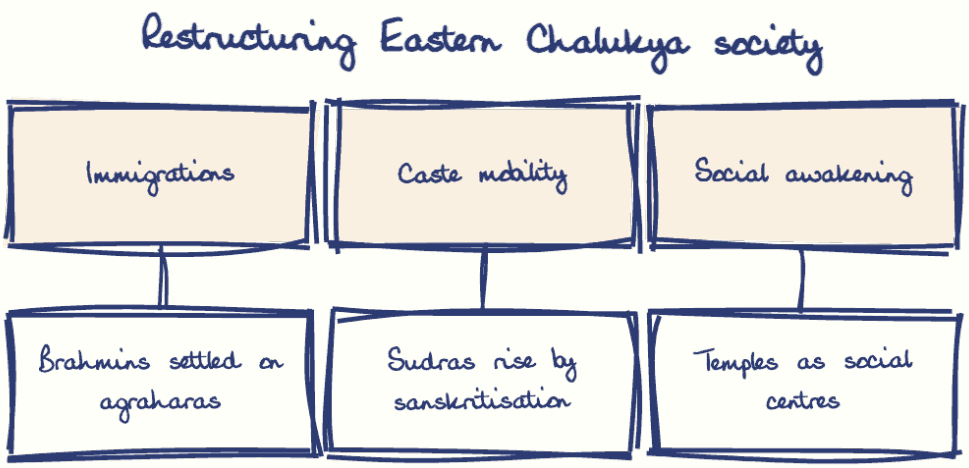


6(b) Explain the re-structuring of the socio-religious life of the Eastern Chalukyas with reference to the impact caused by immigrations, caste mobility and social awakening.

10

Introduction

The Eastern Chalukya period (7th to 12th century CE) was a key phase in Andhra's socio-religious evolution, laying foundations of Telugu culture. Migration, caste mobility and cultural awakening redefined the social fabric.



Impact of Immigrations

1. Northern Brahmins: Muslim invasions in the North drove Brahmins from Mathura and Kanyakubja to Andhra, where rulers granted agraharas and brahmadeya lands, strengthening Vedic learning.
2. Tamil Brahmins: In the Chalukya-Chola period

they settled in Konaseema as the Dravidas, enriching ritual diversity.

3. Kshatriyas and Sudras: Military and administrative expansion brought migrants from Western India, adding warrior and agrarian groups and diversifying the caste order.
4. Komatis: Arya Vaishyas and Kalinga Komatis formed nakara guilds at Penugonda that patronised temples.

Role of Caste Mobility

1. Sanskritisation: Sudras rose by adopting Brahminical rituals and vegetarianism, a process later termed sanskritisation by M.N. Srinivas.
2. Occupational Change: Brahmins entered administration and trade, while some Sudras became schdars and officials, blurring rigid caste boundaries and making the social hierarchy more dynamic.
3. Guild Status: Powerful guilds like the Telikas (oil-mongers) and Komatis used their economic prosperity to claim higher ritual status.
4. Mandalikas: Many Sudra Mandalikas held local power through territory and arms.

Influence of Social Awakening

1. **Decline of Buddhism:** Buddhist viharas were converted into Hindu temples, and Jainism stayed marginal despite royal patronage, consolidating Hindu dominance.
2. **Temple Culture:** Temples built by Vijayaditya II and Rajaraja Narendra became centres of education, charity and culture.
3. **Saiva Monasteries:** Attached to temples, they fed the poor and tended the sick.
4. **Arts:** Courtesans at royal courts and temples cultivated music and dance, merging devotion with cultural expression across social strata.

Conclusion

Under the Eastern Chalukyas, immigration brought new cultural currents, caste mobility loosened old hierarchies and social awakening rebuilt life around temple-centred Hinduism, a legacy still seen in Andhra's heritage today.

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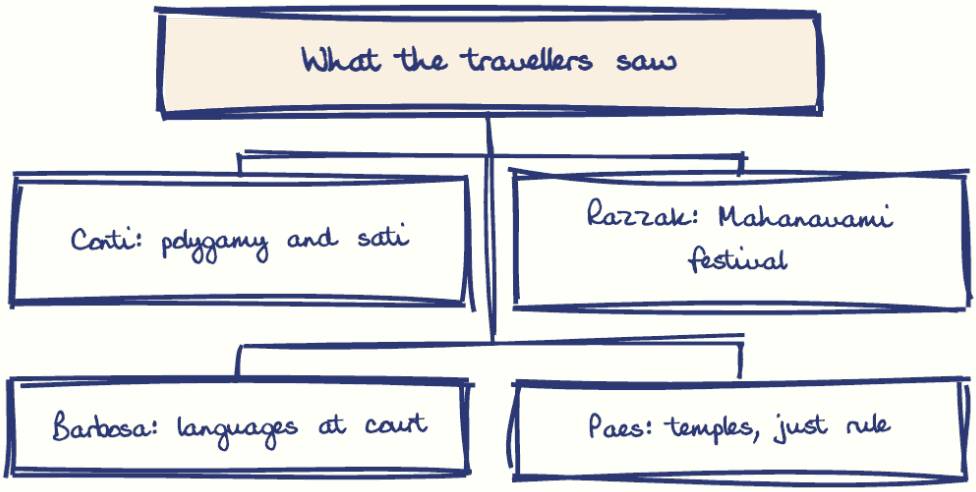
SCAN

7(a) Examine the socio-religious and cultural life of the Vijayanagara kingdom with respect to the writings of foreign travellers such as Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzak, Duarte Barbosa and Domingo Paes.

10

Introduction

The Vijayanagara kingdom (14th to 17th century) was a peak of South Indian socio-religious and cultural synthesis, its legacy preserved at Hampi. Foreign travellers like Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzak, Duarte Barbosa and Domingo Paes offer vital outsider views of its life.



Socio-Religious Life

1. Hindu Patronage: Rulers protected temples and promoted Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada and Tamil, ensuring religious and cultural continuity.

Domingo Paes praised the architectural grandeur of the Hazara Rama and Vittala temples.

2. Social Structure: Nobles lived luxuriously, and women worked even as wrestlers and accountants. Nicolo Conti noted polygamy and sati.

3. Festivals: Navaratri, Deepavali and Holi were widely celebrated, and Abdur Razzak described the Mahanavami festival and the emperor's ritual ride.

4. Justice: The king was supreme judge under the smritis, and Paes stressed the just, centralised rule of Krishna Deva Raya.

Cultural Life

1. Art and Architecture: Massive gopurams and pillared halls marked temples, and the Lepakshi paintings near Anantapur show mastery of mural art.

2. Literature: Krishna Deva Raya, a schdar, patronised poets, and Barbosa and Razzak noted Telugu, Kannada and Tamil at court.

3. Performing Arts: The Bhakti movement shaped devotional music and dance, with temple

festivals as stages, and the Devadasi tradition sustained classical forms.

4. Urban Wealth: Conti and Paes described a cosmopolitan city with markets of spices, textiles and precious stones, whose wealth funded cultural patronage.

Assessing the Travellers

1. Admiration: Paes's account, translated by Robert Sewell, remains a key source.
2. Bias: Barbosa's remarks on the king's female bodyguards and sati may be exaggerated or read through a European lens, so they need cautious analysis.
3. Complementary Views: Razzak's Persian view stressed administration and prosperity, complementing European focus on splendour.
4. A Multifaceted Picture: Together the accounts cover temples, festivals, courts, markets and the lives of women.

Conclusion

Read critically together, the accounts of Conti, Razzak, Barbosa and Paes reveal a devout, hierarchical yet dynamic, prosperous and culturally plural Vijayanagara.

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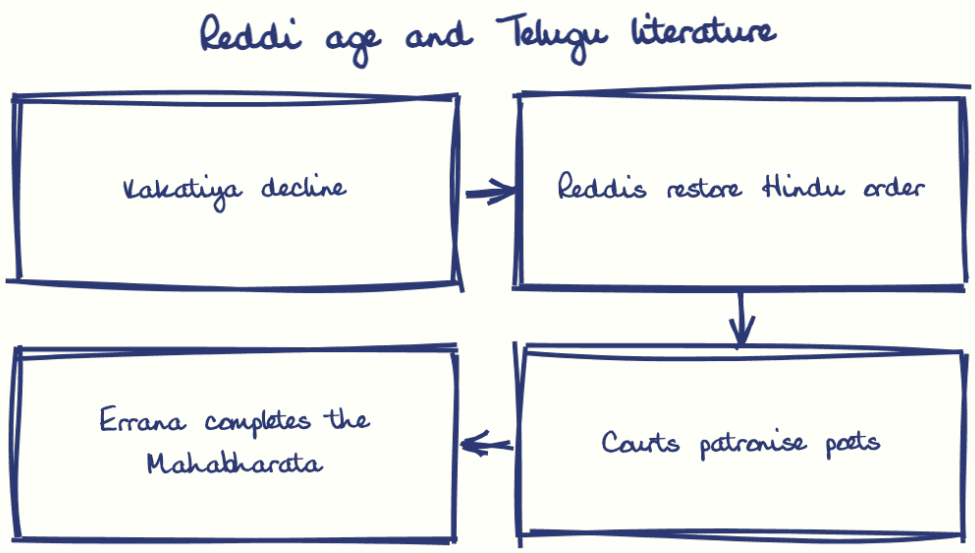
Scan to practice

7(b) Examine the socio-cultural and religious conditions of the Reddi kingdoms with specific reference to the development of Telugu literature.

10

Introduction

The Reddi kingdoms emerged in the 14th century in the Telugu region after the decline of the Kakatiyas. Their era revived Hindu traditions and saw Telugu literature flourish, laying the base of its classical and devotional corpus. Literature reflected and responded to the social and religious conditions of the age.



Socio-Cultural Conditions

1. Restoration of Hindu Order: Reddi rulers restored Vedic customs disrupted by earlier Muslim invasions, posing as protectors of dharma and creating a climate for literary

patronage.

2. Patronage of Poets: Reddi courts attracted poets like Chadalavada Errana, who completed the Mahabharata translation begun by Nannaya and Tikkana.

3. Social Conservatism: Sati, early marriage of girls and denial of education to women reflected a conservative order and limited progressive critique in literature.

4. Courtly Culture: Poets competed for royal favour through erotic themes, as in Potana's Bhogini Dandakam.

Religious Environment

1. Vedic and Saivite Revival: Rulers promoted Shivaratri and worship of Bhairava and Durga, inspiring devotional poetry and treatises.

2. Temple Patronage: Temple steps built at Srisaila and Ahobila made these sites centres of religious and literary activity.

3. Orthodox Practices: Glorification of sati women as demi-goddesses shaped narratives that upheld traditional hierarchy.

Influence on Telugu Literature

1. **Devotion with Classical Tradition:** The Andhra Mahabharata of Nannaya, Tikkana and Errana blended Sanskritic tradition with vernacular expression.
2. **Diverse Genres:** Devotional poetry, historical epics and even erotic poetry grew side by side.
3. **Patronage-Driven Flourishing:** Royal support made monumental works possible that inspired later generations of writers in Andhra.
4. **Limits of Orthodoxy:** Conservative norms restricted social reform themes and reinforced gender roles, so literature rarely questioned the customs of the age.

Way Forward

1. **Inclusive Literary Patronage:** Supporting diverse and marginalised voices today can broaden the perspectives that Telugu literature represents.

Conclusion

The Reddi period combined religious revival and royal patronage to enrich Telugu literature, though its orthodoxy limited the voices it could carry.

How did toppers write this one?
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8(a)(i) Write a short note on the following : (i) Gurujada Apparao's contribution to social reform through the medium of literature

10

Introduction

Gurujada Apparao, born in 1861 in Rayavaram village of Visakhapatnam district, was a pioneering literary figure whose works advanced social reform in Andhra. His era saw evils such as child marriage and the commodification of women in marriage, which he courageously challenged through his writing.

Literature as a Medium of Reform

1. **Reformist Drama:** His drama Kanyasulkam is a landmark in Telugu literature, boldly condemning child marriage and the selling of daughters for marriage. It established literature as a medium of social critique.
2. **Vernacular Language:** Writing in Telugu made his ideas accessible to common people, breaking the elitist barrier of Sanskrit and English and fostering grassroots awakening.
3. **Rational Thought:** He believed literature should improve thinking and broaden perspectives, and his works challenged blind beliefs and superstitions.

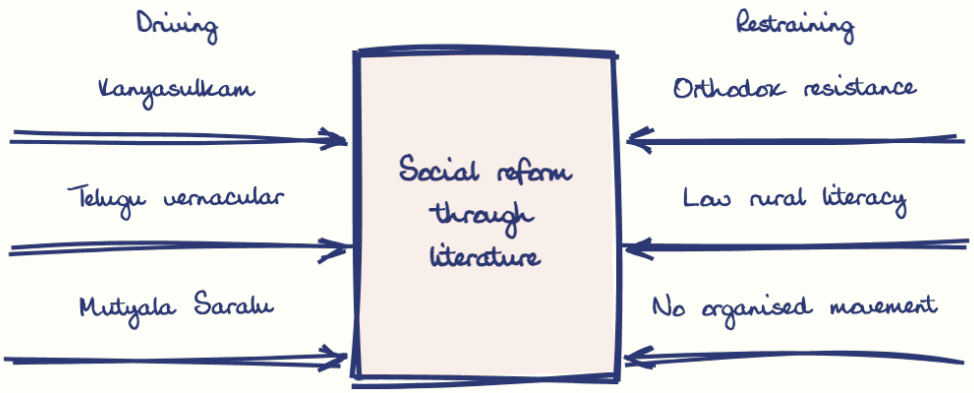
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4. Art with Purpose: His Mutyala Saralu poems pioneered a new style that combined artistic merit with social relevance.

5. Inspiration for Reformers: Later writers and reformers in Andhra used literature as a tool for change.

Gurajada's literary reform



Challenges and Limits

1. Conservative Resistance: Orthodox sections resisted giving up child marriage and dowry, limiting the immediate impact of Kanyasulkam.

2. Limited Reach: Writing in Telugu widened his audience, but low literacy in rural Visakhapatnam and nearby districts slowed the spread of his ideas among the most affected communities.

3. No Organised Movement: Without a large organised movement behind his writing, reform progressed only gradually and needed institutional and political support.

Way Forward

1. Literature in Education: Including his works in school and college curricula can deepen young learners' understanding of reform.
2. Digital Media: Sharing his plays and poems online can overcome literacy and geographic barriers.
3. Research and Festivals: Literary festivals and interdisciplinary research can connect his ideas to present social issues.

Conclusion

Gurajada Apparao's writing challenged regressive customs and promoted rational thought in Andhra. His use of Telugu literature as a medium for reform sowed seeds of progressive change that still inspire, showing how literature can serve social justice and equality.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

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SCAN

8(a)(ii) Write a short note on the following : (ii) Gidugu Ramamurthy's pioneering efforts to strengthen the Vyavaharika Bhasha movement

10

Introduction

The early 20th century witnessed a linguistic and cultural awakening in Andhra aimed at making education and literature accessible to common people. Gidugu Ramamurthy was central to it, promoting Vyavaharika Bhasha, or colloquial Telugu, against the dominance of the classical literary language, in line with the Curzon educational report of 1905 that stressed mother-tongue instruction.

Two forms of Telugu

Classical literary Telugu	Vyavaharika Bhasha
Rigid grammatical style	Everyday spoken idiom
Defended by orthodox schdars	Backed by Curzon report
Learning for a few	Literacy for common people

Gidugu Ramamurthy

1. Father of the Movement: Gidugu (1863 to 1940), a Telugu schdar and social reformer, is regarded as the father of the Vyavaharika

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Bhasha movement.

2. Opposing Literary Telugu: When only classical, grammatical Telugu was used in literature and education, he argued for the spoken language to make learning accessible.
3. Successor to Gurajada: After Gurajada Apparao's death he became the sole leader of the reform, fighting orthodox scholars.
4. Tribal Languages: He compiled a dictionary of the Savara language of the Parlakimidi region in Ganjam district.

The Movement and his Efforts

1. Natural Communication: The movement sought to replace rigid classical Telugu with everyday speech in books and schools.
2. Educational Backing: The Curzon report of 1905 required mother-tongue proficiency for children, strengthening the case for the vernacular.
3. Writing in Vaduka Bhasha: Gidugu's many books in the colloquial dialect showed its literary potential.
4. Support: Jayanti Ramayya, founder of the Andhra Sahitya Parishad, helped institutionalise the movement.

Impact

1. Schools: Colloquial Telugu was gradually accepted in schools, improving literacy among common people.
2. Persistence: Despite strong opposition, he shifted opinion and policy.
3. Legacy: His work laid the foundation of modern Telugu literature and education.

Way Forward

1. Mother-Tongue Education: Early schooling in the mother tongue, in the spirit of the movement and NEP 2020, should be strengthened.
2. Tribal Languages: His Savara work can guide efforts to document other tribal languages.

Conclusion

Gidugu Ramamurthy democratised Telugu by bringing the people's speech into books and classrooms. His persistence against orthodoxy created modern Telugu prose and education.

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8(b)(i)

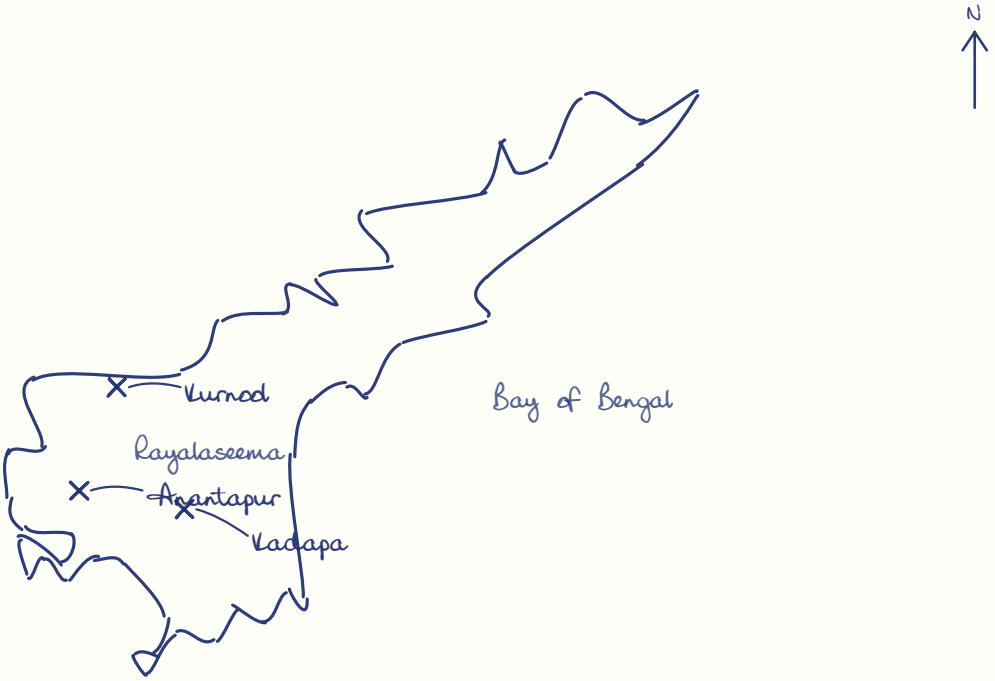
Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (i) Sir Thomas Munro

10

Introduction

Sir Thomas Munro, a prominent East India Company official, is remembered with respect in Andhra Pradesh for his revenue and judicial reforms in the early 19th century. His policies shaped the socio-economic landscape of South India, especially the ceded districts of Rayalaseema, during British consolidation.

Munro's ceded districts



Ryotwari and survey 1802 to 1807

Administrative and Institutional Reforms

1. Ryotwari System: He introduced the Ryotwari system in the Bara Mahals and the ceded districts, collecting revenue directly from cultivators and bypassing zamindars. Peasants gained rights to sell, mortgage or sublet land.
2. Survey and Settlement: Between 1802 and 1807 he surveyed the ceded districts, registering holdings and fixing assessments, work still valued in land disputes.
3. Poligar Suppression: With military support he pacified the lawless poligars, restoring order.
4. Judicial Commission: As its President (1814 to 1818), he moved police supervision from judges to collectors and let village officials handle petty crimes.

Welfare Measures

1. Famine Relief: During the drought and floods of 1802 to 1803 he repaired tanks and irrigation channels without waiting for government orders.
2. Support to Ryots: He advanced loans to ryots for seeds and implements, showing concern for agrarian welfare amid colonial revenue demands.

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Limitations and Outcomes

1. Paternalism: His approach was authoritarian, emphasising British control and excluding Indian political participation.
2. Mixed Economic Impact: Ryotwari raised Company revenue but imposed heavy taxes, causing rural distress in some areas.
3. Education: His plan for schools across the Madras Presidency failed for lack of sustained support, and missionary schools, often with proselytising aims, filled the gap.

Way Forward

1. Local Governance: Empowering village officials with autonomy and resources can strengthen grassroots administration.

Conclusion

Munro left a lasting imprint on Andhra's administrative and agrarian systems through the Ryotwari settlement and judicial reforms. His paternalism constrained political agency, but his efforts to stabilise and systematise governance shaped the region's colonial legacy.

Which sub-topic comes next?
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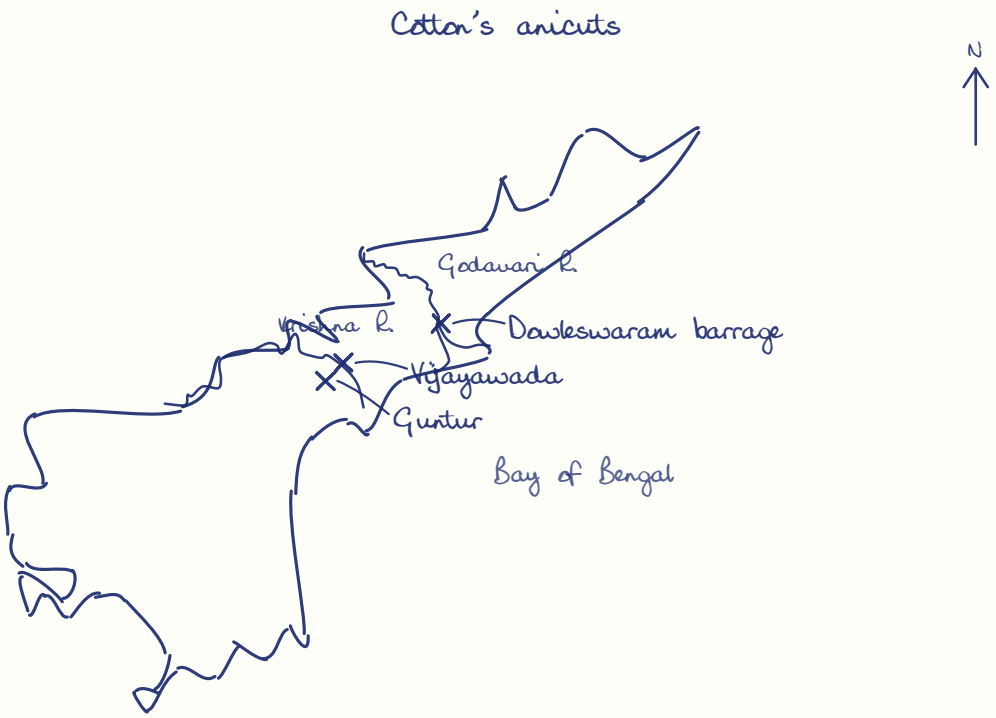
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8(b)(ii) Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (ii) Sir Arthur Cotton

10

Introduction

Sir Arthur Cotton, an East India Company engineer of the 19th century, is revered in Andhra Pradesh for his pioneering irrigation works. His work came after recurrent famines such as the devastating Guntur famine of 1833–34, and it transformed the agriculture of the Godavari and Krishna basins.



Godavari anicut 1852, Krishna anicut 1855

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Engineering Vision and Leadership

1. Godavari Anicut: His (1844) report led the Madras government to approve an anicut near Rajahmundry, which he completed in (1852) at only Rs. (1,50,000).
2. Cost-Effective Engineering: He was called the "founder of the cheapest school of engineering in the world".
3. Indian Collaboration: Veenam Veeranna managed labour and was honoured with the title "Rao Bahadur".

Socio-Economic Impact

1. Famine Mitigation: The anicut ended famines in East and West Godavari and made the region the "Rice bowl of Andhra Pradesh".
2. Krishna Anicut: He was associated with the anicut at Vijayawada, completed in (1855), which boosted productivity in Krishna district.
3. Regional Development: Irrigation improved food security, revenue and local markets.
4. Legacy: After over (150) years, the state built a new barrage named after him, the Sir

Arthur Cotton barrage.

Challenges Overcome

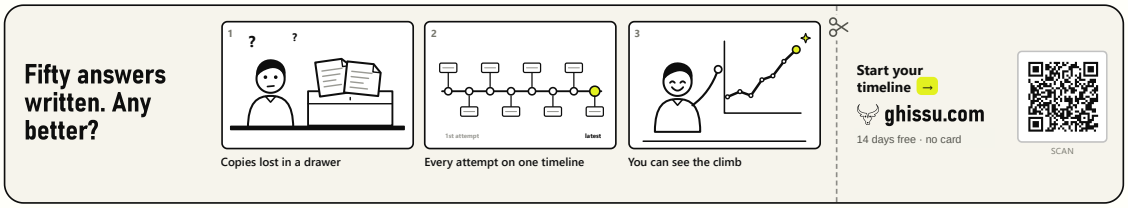
1. Terrain and Labour: He managed difficult terrain, thousands of unskilled workers and colonial red tape.
2. Resource Use: Innovative use of local materials and labour completed the work at a fraction of the expected cost and set a benchmark for public works.

Way Forward

1. Modernising Irrigation: Upgrading projects inspired by his legacy can meet today's water challenges in the Krishna and Godavari basins.

Conclusion

Cotton's low-cost, inclusive engineering ended famines and created lasting prosperity in the Godavari and Krishna deltas, and he remains honoured in Andhra's memory.



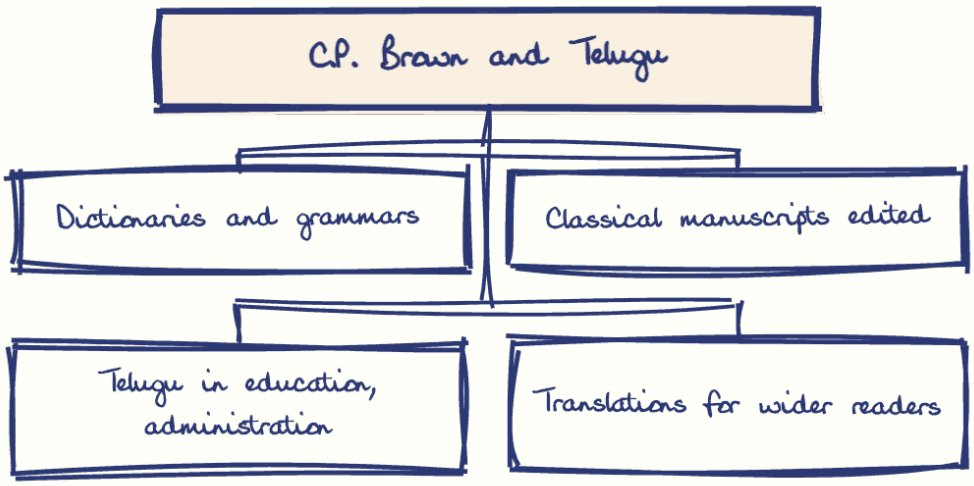
8(b)(iii)

Write a short note on the following East India Company officials and their contributions : (iii) Charles Phillip Brown

10

Introduction

Charles Phillip Brown, an East India Company official in the 19th century, is renowned for his profound contributions to Telugu language and literature. He worked at a time when colonial administration often overlooked indigenous languages, which makes his efforts to preserve and promote regional identity especially significant.



Contributions to Telugu

1. Linguistic Scholarship: As a civil servant in the Madras Presidency, he studied Telugu deeply and compiled dictionaries and grammars that became

foundational texts for scholars and students.

2. Promotion of Telugu Education: He encouraged Telugu in education and administration, countering the colonial tendency to prioritise English and Tamil, and helped make Telugu a language of learning and governance.
3. Literary Revival: He collected, edited and published many classical Telugu manuscripts, rescuing them from neglect and decay and reviving interest among Indians and Europeans.
4. Cultural Mediation: His translations and commentaries made Telugu literature accessible to a wider audience and fostered cross-cultural understanding.

Challenges and Impact

1. Colonial Constraints: He worked within a bureaucracy whose language policies favoured English, which made his advocacy for Telugu difficult.
2. Social Reception: Telugu intellectuals appreciated his work, but some viewed a British official's involvement in local culture with suspicion.
3. Educational Influence: His dictionaries and textbooks became standard references in schools

and colleges, shaping generations of Telugu speakers.

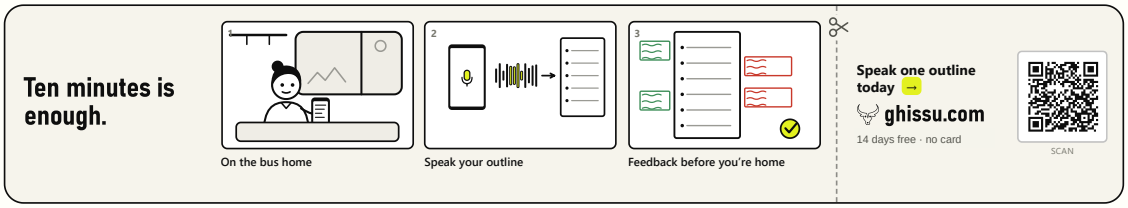
4. Legacy: Universities and literary societies in Andhra Pradesh continue to honour his contribution.

Way Forward

1. Digital Archiving: Digitising Brown's works and other Telugu manuscripts will keep them accessible.
2. Curriculum Integration: Telugu teaching in schools and colleges can draw on his scholarly methods and materials.
3. Support for Regional Languages: Funding research on regional languages would follow his pioneering example.

Conclusion

Brown's dedication shows how a colonial official could contribute positively to India's heritage despite the exploitative context of British rule. His work helped preserve a vital regional identity that still thrives in Andhra Pradesh.



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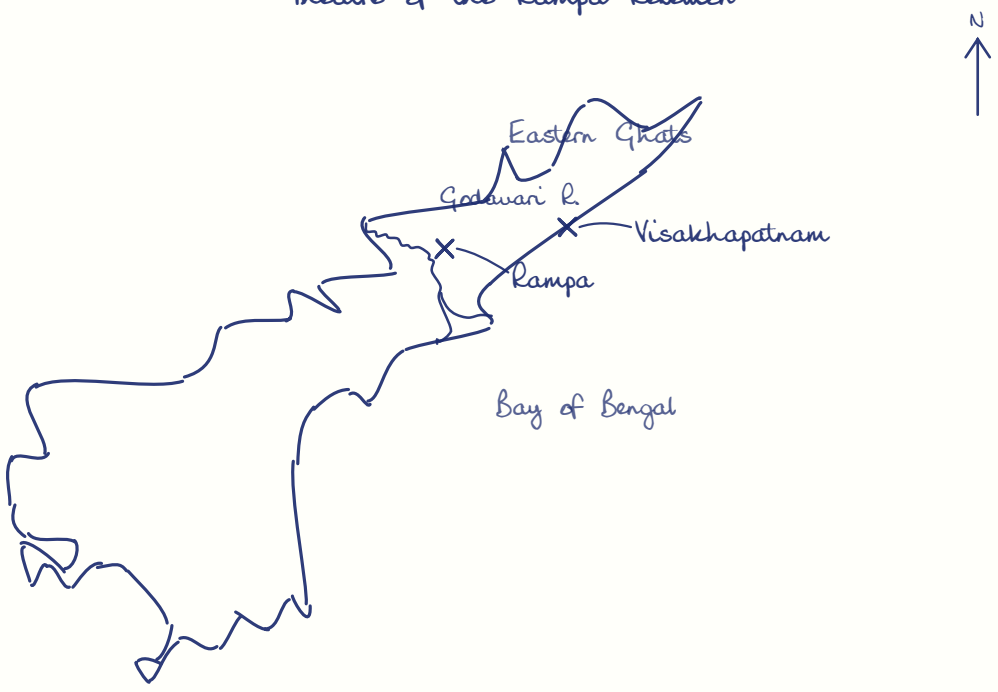
9(a) Examine the role of Alluri Sitarama Raju as the leader of Rampa Rebellion.

10

Introduction

The Rampa Rebellion (1922–1924), led by Alluri Sitarama Raju, was a significant tribal uprising in Andhra's freedom struggle. Unlike Congress-led movements, it grew from tribal grievances against exploitative forest laws and oppressive officials in the agency tracts of East Godavari and Visakhapatnam.

Theatre of the Rampa Rebellion



Agency tracts of East Godavari and Visakhapatnam, 1922–1924

Leadership Qualities and Strategies

1. Charismatic tribal leadership: Raju connected deeply

with the Koya and Konda Dora communities by addressing their exploitation by officials like Tahsildar Bastian. Claims of astrological and healing powers deepened their trust.

2. Guerrilla tactics: In the Gudem hills he used surprise raids on police stations to seize arms. The Damanapalli ghat ambush, which killed officers Scott Coward and Heiter, showed his tactical skill.

3. Nationalist and tribal integration: Influenced by Non-Cooperation but rejecting non-violence, he invoked the Kalki avatar alongside nationalist aims, mobilising support across about 2,500 square miles.

4. Loyal lieutenants: The Gam brothers and Pericherla Suryanarayana Raju helped sustain operations for two years.

Contribution to the Rebellion

1. Tribal mobilisation: He turned local discontent into a coordinated rebellion against forest policies and revenue exploitation.

2. Sustained armed resistance: Attacks on Chintapalli, Krishnadevupeta and Annavaram stations kept arms flowing and forced deployment of the Malabar Police and Assam Rifles.

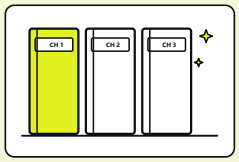
3. Endurance: He evaded capture until 1924 despite crackdowns.

Impact and Legacy

1. Colonial anxiety: Suppression cost the Madras government about Rs 15 lakhs.
2. Folk hero: He became a symbol of tribal resistance in Andhra Pradesh.
3. Limited recognition: The Congress and Andhra Mahasabha did not endorse the rebellion.

Conclusion

Alluri Sitarama Raju's leadership fused tribal grievance with nationalist fervour and posed a serious armed challenge to colonial rule.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

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SCAN

9(b) The evolution of Telugu Dalit literature has led an ideological narrative against caste discrimination, and for a just and equal society with focus on self-respect and dignity. In this connection, examine the contributions made by the Dalit Poets.

10

Introduction

The evolution of Telugu Dalit literature reflects the struggle against caste discrimination and the quest for dignity and equality. Rooted in Dalit realities in Andhra, it challenged Brahmanical hegemony, and Dalit poets shaped a narrative that exposed caste oppression while fostering self-respect and collective identity.

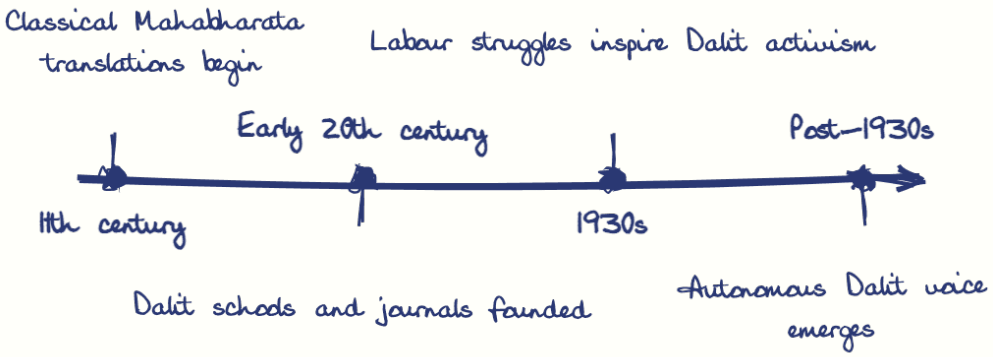
Evolution of Telugu Dalit Literature

1. Absence from the Canon: From the Mahabharata translations of Nannaya and Thikkana, mainstream Telugu literature was dominated by upper-caste narratives.
2. Dalit Intellectuals: In the early 20th century Jala Rangaswamy and Kusuma Dharmanna founded schools and journals such as Jaibheem and Veera-Bharathi.
3. Militant Themes: In the 1930s, poets backed agricultural labour struggles in coastal Andhra and critiqued caste Hindu landlords.

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Evolution of Telugu Dalit Literature



Narrative against Caste Discrimination

1. **Critique of Hegemony:** Poets exposed caste Hindu nationalists who preached equality but did not practise it.
2. **Equality and Swaraj:** They held that social equality and abolition of untouchability were essential for true swaraj.
3. **Rejection of Co-option:** They resisted absorption into mainstream nationalist projects and insisted on independent representation of Dalit realities and aspirations.

Contributions to Self-Respect and Dignity

1. **Dalit Identity:** Dharmanna's scathing attacks built an identity of self-respect and resistance, not victimhood.
2. **Exposing Atrocities:** Rangaswamy documented

atrocities and Dalit misery as protest.

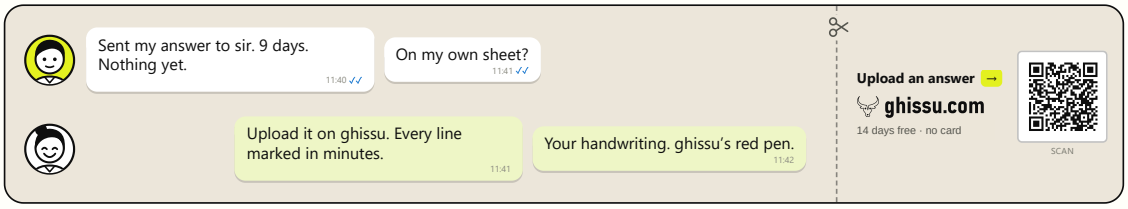
3. Cultural Mobilisation: Hostels, vocational schools and cultural programmes empowered youth and women.

4. New Aesthetics: New forms and imagery broke away from traditional styles.

5. Landmark Works: Gurram Jashuva's Gabbilam (1941) protested untouchability in polished classical metre, and Boyi Bhimanna's play Pakru gave voice to bonded farm servants.

Conclusion

Dalit poets transformed Telugu literature into a catalyst for social change, linking cultural dignity with democratic rights and a just, equal society.



10(a) Explain the inconsistencies of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014 that had adversely affected the residuary state of Andhra Pradesh with regards to apportionment of assets and liabilities.

10

Introduction

The Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014 bifurcated the state into Telangana and residuary Andhra Pradesh. Its inconsistencies in apportioning assets and liabilities severely disadvantaged the residuary state, which also lost Hyderabad as capital and revenue hub.

Where the Act fell short

Assets	Liabilities
Hyderabad kept, no compensation	No transparent debt formula
Revenue base to Telangana	Deficit grants not assured
Institutions in Telangana	Vague pension obligations
No Amaravati funding plan	Slow fund transfers

Inconsistencies in Asset Apportionment

1. Capital city ambiguity: Hyderabad was made common capital for up to ten years, but with no roadmap or compensation for a new capital, leaving

Andhra without a functional centre.

2. Revenue base disparity: Telangana retained Hyderabad's IT firms, pharmaceutical industries and business houses, leaving Andhra a diminished revenue base.
3. Institutional assets: Key educational and health institutions remained concentrated in Telangana, limiting service delivery.
4. Delayed capital: No timeline or funding mechanism for Amaravati caused delays and controversies.

Inconsistencies in Liability Apportionment

1. Unclear debt formula: No transparent formula for dividing pre-existing debt caused disputes and delayed settlements.
2. Inadequate fiscal support: Adequate revenue deficit grants to offset Hyderabad's loss were not assured.
3. Joint obligations: Vague provisions on pensions and employee benefits caused confusion and strain.
4. Slow transfers: Delayed transfer of funds and assets from the Centre and Telangana hurt fiscal stability.

Adverse Effects on Residuary Andhra Pradesh

1. Economic weakness: Often called a "pauper" state,

it struggled with a reduced tax base and weak infrastructure.

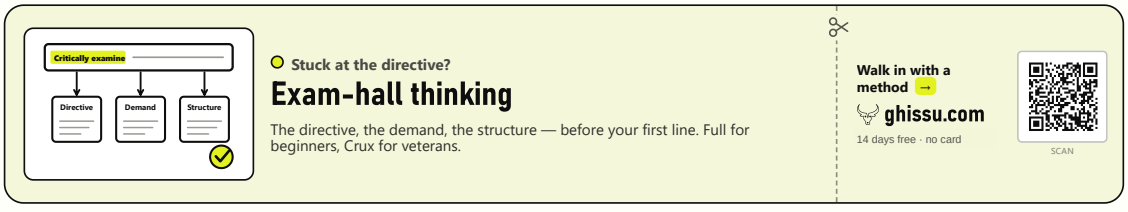
2. Governance challenges: Lacking a capital and institutions, service delivery suffered.
3. Regional imbalance: Backward regions like Rayalaseema fell further behind.
4. Discontent: Perceived injustice fuelled unrest and the demand for special category status.

Way Forward

1. Transparent settlements: An independent mechanism with clear timelines can resolve pending asset and liability disputes.
2. Fiscal support: Adequate revenue deficit grants and targeted schemes for backward regions can bridge gaps.

Conclusion

These inconsistencies handicapped the residuary state's economy and administration. A funded capital roadmap, transparent settlements and fiscal support, through cooperative federalism, can restore its development.

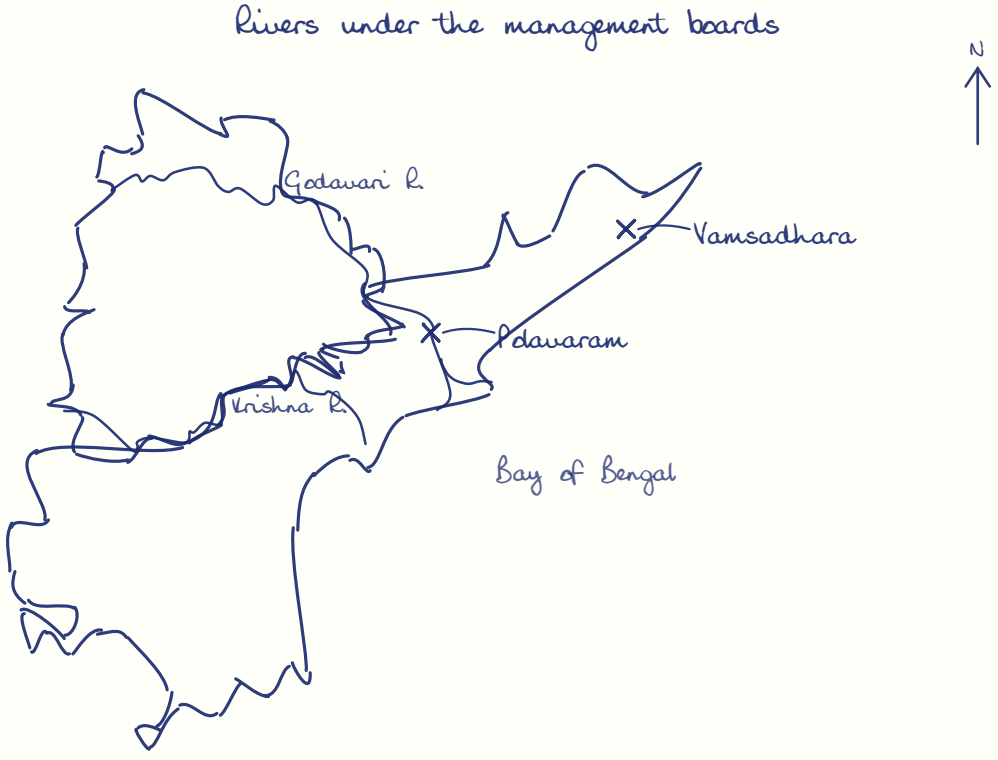


10(b) Examine the principles envisaged under Schedule Eleven of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act 2014, with reference to the functioning of the river management boards.

10

Introduction

The Andhra Pradesh Reorganization Act, 2014 bifurcated the state, making a framework for shared interstate rivers essential to prevent conflict. Schedule Eleven sets out principles for river management boards, crucial for cooperative water governance over the Godavari and Krishna.



Shared basins of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana

Principles Envisaged under Schedule Eleven

1. Legal and institutional framework: River management boards are statutory bodies to regulate, develop and conserve interstate rivers, prepare basin plans and coordinate between successor states.
2. Water sharing and disputes: Sharing is based on population ratios and historical use, the 58.32:41.68 ratio guides allocation, with supervisory committees and review authorities to settle disputes.
3. Operational provisions: The Act mandates river basin master plans, continuous monitoring of projects and expert and state members on executive boards.
4. Ecological management: Though not explicit, ecological factors are implied, in line with the River Basin Management Scheme.

Functioning of River Management Boards

1. Cooperative governance: Boards are platforms for dialogue between Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, supporting joint decisions and reducing unilateral action.
2. Equitable distribution: Population-based norms guide fair allocation, as the Vansadhara Tribunal's 50:50 sharing with Odisha shows.

3. Technical efficiency: Experts on boards improve planning and monitoring of projects like the Polavaram Irrigation Project.

4. Implementation challenges: Political interference, delays, and land and rehabilitation disputes, as in Polavaram's slow progress, hamper them, while overlapping jurisdiction with tribunals and courts creates ambiguity.

Way Forward

1. Board autonomy: Greater board autonomy from political pressure can ensure unbiased decisions.

2. Ecology: The Act should make ecological sustainability a core principle.

3. Transparency: Stakeholder consultation and open reporting can build trust.

4. Technology: Hydrological data systems and GIS mapping can enable real-time monitoring.

Conclusion

Schedule Eleven provides a foundation for cooperative and equitable river management. Effectively implemented, it can make interstate river governance a model of integrated water management, ensuring sustainable development, water security and regional harmony for both states.

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11(a) What are the climatic controls? How do they influence India's climate ?

10

Introduction

India's climate is shaped by climatic controls, natural factors that determine temperature, rainfall, humidity and seasonal variation. Given India's latitudinal extent from about 8°N to 37°N and its diverse topography, these controls matter for agriculture, water resources and disaster preparedness.

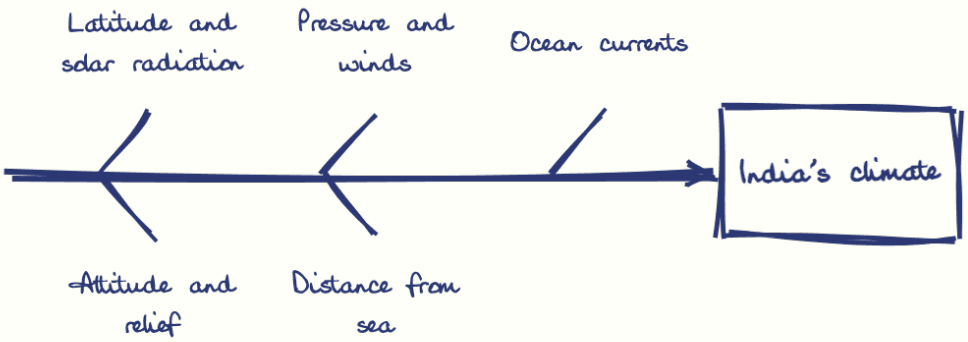
Climatic Controls

1. Latitude and solar radiation: Lying between the equator and the Tropic of Cancer, the south receives high insolation and stays consistently hot, while the north is more temperate with cooler winters.
2. Attitude and relief: The Himalayas, averaging about 6,000 metres, act as a climatic barrier, and the Western and Eastern Ghats induce orographic rainfall.
3. Pressure and wind systems: Pressure differences between land and the Indian Ocean drive the monsoon winds.
4. Distance from the sea: Maritime influence keeps

coastal places like Visakhapatnam moderate and humid, while interiors like Rayalaseema face extremes, a continental climate.

5. Ocean currents: Warm Indian Ocean currents affect monsoon onset and intensity, and sea surface temperatures drive cyclonic activity.

Controls of India's climate



Influence on India's Climate

1. Tropical and subtropical zones: Latitude gives a tropical south and subtropical north; coastal Andhra stays warm year-round, supporting rice and chillies.

2. Milder winters and microclimates: The Himalayas shield the north from severe cold, and the Eastern Ghats create pockets of dense tropical forest.

3. Seasonal rainfall: The southwest monsoon gives

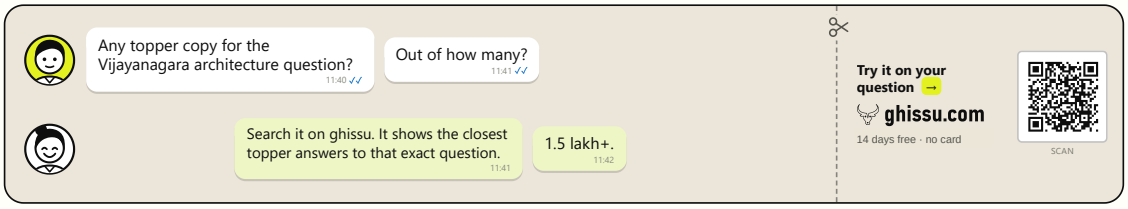
70–80% of India's rainfall, vital for the Godavari and Krishna basins, while the northeast monsoon gives Andhra Pradesh about one-third of its rain.

4. Temperature extremes: Coastal areas are humid with less variation, supporting aquaculture and horticulture, while interior Rayalaseema faces droughts.

5. Cyclone hazards: A warming Indian Ocean has raised cyclone frequency on the east coast, as seen in cyclones Titli and Gaja, raising risks of storm surges and salinity ingress.

Conclusion

Latitude, relief, winds, the sea and ocean currents interact to give India its diverse climate, from humid deltas to drought-prone interiors. Understanding them is crucial for climate-resilient agriculture, water management and disaster preparedness.



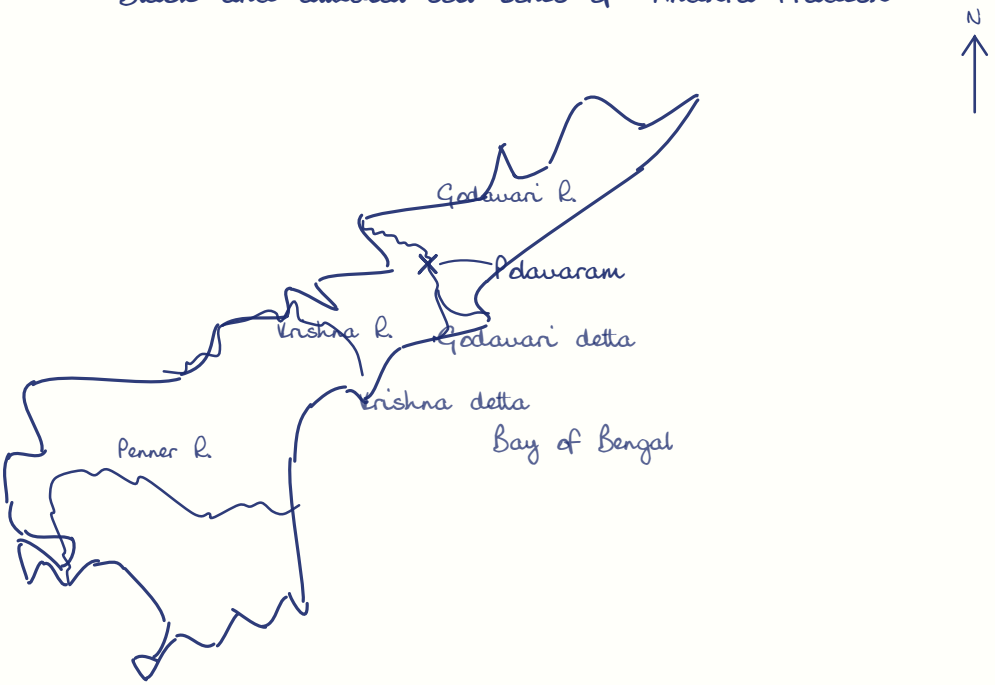
11(b) Describe the characteristic features of Black and Alluvial soils of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Soils shape the agricultural landscape of Andhra Pradesh, a state with physiography ranging from the Deccan Plateau to fertile river deltas. Among its soils, Black and Alluvial soils are particularly significant for their distinct properties and wide distribution.

Black and alluvial soil zones of Andhra Pradesh



alluvium in dettas, black soils on upland plateau

Characteristic Features of Black Soils

1. Origin and composition: Formed from Deccan lava flows, these clayey soils suit cotton and

are called Black Cotton Soils.

2. Physical properties: Dark, deep and impermeable, they become sticky when wet and develop wide cracks when dry, a self-ploughing action that aids aeration.
3. Distribution: They dominate the plateau uplands in the upper Godavari and Krishna basins, supporting cotton, pulses and oilseeds.
4. Fertility: Low in organic matter but rich in calcium carbonate, magnesium, potash and lime, and moisture-retentive.

Characteristic Features of Alluvial Soils

1. Formation and texture: Deposited by the Godavari, Krishna and Penneru, they range from sandy loam to clay and are renewed by river action.
2. Distribution: They cover the coastal plains and the Godavari and Krishna deltas, supporting intensive agriculture.
3. Fertility and crops: Rich in potash, phosphoric acid and lime, they suit rice, sugarcane and pulses, making the state a major rice-producing region, especially East and West Godavari.

Way Forward

1. **Soil health:** Integrated nutrient management and natural farming under ~~APCNF~~ to sustain fertility.
2. **Irrigation and diversification:** Efficient irrigation like the Polavaram Project, with cotton and pulses on black soils and paddy and sugarcane on alluvial soils.

Black vs alluvial soils

Black soils	Alluvial soils
From Deccan lava	From river sediments
Clayey, moisture-retentive	Sandy loam to clay
Upland plateau	Coastal plains and deltas
Cotton, pulses, oilseeds	Rice, sugarcane

Conclusion

Black soils sustain the dryland cotton and pulse belt of the plateau, while alluvial soils make the deltas a rice bowl. Their sustainable management is key to farm productivity.

150 · 250 · 500 words.
Same question, three model answers.
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12(a) What are the objectives and key features of Sagarmala Project ? Why is it important ?

10

Introduction

India's coastline of about 11,098 km and its location on major maritime routes offer a big opportunity for port-led development. The Sagarmala Project aims to harness this by improving port infrastructure and connectivity, with Andhra Pradesh's ports like Visakhapatnam playing a key role.

Objectives

1. Reduce logistics costs: for domestic and export-import cargo by optimising transport modes.
2. Promote port-led industrialisation: through coastal economic zones and clusters.
3. Generate employment: and uplift coastal communities.

Key Features

1. Comprehensive national programme: A flagship of the Ministry of Ports, Shipping and Waterways covering 13 coastal states and UTs.
2. Multi-agency coordination: Central ministries, states and port authorities work together.

3. Infrastructure and connectivity: Port modernisation, new ports and multimodal connectivity by road, rail and inland waterways.
4. Sagarmala 2.0: Sagarmala Finance Corporation Limited has sanctioned loans of over 4,300 crore.
5. Scale: 845 projects worth 6.06 lakh crore are underway, with 315 completed.

Why It Is Important

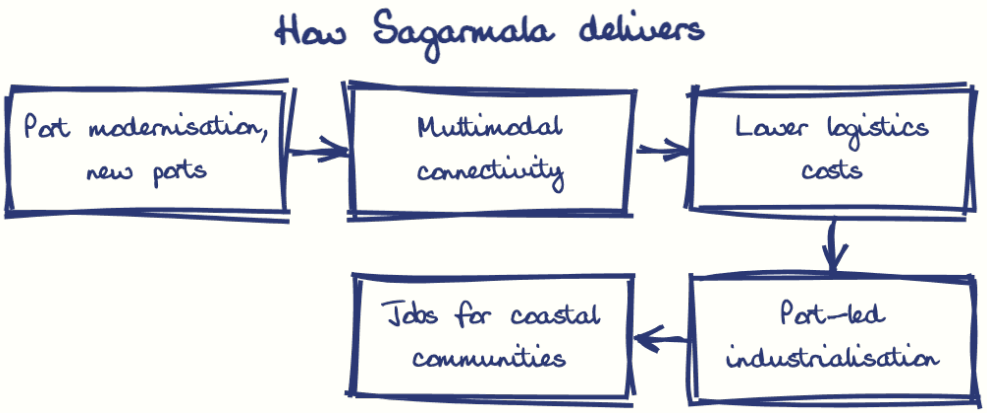
1. Trade competitiveness: Port capacity has doubled since 2013–14 and ship turnaround times fell by nearly 60%.
2. Industry and jobs: Coastal economic zones aid manufacturing states like Andhra Pradesh, and 15 million jobs are expected by 2047.
3. Sustainability: Coastal shipping and inland waterways are more energy-efficient and cut carbon emissions compared to road transport.
4. Social upliftment: Port expansion creates jobs that reduce poverty in coastal communities.

Challenges and Way Forward

Some ports remain underused because rail and road links lag behind, a concern for Andhra Pradesh

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin



too. Integrated hinterland connectivity, faster inter-agency approvals, public-private partnerships and maritime skill programmes will help Sagarmala reach its goals.

Conclusion

Sagarmala is a transformative initiative that uses India's maritime advantages to cut logistics costs, boost industry and create jobs, with major gains for coastal states like Andhra Pradesh. It moves India towards becoming a global maritime hub.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

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see page 4

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Scan to practice

12(b) Discuss the role of sea-ports in the economic development of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Sea-ports are critical nodes in trade networks. With an extensive 974 km coastline and major ports like Visakhapatnam and Krishnapatnam, Andhra Pradesh is strategically placed to use maritime infrastructure for growth, and port modernisation under Sagarmala adds to this.

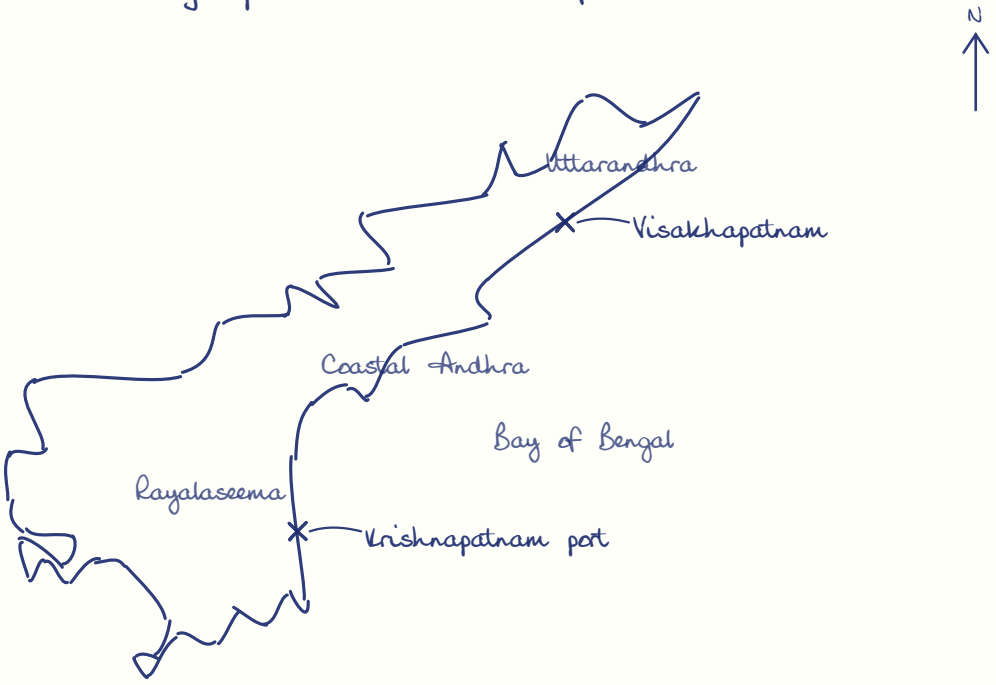
How Sea-Ports Contribute to Development

1. **Trade and commerce:** Ports handle large cargo volumes, cutting logistics costs; globally, a 1 million tonne rise in throughput creates about 300 jobs.
2. **Industrial growth:** Access to raw materials and markets drives port-led industrialisation in coastal economic zones.
3. **Employment and skills:** Ports and allied industries create direct and indirect jobs in logistics, shipbuilding and fisheries, and skill programmes improve coastal livelihoods.
4. **Regional development:** Ports spur road, rail and inland waterway links to the hinterland, fostering regional integration.

Practice 12(b) on Ghissu →
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Scan to practice

Major ports and hinterland of Andhra Pradesh



Specific Impact on Andhra Pradesh

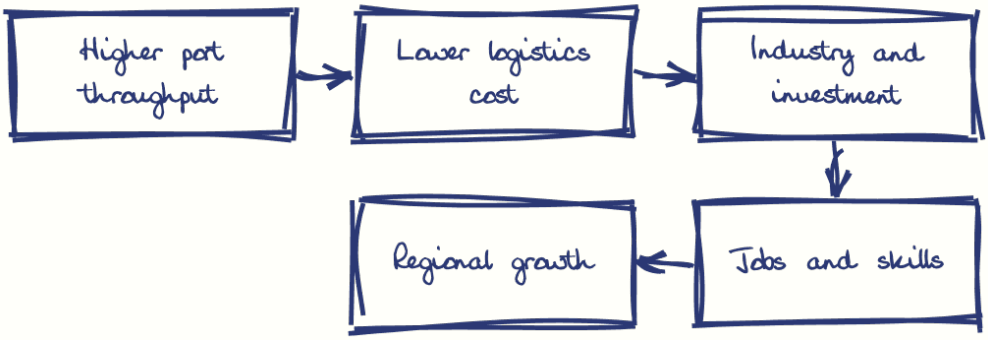
1. **Export boost:** Ports ship chillies and aquaculture produce, supporting a GSDP of 8.73 lakh crore in 2024–25 with 9.24% growth.
2. **Industrial hub:** Visakhapatnam port supports steel plants, oil refineries and shipbuilding, attracting investment and revenue.
3. **Regional balance:** The Visakhapatnam–Chennai corridor improves access to backward Rayalaseema and North Andhra.
4. **Challenges:** Project delays, weak last-mile connectivity, underused port land and governance issues in state enterprises constrain port-led

growth.

Way Forward

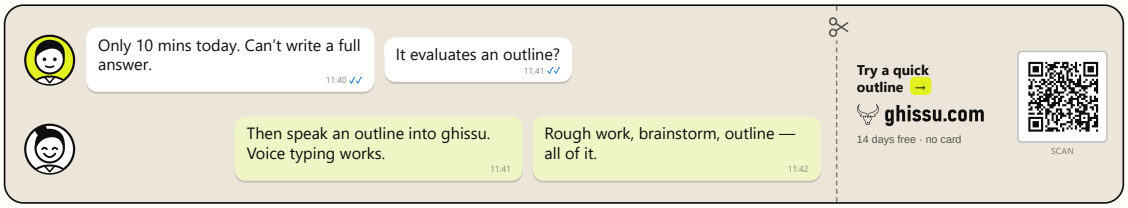
1. Hinterland connectivity: Stronger rail and road links, especially in backward regions.
2. Port-led clusters: Coastal Economic Zones with incentives under Sagarmala.
3. Skills: Targeted training for coastal communities in port and maritime jobs.

Port-led development chain



Conclusion

Sea-ports are pivotal to Andhra Pradesh's economic development through trade, industrial growth and regional integration. With better connectivity, governance and skills, they can drive inclusive growth.



13(a) Give a description of the 'demographic dividend' in the Indian context.

10

Introduction

India is in a phase where the working-age population (15–64 years) far exceeds dependants. This demographic dividend, expected to peak around 2041 with 59% of people of working age, is a historic opportunity. With 68% of working age and 26% aged 10–24, India is among the youngest nations.

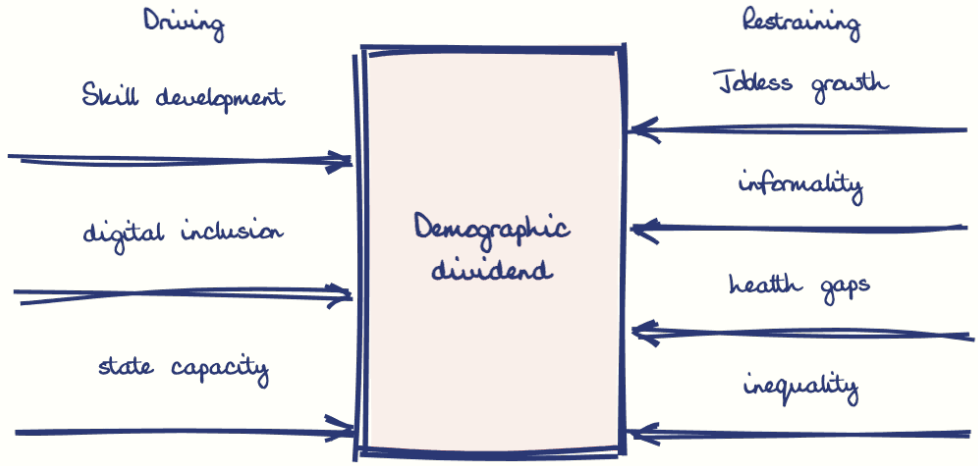
Institutional Framework

1. Skill development: The Skill India Mission addresses skill deficits, drawing on models like Germany's dual vocational system.
2. State capacity: Andhra Pradesh's 9.24% GSDP growth in 2024–25 and per capita income of 2,68,653 against India's 2,00,162 show capacity to absorb workers.
3. Health gaps: Andhra faces 16% doctor and 21% staff nurse shortages in secondary healthcare.
4. Digital inclusion: Digital India expands access to services and formal finance.

Implementation Challenges

1. **Employment absorption:** Employment-to-working-age ratios have fallen in many states; Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu grow at about 6.7–6.8% while Uttar Pradesh and Bihar stay below 4%.
2. **Jobless growth:** A large informal economy, de-industrialisation and technology disruption create a mismatch between labour supply and quality jobs.
3. **Inequality:** Uneven demographic transitions across states and wealth concentration, with the top 10% holding 77%, restrict inclusive growth, and only 28% of rural women have internet access.
4. **Human development:** India ranks 134 of 191 on the UNDP index, showing education and health gaps that cut productivity.

Reaping the demographic dividend



Way Forward

1. **Skilling:** Expand vocational and digital literacy training, especially in Andhra Pradesh's rural and semi-urban areas.
2. **Health:** Raise budgets and fill healthcare vacancies to keep the workforce productive.
3. **Formal jobs:** Support industrial diversification and MSMEs, using port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai.
4. **Inclusion:** Progressive taxation and wider digital access for rural women.

Conclusion

The demographic dividend is a transformative but time-bound window that peaks around 2041. Harnessed through strong institutions, skills, health and inclusive policy, as states like Andhra Pradesh show, it can deliver Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

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13(b) What are different types of rural settlements and factors affecting them ? Add a note on rural settlement patterns in India.

10

Introduction

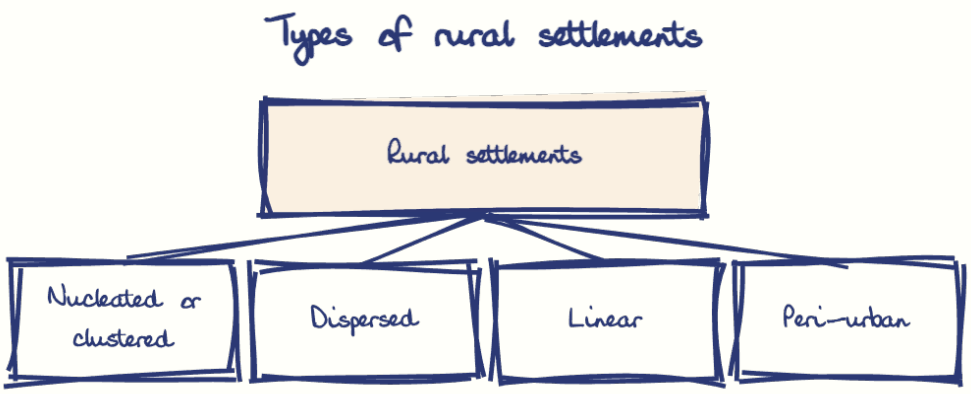
Rural settlements form the backbone of India's agrarian society, housing over 65% of the population. Their forms reflect variations in physical geography, social structure and economic activity, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh where farming dominates.

Types of Rural Settlements

1. Nucleated or clustered: Compact villages in fertile plains like the Krishna delta, suited to intensive irrigated farming.
2. Dispersed: Scattered homes in hilly areas like the Eastern Ghats, linked to pastoral or shifting cultivation.
3. Linear: Villages along roads, highways and canals, as on canal banks in Andhra Pradesh.
4. Peri-urban: Census Towns where growth blurs rural-urban distinctions.

Factors Affecting Rural Settlements

1. Terrain and water: Settlements locate near rivers, lakes and springs.



2. Land tenure: Zamindari and Ryotwari systems produced clustered villages with elites at the centre and labourers on the periphery.
3. Caste: Upper castes occupy central or elevated areas and lower castes the outskirts, shaping social distance within villages.
4. Agriculture and connectivity: Intensive irrigated farming favours clusters, while roads and canals create linear villages.
5. Governance: The 73rd Amendment empowered panchayats to improve water, sanitation and roads.

Rural Settlement Patterns in India

Fertile plains show nucleated patterns, hills dispersed ones, and transport corridors linear ones. Population pressure is expanding villages into peri-urban settlements, and Census Towns need urban services

without urban status. Sanitation gaps, fragmented holdings that drive migration from Rayalaseema, and caste exclusion persist.

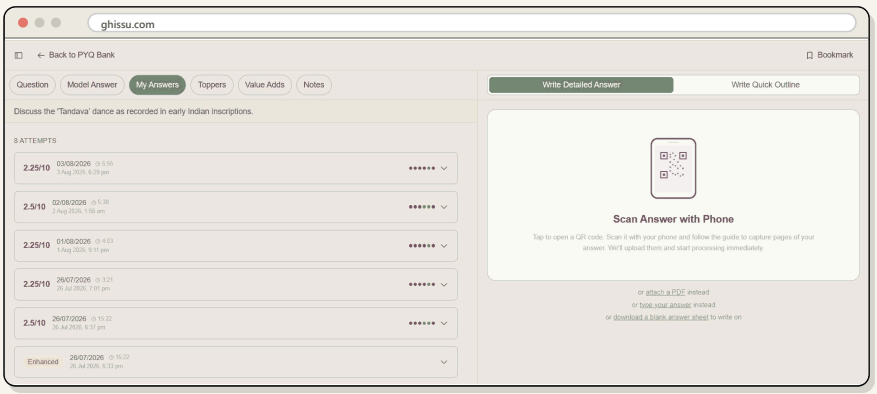
Conclusion

Rural settlements mirror India's geography and society, but infrastructure deficits, agrarian distress and social exclusion still hold many villages back. Settlement-specific planning suited to plains, hills and corridors, better infrastructure and inclusive governance that bridges caste divides are key to balanced rural development.

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MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

Fifty answers written. Are you any better?



1 Eight attempts at one question, first to latest.

2 Every one scored — the curve is visible.

3 Enhanced versions kept beside your own.

Start your timeline →

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14(a) Discuss the various forest conservation programmes in India.

10

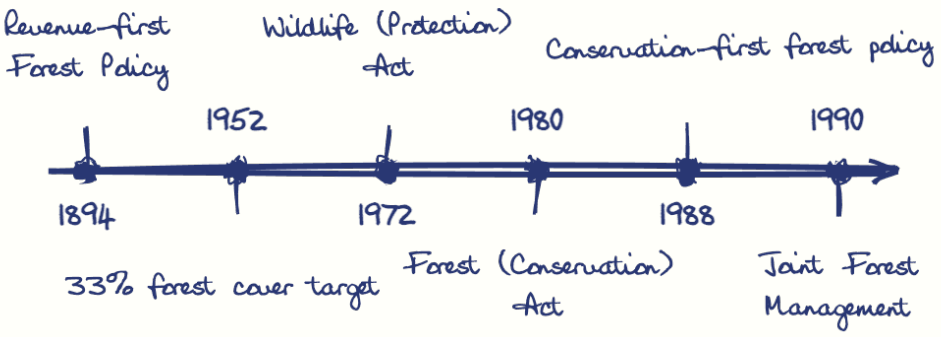
Introduction

India's forests are critical for ecological balance, climate regulation and livelihoods. Despite legal frameworks and forest cover rising to about 25% of the area, degradation, illegal exploitation and conflicting land use persist. Forest conservation programmes have evolved through reforms, community participation and scientific management.

Policy and Institutional Framework

1. **Colonial roots:** The 1855 Charter and 1894 Forest Policy prioritised revenue, causing conflicts like the Forest Satyagraha in Palnadu, Guntur.
2. **Forest Policy 1952:** Recognised forests' protective role and set a 33% forest cover target.
3. **National Forest Policy 1988:** Shifted to conservation and introduced Joint Forest Management, implemented from 1990.
4. **Laws and funding:** The Forest (Conservation) Act 1980 and Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972 regulate diversion, while CAMPA funds afforestation.

Evolution of forest conservation in India



Major Programmes

1. Afforestation missions: The National Afforestation Programme and Green India Mission balance ecology and economy.
2. Social forestry and agroforestry: Trees on farms and village woodlots expand cover beyond reserved forests.
3. MGNREGA: Links conservation with rural jobs, easing pressure in drought-prone Andhra Pradesh.
4. Research and capacity: ICFRE and state departments support training and research.
5. Climate link: NAPCC and INCCA integrate forests into climate policy.

Challenges

1. Quality of cover: Plantations and monocultures inflate the 25.17% cover figure and hide the degradation of natural forests.

2. Community conflict: Grievances like those in Palnadu show tensions between officials and the forest-dependent poor.

3. Opportunity costs: Land-use restrictions affect development projects in states like Andhra Pradesh.

Way Forward

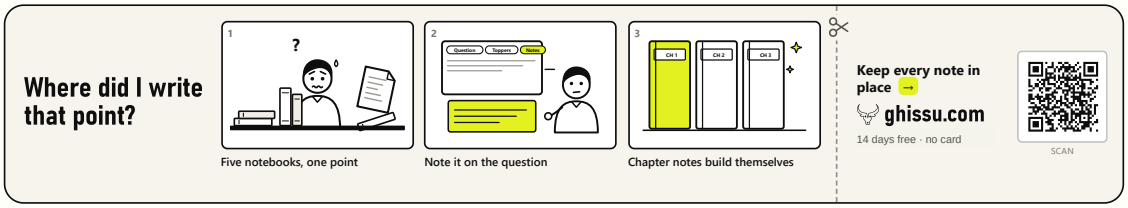
1. Community rights: Stronger Forest Rights Act implementation for tribal and forest-dependent communities.

2. Monitoring: Remote sensing and field surveys to separate natural forests from plantations.

3. Restoration: Scale up the Green India Mission with native species.

Conclusion

India's programmes have moved from central control to participatory conservation, but must now focus on forest quality.



14(b) Discuss various in situ conservation strategies of biodiversity in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

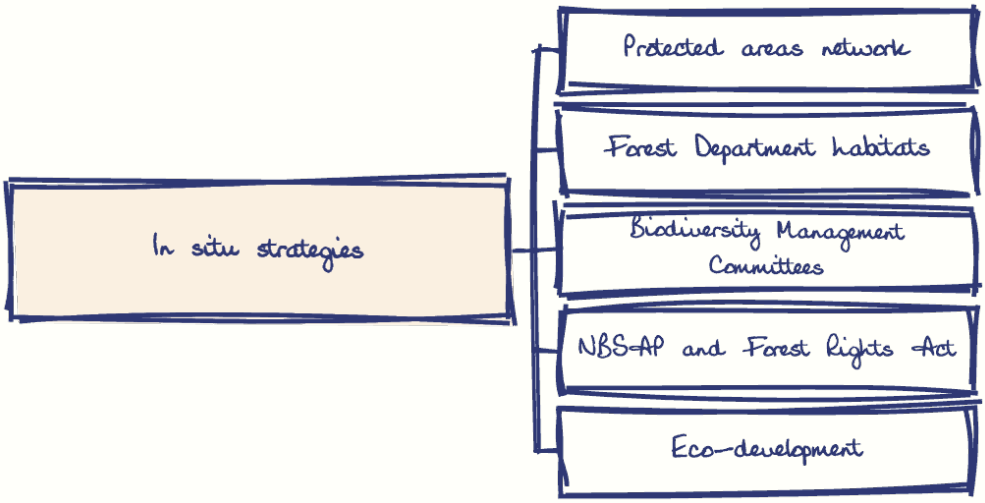
Biodiversity conservation sustains ecological balance and livelihoods in Andhra Pradesh, which hosts endemic species such as Cycas beddomei and Pterocarpus santalinus. In situ conservation, protecting species in their natural habitats, preserves genetic diversity and ecosystem functions across ecosystems from the Eastern Ghats to coastal mangroves.

In Situ Conservation Strategies

1. **Forest management:** The Forest Department manages dry deciduous forests and mangroves in the Godavari and Krishna estuaries, home to fishing cats and otters.
2. **Protected areas network:** Wildlife sanctuaries and protected areas, part of India's network of over 1,134, form core zones for tigers and panthers.
3. **Biodiversity Management Committees:** Under the Biodiversity Act, BMCs involve communities and document species in People's Biodiversity Registers.
4. **Policy instruments:** The NBSAP 2024–30 prioritises in situ conservation, while the Forest Rights Act secures community rights.

5. Eco-development: Programmes giving alternative livelihoods reduce pressure on forests.

In situ conservation in Andhra Pradesh



Challenges

1. Human-wildlife conflict: Conflict near forest fringes where farming and livestock dominate needs landscape management and community participation.
2. Habitat fragmentation: Mining and infrastructure fragment habitats, and C&AG reports flag gaps in mining regulation.
3. Livelihood dependence: Many communities depend on forest resources, complicating strict protection.
4. Weak monitoring: Surveys have begun, but data on species distribution and ecosystem health remain limited, hampering adaptive management.

Way Forward

1. Empower BMCs: Technical and financial support, using traditional knowledge.
2. Corridors: Link fragmented patches in the Eastern Ghats.
3. Development planning: Strict environmental impact assessments for mining and infrastructure projects.
4. Capacity building: Monitoring technology and training for forest officials and local communities.

Assessment

The framework is sound, but threats lie outside protected areas, where mining, infrastructure and farming fragment habitats. Success depends on communities gaining from protection.

Conclusion

In situ conservation is crucial to preserve Andhra Pradesh's unique biodiversity and the ecosystem services that support rural livelihoods. Robust institutions, community engagement and science can make it succeed and advance SDG (15) on life on land.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

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Scan to practice

15(a) What is meant by Environment Impact Assessment ? Evaluate it. Also give suggestions to make it effective.

10

Introduction

Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA) is a planning tool that integrates environmental considerations into development projects at an early stage. In states like Andhra Pradesh, with expanding urban centres and large irrigation projects such as Jala Yagnam, EIA helps foresee and mitigate environmental damage.

Significance of EIA

1. Early identification of risks: Adverse impacts are predicted at the feasibility stage, allowing design changes. MoEFCC mandates EIA for projects likely to alter ecosystems.
2. Integrated mitigation: Environment Management Plans embed mitigation in execution, avoiding costly redesigns.
3. Informed decision-making: Public hearings add transparency and legitimacy, crucial for sensitive coastal areas like Visakhapatnam.
4. Sustainable development: EIA aligns growth with initiatives like NCAP and Mission LiFE.

Limitations

1. Inadequate coverage: Many high-impact projects remain outside the mandatory EIA ambit.
2. Quality and transparency: Reports lack biodiversity detail and EMPs are not fully disclosed.
3. Weak public participation: Hearings often fail to engage marginalised groups.
4. Poor post-clearance monitoring: Enforcement is inconsistent, as gaps in urban solid waste management in Andhra Pradesh show.

EIA in India: an evaluation

Strengths	Limitations
Early risk identification	Inadequate coverage
Mitigation through EMPs	Poor report quality
Public hearings	Weak participation
Informed decisions	Weak post-clearance monitoring

Suggestions

1. Independent EIA authority: A statutory autonomous state body for impartial assessment.
2. Wider coverage: Include smaller-scale and urban

projects.

3. Transparency: Publish full EIA reports and EMPs online.

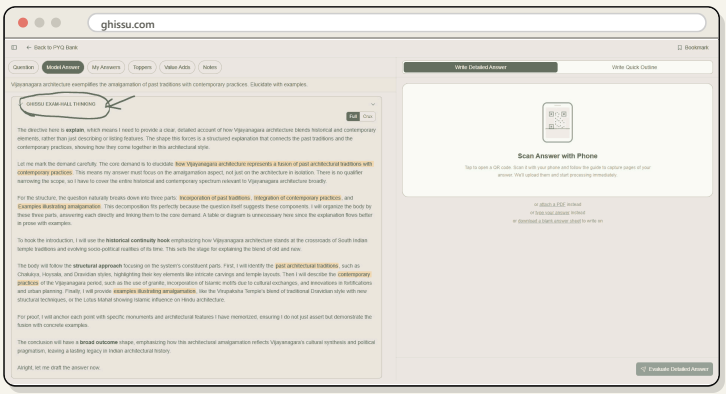
4. Monitoring: Continuous compliance checks using technology and community monitoring.

Conclusion

EIA is vital for sustainable development, particularly in fast-growing states like Andhra Pradesh, but its limitations undermine its potential. Stronger institutions, wider coverage, transparency and enforcement will make it serve the Sustainable Development Goals.

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Know the topic, but freeze at the question?



Decode your next question →

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1 The question broken open before a single line of the answer.

2 Directive, demand and structure highlighted in the text.

3 Full walks a beginner through it; Crux is a ten-second check.

15(b) Define 'Drought'. What are its different types ? Add a note on drought prone areas in India.

10

Introduction

Drought is a prolonged deficiency in water availability due to sub-normal rainfall or its erratic distribution. In India, where farming depends on the southwest monsoon, it threatens food security, livelihoods and water resources.

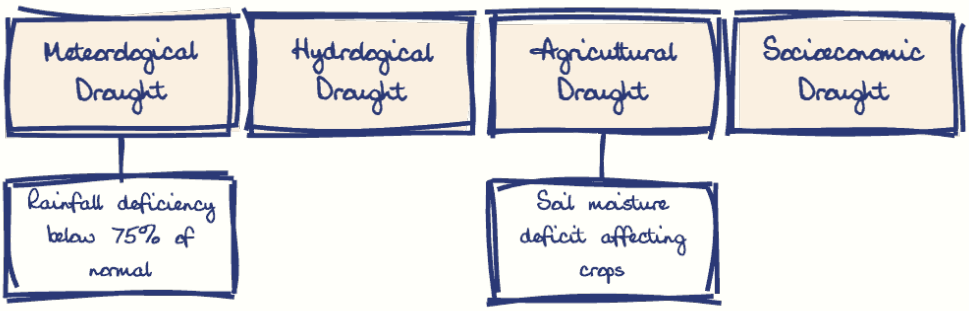
Definition

The IMD defines drought as mean annual rainfall below 75% of normal, and severe drought as a deficit above 50%. Timing and distribution of rain matter as much as quantity.

Types of Drought

1. Meteorological: Rainfall deficiency over a period.
2. Hydrological: Reduced surface and groundwater, with drying rivers and falling water tables.
3. Agricultural: Insufficient soil moisture causing crop failure.
4. Socioeconomic: Effects on livelihoods, causing migration, food insecurity and poverty.

Types of Drought



Drought Prone Areas in India

1. **Extent:** About (19%) of India's area and (12%) of its population face drought each year; about (30%) of the country is drought-prone.
2. **Arid west:** Western Rajasthan (Marusthali, Jaisalmer, Barmer) and Kachchh in Gujarat are most severe.
3. **Rain-shadow saith:** Southern rain-shadow regions, including Rayalaseema in Andhra Pradesh, suffer recurrent drought, which the state tackles through watershed development and micro-irrigation under Krishi Sinchai Yojana.

Impacts and Management

1. **Impacts:** Drought causes crop failure, fodder scarcity, falling water tables and migration; Andhra Pradesh's 2014-15 season saw food grain output fall.

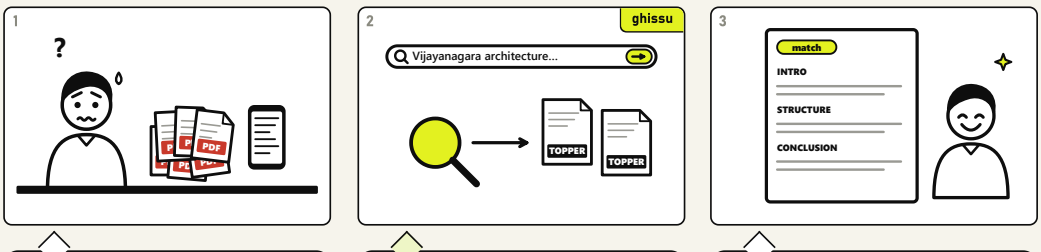
2. Institutions: The NDMA leads long-term mitigation, while states declare drought using the Manual for Drought Management (2009).
3. Early warning: Community-led systems, as in Marathwada, show the value of local participation.

Conclusion

Drought is a recurring hazard for India's rainfed economy, hitting small and marginal farmers hardest through crop loss, debt and migration. It must be managed through early warning, watershed development, micro-irrigation and groundwater recharge as monsoons become less predictable.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW · TOPPERS' ANSWERS, PER QUESTION

The topper copy hunt



Telegram, YouTube, forty PDFs... nothing on this question.

Type the question into ghissu.

Five topper answers to this exact one!

— Borrow the topper's approach, not the topper's sentences.

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APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2020

This book is arranged year by year. For subject-wise, topic-wise and sub-topic-wise PYQs, with UPSC questions from 1979 to 2026 mapped to the APPSC syllabus, sign in at **ghissu.com** and join the waitlist (usually approved in 1 to 2 days).

1(a) Critically explain the salient features of urban planning of Harappan Civilization.

10

Introduction

The urban planning of the Harappan Civilization, dating to about 2600 to 1900 BCE, is one of the earliest examples of sophisticated city design. Grid streets and advanced drainage reflect a highly organised and disciplined society.

Salient Features

1. **Grid pattern layout:** Cities like Mohenjo-Daro, Harappa and Dholavira had grid-pattern streets oriented to the cardinal directions, with wide main roads crossed by narrower lanes.
2. **Citadel and lower town:** A raised, often fortified citadel held civic and ritual structures, such as the Great Bath at Mohenjo-Daro, while the lower town had houses around courtyards.
3. **Drainage and sanitation:** Covered drains ran along streets and connected to house drains, ensuring waste water management unparalleled in contemporary civilizations.
4. **Standardised building materials:** Kiln-fired bricks of uniform size (about 7 × 14 × 28 cm) showed quality control and durability in

flood-prone areas.

5. Water management: Wells and large reservoirs, especially at Dholavira, show rainwater harvesting, while granaries stored agricultural surplus.

Harappan planning: strengths and limits

Strengths	Limits
Grid streets, civic order	Uniformity may curb mobility
Covered drains, hygiene	Citadel apart, stratification
Reservoirs, raised platforms	Vulnerable to climate change

Critical Analysis

1. Civic order and health: Such planning suggests a centralised authority able to organise labour and resources efficiently.
2. Economic implications: Granaries and standardised weights point to a regulated economy supporting trade and craft specialisation.
3. Limited inclusivity: Segregation of citadel and residential areas may indicate social stratification. The absence of palaces or monumental temples suggests a different political

order, still debated.

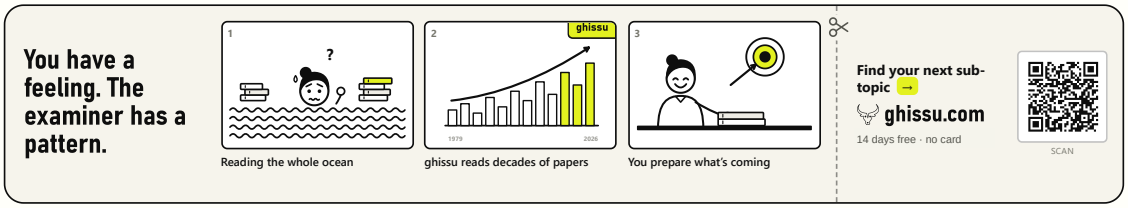
4. Environmental vulnerability: Elevated platforms and water systems show adaptation to riverine floods, yet the decline due to climate change and ecological disruption exposed limits of urban resilience.

Lessons for Today

1. Water and sanitation: Harappan-style rainwater harvesting and drainage can help address water scarcity and public health in fast-growing Indian cities.
2. Inclusive design: Urban design must ensure equitable access to resources and spaces, avoiding the stratification seen in Harappan cities.

Conclusion

Harappan planning was an early model of organised, sustainable city life balancing civic order, hygiene and resource management. Its legacy shows the value of environmental adaptation and public health in urban design.



1(b) Critically explain the causes of the emergence of Buddhism in ancient India.

10

Introduction

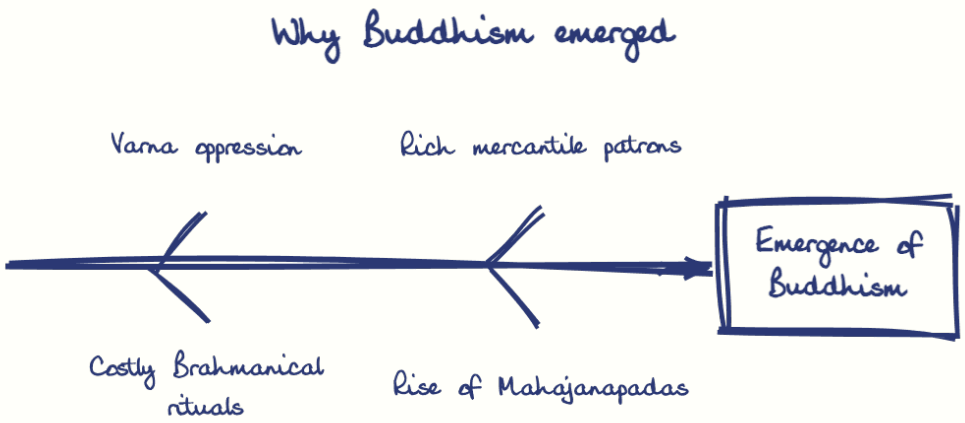
Buddhism emerged in the 6th–5th centuries BCE, transforming India's religious and social landscape. The period saw intense social conflict, economic change and religious ferment that challenged Brahmanical orthodoxy.

Social, Religious and Economic Causes

1. **Caste oppression:** The rigid varna system marginalised lower castes and non-Aryans. Buddhism rejected caste and promoted equality, appealing to oppressed classes and tribal republics like the Andhras.
2. **Ritual critique:** Complex priest-controlled sacrifices alienated many. The Four Noble Truths and Eightfold Path offered a rational path based on self-effort (attadipa).
3. **Economic prosperity:** Growth of trade, agriculture and crafts created a mercantile class that patronised monasteries, which became centres of learning and welfare.

Historical Context: A Critical View

1. **Political fragmentation:** The decline of the Vedic



tribal order and rise of Mahajanapadas fostered debate and experimentation, letting Buddhism flourish as a reform movement.

2. Institutional support: Its spread owed much to missionary monks and Ashoka's Prakrit edicts and councils, which gave legitimacy and reach.
3. Adaptability: Assimilating cults like the Naga cult and admitting all castes and women widened its base, as seen in the Amaravati Stupa in Andhradesa.
4. Philosophy: Nagarjuna's Madhyamaka kept Buddhism relevant against Jainism and Puranic Hinduism.

Way Forward

1. Heritage and diplomacy: Conserving Buddhist sites in Andhra Pradesh and drawing on its ideals of peace in diplomacy can carry its legacy

forward.

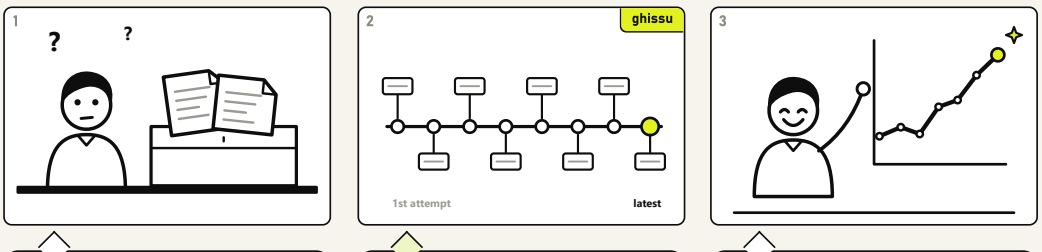
2. Inclusive policies: Buddhism's emphasis on equality and compassion can inspire stronger social justice policies for marginalised communities.

Conclusion

Buddhism's emergence was a complex interplay of social inequity, religious dissatisfaction and economic change, while patronage and adaptability sustained it. Its ethical paradigm continues to influence Asia today. In the spirit of cultural pluralism (Articles 25–29), its legacy of equality and compassion continues to resonate in India's social justice goals.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

The drawer of old answers



Fifty answers in here. Am I improving? No idea.

Every attempt, scored, on one line.

The line is going up. I AM getting better.

— You can't fix what you can't see.

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SCAN

2(a) Draw an outline of society under the Eastern Chalukyas.

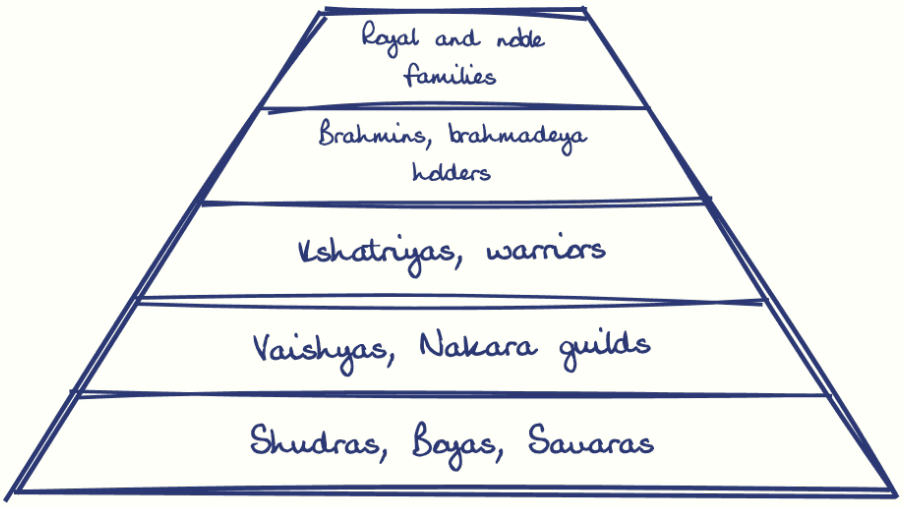
10

Introduction

The Eastern Chalukyas ruled the Vengi region from the 7th to the 12th century CE. Their society blended indigenous traditions with influences from the Western Chalukyas and the Cholas, shaping distinct patterns of caste, occupation, gender and religion.

Social Hierarchy

Eastern Chalukya social order



1. Varna-based stratification: Brahmins held the highest status as priests and scholars, followed by Kshatriyas as rulers and warriors and Vaishyas in trade and agriculture. Shudras and tribal groups like Boyas and Savaras

formed the lower strata.

2. Feudal and agrarian elements: Brahmadeyas (land grants to Brahmins) and Velala landowners held superior rights over tenants, linking land control with caste.
3. Guilds and urban classes: Guilds such as the Nakara and Telikas (oil-mongers) show a privileged mercantile class.
4. Nobility: Royal and noble families kept status through land grants, military power and marriage within their class.

Roles of Social Groups

1. Caste and occupation: Each caste had specific occupations; Shudras performed service and artisanal tasks, and tribal groups had limited social mobility.
2. Women: Patriarchal norms prevailed, but royal and noble women influenced society through temple patronage and property rights, while courtesans of courts and temples contributed to music, dance and ceremonies.
3. State service: The army let adventurers rise to chieftainship, and learned men gained respect and standing as civil or military officers.

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4. Religious participation: Brahmins led Vedic rituals, while other communities took part in temple activities, festivals and charity.

Religion and Culture

1. Religious tolerance: Rulers performed ~~Asvamedha~~ and Vajapeya and built temples to Shiva and Vishnu, while Buddhism and Jainism persisted.
2. Temple-centred society: Temples were not only religious centres but social, economic and cultural hubs, supported by land grants and donations from merchants, courtesans and other groups, which fostered art and ritual.
3. Literature and exchange: Regional languages grew with Sanskrit, and maritime links with Southeast ~~Asia~~ enriched art.

Conclusion

Eastern Chalukyan society was hierarchical and land-based, with caste closely tied to land and occupation. Yet it was integrated through guilds, temples and religious tolerance, giving the Vengi region a rich and dynamic cultural synthesis.

Where did you write that point?
Notes that live with the question.
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2(b) Vividly examine the impact of Bhakti Movement during medieval India.

10

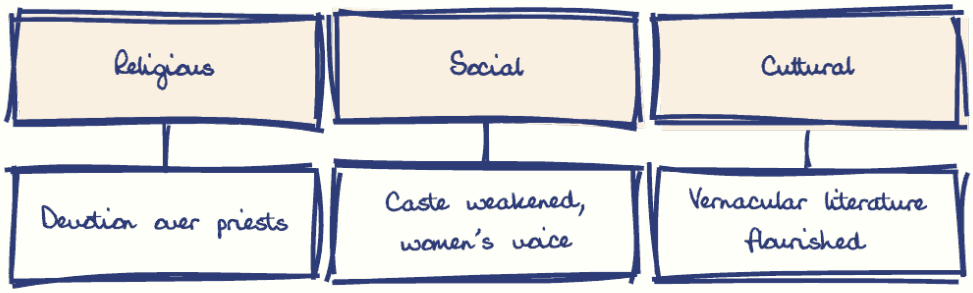
Introduction

The Bhakti Movement, flourishing from the 7th to 17th centuries, challenged orthodox ritualism and caste hierarchies. A response to the rigid Brahmanical order and the upheavals under the Delhi Sultanate, it democratised spirituality through personal devotion to God.

Context

1. Reaction to ritual and caste: Elaborate rituals and exclusion alienated lower castes and women.
2. Political upheaval: Temple destruction and declining Rajput power weakened Brahmanical authority, leaving room for Bhakti and Sufism.
3. Older roots: Ideas from the Upanishads, Bhagavad Gita and Bhagavata Purana combined with Buddhist, Jain and Sufi influences.

Impact of the Bhakti movement



Religious Impact

1. Devotion as salvation: Love for a personal God bypassed rituals and priests, a radical shift from the karma and jnana paths.
2. Inclusive discipleship: Ramananda accepted disciples from all castes, including cobblers and weavers.

Social Impact

1. Weakening caste: By holding that devotion transcended birth, it undermined rigid stratification.
2. Empowering women: Meera Bai and Andal blended devotion with social critique, challenging patriarchal norms.
3. Congregational worship: Community singing of bhajans created social spaces that transcended caste and gender barriers, empowering marginalised groups.

Cultural Impact

1. Vernacular literature: Namadeva's Marathi abhangas and Kabir's Hindi dohas enriched Marathi, Hindi, Tamil and Telugu literature, breaking the monopoly of Sanskrit.
2. Pan-Indian spread: The Alwars and Nayanars

promoted Vaishnavism and Shaivism in the south, while Ramananda, Kabir and Ravidas preached devotion and equality in the north.

3. Lived spirituality: Regional literature made spirituality a lived experience for the masses and fostered cultural integration.

Conclusion

The Bhakti Movement weakened caste hierarchies, empowered women and marginalised groups, and enriched vernacular literature and music. Its enduring legacy continues to shape India's pluralistic heritage and religious landscape.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON ANSWER EVALUATION

Mark your own answer in four checks

Before you ask anyone for feedback, run these four checks. Most lost marks hide in one of them.

1. **Demand** — Does your first line answer what the directive asks — not just the topic?
2. **Dimensions** — At least three: social, economic, political, ethical, environmental...
3. **Evidence** — One fact, report, case or number in every paragraph.
4. **Verdict** — Does the conclusion add a way forward, or only repeat the body?

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SCAN

3(a) Critically evaluate the central administration under Akbar.

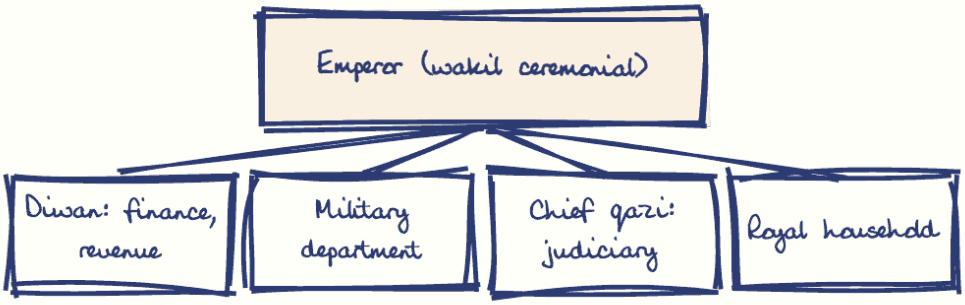
10

Introduction

Akbar's central administration transformed Mughal governance by blending Timurid traditions with innovative reforms. Satish Chandra highlights his reorganisation of the central machinery, while Tapan Raychaudhuri criticises its exploitative economic impact. A fair evaluation weighs efficiency against its costs.

Structural Innovations and Efficiency

Akbar's central administration



1. **Division of power:** Akbar replaced the all-powerful wazir with four departments for finance, military, judiciary and the royal household, introducing checks and balances and accountability.
2. **Revenue reforms:** Building on Sher Shah, the dahsala system fixed revenue on a ten-year

average of produce and prices, stabilising income and curbing arbitrary assessment.

3. Mansabdari system: A graded hierarchy linking rank to salary and jagir professionalised the nobility and ensured loyalty.

4. Intelligence and records: The mir bakhshi managed intelligence and nobles, while court writers recorded orders, enabling informed central control.

Limitations and Concerns

1. Economic exploitation: As Raychaudhuri notes, central price fixing and jagirdars raised peasant dues, a top-down model that put imperial revenue over rural welfare.

2. Corruption and nepotism: The chief qazi's post suffered corruption, and jagirs sometimes favoured nobles over merit, breeding local discontent.

3. Limited local autonomy: Centralisation reduced the autonomy of local officials and traditional rulers, alienating regional powers.

4. Fragmented power: The wakil became ceremonial and the diwan was confined to revenue, causing overlaps and confusion.

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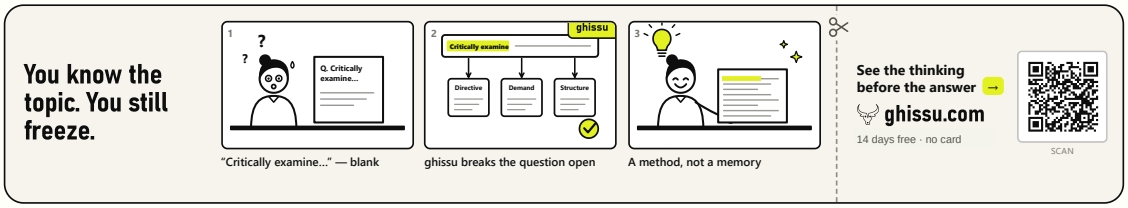
Scan to practice

Way Forward (Lessons for Governance)

1. Anti-corruption oversight: Rigorous oversight and transparent appointments curb corruption in judicial and revenue departments.
2. Local participation: Including local elites and traditional authorities balances central control with regional autonomy and reduces alienation.
3. Equitable revenue: Assessments must reflect local economic conditions to protect peasants and sustain agrarian productivity.
4. Departmental coordination: Better coordination among departments reduces overlaps and improves efficiency.

Conclusion

Akbar's administration was a pioneering durable framework that combined structural innovation with imperial ambition. Yet its exploitative tendencies and administrative gaps reveal the challenge of balancing central authority with socio-economic justice. Its enduring lesson is that strong administration must also be just and responsive, serving the peasant as much as the treasury, if it is to win lasting legitimacy.



3(b) Draw an outline of the rise of Maratha Empire with special reference to Shivaji's contribution.

10

Introduction

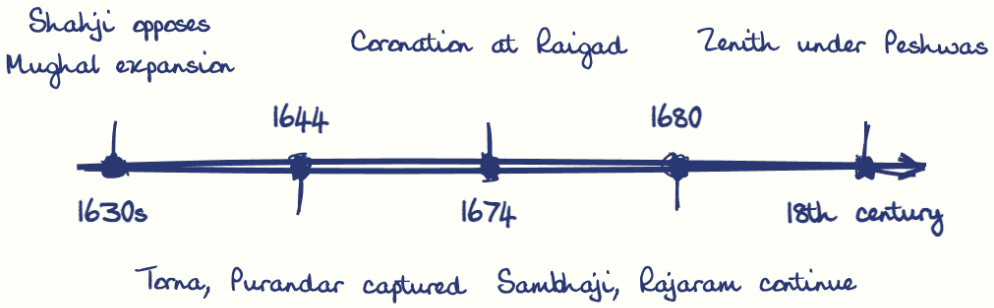
The rise of the Maratha Empire symbolised indigenous resistance to Mughal dominance in the 17th century. Historians debate Shivaji through nationalist, subaltern and revisionist lenses, yet all see him as a unifier and state-builder in a fragmented Deccan whose memory still shapes Maharashtra's identity.

Outline of the Rise

1. Early resistance: Shahji Bhonsle served the Bijapur Sultanate but gradually opposed Mughal expansion, setting the stage for Shivaji in the 1630s and 1640s.
2. Initial conquests: From (1644) Shivaji captured Torna and Purandar, consolidating the Pune region with support from Mavlis and Kunbis.
3. Coronation (1674): Crowned Chhatrapati at Raigad, he gained legitimacy beyond military might and diplomatic equality with the Deccan sultanates.
4. Post-Shivaji expansion: ~~After~~ (1680,) Sambhaji and Rajaram expanded despite Mughal pressure,

and under the Peshwas the empire reached its zenith in the 18th century, extending influence across north and south India.

Rise of the Marathas



Shivaji's Contribution

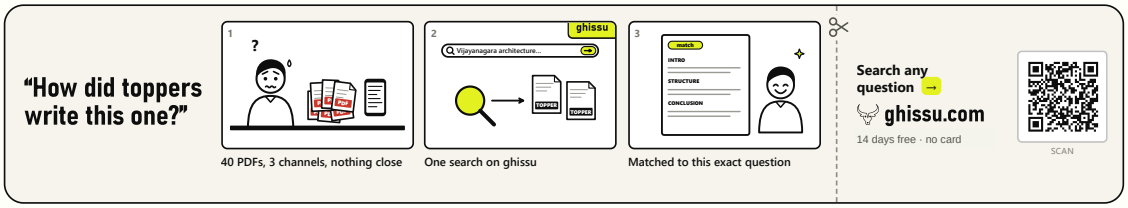
1. Sovereign state: His coronation was a watershed that turned a confederation of chiefs into a recognised kingdom, enabling diplomatic relations and internal legitimacy.
2. Military and naval innovation: Forts and guerrilla tactics in the rugged Western Ghats disrupted Mughal supply lines, while a navy protected the Konkan coast, showing foresight in asymmetric warfare.
3. Diplomacy: Alliances with the Golconda Sultanate and treaties with Bijapur and the Qutb Shahi rulers gave military and financial support for campaigns against the Mughals.

4. Institutional governance: The Ashta Pradhan council, revenue reforms and a standing army moved rule beyond personal loyalty and ensured continuity after his reign.

5. Identity and symbolism: A crafted Kshatriya genealogy and Hindu cultural revival united warrior and peasant groups under Swarajya, though this remains contested in caste politics.

Conclusion

Shivaji turned scattered resistance into a sovereign Maratha state with lasting institutions, transforming a confederation of chiefs into a recognised kingdom. His forts, navy and council laid the foundation on which the Peshwas built an empire. Preserving his forts and presenting his legacy through inclusive narratives can keep this history a source of unity rather than division.



4(a) Critically explain the role of Subsidiary Alliance system in the rise and expansion of British Raj in India.

10

Introduction

The Subsidiary Alliance, introduced by Lord Wellesley in the late 18th century, was a pivotal strategy in the rise of the British Raj. Nationalists see it as a tool of subjugation, imperialists as a source of stability. It explains how a trading company became the paramount power.

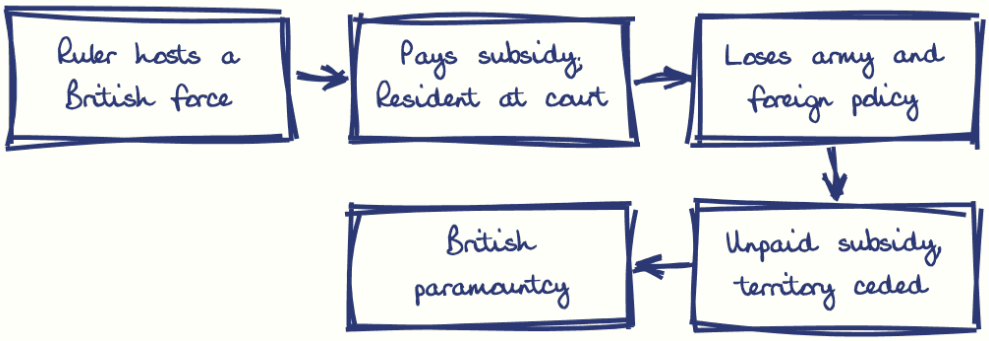
Mechanism of the System

1. Core terms: An Indian ruler hosted a permanent British force and paid for its upkeep, surrendering foreign policy and defence.
2. Stages of evolution: It grew from military help to joint campaigns, then subsidies for stationed troops, and finally territorial cession for unpaid dues.
3. Residents: A British Resident at court wielded great influence over administration and diplomacy.
4. Loss of sovereignty: States could not keep independent armies, negotiate with other powers or employ foreign experts.

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How the Subsidiary Alliance worked



Role in British Expansion

1. **Strategic military presence:** Troops in allied states gave footholds for rapid deployment against rivals.
2. **Economic drain and annexation:** Costly subsidies bankrupted states and forced territorial cession.
3. **Neutralising rivals:** Rulers were cut off from the French, as Hyderabad disbanded its French troops.
4. **Pretext for intervention:** 'Inefficient' rule justified annexation, as when Awadh ceded Rohilkhand.

Critical Evaluation

1. **Erosion of sovereignty:** Rulers became puppets, entrenching British paramountcy.
2. **Socio-economic damage:** Disbanded armies

caused unemployment and the rise of Pindaree bands.

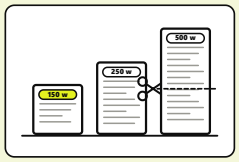
3. Internal decay: Protected rulers neglected governance and oppressed subjects, inviting further intervention.

Way Forward

1. Sovereignty lessons: Its legacy reinforces the importance of sovereign autonomy in contemporary foreign policy and defence agreements.

Conclusion

Under the guise of protection, the Subsidiary Alliance enabled military dominance and territorial gain, laying the foundation of the Raj while dismantling Indian sovereignty.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

Read one question three ways →

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SCAN

4(b) Delineate the contribution of Dr. B.R. Ambedkar with special reference to the conditions of untouchables and labourers in colonial India?

10

Introduction

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar was a towering figure in India's struggle against social injustice, especially for untouchables and labourers under colonial rule. As a jurist, economist and social reformer, he challenged entrenched caste hierarchy and economic exploitation together.

Ambedkar's twin struggle

Untouchables	Labourers
Poona Pact, reserved seats	Labour welfare departments
Mahad Satyagraha (1927)	Employment exchanges
Bahishkrit Hitkarini Sabha	No income tax on the poor
Caste oppression	Labour exploitation

Contribution to the Conditions of Untouchables

1. **Political Rights:** He demanded separate electorates and reservations for untouchables. His role in the Poona Pact of 1932 secured reserved seats for Dalits in legislatures.

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2. Identity and Assertion: He popularised the term "Dalit" and led the Mahad Satyagraha (1927) for public rights, fostering self-respect, though it provoked violent backlash from caste Hindus.

3. Education and Mobilisation: Through the Bahishkrit Hitkarini Sabha he promoted education and cultural awareness, inspiring schools and hostels for untouchables.

4. Limits: Political rights alone were insufficient without social and economic justice. Dalit literacy stayed low, and the absorption of Dalit leaders into the Congress and Communist parties diluted autonomous movements.

Contribution to the Conditions of Labourers

1. Labour Rights: His economic writings exposed the exploitation of agricultural and industrial labourers. He supported employment exchanges and labour welfare departments, which began to institutionalise labour protection under colonial administration.

2. Land and Taxation: He contributed to land revenue policy and opposed income tax on low-income groups to reduce the burden on poor labourers and peasants.

3. Structural Resistance: Wealthy landlords and

caste elites resisted labour empowerment, and a colonial state with limited commitment to welfare left many labourers vulnerable to exploitation and discrimination.

4. Caste and Class: He showed that untouchability compounded labour exploitation, so emancipation needed both social and economic justice.

Lasting Legacy

As an economist he influenced the establishment of the Finance Commission and the Reserve Bank of India. As Chairman of the Drafting Committee, he later embedded these goals in the Constitution through fundamental rights and affirmative action for Scheduled Castes and Tribes, backed by the (1955) Untouchability Act.

Conclusion

Ambedkar's work united the struggle for dignity with the struggle for livelihood. His insistence that political rights need social and economic justice shaped India's socio-political landscape.

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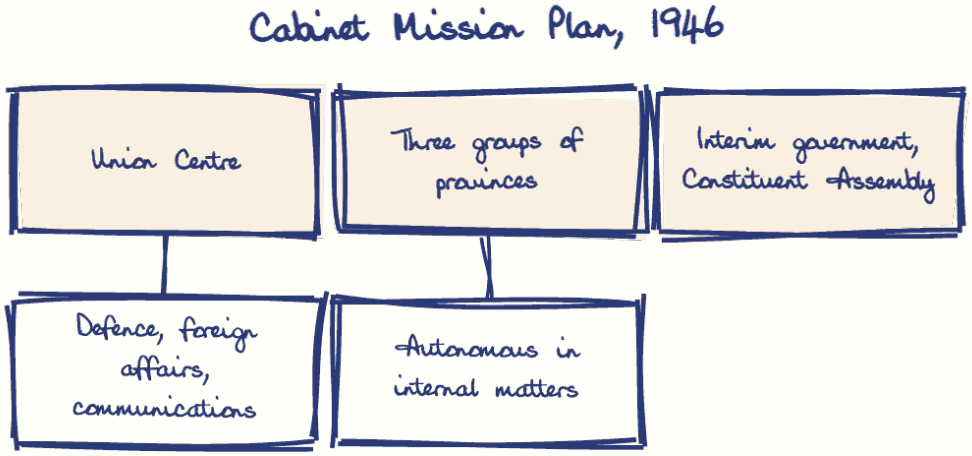
5(a) Examine the recommendations of the Cabinet Mission plan.

10

Introduction

The Cabinet Mission Plan of 1946 aimed to resolve the deadlock between the Indian National Congress and the Muslim League over India's constitutional future. Nationalist scholars see it as a missed opportunity for unity, while others see it as a pragmatic British attempt to manage a complex transition.

Key Recommendations



1. **Federal Structure:** A united India with three **groups of provinces:** Muslim-majority provinces in the northwest and east, Hindu-majority provinces, and others, each autonomous in internal matters.

2. Division of Powers: The Centre would hold only defence, foreign affairs and communications, giving wide provincial autonomy to meet the League's demand for self-governance.
3. Interim Government: An interim government of representatives of major parties, including the Congress and the League, would administer until the constitution was framed.
4. Constituent Assembly: A Constituent Assembly elected indirectly by provincial assemblies would draft the constitution.

Examination of the Recommendations

1. Accommodation and Tension: The plan balanced the Congress demand for a strong Centre with League autonomy, but Congress saw grouping as a step to partition and the League found it insufficient.
2. Communal Divisions: Group autonomy institutionalised communal divisions and fuelled separatist tendencies.
3. Interim Government Challenges: League inclusion was a breakthrough, but its boycott in 1946 weakened the government.
4. Constitutional Delays: Indirect election of the

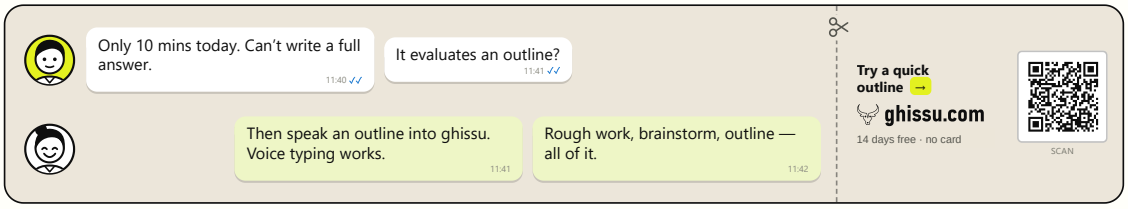
Assembly delayed the process and allowed communal politics to dominate, leading to the demand for Pakistan.

Impact and Legacy

1. **Temporary Halt:** It rejected a full-fledged Pakistan and delayed partition without resolving tensions.
2. **Foundation for Federalism:** It laid groundwork for federal principles in the Constitution.
3. **Polarisation:** Its failure to win consensus deepened the Congress–League divide and hastened partition and communal violence.
4. **Negotiated Decolonisation:** It remains a significant example of a negotiated attempt at decolonisation.

Conclusion

The plan was a landmark attempt at a negotiated transition through federalism and interim governance. Its failure showed how hard it was to manage communal divisions, yet it shaped India's constitutional federalism.



5(b) Critically evaluate the impact of Quit India Movement of 1942.

10

Introduction

The Quit India Movement of 1942 was launched amid World War II and the failure of the Cripps Mission. Nationalist scholars stress its mass mobilisation and radicalisation, while others point to the limits imposed by repression and lack of organised leadership.

Mass Mobilisation and Radicalisation

1. Popular Participation: Students, peasants, women and workers took part, expanding the nationalist base beyond elite leadership and showing the public's readiness for decisive action.
2. Assertive Resistance: Unlike earlier campaigns, it accommodated limited violence and direct defiance. Gandhi's "Do or Die" call inspired a militant spirit.
3. Parallel Governments: In Bihar and Odisha, local people's governments took over administration, a practical assertion of sovereignty.
4. Underground Networks: Despite arrests of Congress leaders, activists sustained resistance through secret communication and sabotage.

Quit India: gains and limits

Gains	Limits
Mass participation	Over 100,000 arrests
Do or Die militancy	Leaderless, fragmented
Parallel governments	Weak agrarian base
Underground networks	League, Mahasabha aloof

Limitations

1. **Severe Repression:** Mass arrests exceeding 100,000, violence and censorship decapitated the leadership and cut short the movement.
2. **Leaderless Movement:** With senior leaders jailed, actions became fragmented, letting the British regain control.
3. **Limited Agrarian Involvement:** Unlike Civil Disobedience, it did not deeply engage the peasantry or agrarian issues.
4. **Communal Divisions:** The Muslim League and Hindu Mahasabha opposed or stayed aloof, weakening national unity.

Critical Assessment

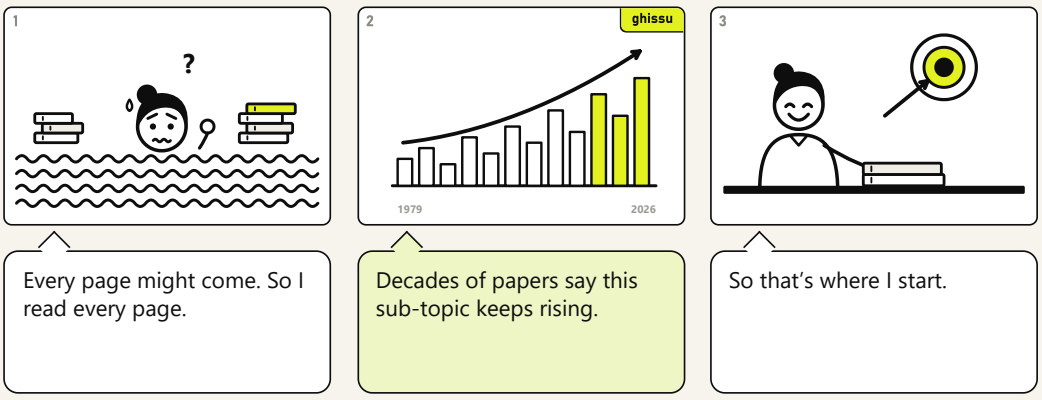
Its gains were political and psychological rather than immediate: it could not overthrow British rule in 1942, but it proved that Indians were ready for decisive action and could even govern themselves locally.

Conclusion

Quit India was a watershed that awakened the masses and challenged British legitimacy despite repression. It showed the people's resolve for complete independence and set the stage for the post-war negotiations that led to freedom.

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6(a) Discuss salient features of the Agrarian system under the Satavahanas.

10

Introduction

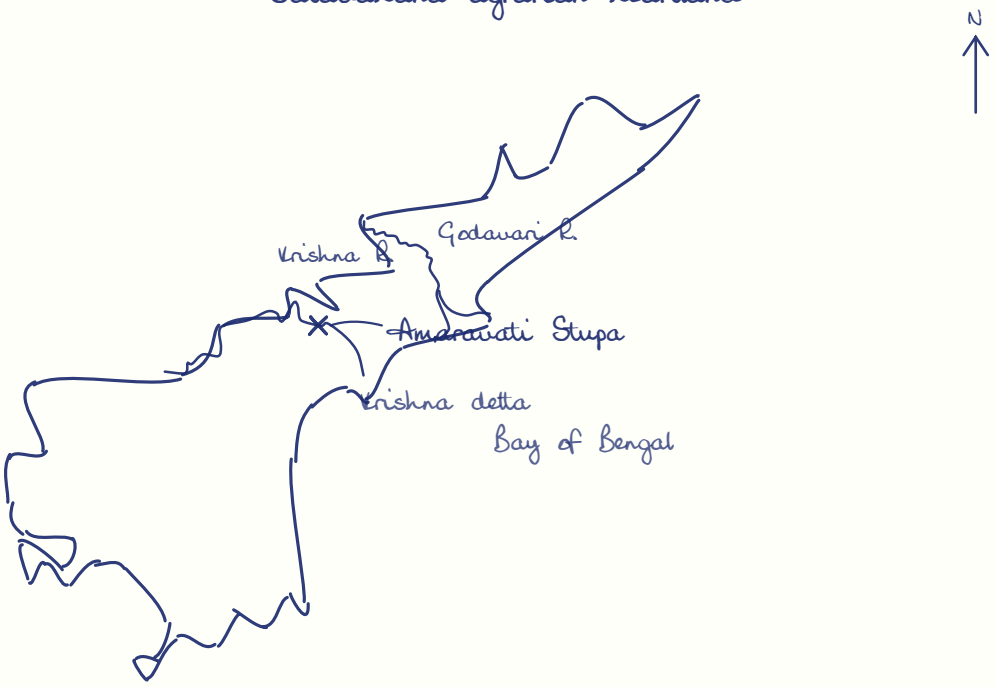
The Satavahanas, flourishing from around the 1st century BCE to the 3rd century CE, were a pivotal Deccan power. Their agrarian system laid the foundation for economic prosperity and social stability, combining institutions, production and social relations.

Administration and Land Management

1. Village as Basic Unit: The grama was the smallest unit, with a gramika or gramani overseeing several villages, a decentralised rural system.
2. Tax-Free Land Grants: They pioneered tax-free villages and lands (agraharas) for Brahmanas and Buddhist monks, creating semi-autonomous enclaves that raised productivity.
3. Military Oversight: Rural administration was militarised, with gaulmikas commanding regiments to keep order, so stability rested on coercion as well as administration.
4. Feudatory Landholders: A three-tier system of rajas, mahabhojas and senapatis held land

under central oversight.

Satavahana agrarian heartland



Paddy, sugarcane and jute on fertile river tracts

Agricultural Economy

1. Backbone of Economy: Fertile tracts along the Krishna and Godavari grew paddy, sugarcane, gingelly and jute, sustaining surplus.
2. Technology: Iron tools such as socketed hoes, sickles and ploughshares, with riverine irrigation, raised efficiency.
3. Animal Husbandry: Cattle were integral to farming, and jute was likely grown as fodder, a mixed economy of crops and livestock.

4. Village Industry: Jaggery mills and other agro-based industries in villages show how farming and craft production depended on each other.

Agrarian Society

1. Gahapatis: The gahapati, head of a cultivator household, organised village agrarian life within a structured hierarchy.
2. Guilds: Artisans in srenis and merchants in Nigamasabhas linked produce to markets in towns like Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda.
3. Religious Patronage: Grantees preached respect for political authority and social norms, helping agrarian peace.
4. Status of Women: The relatively high status of women, including royal women in religious affairs, shaped rural society.

Conclusion

The Satavahana agrarian system combined institutional innovation, economic vitality and social complexity to sustain one of ancient India's most prosperous regions. Its lessons favour decentralised village governance, farming linked with crafts and a greater role for women in rural life.

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6(b) Write a note on art and architecture under the Pallavas.

10

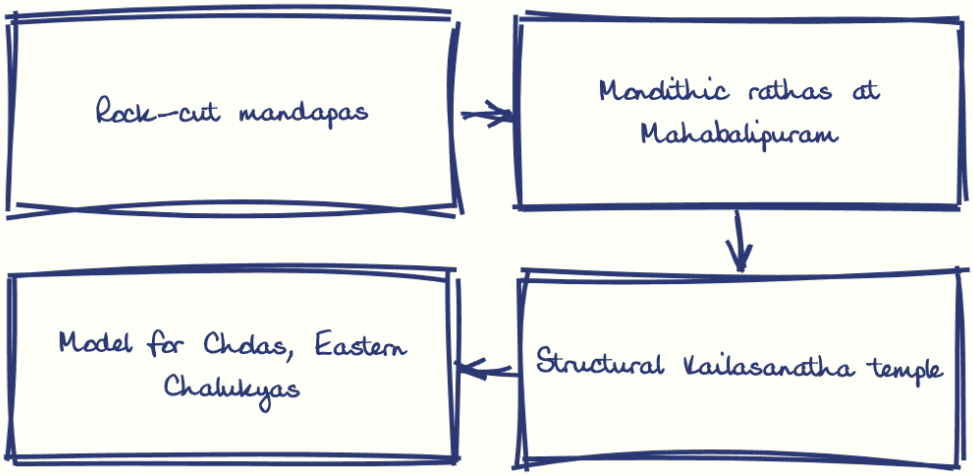
Introduction

The Pallava dynasty, flourishing from the 4th to the 9th century CE in South India, transformed Indian art and architecture. It laid the foundation of the Dravidian style, whose legacy is visible at Mahabalipuram, a UNESCO World Heritage site.

Features of Pallava Art

1. Sculptural Excellence: Reliefs like the Descent of the Ganges, or Arjuna's penance, at Mahabalipuram narrate myths with dynamic expression and detail.
2. Religious Symbolism: Sculptures depict Hindu deities and epics of the Saiva and Vaishnava faiths, with Buddhist influences showing pluralism.
3. Frescoes: Murals in the Sittannavasal caves show vivid colours and spiritual themes.
4. Literature and Art: Patronage of Mahendravarman I and Dandin linked literary and visual culture.

Evolution of Pallava architecture



Characteristics of Pallava Architecture

1. **Rock-Cut to Structural:** Early rock-cut mandapas and Rathas at Mahabalipuram gave way to structural temples like the Kailasanatha and Vaikunta Perumal at Kanchipuram.
2. **Temple Elements:** Tiered vimanas and early gopurams became defining features of South Indian temples.
3. **Functional Design:** Pillared mandapas served as halls for worship and cultural performance.
4. **Scale and Ornament:** Pyramidal towers adorned with deities and floral motifs symbolised devotion and royal power.

Significance and Influence

1. **South Indian Standard:** Their style shaped the

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Chodas and the Eastern Chalukyas, merging with local traditions in Andhra.

2. Southeast Asia: Their motifs influenced temples in Kambuja (Cambodia) and Champa (Vietnam), a form of soft power.

3. Social Role: Temples became centres of social life, fostering the Bhakti movement and the Devadasi tradition that preserved classical dance and music.

4. Andhra Legacy: Pallava innovations informed Andhra's temple building, seen in Eastern Chalukya and Vijayanagara monuments.

Way Forward

1. Conservation and Research: Better preservation of Pallava monuments and joint research with Andhra's universities can deepen this shared heritage.

Conclusion

Pallava art and architecture moved temple building from rock-cut caves to grand structural temples, set the standard for South India and carried Indian culture abroad, a shared heritage that deserves conservation.

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7(a) Write a brief note on the architecture during the period of Vijayanagar Empire.

10

Introduction

The Vijayanagar Empire (1336 to 1678 CE) marks a pinnacle of South Indian architecture, known for its distinctive Dravidian temple style. The ruins of its capital Hampi, now a UNESCO World Heritage site, reflect a synthesis of indigenous and external influences and the ethos of a Hindu kingdom that resisted invasions for centuries.

Vijayanagar architecture

Temples	Secular buildings
Towering gopurams	Arches and domes
Kalyana Mandapam	Lotus Mahal
Thousand-pillared halls	Elephant stables
Monolithic statues	Fortified walls, tanks

Key Characteristics

1. Dravidian Temple Grandeur: Massive temples with towering gopurams and expansive mandapas, as in the Virupaksha and Vittala temples, carry intricate carvings of deities and

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myths.

2. Hybrid Pravida Style: Chalukyan, Chola and Pandya traditions merged, adding the Kalyana Mandapam and 1000-pillared halls like the Vasanta Mandapa.

3. Indo-Islamic Elements: Guard quarters, elephant stables and queen's baths used arches and domes, with the Lotus Mahal as the prime example.

4. Monoliths and Urban Planning: Single-granite statues like Lakshmi Narasimha and Badavilinga stood beside fortified walls, Hampi Bazaar and tanks with aqueducts.

Historical Context

1. Response to Invasions: As a Hindu bulwark against the Deccan Sultanates, grand and fortified buildings asserted legitimacy and resilience.

2. Patronage: Brahmins and local elites managed temples, which acted as centres of community life and royal authority, tied to festivals and royal ceremonies.

3. Battle of Talikota (1565): Defeat and destruction ended the capital's tradition, but the

style passed to Nayaka architecture in the Tamil and Andhra regions.

Significance

1. Cultural Legacy: It preserved and innovated Dravidian styles, symbolising Hindu cultural endurance.
2. Heritage and Tourism: Hampi draws scholars and tourists worldwide, supporting local economies and raising awareness of heritage conservation.
3. Influence on Later Styles: The Nayaka style continued its elaborate pillared halls and gopurams across the Deccan and South India.

Conclusion

Vijayanagar architecture combined religious devotion, imperial power and openness to new forms, leaving a legacy that shaped South Indian temple building long after the empire fell. Its temples, monoliths and planned capital still stand as a record of a confident Hindu kingdom and of a culture open to many influences.

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7(b) "The foundation of Vijayanagara Empire coincided in point of time with the outburst of a momentous literary movement in South India." Discuss it.

10

Introduction

The Vijayanagara Empire, founded in 1336 CE, marked the consolidation of Hindu political power in the face of Islamic incursions. Its foundation coincided with a remarkable literary renaissance in vernacular and classical literature. Political stability and cultural efflorescence reinforced each other.

Foundation of the Vijayanagara Empire

1. Origins amid Turmoil: Harihara and Bukka, former ministers of Kampili, returned to Hinduism under the sage Vidyaranya and founded Vijayanagara to resist Muslim domination.
2. Political Consolidation: The empire unified diverse linguistic groups across the Deccan and defended Hindu traditions against the Bahmani Sultanate.
3. Stable Society: Agriculture, trade and crafts sustained prosperity, while rulers upheld Varnashrama Dharma and promoted temples and festivals.

The Literary Movement

1. Telugu and Kannada Literature: Royal patronage

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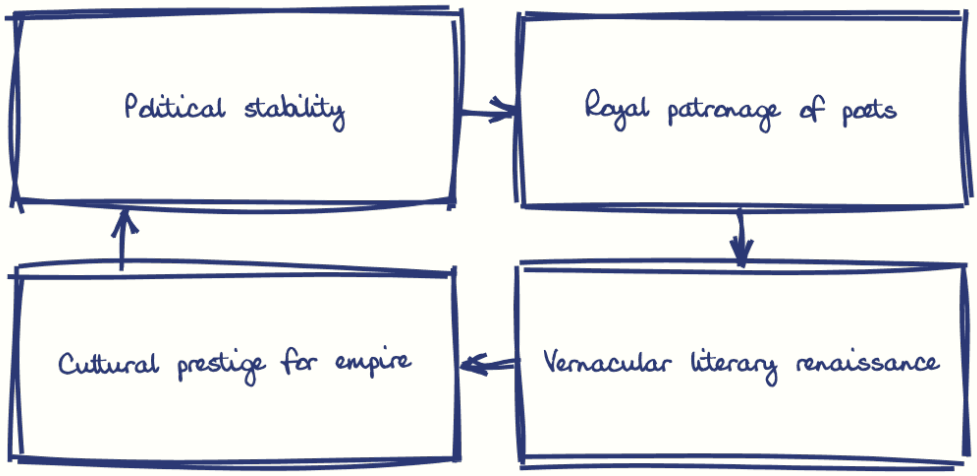
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encouraged poets like Srinatha and Pothana, whose devotional and epic works enriched regional languages.

2. Bhakti and Classical Synthesis: Sanskrit traditions blended with vernacular Bhakti poetry, such as the Telugu Ramayana and Purandara Dasa's Kannada songs.

3. Courtly and Popular Literature: Courts produced chronicles, panegyrics and treatises while also supporting folk traditions.

Empire and literature



Interrelation of Empire and Literature

1. Patronage as Catalyst: Rulers legitimised their rule by reviving Hindu culture alongside vernacular languages.

2. Literature as Resistance: Works celebrating Hindu

mythology and valour served as ideological resistance.

3. Mutual Reinforcement: Stability enabled creativity, and literature raised the empire's cultural prestige.

4. Limitations: The movement was elite-driven, shaped by Brahminical and royal patronage, with lower castes and women marginal.

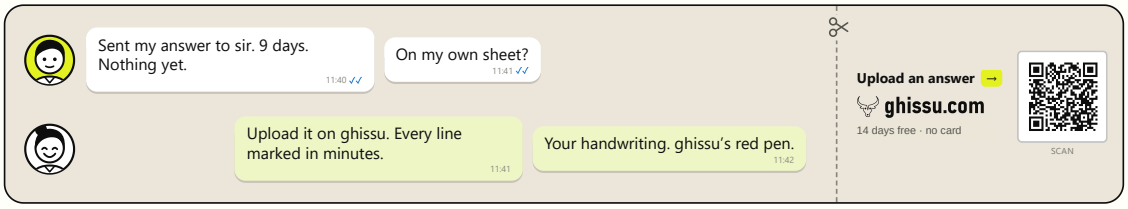
Way Forward

1. Preserve the Heritage: Academic programmes and digital archives can preserve Vijayanagara-era Telugu and Kannada literature.

2. Inclusive Scholarship: Research should recover the voices of women and lower castes for a fuller literary history.

Conclusion

The coincidence was no accident: the empire and the literary movement grew together, each strengthening the other's place in South Indian history.



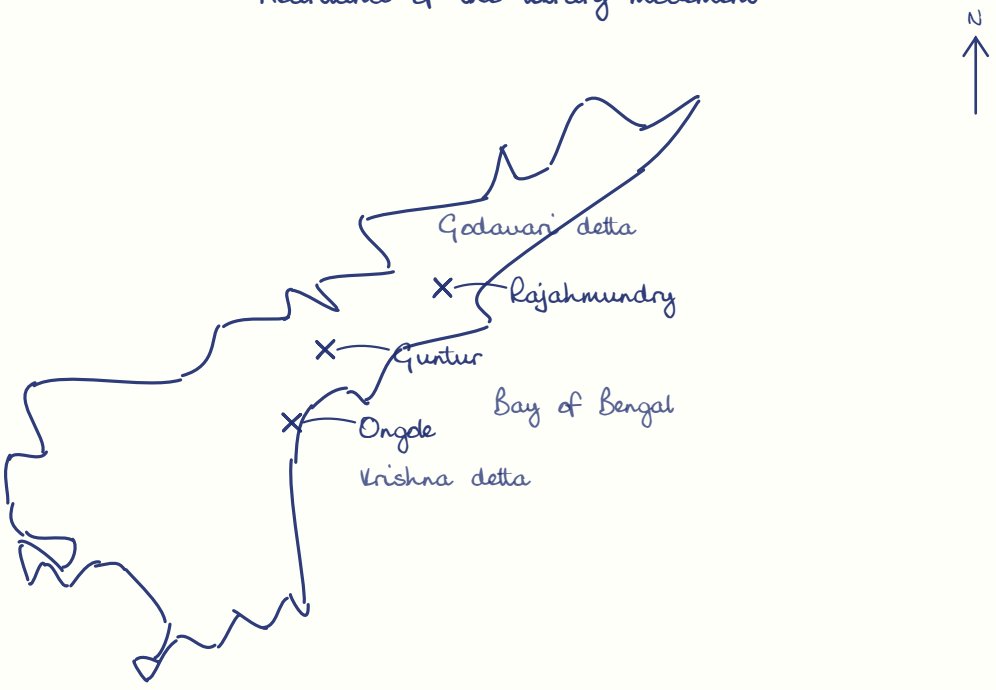
8(a) Write a brief account of library movement in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The library movement in Andhra Pradesh was a unique, self-generated people's movement that contributed to the region's social, political and cultural awakening. Unlike places where libraries came with colonial support, it was driven by local activists who saw libraries as tools of human development, and it supported the freedom struggle and literacy in the early 20th century.

Heartland of the library movement



Library pilgrimages toured these villages, 1937 to 1951

Origins and Development

1. **Early Libraries:** The Arsha Grandhalaya in Rajahmundry (1839) and Saraswati Nilayam (1886) laid its foundation.
2. **Political Awakening:** The Partition of Bengal in (1905) and the Andhra movement from (1913) drew youth to libraries as centres of discourse.
3. **Library Pilgrimages:** Between (1937) and (1951), teams toured villages of East Godavari, Krishna and Guntur, holding exhibitions and founding libraries.

Contributions and Impact

1. **Spread of Literacy:** Libraries grew from (163) to (600), reaching urban and rural areas.
2. **Social and Cultural Hubs:** Village libraries promoted adult education, reform, health and cooperation through magic lantern shows and bhajans.
3. **Freedom and Reform Movements:** Libraries offered political education for the Swadeshi and Andhra movements.
4. **Mobile and Boat Libraries:** Paturi Naga Bhushanam's boat library service took books to remote villages.

Notable Institutions

1. Andhra Desa Library Association: Its annual conferences from 1914 professionalised library work.
2. Model Libraries: Gautami Library, Rajahmundry and C.V.N. Library, Ongole became landmarks.
3. Language Movement: Links with Gidugu Rama Murthy Pantulu's Telugu movement built reading habits and cultural pride.

Way Forward

1. Digital Libraries: Investing in e-resources can extend access in rural and remote areas.
2. Link with Education: Connecting libraries with Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan can support lifelong learning.

Conclusion

Andhra's library movement turned reading into a people's movement. Built by volunteers rather than the state, it fuelled literacy, reform and the freedom struggle in the villages, and its spirit can guide today's digital and community libraries.

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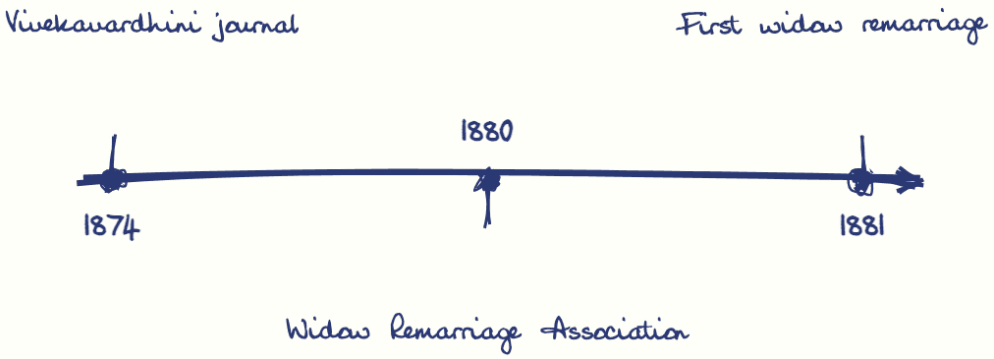
8(b) Critically evaluate the contribution of Kandukari Veeresalingam in the light of social reform movement in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The social reform movement in Andhra in the late 19th and early 20th centuries challenged orthodox traditions and promoted progressive values. Kandukuri Veeresalingam, hailed as the father of the Andhra renaissance, led it through education, women's emancipation and social critique.

Veeresalingam's reform milestones



Key Contributions

1. **Telugu Literature and Education:** He wrote the first Telugu novel, Rajasekhara Charitram, and the earliest Telugu books on natural sciences and history, making knowledge accessible.

2. Women's Education: He started the journal Vivekavardhini in (1874) and the first girls' schod at Dawakeswaram, then another in Rajahmundry, using spoken Telugu (Vyavaharika Bhasha).
3. Widow Remarriage: He founded the Widow Remarriage Association in (1880) and conducted the first widow remarriage among higher castes in Andhra in (1881).
4. Social Critique: He condemned child marriage, Kanyasulkam and the nautch system, supported Devadasis and fought caste discrimination.

Critical Evaluation

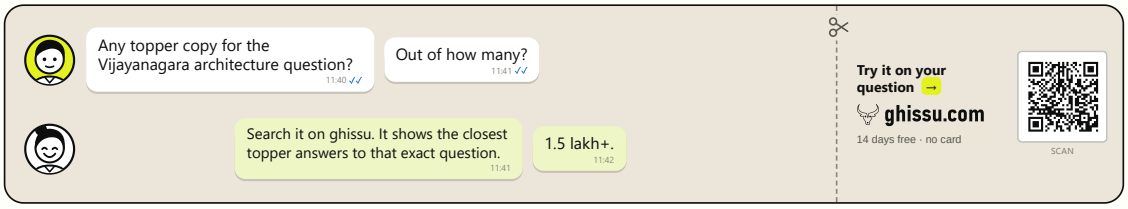
1. Catalyst of Renaissance: His work awakened Rajahmundry and coastal Andhra and inspired an educated class.
2. Women's Empowerment: His reforms were revolutionary in a patriarchal society but largely benefited upper-caste women.
3. Institutionalising Reform: The Sangha Samskarana Samajam and the Widow Remarriage Association sustained momentum despite orthodox resistance and slow social acceptance.
4. Limitations: The movement did not reach Dalits and lower castes, a gap later reformers filled.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive Reform: Future reform must include marginalised castes and communities.
2. Women's Empowerment: Self-help groups and the National Rural Livelihoods Mission can carry women's agency beyond education.
3. Legal Enforcement: Strict implementation of laws against child marriage and caste discrimination in Andhra Pradesh can carry his agenda forward.

Conclusion

Veeresalingam was transformative in starting Andhra's social reform movement, especially for women's education and against regressive customs. Though its reach stayed limited, it laid the base for later, more inclusive movements.

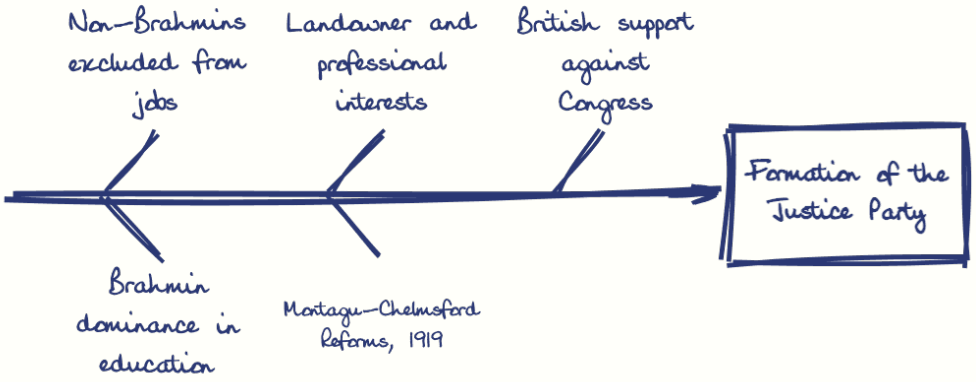


9(a) Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Justice Party. 10

Introduction

The Justice Party emerged in the early 20th century as a major force in the Madras Presidency. It arose from the discontent of non-Brahmin communities who felt marginalised under British rule and Brahmin dominance, and its formation shows the interplay of political, social, economic, caste and colonial factors.

Why the Justice Party formed



Political, Social and Economic Circumstances

1. **Political Marginalisation:** Non-Brahmin elites were excluded as Brahmins held government jobs and council seats. After the Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919, the Congress boycott of the 1920 elections let the party win 63 of 98 seats.

2. Social Assertion: Vellalas, Reddis, Kapus and Kammas in the Telugu districts, and Nairs and Beri Chettis, challenged Brahmin dominance in education and administration.

3. Economic Interests: Wealthy landowners and urban professionals sought to protect privileges they gained from colonial land policy.

Caste and Colonial Factors

1. Non-Brahmin Identity: It united diverse groups through their shared exclusion, a form of non-Brahmin identity politics.

2. Dyarchy: The 1919 reforms opened new political spaces that the party exploited as the main non-Congress force.

3. Colonial Patronage: The British supported it as a counterweight to the Congress, seen as a nationalist threat, which made the party dependent on colonial goodwill.

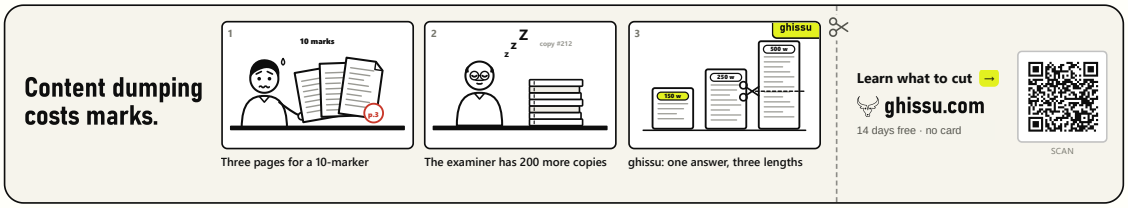
4. Founding Moment of 1916: Dr. T. M. Nair, P. Theagaraya Chetty and C. Natesa Mudaliar founded the South Indian Liberal Federation and issued the Non-Brahmin Manifesto, the party took its name from its daily, Justice.

Critical Evaluation

1. **Limited Dalit Inclusion:** Upper non-Brahmin leaders neglected the concerns of untouchables.
2. **Regional Divides:** Tamil-Telugu tensions and reluctance to back a separate Andhra province weakened cohesion.
3. **Legacy:** Its caste-based mobilisation laid groundwork for later Dravidian politics.

Conclusion

The Justice Party grew from genuine non-Brahmin grievances against exclusion, but it was shaped by landed elite interests and colonial opportunity, and its caste-based politics left a lasting mark on South India.



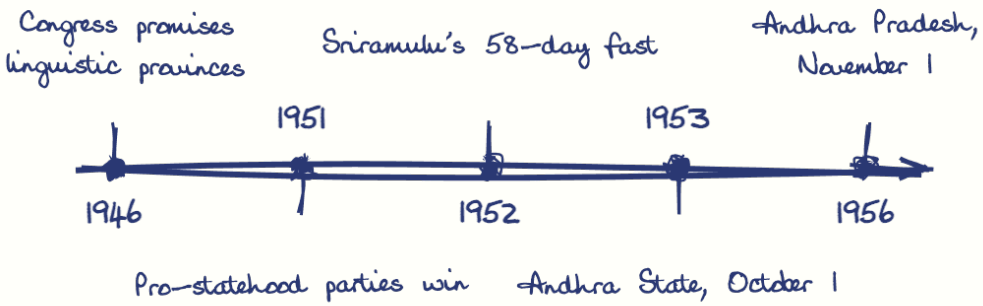
9(b) Critically explain the circumstances which led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1950s.

10

Introduction

The formation of Andhra Pradesh in the 1950s was a pivotal moment in post-independence reorganisation, reflecting the rising assertion of linguistic identity within national unity. Historical grievances and political aspirations drove it, and it shaped the wider reorganisation of states.

Road to Andhra Pradesh



Historical and Political Circumstances

1. Colonial legacy: Telugus were divided between the Madras Presidency and Hyderabad State, diluting their identity and fostering a desire for a unified province.
2. Post-independence discontent: The Congress had promised linguistic provinces in its (1946)

manifesto, but its reluctance after 1947 frustrated Telugu leaders, especially in coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema.

3. Conflicts in Madras: Telugu–Tamil tensions, involving leaders like Rajagopalachari and T. Prakasam, exposed the difficulties of a multilingual state.

4. Official ambivalence: The J.V.P. Committee and Dar Commission advised against linguistic states to protect unity, yet acknowledged strong Andhra sentiment.

Key Events

1. Sriramulu's martyrdom: Potti Sriramulu's 58-day fast in 1952 and his death triggered riots, compelling the Centre to concede.

2. Electoral mandate: In 1951 the Congress fared poorly in Telugu areas, where pro-statehood parties, including communists, won.

3. Legal steps: Nehru announced Andhra State under Article 3, and the Wanchoo Committee examined its finances, leading to its creation in 1953.

4. Merger with Telangana: The SRC saw advantages in uniting Telugu speakers and the Godavari

and Krishna basins but advised waiting till about 1961; pressure for Visalandhra brought the merger earlier, and the States Reorganisation Act, 1956 formed Andhra Pradesh on November 1, 1956.

Critical Assessment

The Gentlemen's Agreement sought to protect Telangana but sowed seeds of future tension, as disparities with Coastal Andhra persisted for decades.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh balanced cultural identity with national integration and set a precedent for reshaping India's federal map, though its regional fault lines endured.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

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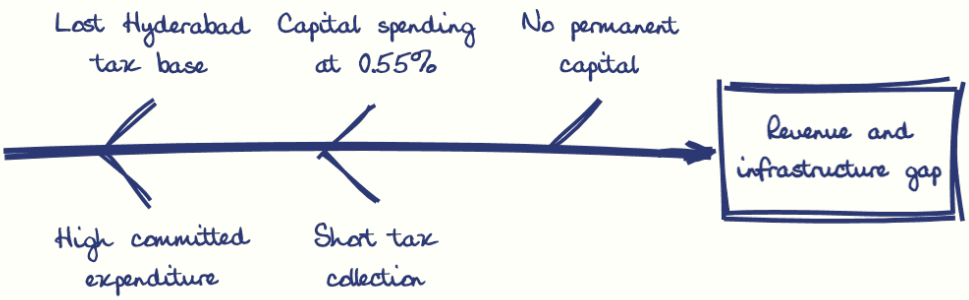
10(a) Discuss the revenue and infrastructural challenges for new Andhra Pradesh after bifurcation in 2014.

10

Introduction

The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014 left the new state without Hyderabad, its major revenue and infrastructure hub. This posed unique challenges that shape the state's developmental path and fiscal health.

Why new Andhra Pradesh is strained



Revenue Challenges

1. Loss of Hyderabad's revenue base: Telangana kept Hyderabad, home to most IT firms, pharmaceutical industries and business houses, so Andhra lost much of its own tax revenue and had to rely on a smaller base.
2. Rising deficits: The revenue deficit quadrupled, and the fiscal deficit rose to 52,508 crore (3.98% of GSDP), as spending far outpaced

revenue.

3. High committed expenditure: About 69% of revenue receipts in 2023–24 go to salaries, pensions and interest, while subsidies rose sharply.
4. Collection inefficiencies: CAG audits found underassessment and short collection in mining and commercial taxes running into hundreds of crores.

Infrastructural Challenges

1. No permanent capital: Functioning from Hyderabad under a temporary arrangement delayed investment in governance and urban infrastructure.
2. Underinvestment: Capital expenditure fell to just 0.55% of GSDP, a five-year low, hindering essential services.
3. Regional disparities: Rayalaseema and Uttara Andhra lag Coastal Andhra in irrigation, transport and industry.
4. Water and irrigation: Krishna and Godavari disputes and delays in Polavaram constrained farm productivity.

Bifurcation Context

1. Disrupted linkages: Losing Hyderabad, the financial

nucleus, forced the state to rebuild from a disadvantaged position.

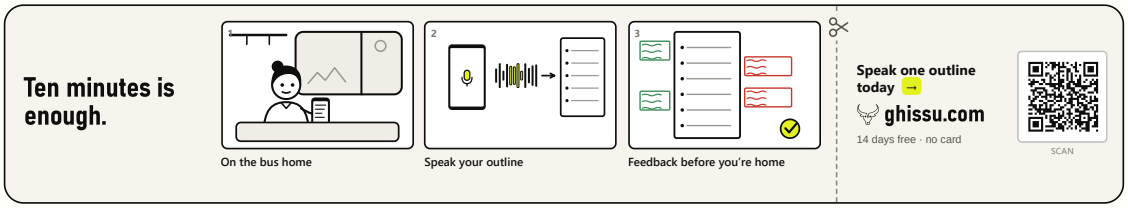
2. Special Category Status: This demand reflects the need for fiscal support, as central grants have not ended revenue shortfalls and borrowing limits.

3. Administrative transition: Setting up new institutions under a temporary capital slowed governance and infrastructure rollout.

4. Regional legacy: Bifurcation exposed and sometimes deepened old regional disparities, complicating equitable infrastructure and revenue generation across districts.

Conclusion

New Andhra Pradesh faces a shrunken revenue base and weak infrastructure. Accelerating capital expenditure on growth-oriented projects, plugging revenue leakages and balanced regional investment are essential for recovery.



10(b) Discuss the impact of bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh (2014) on trade and commerce.

10

Introduction

The bifurcation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014 under the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014 redrew political boundaries and reshaped trade and commerce in the residual state. Its impact matters given the state's strategic coast, industrial hubs and agricultural base.

Trade geography after bifurcation



Hyderabad lost, ports and dettas carry commerce

Economic and Commercial Consequences

1. **Loss of Hyderabad:** The major commercial and

IT hub went to Telangana, leaving a vacuum. Andhra had to rebuild commercial infrastructure, affecting trade flows and investment.

2. Capital costs: With Hyderabad a common capital for up to ten years, building Amaravati demanded heavy investment, diverting resources from trade facilitation.

3. Agricultural and industrial base: The state retained the Krishna and Godavari deltas and assets like the Visakhapatnam steel plant and ports, which sustained commerce.

4. Fiscal stress: The revenue deficit quadrupled to 43,487 crore in 2022–23, constraining investment in trade infrastructure.

Challenges and Opportunities

1. Water disputes: Krishna and Godavari water disputes threaten irrigation, industry and farm-related trade.

2. Coastal and port development: The 974 km coastline and Visakhapatnam port support port-led corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai to boost exports.

3. Industrial diversification: Steel, oil refining and shipbuilding in Visakhapatnam and fertiliser

plants in Kakinada offer a diversified trade base.

4. Digital facilitation: e-Seva improved government-to-citizen and business services, cut transaction costs and made the environment more conducive to commerce.

Regional Roles

1. Coastal Andhra: The deltas remain the backbone of rice, aquaculture and horticulture trade.
2. Visakhapatnam: Its steel plant, refinery and shipyards make it the industrial heart, and its port is a gateway for international trade.
3. Rayalaseema and North Andhra: Drought-prone Rayalaseema and less developed North Andhra can grow through irrigation like Polavaram and better connectivity.
4. Infrastructure: Expanding roads, railways and power supports trade logistics.

Conclusion

Bifurcation initially weakened Andhra's commerce through the loss of Hyderabad and fiscal stress. Yet its coastline, ports, fertile deltas and diversified industries give it a strong base to rebuild trade on a port-led, coastal model.

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Scan to practice

11(a) Give a brief account of geographical features of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh, located between 12°41' and 22°N latitude and 77° and 84°40E longitude, is a geographically diverse state bordered by Telangana, Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Karnataka and Tamil Nadu and the Bay of Bengal. Its blend of coastal plains, plateaus and hill ranges shapes its agriculture, resources and development.

Main Geographical Features

1. **Relief and topography:** The state covers the eastern Deccan Plateau and much of the Eastern Ghats, plus extensive coastal plains along a 974 km coastline, the second longest in India.

2. **Climate:** A tropical climate with hot summers from March to June and a southwest monsoon from July to September; the northeast monsoon gives about one-third of annual rainfall, benefiting Rayalaseema.

3. **Drainage:** The Godavari and Krishna flow east into the Bay of Bengal forming fertile deltas, along with the Vamsadhara, Nagavali and Penneru, feeding the Godavari Delta System

and Tungabhadra Project.

4. Soils and vegetation: Soils range from sandy to clayey and dry deciduous forests with teak and Terminalia cover about 21.58% of the area.

Physical regions and rivers of Andhra Pradesh



Spatial Distribution

1. Topographical variation: The Eastern Ghats run parallel to the coast in the north and centre with dense forests, while the drier plateau dominates the west and south.
2. Rainfall contrast: Coastal Andhra gets about 80% of rain from the southwest monsoon,

while Rayalaseema depends on the northeast monsoon, making rainfall uneven and droughts frequent.

3. River basins: Deltas in East Godavari, West Godavari and Krishna districts support intensive rice and aquaculture, though inter-state water sharing creates disputes.

4. Forests and soils: Forests concentrate in the Eastern Ghats, alluvial soils dominate the coast, while red and black soils on the plateau suit dryland farming.

Way Forward

1. Watershed management: Integrated watershed development in drought-prone Rayalaseema to conserve water and soil.

2. Coastal and forest protection: Coastal zone management, sustainable fisheries and afforestation in the Eastern Ghats to preserve endemic species and forest livelihoods.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh's diverse relief, climate, rivers and soils form the foundation of its agriculture and economy, and planning must respect these regional differences.

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Scan to practice

11(b) Give a brief account of the drainage system of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh is drained almost entirely by east-flowing peninsular rivers that cross the Eastern Ghats and the coastal plains before entering the Bay of Bengal. The Godavari and Krishna dominate and build fertile deltas, supported by the Penna in the south and smaller rivers in the north.

Major rivers and wetlands of Andhra Pradesh



Major River Systems

1. Godavari: The longest peninsular river receives

the Sabari, which brings the Sileru, cuts a gorge through the Papikonda hills where the Polavaram Project is being built, and splits at the Dowleswaram barrage into the Gautami and Vasishta Godavari, forming the Konaseema delta.

2. Krishna: Joined by the Tungabhadra near Kurnool, it forms the Telangana boundary along the Srisailam and Nagarjuna Sagar reservoirs and builds its delta below the Prakasam Barrage at Vijayawada.

3. Penna: Rising in Karnataka, it flows through Anantapur, Kadapa and Nellore; the Chitravati, Papagni and Kunderu drain Rayalaseema, and Somasila stores its waters.

4. Northern rivers: The Vamsadhara and Nagavali drain Srikakulam and Vizianagaram, while the Sarada and Gostani drain the Visakhapatnam hills.

5. Southern coastal rivers: The Gundlakamma and Swarnamukhi are short, seasonal rivers rising in the Nallamala and Seshachalam hills.

Characteristic Features

1. Monsoon-fed: Rivers depend on both monsoons,

so many smaller ones run dry in summer.

2. Deltas and wetlands: The deltas form the state's rice bowl, with Kolleru Lake between them and the Pulicat lagoon in the south.

3. Inter-state character: All major rivers rise outside the state, so sharing needs tribunals and river management boards.

Significance

1. Irrigation and power: Cotton's anicuts and reservoirs like Srisailam, Nagarjuna Sagar and Somasila irrigate millions of acres, while Srisailam, Sileru and Machkund generate power.

2. River linking: The Pattiseema lift scheme (2015–16) began moving Godavari water to the Krishna delta.

Conclusion

Completing Polavaram, protecting Kolleru and Pulicat, and governing shared rivers cooperatively will decide how well this river wealth serves the whole state.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

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ghissu has already done this for every topic — with the trend drawn out.

See the trend for your chapter →
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Scan to practice

12(a) Critically analyse the components and impacts of the Green Revolution in India.

10

Introduction

The Green Revolution, initiated in the 1960s, transformed Indian agriculture to achieve food self-sufficiency amid frequent famines. Its effects still shape regions like coastal Andhra Pradesh, where irrigation and high-yielding varieties were adopted early.

Core Components

1. HYV seeds: Improved high-yielding varieties of wheat and rice raised productivity in irrigated regions such as coastal Andhra and Punjab.
2. Irrigation: Canals, tube wells and command area projects, like the Godavari canals, supplied reliable water.
3. Chemical inputs: Fertilisers, pesticides and herbicides met the high nutrient demand of HYV seeds, boosting yields but creating ecological problems.
4. Credit and markets: Heavy investment needs made affordable credit and marketing vital; RLVY later supported Andhra farmers.
5. Mechanisation and extension: Tractors, threshers,

agricuttural universities and extension services spread the new technology.

Impacts

1. Food security: Foodgrain output rose sharply and India became self-sufficient by the 1970s; Andhra's rice yields grew.
2. Rural growth: Higher productivity created rural jobs and agro-industry in coastal Andhra and Rayalaseema.
3. Regional and social inequality: Medium and large farmers with irrigation gained, while rainfed smallholders were excluded.
4. Ecological degradation: Chemicals reduced soil fertility, depleted water tables and displaced millets, cutting biodiversity.
5. Commercialisation: Market dependence on inputs sometimes caused indebtedness.

Green Revolution: gains and costs

Gains	Costs
Foodgrain self-sufficiency	Rainfed smallholders left out
Higher rice yields	Soil fertility loss
Rural jobs, agro-industry	Falling water tables
Modernised agriculture	Input debt

Critical Evaluation

The Green Revolution averted famine and modernised agriculture, but its focus on irrigated belts like Andhra's coast left dry regions behind, perpetuating agrarian inequality. It also imposed lasting environmental costs such as groundwater depletion, soil degradation and the loss of millets from cropping.

Conclusion

India must now build inclusive and sustainable farming that extends these gains to rainfed regions and smallholders, while restoring soil health and groundwater.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

Measure progress, don't guess it

Writing more is not the same as writing better. This is how to know which one you're doing.

1. **Score everything** — Even a rough attempt gets a number.
2. **Rewrite** — The same question, one week later.
3. **Compare** — Intro, dimensions, conclusion — side by side.
4. **One fix at a time** — Track a single weakness until it's gone.

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My Answers keeps every attempt, every score and every enhanced version on one timeline.



Watch your curve →

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SCAN

12(b) Give a concise description of fisheries management and development in India?

10

Introduction

Fisheries matter for food security, employment and export earnings. India is the third largest fish producer globally, with output rising from 96 lakh tonnes in 2013–14 to 195 lakh tonnes in 2024–25, and the sector supports over 30 million livelihoods.

Institutional Framework and Policy

1. **Centre–state coordination:** Fisheries is a state subject, but the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana aims to raise output by 70 lakh tonnes and double fishers' incomes; Andhra Pradesh has implemented it actively.
2. **Dedicated institutions:** The NFDB promotes research, while the FIDF gives concessional finance for harbours and cold chains to cut post-harvest losses.
3. **Regulation:** The 2004 Marine Policy protects traditional fishers' zones and promotes deep-sea fishing.
4. **Digital and insurance:** PM-MKSSY formalises the sector through digital platforms and aquaculture insurance.

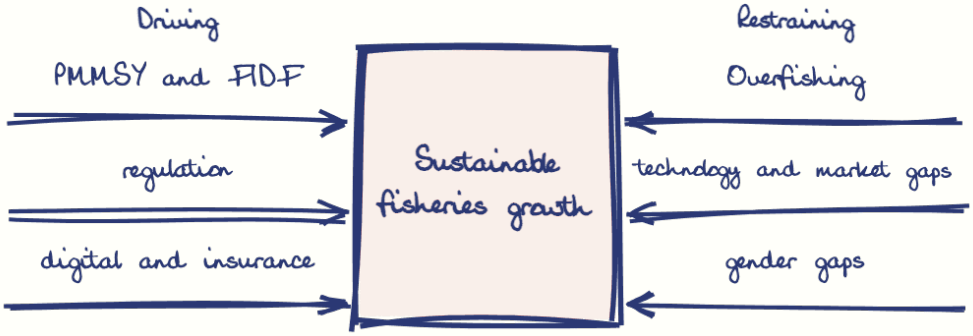
Challenges

1. Overfishing: Only (66%) of stocks remain biologically sustainable, with declines in species like tuna, and IUU fishing leads to frequent arrests in Palk Bay.
2. Technology and markets: Small fishers lack GPS and fish finders, and about (69%) of inland output is sold in unhygienic markets.
3. Gender gaps: Women handle over (70%) of marketing and processing but remain unrecognised and undercompensated, and the workforce is largely marginalised.

Outcomes

Seafood exports reached 62,408 crore in FY 2024–25, with marine exports growing over (11%) in recent years. Andhra Pradesh, the largest fish producer, drives this growth through its long coastline and aquaculture.

Fisheries development in India

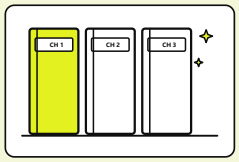


Way Forward

1. Sustainable practices: Stricter regulation and community-based management to curb overfishing and protect marine biodiversity.
2. Technology adoption: ~~Affordable~~ modern and digital tools for small-scale fishers.
3. Markets: Hygienic value addition and processing, especially in inland fisheries.
4. Inclusion: Skills, fair wages and social security for women fishers.

Conclusion

Fisheries are pivotal for livelihoods, nutrition and exports. Balancing higher production with ecological sustainability and social equity, through schemes like PMMSY and digital initiatives, will secure the sector's future and support food security and rural development.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

Note from toppers' answers, exam-hall thinking and model answers — your notes gather into topic and chapter notes on their own.

Build notes that find you →

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SCAN

13(a) Write a brief note on the rural and urban population of Andhra Pradesh in the light of the census of India 2011.

10

Introduction

The Census 2011 shows that Andhra Pradesh, with a population of about 4.96 crore, is predominantly rural but urbanising steadily. This distribution shapes its economy, social structure and policy needs.

Rural Population

1. **Rural majority:** About 70.53% of the population lives in rural areas, with slowing rural growth.
2. **Rural governance:** 13 Zilla Praja Parishads, 660 Mandal Praja Parishads and 13,428 Gram Panchayats manage rural needs and schemes like MGNREGS.
3. **Census-based planning:** Census 2011 data guides MGNREGS for rural jobs and PM-AY for housing.
4. **Service gaps:** Bodies like the Dr. NTR Vaidya Seva Trust and AP Vaidya Vidhana Parishad serve both areas, but rural areas still lack health staff and facilities.

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Urban Population

1. Rising urbanisation: The urban share rose to 29.47% in 2011 from 24.13% in 2001.
2. Regional variation: Visakhapatnam district leads with 47.45% urbanisation.
3. Urban governance: 112 statutory and 83 census towns, including Greater Visakhapatnam and Vijayawada corporations.
4. Strain: Rural-to-urban migration for jobs and education has outpaced infrastructure, straining housing, sanitation and waste management, as CAG audits note.

Rural vs urban Andhra Pradesh (Census 2011)

Rural	Urban
70.53% of population	29.47% of population
Literacy 62.4%	Literacy 79.2%
13,428 Gram Panchayats	112 statutory, 83 census towns
Health staff gaps	Housing, sanitation strain

Socio-Economic Features

1. Literacy gap: Rural literacy is 62.4% against

urban 79.2%, male literacy is 74.8% and female 60%.

2. Sex ratio: 997 females per 1000 males, above the national average, with favourable ratios among SCs and STs.

Way Forward

1. Rural health: More health staff and facilities, using schemes like Janani Suraksha Yojana.
2. Urban planning: GIS-based planning and better waste management.
3. Balanced development: The National Rurban Mission to improve rural livelihoods and ease migration pressure on cities.
4. Female literacy: Educational and digital outreach to close the rural female literacy gap.

Conclusion

Census 2011 depicts Andhra Pradesh as a rural state in transition, with rising urbanisation, literacy gaps and an improving sex ratio. Integrated rural-urban planning is key to its balanced development.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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13(b) Write a brief note on tribal population of Andhra Pradesh in the context of census report of 2011.

10

Introduction

The tribal population holds a significant place in Andhra Pradesh's demographic and cultural fabric, forming about 7% of the population as per the 2011 Census. Their demography, socio-economic status and distribution shape inclusive development policy.

Demographic Characteristics

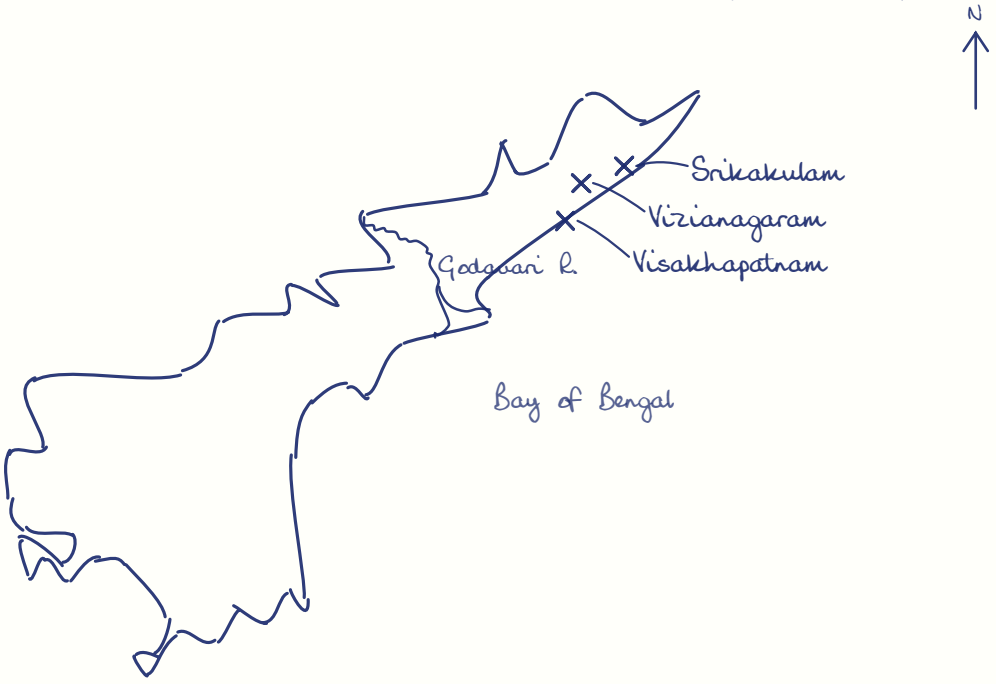
1. Size: About 4.75 million tribals, a share higher than many southern states, making it the largest tribal concentration in South India.
2. Distribution: Concentrated in the hilly, forested Agency Areas of Visakhapatnam, East Godavari, West Godavari, Srikakulam and Vizianagaram, which once sheltered tribes displaced by agrarian expansion.
3. Sex ratio: A favourable 1012 females per 1000 males, above the state average of 997 and national 943.
4. Literacy: Lower than the state average, with female literacy lagging most.
5. Diversity: Mostly Dravidian, with some

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Indo-European and Austric speakers; major tribes include the Yenadi, Koya, Yerukala, Konda Reddi and Gond.

Tribal concentration in Andhra Pradesh (Census 2011)



most tribes live in the hilly Agency Areas

Socio-Economic Status

1. Livelihoods: Gathering-hunting (Chenchu, Yenadi), pastoralism (Gaudu, Sugali), crafts (Kammara) and agriculture (Konda Dora, Koya).
2. Poverty: Although state poverty has fallen sharply, tribal areas still lag, with higher poverty and weaker health and education access.
3. Social services: Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and ICDS operate, but remoteness and health staff

shortfalls limit them.

4. Rural character: Tribals are mostly rural, with Visakhapatnam having the highest numbers and little urban presence.

Policy Implications

1. Targeted welfare: Focused education, health and livelihood policies through programmes like Swarna Andhra Vision 2047 and Mission Shakti.
2. Infrastructure: Roads, schools and health centres in Agency Areas to narrow regional gaps.
3. Cultural preservation: Development that protects tribal identity and traditional livelihoods with community participation.
4. Monitoring: Census data as a baseline to tailor schemes like Janani Suraksha Yojana and PMSMA.

Conclusion

The 2011 Census shows a large, diverse and gender-balanced tribal population that still lags in literacy, health and income. Inclusive policy must close these gaps while preserving tribal culture and livelihoods.

Stuck at "Critically examine"?
See the thinking before you write.
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14(a) In the light of the All India Tiger Estimation Report 2018, critically evaluate the Project Tiger.

10

Introduction

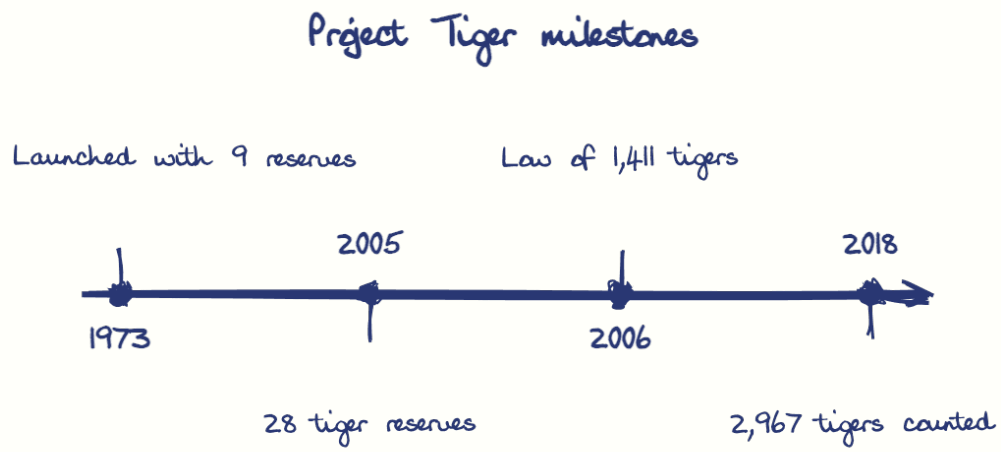
Project Tiger, launched in 1973, is India's flagship initiative to preserve viable tiger populations and their habitats. The All India Tiger Estimation Report 2018, which recorded a rise to 2,967 tigers, is a key benchmark to evaluate it.

Achievements

1. Population recovery: Tiger numbers rose from a low of 1,411 in 2006 to nearly 3,000 in 2018, thanks to protection, habitat management and anti-poaching.
2. Validated strategy: The report's 33% rise since 2014 validates scientific monitoring through camera traps and DNA analysis.
3. More reserves: Reserves grew from 9 in 1973 to 28 by 2005, covering over 37,000 sq. km.
4. Data-driven patrolling: MSTRIPES enables real-time patrolling and crime detection.

Shortcomings

1. Limited coverage: Reserves cover only about 1.14%



of India's area.

2. Habitat shrinkage: The report notes habitat contraction, with local declines in the Western Ghats.
3. Uneven management: ME-AF scores show Kanha very high while Sariska lags.
4. Conflict and displacement: Weak mitigation of human-tiger conflict and displacement of communities under a top-down approach have fuelled resentment.
5. Data gaps: Some states show uneven implementation.

Landscape Perspective

The report stresses tiger landscapes beyond reserves, like the Central Indian Highlands and Andhra Pradesh's Eastern Ghats. Project Tiger must

therefore link with corridor management by state forest departments and local governance.

Way Forward

1. Habitat connectivity: Strengthen corridors linking reserves in the Central Indian and Eastern Ghats landscapes for genetic flow and less conflict.
2. Community participation: Institutionalise participatory conservation with local communities and panchayats.
3. State capacity: Train and equip forest staff in tiger range states, including Andhra Pradesh.
4. Adaptive management: Wider use of MSTRIPES and PRAGATI for data-driven decisions.

Conclusion

Project Tiger has largely reversed tiger decline, but needs a landscape-level, community-inclusive approach to secure habitats.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

See how toppers wrote it → ghissu.com

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SCAN

14(b) Briefly describe the flora and fauna of National Parks in Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

Andhra Pradesh, with topography ranging from the Eastern Ghats to the coastal plains, hosts rich flora and fauna in its national parks. These protected areas conserve endemic plants and diverse wildlife, and are vital for ecological balance.

Management of National Parks

1. Forest Department: It protects and manages the parks under the Wildlife Protection Act, 1972.
2. Strict protection: Human exploitation and grazing are prohibited, keeping ecosystems largely undisturbed, which is vital for biodiversity.
3. Flagship site: The Nagarjunasagar–Srisailam Tiger Reserve is one of India's largest tiger reserves.

Flora

1. Dry deciduous forests: The predominant type, with teak, Terminalia, Dalbergia, Pterocarpus and Anogeissus suited to the climate.
2. Endemic and rare plants: Cycas beddomei, red sandalwood (Pterocarpus santalinus), Terminalia pallida and Syzygium alternifolium sustain genetic



tiger reserve in the south-west, mangroves in the estuaries

diversity.

3. Mangroves: Coastal parks in the Godavari and Krishna estuaries hold mangroves that buffer against erosion.

4. Native regeneration: Dense mini forests and eco-friendly nurseries regenerate native species.

Fauna

1. Mammals: Tigers, panthers, hyenas, blackbucks, cheetals and sambars reflect rich faunal diversity.

2. Birds and reptiles: Several parks are important bird habitats and migratory stopovers.

3. Keystone species: Estuarine mangroves shelter fishing cats and otters, while freshwater bodies sustain turtles.

4. Outcomes: Project Tiger and Project Elephant have stabilised key populations despite habitat fragmentation.

Way Forward

1. Habitat connectivity: Ecological corridors between parks for wildlife movement and genetic exchange.

2. Community participation: Awareness and eco-tourism livelihoods for local communities.

3. Research: Biodiversity assessments and GIS-based threat mapping.

4. Climate resilience: Climate-adaptive plans for vulnerable flora and fauna.

Conclusion

The flora and fauna of Andhra Pradesh's national parks are a vital natural heritage. Sustained protection and innovative management, aligned with Project Tiger, will keep them thriving.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

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SCAN

15(a) Give a brief account of factors responsible for environmental pollution.

10

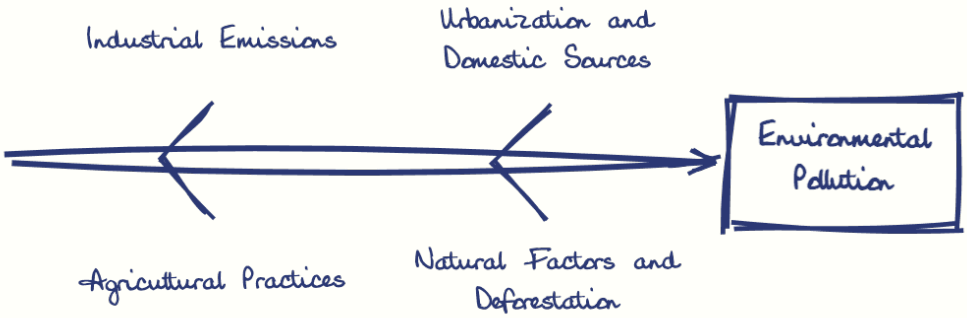
Introduction

Rapid industrialisation, urbanisation and population growth have made environmental pollution a critical concern in India. Degrading air, water and soil threaten health and biodiversity, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh with industrial corridors and intensive agriculture.

Main Factors Causing Pollution

1. Industrial emissions: Hubs like Visakhapatnam release particulate matter, sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides. Port-led corridors have intensified pollution due to inadequate waste treatment.
2. Agricultural practices: Heavy use of fertilisers and pesticides in Rayalaseema's chilli farming and horticulture contaminates soil and water; stubble burning releases particulates and greenhouse gases.
3. Urbanisation and domestic sources: Vijayawada and Amaravati generate vehicular emissions, solid waste and untreated sewage, with poor sanitation infrastructure.
4. Deforestation: Forest loss disrupts the carbon cycle, raises CO_2, causes soil erosion and reduces natural filtration.

Factors Responsible for Environmental Pollution



Factors by Type of Pollution

1. Air: Rising private vehicles emit carbon monoxide and nitrogen oxides; thermal plants add to the burden.
2. Water: Effluents and sewage degrade the Krishna and Godavari; farm runoff pollutes groundwater.
3. Soil: Chemical inputs, industrial waste and landfill leachate reduce fertility.
4. Noise and waste: Traffic and construction raise noise, while poorly managed biomedical and plastic waste adds hazards.

These factors overlap: industrial and farm pollutants enter urban ecosystems, while deforestation lowers the environment's resilience.

Way Forward

1. Pollution Control Board: Enhance the capacity and

autonomy of the Andhra Pradesh Pollution Contrd Board to monitor emissions and waste disposal.

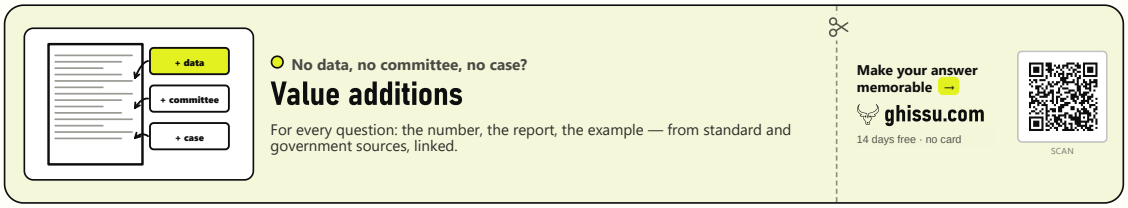
2. Sustainable agricutture: Organic farming and integrated pest management in Rayalaseema and coastal belts.

3. Urban infrastructure: Sewage treatment plants, solid waste management and public transport in Vijayawada and Amaravati.

4. Afforestation: Reforestation and watershed projects in forested and drought-prone areas.

Conclusion

Pollution in Andhra Pradesh arises from industrial growth, agricuttural intensification, urban expansion and resource depletion. Integrated governance and sustainable practices will protect public heatth, in line with the SDGs.



15(b) Give a brief account of the concept and importance of Sustainable Development.

10

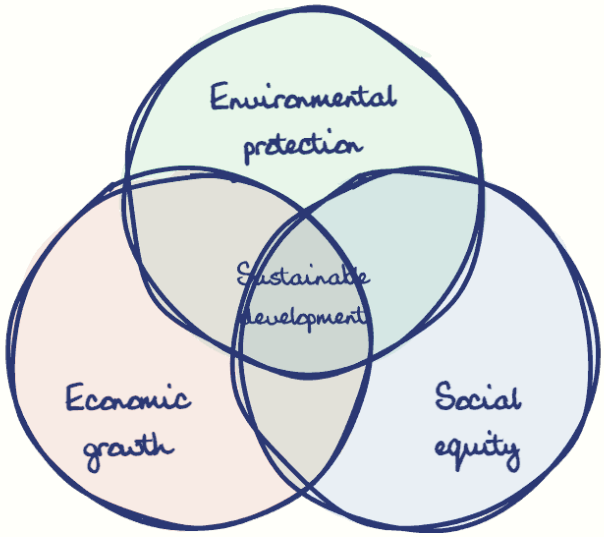
Introduction

Sustainable development has gained critical importance as the world faces environmental degradation, social inequity and economic challenges. Popularised by the (1987) Brundtland Commission, it means meeting present needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet theirs. For Andhra Pradesh, with agrarian and coastal vulnerabilities, it is vital.

Concept of Sustainable Development

1. Intergenerational equity: Today's growth must not exhaust resources needed by future generations.
2. Integration of pillars: Economic, social and environmental goals must be pursued together.
3. Global commitment: The (1992) Rio Earth Summit and the UN Sustainable Development Goals institutionalised it, guiding schemes like Swachh Bharat Mission and Jal Jeevan Mission.
4. Guiding principles: The Polluter Pays and Precautionary principles ensure projects internalise environmental costs.
5. Participatory governance: The Rio Declaration stresses local participation.

Three pillars of sustainable development



Importance

1. Environmental protection: Unchecked growth has caused depletion and pollution in coastal and drought-prone Rayalaseema; renewable energy and sustainable farming offer a way out.
2. Social equity: Land distribution under YSR and Rajiv Griha Kalpa housing improved access for marginalised groups, though gender and rural poverty gaps remain.
3. Better resource management: Technology such as SV-AM/TV-A improves land and resource management.

Challenges

1. Resource and capacity limits: Limited finance and technology hinder rural implementation, and digital efforts like Rajiv Internet Village are hard to scale.

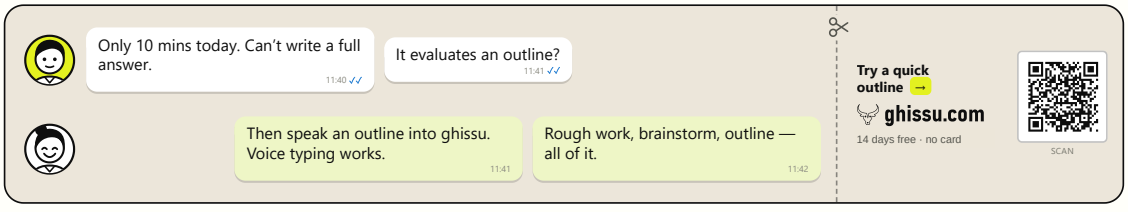
2. Monitoring gaps: Data gaps and coordination issues delay timely adaptation.

Way Forward

1. Local governance: Empower Panchayati Raj institutions with resources and training.
2. Green growth: Promote renewable energy and green technologies suited to the state's agro-climatic zones.
3. Safety nets: Expand schemes like DAY-NRLM to address rural poverty.
4. Data systems: GIS and digital platforms for real-time monitoring.

Conclusion

Sustainable development is essential for long-term prosperity, social equity and environmental health, especially in states like Andhra Pradesh where these challenges intersect. Integrating the SDGs into policy reflects Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2017

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P-II
1(a)

Explain in what respects the Harappan civilization differed from that of the later Vedic civilization.

10

Introduction

The Harappan civilization, flourishing around 2600 to 1900 BCE, was one of the world's earliest urban cultures, while the later Vedic civilization, emerging around 1500 BCE, marked a major cultural and social transformation. Their differences explain why Harappan urbanism did not continue into the Vedic period.

Harappan vs Later Vedic

Harappan	Later Vedic
Planned cities	Rural settlements
Trade and crafts	Agriculture, cattle rearing
Fertility cults	Fire sacrifices, horse
Undeciphered script	Sanskrit texts
No rigid hierarchy	Varna stratification

Points of Difference

1. Urbanisation: Harappa and Mohenjo-daro were planned cities with grids, fortified citadels and drainage, later Vedic society was rural and

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pastoral with small settlements.

2. Economy: Harappans practised bead-making, metallurgy and seal carving and kept maritime trade with Mesopotamia. Later Vedic people relied on cattle rearing and agriculture with iron tools and black-and-red ware.

3. Political organisation: Harappa was possibly a network of city-states with a merchant ruling class, granaries and fortifications but no temples, palaces or warrior elite. Later Vedic polity was monarchical, with kingship backed by priestly Brahmins.

4. Religion: Harappans had fertility cults, mother goddess figurines and unicorn and rhinoceros seals, but no fire altars or horse. Vedic religion centred on fire sacrifices (yajnas), Indra, Agni and the horse as a symbol of power.

5. Language and literature: The Indus script remains undeciphered, with no direct link to an Indo-Aryan language established, while Vedic texts like the Rig Veda were composed in early Indo-Aryan Sanskrit, giving a distinct linguistic and cultural identity.

6. Social structure: Harappa shows little evidence of rigid hierarchy, while Vedic society was

stratified by the Varna system into Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas and Shudras.

Way Forward

1. Interdisciplinary research: Collaboration among archaeologists, linguists and historians can decipher the script and clarify cultural continuities or ruptures.
2. Preserve sites: Stronger conservation of Harappan sites like Dholavira and Mohenjo-daro will support ongoing research and build public awareness of both phases of ancient Indian history.

Conclusion

The Harappan civilization was urban, commercial and without priestly or warrior dominance, while the later Vedic civilization was rural, ritual-centred and hierarchical. This contrast explains why Harappan urbanism did not directly continue into the Vedic period, and it marks a decisive turn in the evolution of Indian society, economy and religious thought.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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SCAN

P-II
1(b)

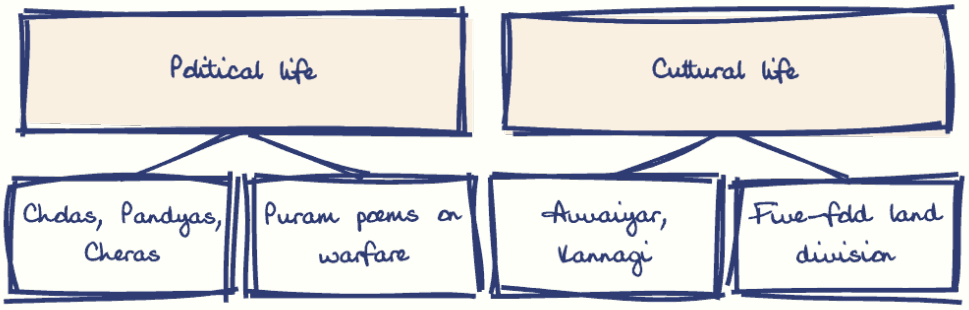
What do you know about Sangam age ? How does Sangam age literature help us in knowing the political and cultural life of that age ?

10

Introduction

The Sangam Age, spanning roughly 300 BCE to 300 CE, was a formative period in South Indian history, marked by Tamil literature flourishing under royal patronage. It is named after the Sangams, assemblies of Tamil poets, whose works remain invaluable for reconstructing life in ancient Tamilakam.

Sangam literature as a source



Political Life Revealed by the Literature

1. **Three kingdoms:** The Chdas, Pandyas and Cheras were ruled by hereditary monarchs who wielded considerable authority and patronised the Sangam assemblies.
2. **Monarchical administration:** Kings (Arasar) were supported by ministers and local

chieftains, and loyalty, valour and justice were prized royal virtues.

3. Military and diplomacy: The Puram poems describe frequent warfare, alliances and heroic exploits, showing that military prowess was crucial for sovereignty.

4. Social order: Tolkappiyam reveals caste divisions and land classifications regulated under royal oversight.

Cultural Life Revealed by the Literature

1. Social stratification: Texts describe priests, rulers, traders and agriculturists with distinct roles, a clear division of labour.

2. Women: Society was patriarchal, but female poets like Avvaiyar enriched literature; love marriages were common and chastity was valued, as with Kannagi.

3. Religion: A polytheistic society worshipped Murugan and Mayon, with festivals, rituals and temples central to daily life.

4. Arts and pastimes: Poetry, music, dance, festivals and hero stones show a vibrant cultural milieu.

Economic Life

1. **Land and livelihood:** The five-fold land classification of kurinji, mullai, marudam, neithal and palai linked geography with economy, each with its own deity.
2. **Trade and crafts:** Agriculture was the backbone, while merchants, markets, artisans and coins show a monetised economy with local and long-distance trade.
3. **Ecological sensitivity:** The poems show communities adapting livelihoods to diverse terrains, an early sense of sustainable resource use.

Conclusion

Sangam literature is not merely a collection of poems but a living heritage that illuminates the political institutions, social fabric and cultural ethos of early Tamilakam. Preserving and studying it enriches India's understanding of its regional histories.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

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SCAN

P-II
2(a)

Analyse the cultural contribution of Cholas and explain their contribution for the cultural expansion in South East Asia.

10

Introduction

The Chola dynasty (9th to 13th century CE) is renowned for monumental cultural achievement and maritime prowess. Its contributions shaped South India and drove a profound cultural expansion into Southeast Asia, an early instance of India's soft power.

Cultural Contributions of the Cholas

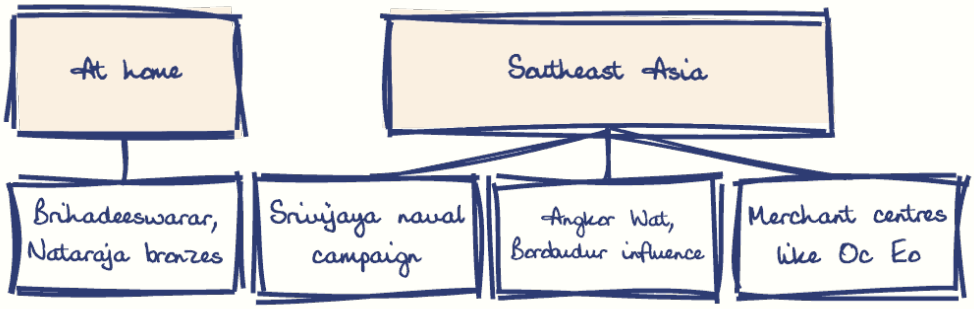
1. **Temple architecture:** The Brihadeeswarar Temple at Thanjavur, a UNESCO World Heritage site, shows advanced granite construction and fine sculpture. Temples were hubs of religion, arts and education.
2. **Bronze artistry:** The iconic Nataraja (dancing Shiva), cast by the lost-wax technique, symbolised devotion and artistic excellence and influenced Indian and Southeast Asian iconography.
3. **Religious patronage and literature:** The Cholas patronised Shaivism and temple rituals and fostered Tamil devotional poetry.
4. **Cultural synthesis:** Naval expeditions and trade

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blended Indian and local elements in art, language and religion.

Chola cultural reach



Contribution to Cultural Expansion in Southeast Asia

1. Naval expeditions: Rajendra Chola's 11th-century campaign against the Srivijaya kingdom in Sumatra secured key sea routes for the spread of Indian ideas.
2. Religious dissemination: Shaivism spread, seen in Sanskrit inscriptions, temples and the adoption of Indian maths and astronomy in Champa and Cambodia.
3. Art and language: Indian styles merged with local traditions, as at Angkor Wat and Borobudur, while Sanskrit and Tamil loanwords enriched Bahasa Indonesia.
4. Trade as a vector: Indian merchants and

settlers founded centres like Oc Eo in southern Vietnam, sustaining interactions that built a syncretic art and literature blending Indian and Southeast Asian elements.

Conclusion

The Chōlas shaped South Indian identity and projected Indian civilisation across Southeast Asia through architecture, religion, art and maritime power, laying the foundation for enduring India–ASEAN ties. Joint conservation of shared monuments can keep this legacy alive.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON · MODEL ANSWERS IN 150 · 250 · 500

Write to the word limit, not past it

In UPSC GS Mains, a 10-marker takes about 150 words and a 15-marker about 250. Twenty questions in three hours leaves roughly 7 and 11 minutes each.

1. **150 words** — A definition, two dimensions, a one-line verdict.
2. **250 words** — Add a line of context, a third dimension, one example each.
3. **500 words** — Add a diagram, a second example each, a way forward.
4. **The rule** — Draft the 150 first. Expand only where marks are.

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Read one question three ways →

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P-II
2(b)

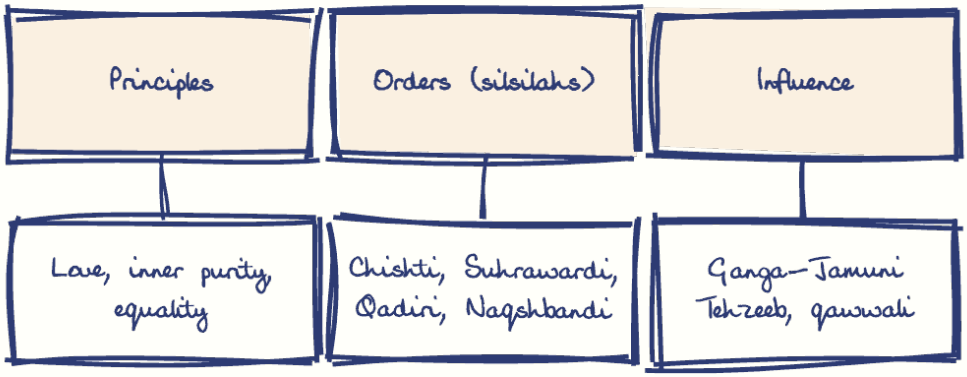
Explain Sufism and discuss its main principles, important orders and their influence on the Indian society.

10

Introduction

Sufism, the mystical dimension of Islam, emphasises love, devotion and inner purity over external ritual. Arriving in India in the 11th and 12th centuries, it adapted to local contexts and built a syncretic tradition bridging Hindu and Muslim communities.

Sufism in India



Main Principles

1. Mystical devotion: The soul seeks union with God through love, cleansing the heart of pride, jealousy and hatred rather than relying only on namaz and roza.
2. Equality: Sufism rejected caste and class,

promoting universal brotherhood and attracting marginalised communities.

3. Syncretism: Influenced by Hindu yogic and Buddhist practices, it shared ideas of God and the soul and practices like penance and fasting.

Important Orders

1. Silsilahs: About twelve major orders, such as the Chishti, Suhrawardi, Qadiri, Firdausi and Naqshbandi, were led by a pir living in a khanqah. The pir–disciple bond was central, and pirs nominated successors.

2. Ba-shara and Be-shara: Some orders followed Islamic law while others, often wandering saints, did not, causing tensions but reaching wider strata.

Influence on Indian Society

1. Religious harmony: Khwaja Mainuddin Chishti and Nizamuddin Auliya created spaces where Hindus and Muslims prayed together, promoting the Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb.

2. Vernacular literature: Saints preached in Persian and later in Punjabi, Bengali and Awadhi. Amir Khusrau enriched Hindavi and Urdu,

and Bulleh Shah's Punjabi Kafis expressed divine love and selflessness.

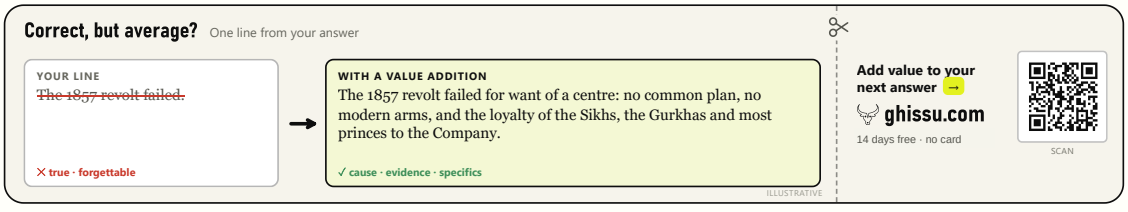
3. Music and architecture: Qawwali became a medium of spiritual expression, and dargahs blended Persian and Indian styles.

4. Welfare and equality: Khanqahs served as centres of education and charity, uplifting the poor.

5. Social egalitarianism: By rejecting caste barriers and stressing universal love, Sufism gave spiritual space to marginalised groups and influenced wider social reform.

Conclusion

Sufism blended Islamic mysticism with Indian religious ideas to shape India's composite culture through harmony, literature, music and service. Its emphasis on love, equality and service to humanity bridged Hindu and Muslim communities. Its dargahs remain vibrant pilgrimage sites for devotees of all religions, symbolising India's pluralistic ethos and its tradition of spiritual inclusiveness.



P-II
3(a)

State the reasons for the rise of Chhatrapati Shivaji and also describe the administrative, military and land revenue systems of his empire.

10

Introduction

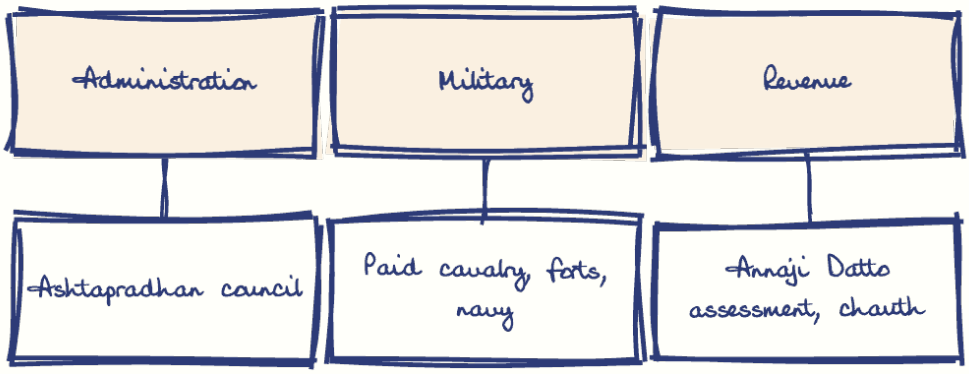
The rise of Chhatrapati Shivaji in the 17th century symbolised indigenous resistance to Mughal and Deccan Sultanate dominance. His ascent was not merely military but institutional: he founded a sovereign Maratha state with distinct administrative, military and revenue systems.

Reasons for his Rise

1. Geopolitical context: The weakening Bijapur Sultanate and Mughal preoccupation in the north allowed rapid expansion through forts and raids.
2. Popular support: Jijabai's vision and the Bhakti movement's influence won the loyalty of Mavlis and Maratha chiefs.
3. Guerrilla warfare and forts: Swift attacks and control of over 300 forts, such as Rajgad and Raigad, outwitted larger Mughal forces.
4. Coronation (1674): Vedic rites at Raigad established him as a Kshatriya king and united the chiefs.

Administrative and Military Organisation

Shivaji's state systems



1. **Ashtapradhan:** Eight ministers answerable to him, including Peshwa (finance), Senapati (military), Waknis (intelligence) and Nyayadhish (justice).
2. **Army:** A regular cavalry of 30,000–40,000 paid in cash, with strict discipline, no women on campaign and plunder accounted for.
3. **Fort management:** Three commanders guarded each fort to prevent treachery, with permanent Mavali soldiers and gunners.
4. **Navy:** Recognising the importance of coastal control, he built a navy to protect Konkan ports and challenge Portuguese and Mughal sea power.

Land Revenue System

1. **Assessment:** Following Malik Ambar's model,

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Annaji Datto's 1679 assessment fixed tax by land quality and productivity.

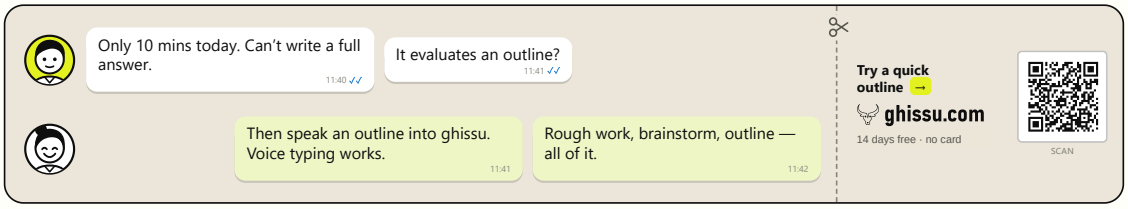
2. Chauth and sardeshmukhi: A quarter plus an additional tenth of land revenue was levied as tribute from territories under influence.

3. Cash salaries: Preferring cash to land grants promoted loyalty and checked feudal fragmentation.

4. Fiscal base: Forts, ports, trade routes, plunder and the Qutb Shahi subsidy strengthened state finances.

Conclusion

Shivaji's rise blended military genius, administrative innovation and cultural assertion, creating a centralised yet functional state whose institutions outlived him. His cash-paid army, assessed revenue and fort system still offer lessons in fiscal clarity and defensive planning.



P-II
3(b)

Describe the impact of the Revolt of 1857 on British Rule in India. What were the major changes in the British policies and rule after the revolt ?

10

Introduction

The Revolt of 1857, often termed India's First War of Independence, profoundly shook the foundations of British authority. Historians of every school agree that it exposed the vulnerabilities of Company administration and led to a complete overhaul of British governance and policy.

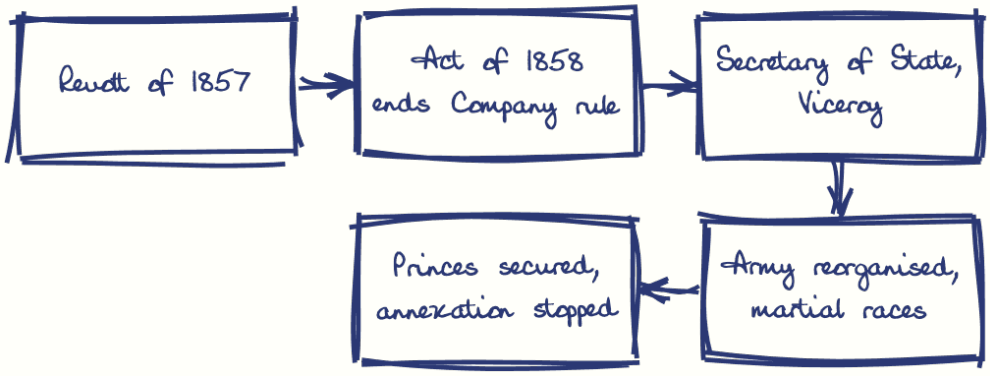
Impact on British Rule

1. **End of Company rule:** The Government of India Act, 1858 transferred sovereignty to the Crown, beginning the Raj; Queen Victoria was proclaimed Empress of India in 1877.
2. **Racial divide:** Narratives of Indian untrustworthiness justified racial superiority and segregation, deepening alienation.
3. **Military weakness exposed:** The British raised the proportion of European troops and recruited martial races like Sikhs and Gurkhas.
4. **Princely states realigned:** Loyal princes were rewarded as the Doctrine of Lapse was abandoned and adoption allowed.

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From revolt to Crown rule



Major Changes in Policy

1. Queen's Proclamation (1858): It promised religious neutrality, non-interference in customs and equal treatment, though discrimination persisted.
2. Divide and rule: Muslims, blamed for the revolt, faced discrimination, sowing communal tension.
3. Economic and social policy: Zamindars were protected as allies, and railways and telegraphs consolidated control.
4. Limited participation: The Indian Councils Act of 1861 allowed token representation.

Changes in Administration

1. Centralisation: A Secretary of State in London and a Viceroy in India tightened control.
2. Civil service: The Indian Civil Service Act of

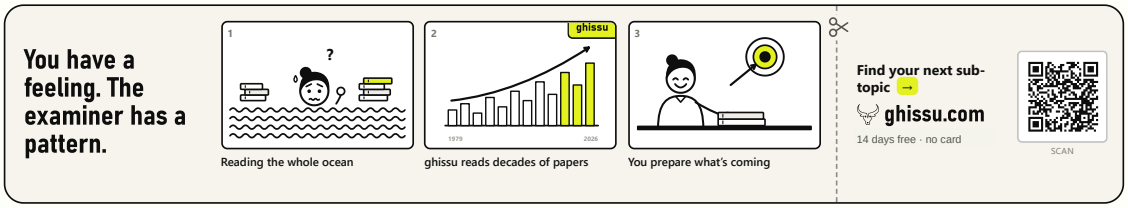
(1861) restructured the bureaucracy, nominally open to Indians but guarded by competitive exams and racial barriers.

3. Army reorganisation: Troops from different regions and communities were mixed to prevent future mutinies.

4. Legal control: Special courts tried suspected rebels, and the Arms Act barred Indians from possessing weapons.

Conclusion

The revolt ended Company rule but produced a more centralised, cautious and divisive Raj, whose policies of racial distance, princely alliance and communal division shaped the colonial trajectory for decades.



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P-II
4(a)

Describe the impact of the teachings of Swami Vivekananda in arousing nationalistic feeling and the spirit of service in Indians.

10

Introduction

Swami Vivekananda's teachings awakened national pride and a spirit of service in late 19th and early 20th-century India. Amid colonial subjugation and social stagnation, his message of pride in India's heritage and duty to society inspired new confidence, especially among the youth.

Arousing Nationalistic Feeling

1. Reassertion of heritage: He reminded Indians of their rich spiritual and cultural legacy, which colonial narratives had undermined.
2. Unity in diversity: Harmonising Hindu sects strengthened a collective identity rooted in shared values.
3. Defence against Western criticism: He countered missionary propaganda and presented Indian spirituality as a universal philosophy.
4. Bridge between East and West: Interpreting Vedanta in modern terms, he urged Indians to embrace science and humanism without losing their roots.

Arousing the Spirit of Service

1. Service as worship: He redefined monasticism, joining renunciation to active service of the poor as service of God.
2. Focus on the masses: He urged the educated elite to uplift the poor, calling those who ignored suffering traitors.
3. Institutional social work: The Ramakrishna Mission ran hospitals, schools and relief, a model of humanitarian national regeneration.
4. Youth empowerment: He instilled self-reliance and courage, still honoured on National Youth Day.

Vivekananda's message in action



Limitations

1. No direct politics: He avoided political activism, which limited immediate mobilisation, though his spiritual nationalism indirectly fuelled later movements.

2. Social conservatism: Entrenched hierarchies and orthodox attitudes slowed his call for equality.
3. Scaling the model: Replicating the Ramakrishna Mission nationally faced resource and regional constraints.

Way Forward

1. Civic education: Teach his ideas of service and national pride to nurture responsible citizens.
2. Service networks and youth: Replicate Mission-style service and build youth leadership programmes.

Conclusion

Vivekananda blended spiritual pride with practical action, inspiring an India where cultural confidence and humanitarian service go hand in hand.



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My answers

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SCAN

P-II
4(b)

Describe the contribution of Narayana Guru in social awakening and the result of his teachings on society.

10

Introduction

Narayana Guru's teachings were a beacon of social awakening in late 19th and early 20th century Kerala, a period of rigid caste hierarchy and social discrimination. His reformist mission challenged entrenched orthodoxy and sought equality and spiritual unity beyond caste and religious divides. Its enduring impact lies in fostering social cohesion.

Contribution to Social Awakening

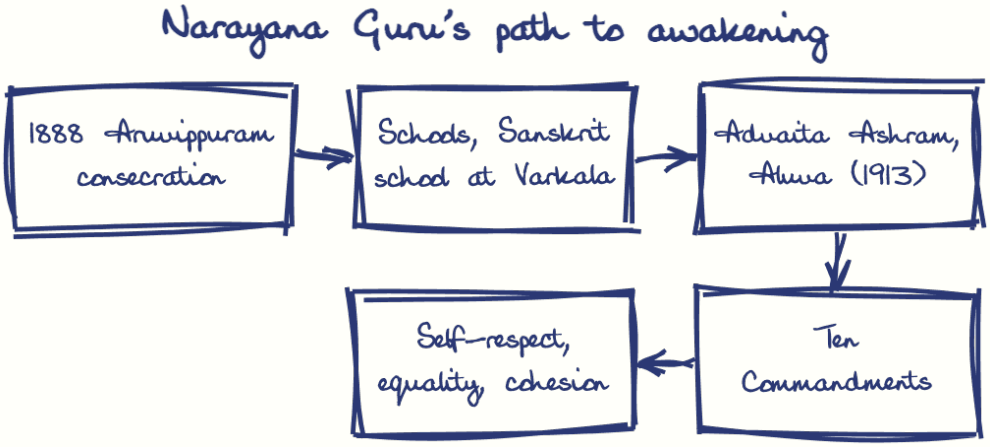
1. **Temple Consecration as Protest:** In (1888) he installed a Shiva idol at Aruvippuram, defying the Brahminical monopoly over temple rituals. It was a radical assertion of spiritual equality that challenged caste-based religious authority.
2. **Educational Institutions:** He founded schools and a Sanskrit school in Varkala for poor boys and orphans irrespective of caste. This institutionalised access to knowledge as a tool of empowerment.
3. **Advaita Ashram:** Founded at Aluva in (1913), it embodied Om Sahodaryam Sarvatra

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(all men are equal before God) and served as a spiritual and social hub promoting inclusivity and fraternity.

4. Ten Commandments: His ethical precepts stressed education, organisation, industry, caste abolition, religious tolerance and social welfare, giving society a structured moral framework for transformation.



Results of His Teachings

1. Overcoming Orthodoxy: Brahmin priests and conservative elements opposed his challenge to caste privilege, but his personal austerity and spiritual authority gradually won wide respect.

2. Religious Harmony: He held all religions valid if they promote human welfare and endorsed inter-caste marriage and dining, which fostered harmony and reduced communal tension.

3. Empowerment: Education and spiritual dignity broke the social isolation of lower castes and the poor and inspired self-respect among oppressed groups.

4. Ethical Reform: Teachings against liquor and wasteful expenditure, with a call for hard work and neighbourly welfare, built a disciplined, progressive ethos in Kerala. This ethos continues to influence Kerala's social fabric.

Conclusion

Narayana Guru turned spiritual reform into a powerful movement against caste injustice. His vision of universal brotherhood inspired later reformers and laid the foundation for a more inclusive society. Extending caste-neutral education and interfaith and intercaste dialogue today would carry his vision forward, in line with the constitutional values of justice and fraternity.

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Open the notes tab →

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SCAN

P-II
5(a)

Discuss the contribution of the Revolutionary Nationalists to the Freedom Movement and their impact on the British Rule.

10

Introduction

The revolutionary nationalists played a pivotal yet complex role in the freedom struggle, offering a radical alternative to moderate and Gandhian approaches. Inspired by the Russian and Irish revolutions, they demanded complete independence through direct action and challenged British authority in new ways.

Contribution to the Freedom Movement

1. **Armed Struggle:** Acts such as the Chapekar brothers' assassination of British officials in (1897) and the Chittagong Armoury Raid of (1930) sought to awaken political consciousness and inspire mobilisation.
2. **Shift Towards Socialism:** Influenced by the (1917) Russian Revolution, the HSRA under Bhagat Singh widened the goal to social justice, equality and workers' rights.
3. **Youth Engagement:** Bodies like the Punjab Naujawan Bharat Sabha engaged youth, workers and peasants, moving from isolated violence to sustained political work.

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4. Propaganda by Deed: Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt's 1929 bombing of the Central Legislative Assembly was meant to dramatise the cause, not cause casualties.

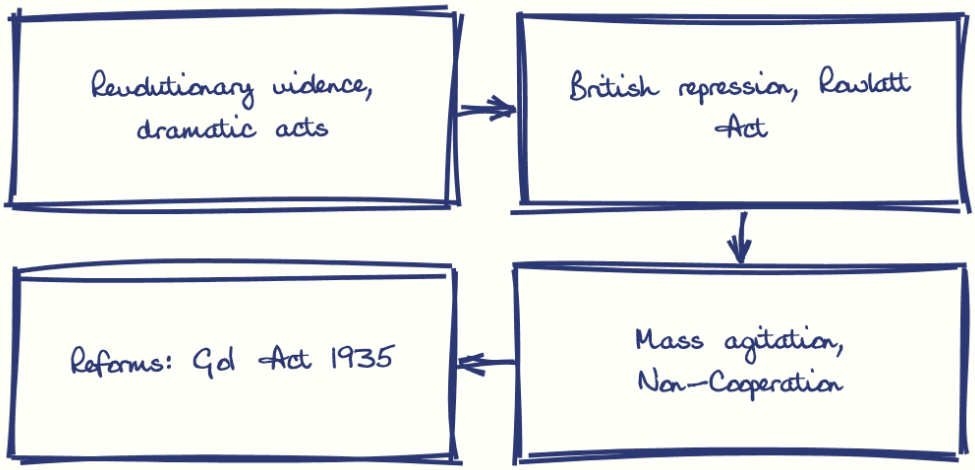
Impact on British Rule

1. Undermining Security: The British had to divert significant resources to intelligence and repression, exposing the vulnerabilities of colonial control.
2. Repressive Legislation: Harsh laws like the Rowlatt Act (1919) alienated moderate opinion and fuelled wider agitation, including Gandhi's non-cooperation.
3. Indirect Concessions: The revolutionary threat contributed to reforms like the Government of India Act 1935, though these fell short of self-rule.
4. Limitations: Their violent methods isolated them from the masses and drew criticism even within nationalist ranks.

Overall Assessment

Revolutionary violence provoked British repression such as the Rowlatt Act, repression fed mass agitation like Non-Cooperation, and mass agitation pushed

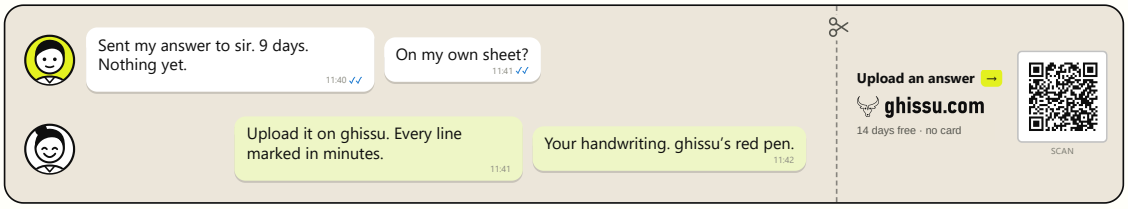
Chain of revolutionary impact



the British towards reforms. In this chain the revolutionaries acted as a catalyst for the wider struggle.

Conclusion

The revolutionary nationalists injected urgency, radicalism and a vision of social justice into the struggle. Though their methods limited mass appeal, they compelled the British to confront the untenability of their rule and inspired later generations to pursue freedom with courage and conviction.



P-II
5(b)

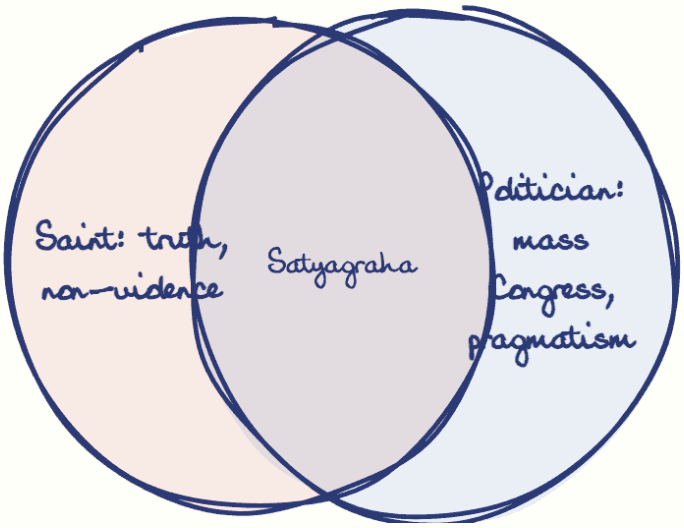
"Gandhi was a politician among saints and a saint among politicians." Discuss.

10

Introduction

The description of Gandhi as "a politician among saints and a saint among politicians" captures the unique synthesis of spirituality and political acumen in his leadership. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians debate how his moral ideals shaped his politics and how politics shaped his ideals.

Gandhi: saint and politician



A Saint Among Politicians

1. **Spiritual Ethos in Politics:** He made truth (Satya) and non-violence (Ahimsa) central to political action rather than expediency. Satyagraha was a principled commitment to

ethical resistance, not a mere tactic.

2. Ethical Leadership: His insistence on integrity, humility and self-sacrifice set a high standard, and his vision of decentralised democracy later inspired the 73rd Constitutional Amendment.

3. Moral Restraint: He was willing to suspend movements when unprincipled elements threatened their moral foundation.

A Politician Among Saints

1. Institutional Innovation: He transformed the Congress from an elite body into a mass movement rooted in grassroots participation, with ideas like Gram Swaraj and trusteeship.

2. Balancing Idealism and Pragmatism: His career was a constant negotiation between lofty ideals and the practical demands of mass mobilisation.

3. Political Inclusivity: Drawing on his South African experience, he sought to unify diverse religious and social groups into one national movement, though his methods sometimes alienated radical elements.

Limits of the Synthesis

1. Symbolism vs Change: Campaigns against

untouchability and for communal harmony created powerful symbols, but deep prejudice and political opposition limited their impact, showing the gap between saintly vision and political reality.

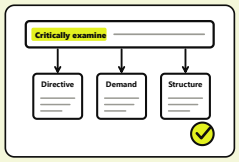
2. Critics: His Harijan programme faced orthodox resistance and Dalit scepticism, and Ambedkar criticised his caste reform as inadequate.

Legacy

His model of non-violent resistance and moral leadership influenced global civil rights movements and still informs debates on ethical governance, social justice and political accountability.

Conclusion

Gandhi's blend of saintliness and political skill redefined the freedom struggle. It shows that moral politics can mobilise masses and challenge injustice, in the spirit of Sarvodaya, while grappling with social realities.



Stuck at the directive?

Exam-hall thinking

The directive, the demand, the structure — before your first line. Full for beginners, Crux for veterans.

Walk in with a method →

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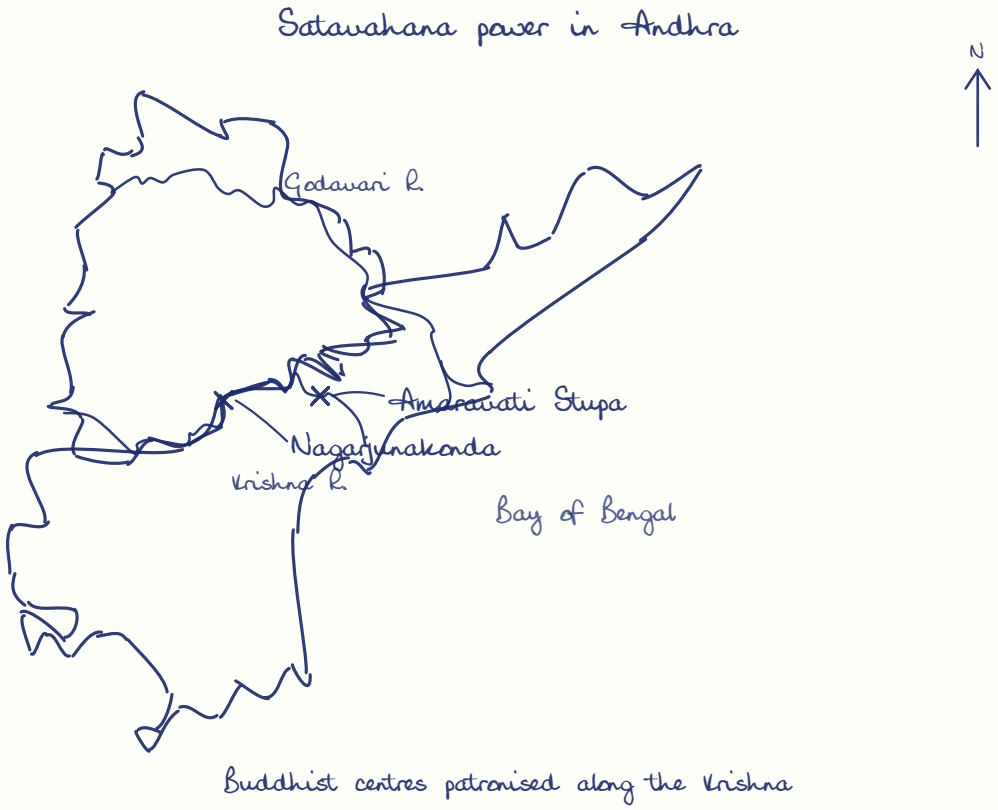
P-II
6(a)

Trace the origin and expansion of the Satavahana power and describe their contribution to religion and literature.

10

Introduction

The Satavahana dynasty emerged after the Mauryan decline and shaped the political and cultural landscape of the Deccan and Andhra. Their reign was marked by religious synthesis and literary development, blending Brahmanism, Buddhism and local traditions.



Origin of Satavahana Power

1. **Local Roots:** They are believed to come from a

Deccan tribe identified with the Andhras, who adopted Brahmanical customs and legitimised rule through Vedic rituals.

2. Post-Mauryan Rise: As the Mauryan Empire disintegrated, they used their administrative experience under it to assert independent kingship.

3. Capital and Early Kings: Pratishthana (Paithan) was the capital, and Satakarni I, around (50) BCE, consolidated power through campaigns and Vedic sacrifices.

Expansion

1. Military Campaigns: Satakarni I pushed beyond the Narmada into Malwa and into the Godavari valley, contending with the Shakas and Kharavela of Kalinga.

2. Territorial Reach: At its zenith the empire stretched from the Aravallis to the Nilgiris and from the Arabian Sea to the Bay of Bengal.

3. Administration: A hereditary monarchy ruled through feudatories such as mahabhojas and senapatis, who held local authority under the centre.

4. Decline: Pressure from the Abhiras, Traikutakas and Ikshvakus led to fragmentation.

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Contribution to Religion

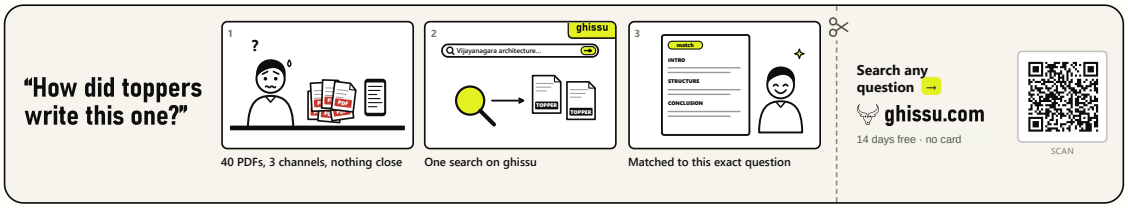
1. **Brahmanical Revival:** They performed asvamedha and rajasuya, as recorded in the Nanaghat inscriptions of Queen Naganika.
2. **Patronage of Buddhism:** They supported Mahayana monasteries and stupas at Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati, fostering religious harmony.
3. **Buddhist Philosophy:** Acharya Nagarjuna received royal support and enriched Mahayana thought.

Contribution to Literature

1. **Prakrit:** Prakrit was the language of inscriptions and court literature, and King Hala composed the Gathasaptasati.
2. **Rise of Sanskrit:** Later rulers like Kuntala Satakarni promoted Sanskrit, reflected in Sarvavarma's Katantra Vyakarana.

Conclusion

The Satavahanas rose from local roots to a vast Deccan empire and left a lasting heritage of religious tolerance and literary growth in Andhra.



P-II
6(b)

Explain the political significance of Vengi Chalukyas and describe their role in moulding the culture of the Andhra.

10

Introduction

The Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi, established in the 7th century AD, ruled for nearly five centuries and shaped the politics and cultural identity of Andhra. They were key architects of its governance, literature and religion.

Eastern Chalukya kingdom of Vengi



Coastal Andhra ruled for nearly 500 years

Political Significance

1. **Stable Kingdom:** Kubja Vishnuvardhana, brother of Pulakesi II, was made viceroy of Vengi

around (624) AD, founding a dynasty that ruled coastal Andhra for nearly (500) years.

2. Buffer State: Vengi stood between the Pallavas, Rashtrakutas and later the Cholas. Despite external pressure it kept its autonomy through skilful alliances and wars, as under Bhima I and Rajaraja Narendra.

3. Chola Integration: Marriage ties and the rise of Kulothunga I, a descendant of the Eastern Chalukyas, merged Andhra into the larger South Indian polity.

4. Decentralised Governance: Mandalikas like the Velanati Cholas controlled large parts of coastal Andhra, giving effective local rule and military support and fostering loyalty among diverse communities.

Moulding Andhra Culture

1. Telugu Language and Literature: Their court patronised poets and scholars, developing Telugu as a literary language and laying the foundation of Telugu literature's golden age.

2. Religion and Architecture: They promoted Brahmanical Hinduism while tolerating Buddhism and Jainism, and built temples and cave shrines at Undavalli and

Vijayawada blending northern and southern styles.

3. Cultural Synthesis: They encouraged Brahmins and other communities from north and south India to settle, creating a cosmopolitan culture and spreading Vedic learning and ritual.

4. Vedic Dharma: Grand sacrifices like Asvamedha and Vajapeya reinforced an order based on varna and dharma, consolidating Hindu norms that still shape the region's ethos.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Conservation: Sites like the Undavalli caves and Kapoteswara temple need stronger conservation and promotion.

Conclusion

The Vengi Chalukyas gave Andhra political stability for five centuries, secured its place in the South Indian polity and moulded its distinct Telugu cultural identity through patronage of literature, temples and Vedic learning.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths → ghissu.com

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P-II
7(a)

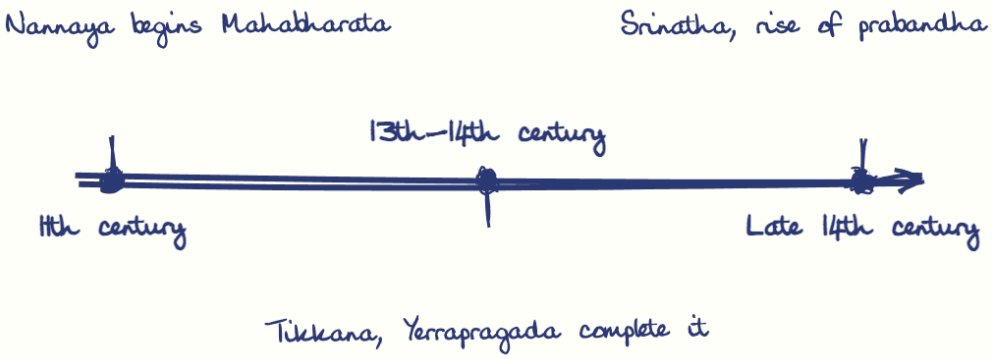
Critically analyse the growth of Telugu language and literature between 1000 AD and 1500 AD.

10

Introduction

The period 1000 to 1500 AD was formative for Telugu. It crystallised as a literary language distinct from its Dravidian roots and Sanskrit influences, nurtured by the Eastern Chalukyas, Kakatiyas and Vijayanagara.

Telugu literature, 1000 to 1500



Development of the Language

1. Early Foundations: Nannaya, court poet of Raja Raja Narendra of Rajahmahendravaram, rendered two and a half parvas of the Mahabharata in the 11th century, blending Sanskrit metres with Telugu vocabulary.

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2. The Kavitraya: In the 13th and 14th centuries Tikkana and Yerrapragada completed the Mahabharata, maturing narrative style and language.
3. Script and Dialects: The Telugu script evolved from the Pallava script, regional dialects emerged, and the language balanced classical and colloquial forms.
4. Official Status: Kakatiya and Vijayanagara rulers used Telugu in administration, standardising it.

Evolution of Literature

1. Epic and Devotional Works: Translations of the epics stood beside Shaivite and Vaishnavite works like the Basava Purana and Sivatathwa Sara, reflecting the Bhakti movement.
2. Original Poetry: By the late 14th century Srinatha, the "Byron of Andhra", wrote Palnati Veera Charitra, and the prabandha genre rose.
3. Style: Sanskritised diction blended with native idioms and varied metres, and the Kavitraya set a high standard for later generations.
4. Popular Forms: Folk themes and desi elements made literature accessible across social strata.

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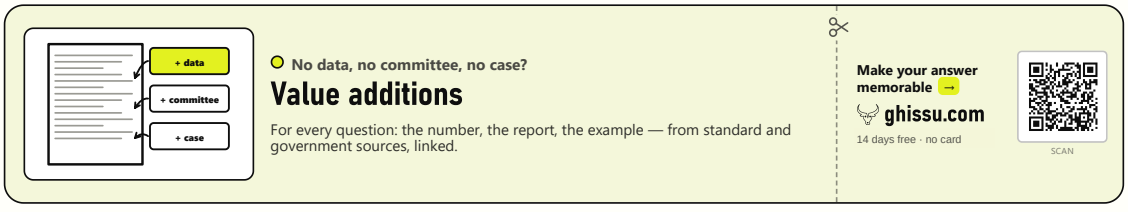
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Critical Assessment

1. **Royal Patronage:** Support from successive dynasties gave prestige, peaking under Krishna Deva Raya with the Ashtadiggajas.
2. **Religious Movements:** The Bhakti stress on vernaculars spread Telugu religious poetry, while Shaivism and Vaishnavism shaped its themes and forms.
3. **Limitations:** Sanskrit dominance and regional conflicts held back fuller growth, and much early writing remained translation.
4. **Overall Balance:** Telugu nonetheless moved from translation to original prabandhas and from court to common people.

Conclusion

These five centuries carried Telugu from Nannaya's translation to Srinatha's original prabandhas, giving it script, standard and classical stature while it still negotiated with Sanskrit.



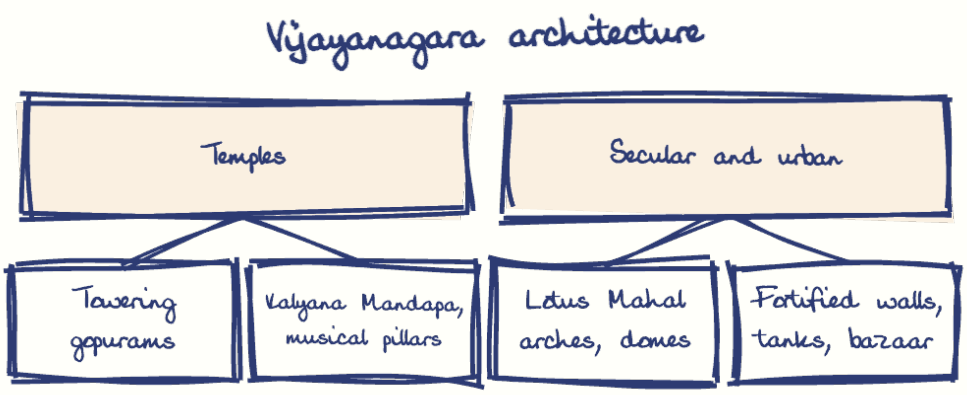
P-II
7(b)

Describe the characteristics of Vijayanagara architecture.

10

Introduction

Vijayanagara architecture, flourishing between the 14th and 17th centuries, represents a pinnacle of South Indian temple design and urban planning. It is renowned for grand scale, intricate carvings and a synthesis of cultural influences, reflecting the empire's role as a Hindu bastion in the turbulent Deccan.



Key Features

1. Monumental Temple Complexes: The Vittala and Virupaksha temples at Hampi have towering gopurams and expansive mandapas for large congregations and royal ceremonies.
2. Hybrid Style: Dravidian design merged with Chalukya, Pandya and Chola influences, along with Indo-Islamic elements seen in the Lotus

Mahals

3. Elaborate Sculpture: Pillars and walls show deities, myths and prancing horses, reflecting devotion and the empire's martial ethos.

4. Urban Planning: Hampi had fortified walls, concentric moats, bastions, Hampi Bazaar, large tanks and granaries.

Stylistic and Structural Elements

1. Gopurams and Mandapas: Slender, multi-storied gopurams symbolised sanctity and royal power, while the Kalyana Mandapa hosted divine marriages on carved granite pillars.

2. Musical Pillars and Monoliths: The Vittala Temple's musical pillars emit tones when struck, and the monolithic Lakshmi Narasimha shows technical prowess.

3. Secular Buildings: Royal baths and elephant stables used arches, domes and plasterwork, showing syncretism.

4. Granite and Ornament: Durable granite allowed detailed carving and longevity, balancing structural solidity with the decorative exuberance of sculpted pillars and reliefs.

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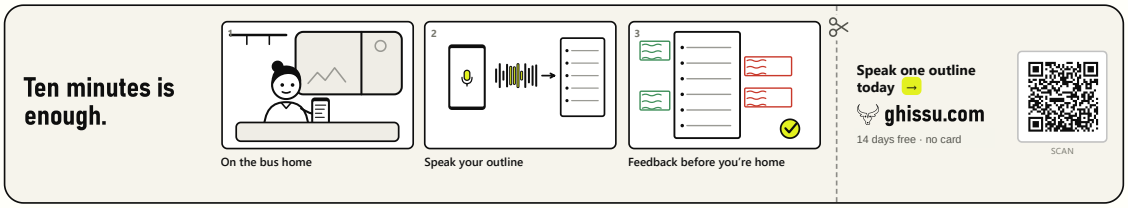
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Significance

1. **Hindu Identity:** Temple building preserved Hindu traditions during Islamic expansion and reinforced legitimacy.
2. **Imperial Power:** Scale and ornament projected wealth, military strength and a cosmopolitan character, drawing pilgrims, traders and artists.
3. **Languages and Arts:** Building patronage coincided with Telugu, Kannada and Sanskrit literature, and reliefs celebrated rulers like Srikrishnadeva Raya.
4. **Heritage Today:** Hampi, a UNESCO World Heritage site, continues to inspire cultural identity and tourism.

Conclusion

Vijayanagara architecture fused grandeur, craftsmanship and openness to diverse traditions, and Hampi remains an enduring symbol of regional identity and artistic achievement.



P-II
8(a)

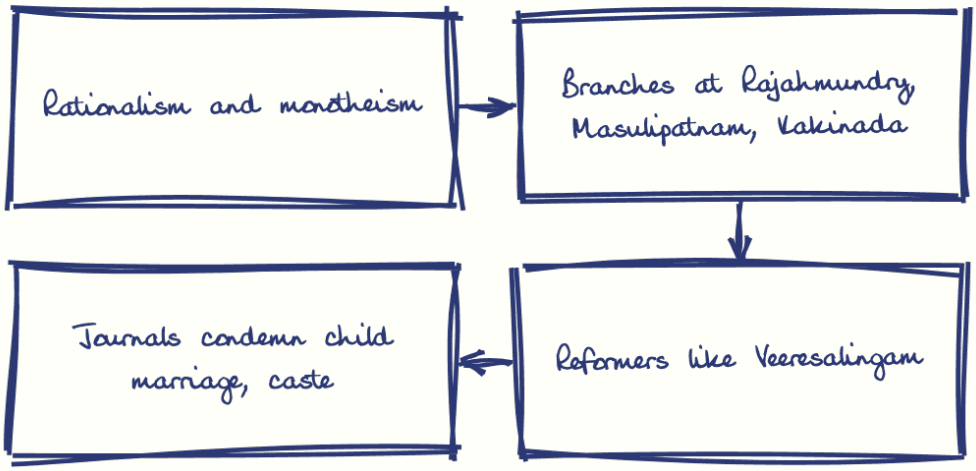
State the influence of Brahma Samaj Movement on the social reformers of Andhra and highlight how that ideology is reflected in their writings.

10

Introduction

The Brahmo Samaj, founded by Raja Ram Mohan Roy in the early 19th century, was a pioneering socio-religious reform movement. It reached Andhra in the late 19th century and catalysed a social awakening whose ideals are clearly reflected in the writings of Andhra's reformers.

From Brahmo ideals to reform writing



Influence on Andhra Social Reformers

1. Catalyst for Awakening: Its rationalism and monotheism challenged superstition and orthodoxy, helping Kandukuri Veeresalingam advocate widow remarriage and women's education.

2. Key Centres: Branches at Rajahmundry (1878), Masulipatnam (1882) and Kakinada (1888) became hubs of reform, and R. Venkataratnam Naydu and Veeresalingam were directly shaped by Brahmo ideals.
3. Rational and Ethical Living: Rejection of idol worship, caste discrimination and social evils inspired campaigns against child marriage and untouchability.
4. Limitations: Its reach was largely confined to the urban educated elite, leaving rural customs untouched.

Reflection in their Writings

1. Literature for Reform: Veeresalingam used journals and magazines to spread Brahmo ideals, boldly condemning child marriage and caste discrimination.
2. Rationalism and Humanism: Writings encouraged education, especially for women, and ethical living based on reason rather than blind faith, as his magazines for women's upliftment show.
3. Religious and Social Unity: They called for religious tolerance and social harmony, echoing the Brahmo universalist outlook.

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4. Constraints: Low literacy and entrenched tradition limited their impact on the rural masses, showing how hard it was to turn Brahmo ideology into mass change.

Way Forward

1. Rural Outreach: Awareness programmes in rural Andhra can carry these reformist ideals beyond urban elites.
2. Media for Reform: Digital and vernacular media can spread rational and humanist values more widely.
3. Interfaith Dialogue: Initiatives for tolerance can reflect the Brahmo universalist ethos and strengthen communal harmony.

Conclusion

The Brahmo Samaj gave Andhra's reformers a rational, ethical and reformist outlook. Their writings on women's education, widow remarriage and caste carried this ideology to the public, though mainly among the educated classes. Extending that outlook to rural Andhra remained the unfinished task of the movement.

STUDY TIP · BEFORE YOU OPEN A CHAPTER
List what was asked from it in the last ten years. Read that first; the rest second.

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See the trend for your chapter →
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P-II
8(b)

Assess the role of Western education and contribution of Christian Missionaries in the socio-cultural awakening in Andhra.

10

Introduction

The socio-cultural awakening in Andhra during the 19th and early 20th centuries reshaped its social fabric and outlook. Western education and Christian missionaries introduced new ideas, challenged orthodox practices and fostered reformist zeal as society moved towards modernity.

Two drivers of awakening

Western education	Christian missionaries
University of Madras, colleges	Machilipatnam school, 1843
Rationalist educated elite	Girls' and zenana classes
Mostly upper classes	Reached marginalised groups
Comparative study of scriptures	Opposed devadasi system

Role of Western Education

1. English Education: The University of Madras (1857) and colleges in Machilipatnam, Rajahmundry and Visakhapatnam created an educated elite with liberal and rationalist ideas.

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2. Reformist Class: Enlightenment values of equality, liberty and scientific temper inspired pioneers of social and political reform.

3. Comparative Study: Indian scriptures were studied alongside Western texts, fostering critical thinking and cultural pride.

4. Limitations: Access was mostly for upper and middle classes, neglecting rural and marginalised groups and reinforcing hierarchies.

Contribution of Christian Missionaries

1. Education and Health: The Machilipatnam school (1843) and Rajahmundry nursing school (1917) gave free services to marginalised communities.

2. Social Reform: Missionaries opposed child marriage, female infanticide and the devadasi system, and backed widow remarriage and zenana classes.

3. Women and Lower Castes: Girls' and vocational education challenged patriarchy and caste barriers.

4. Cultural Disruption: Evangelisation sometimes disrupted indigenous practices and caused religious tensions over identity.

Overall Impact

1. Modernisation: Both were catalysts for modernisation

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and a new social consciousness.

2. New Social Consciousness: The educated elite challenged orthodoxy and advocated egalitarian values.

3. Uneven Reach: Coastal Andhra changed more than the interior, and some sections resisted changes seen as threats to their identity.

Conclusion

Western education and missionaries laid the foundations of modern Andhra, though their reach was uneven and their methods sometimes clashed with tradition.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

Measure progress, don't guess it

Writing more is not the same as writing better. This is how to know which one you're doing.

1. **Score everything** — Even a rough attempt gets a number.
2. **Rewrite** — The same question, one week later.
3. **Compare** — Intro, dimensions, conclusion — side by side.
4. **One fix at a time** — Track a single weakness until it's gone.

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P-II
9(a)

Critically examine the objectives and results of the movement of Tripuraneni Ramaswamy Chowdary.

10

Introduction

Tripuraneni Ramaswamy Chowdary was a pioneering social reformer and rationalist in Andhra Pradesh in the early 20th century. His movement arose when Andhra society was grappling with rigid caste hierarchies, superstition and gender discrimination. A critical look shows bold aspirations but clear limits.

Tripuraneni's movement

Objectives	Results
Atheistic rationalism	Inspired Hetuvada, rationalist centres
End caste and child marriage	Caste and patriarchy persisted
Reform through theatre	No mass organisation built

Objectives and Reformist Vision

1. Rationalist ideology: The movement rested on atheistic rationalism, rejecting orthodox Hindu beliefs, as seen in *Brahma Bhagvadgita* and *Sambuka Vadha*. It aimed to free society from

dogma and build scientific temper.

2. Social reform agenda: He condemned child marriage, advocated widow remarriage, promoted women's education and opposed caste discrimination. These goals were more radical than the wider Andhra Renaissance in directly challenging orthodoxy.

3. Cultural and literary tools: He used theatre, including the Telugu play *Vivaha Vidhi*, and performed marriages himself to model progressive practice beyond rhetoric.

Results and Limitations

1. Resistance from orthodoxy: Conservative caste groups and religious authorities saw his atheism as a threat to traditional power, which constrained his reach in rural areas.

2. No formal organisation: Unlike Kandukuri Viresalingam, he built no mass organisation or political platform, so intellectual critique did not turn into mass transformation.

3. Influence on Andhra rationalism: His ideas inspired later rationalists, atheistic centres in Vijayawada and publications like *Hetuvada*.

4. Partial legacy: His critique of puranas and

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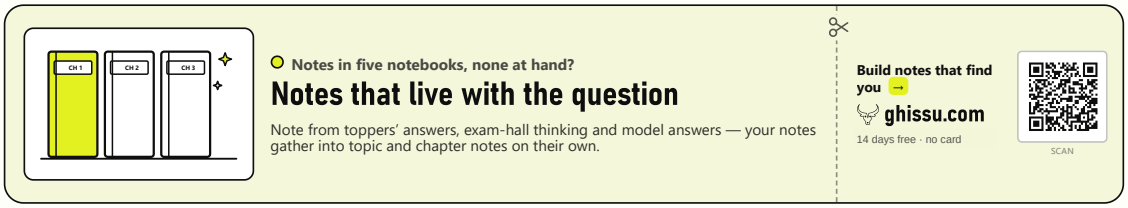
caste injustice gradually eroded unquestioned religious authority, though caste and patriarchy persisted.

Way Forward

1. Institutional networks: Formal organisations can carry his rationalist ideals forward.
2. Education and reform: Embedding rationalist thought in schod and college curricula can nurture critical thinking and gender equality from a young age.
3. Media and arts: Theatre, literature and digital media can revive his cuttural strategy against superstition and caste discrimination.

Conclusion

Tripuraneni's movement was a bold, intellectually rigorous attack on orthodoxy whose immediate resutts were limited by resistance and weak organisation. Its enduring legacy lies in inspiring later rationalist currents in the region, while the unfinished agenda of caste and gender equality still calls for renewed effort.



P-II
9(b)

Describe the reasons and state the important events that led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh State in 1956.

10

Introduction

The formation of Andhra Pradesh in 1956 was a milestone in India's post-independence linguistic reorganisation. The demand for a Telugu state had deep historical roots and was part of the national debate on linguistic states. Potti Sreeramulu's death led to Andhra State in 1953, which merged with Telangana in 1956.

Reasons for Formation

1. Linguistic and cultural identity: Telugu speakers felt their language and culture were neglected in the Madras Presidency, dominated by Tamil speakers.

2. Political marginalisation: Telugu leaders and legislators felt sidelined by Tamil leaders, and the refusal to concede Madras city, culturally significant and economically vital, deepened discontent.

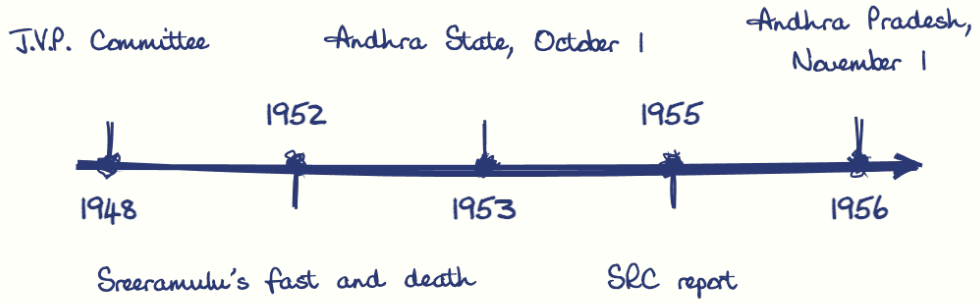
3. Congress commitment: The Congress promised linguistic reorganisation in its 1946 manifesto, though hesitant, Nehru later accepted the principle for unity and stability.

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4. Sreeramulu's fast: Potti Sreeramulu's fast unto death in (1952) created unrest and sympathy, and his death after (58) days forced the Centre to concede.

Road to Andhra Pradesh



Important Events

1. Andhra Mahasabha: It and other organisations had campaigned for a separate Telugu province since the early 20th century, laying the ground for political mobilisation.
2. J.V.P. Committee (1948): Nehru, Patel and Pattabhi Sitaramayya examined linguistic demands and acknowledged Andhra's strong case.
3. Andhra State (1953): Protests and hartals after Sreeramulu's death made Nehru announce Andhra State in December (1952.) it was born on October (1, 1953.)

4. SRC and 1956 merger: The States Reorganisation Commission report of 1955 recommended merging Telangana with Andhra State, forming Andhra Pradesh on November 1, 1956 under the Gentlemen's Agreement.

Way Forward

1. Regional integration: Regional committees and equitable resource sharing can maintain unity within linguistically diverse states.
2. Inclusive development: Addressing disparities between coastal Andhra, Rayalaseema and Telangana can sustain that unity.

Conclusion

Linguistic pride, political assertion and the sacrifice of Potti Sreeramulu combined to create Andhra Pradesh. Its formation encouraged demands from other linguistic groups and set a precedent for reorganising states on linguistic lines.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

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P-II
10(a)

Evaluate the seriousness of the problems in reorganisation of Andhra Pradesh with reference to the financial position of the State of Andhra Pradesh immediately after reorganisation.

10

Introduction

The reorganisation of Andhra Pradesh in 2014, which created Telangana, was a significant moment in India's federal history. It reshaped the political map and posed complex administrative and financial challenges for the residual state. Their seriousness is best judged through its financial position right after bifurcation.

Problems of Reorganisation

1. **Loss of Hyderabad:** Hyderabad became a joint capital for only ten years, creating uncertainty and straining resources for a new capital.
2. **Asset and liability disputes:** Contentious apportionment between the two states delayed financial settlements and hurt fiscal stability.
3. **Political and social unrest:** Agitations like the "Jai Andhra" movement and employee strikes disrupted governance, revenue generation and expenditure management.
4. **Water conflicts:** Krishna and Godavari disputes created uncertainty in agricultural planning and

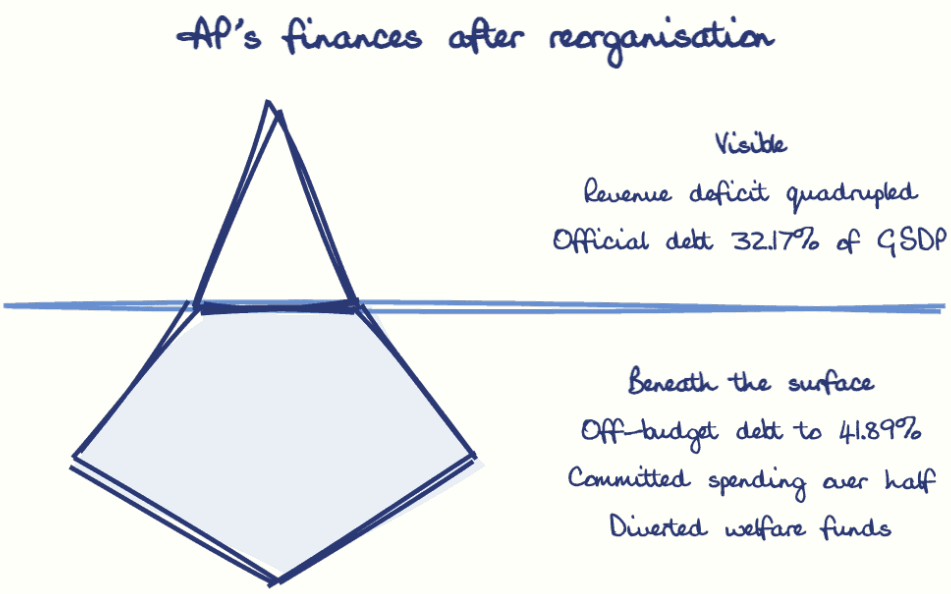
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hydroelectric projects.

Financial Position ~~After~~ Reorganisation

1. Revenue deficit: The revenue deficit quadrupled, reflecting immediate fiscal strain.
2. High committed expenditure: Over 50% of revenue expenditure went to salaries, pensions and interest, limiting development spending.
3. Low capital expenditure: ~~At~~ just 0.55% of GSDP in 2022–23, it showed underinvestment in infrastructure and services.
4. Debt burden: Official liabilities were 32.17% of GSDP, but with off-budget borrowings the real burden rose to 41.89%.



How Serious Were the Problems

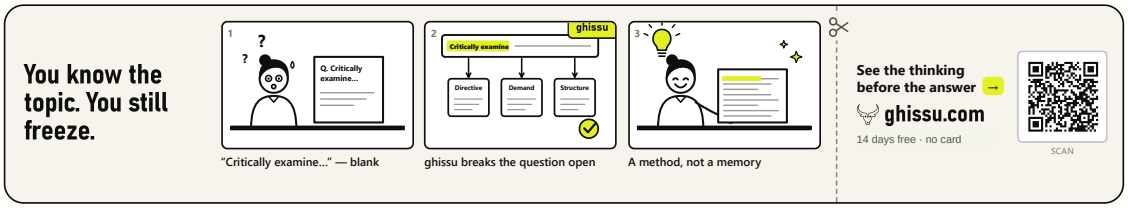
1. **Structural imbalance:** High committed spending and weak revenue created a structural fiscal imbalance, forcing more debt for new schemes.
2. **Delayed capital formation:** Uncertainty over Amaravati delayed investment critical for revival.
3. **Governance gaps:** Audits revealed diversion of welfare funds and pending revenue recoveries.
4. **Developmental backlog:** Backward regions like Rayalaseema needed outlays the state could barely afford.

Way Forward

Wider revenue mobilisation, higher capital spending including Polavaram, stricter audits and corridors like Visakhapatnam–Chennai can restore balance.

Conclusion

The problems after reorganisation were indeed serious, especially in finance, where high deficits, a heavy debt burden and low capital spending constrained the state's growth and its capacity to recover from bifurcation.



P-II
10(b)

Explain the problems encountered till now in bifurcation of assets of institutions mentioned in Schedule IX and Schedule X of the Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014.

10

Introduction

The Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014 created Telangana as a separate state and provided for the division of assets and liabilities of institutions listed in Schedule IX and Schedule X, including key public sector undertakings and government bodies. Despite this legal framework, the division has faced persistent problems affecting governance, fiscal health and institutional functioning.

Problems Encountered in Bifurcation

1. Valuation and apportionment disputes: Disagreements over valuation methods and the population-based 58.32:41.68 ratio led to delays and litigation between the two states.

2. Delayed transfer of control: Many Schedule IX and X institutions, including State Public Sector Enterprises (SPSEs), saw delays in transfer of administrative control and ownership, causing operational disruptions.

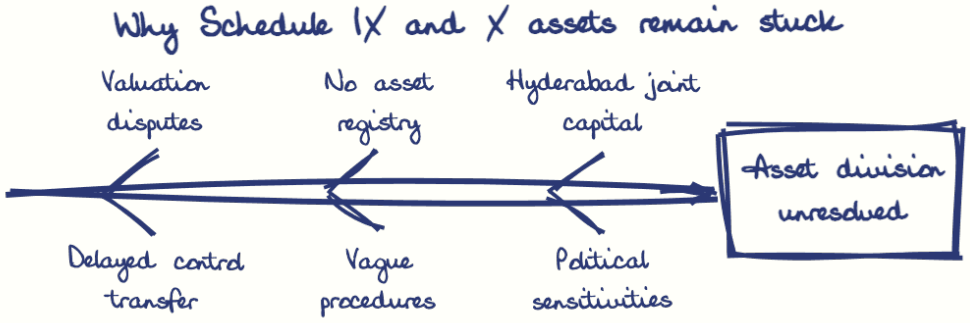
3. Off-budget borrowings: Uneven distribution of liabilities left Andhra Pradesh with off-budget

borrowings of 1,28,048 crore as of March 2023, constraining capital expenditure.

4. Arrears in SPSEs: 90 of 103 working SPSEs in Andhra Pradesh had 342 accounts in arrears ranging from 1 to 17 years as of September 2023.

Causes of These Problems

1. Complex institutional structures: Intertwined assets and liabilities, with no unified asset registry, made clear-cut division difficult.
2. Inadequate procedures: The Act lacked detailed procedural clarity, creating administrative bottlenecks and jurisdictional conflicts.
3. Political sensitivities: Telangana's insistence on Hyderabad as joint capital for ten years complicated asset sharing.
4. Revenue imbalance: Andhra Pradesh's revenue deficit of 22,317 crore (1.5% of GSDP) in 2023-24 partly reflects uneven distribution of revenue-generating assets.



Impact

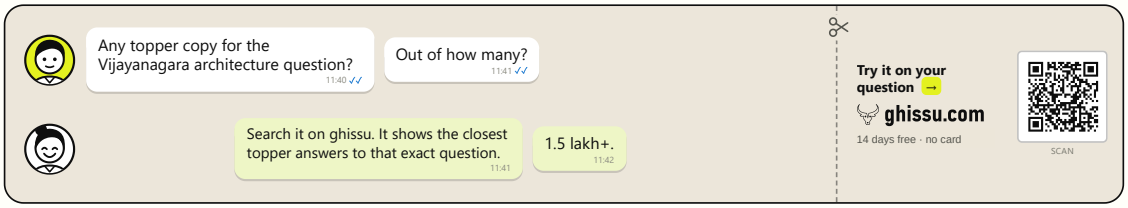
Prolonged disputes caused operational disruptions in SPSEs, delayed decisions and reduced investor confidence in both states.

Way Forward

1. Joint Asset Management Authority: A bilateral agency to oversee transparent valuation, transfer and management of disputed assets.
2. Audits and legal clarity: Comprehensive audits of SPSEs and supplementary legislation with fast-track mechanisms for disputes.

Conclusion

Timely, cooperative resolution of Schedule IX and X disputes is vital for the fiscal stability and institutional strength of both Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.



APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2016

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P-II
1(a)

Compare Hinayana and Mahayana Buddhism. Why did Buddhism become popular and decline subsequently?

10

Introduction

Buddhism, which began with Gautama Buddha's teachings in the 6th century BCE, evolved into schools such as Hinayana and Mahayana. It gained immense popularity across Asia through its inclusive philosophy, but later declined in its land of origin.

Hinayana and Mahayana Compared

Hinayana vs Mahayana Buddhism

Hinayana Buddhism	Mahayana Buddhism
Individual liberation	Universal salvation
Original teachings, monastic discipline	New scriptures, devotional practices
Buddha as teacher	Buddha as divine figure
Sri Lanka, Southeast Asia	East Asia, parts of India

1. Orientation: Hinayana, often identified with Theravada, stresses personal enlightenment through the Pali Canon, while Mahayana's Bodhisattva ideal emphasises compassion and salvation for

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all beings.

2. Scriptures and practice: Mahayana added sutras like Prajnaparamita and Vaipulya, with idol worship, elaborate rituals and veneration of many Buddhas, unlike the austere discipline of Hinayana.

3. Inclusivity: Mahayana held that all, not only monks, could attain Buddhahood, appealing broadly to lay followers.

Reasons for Popularity

1. Social inclusiveness: It rejected the varna system and was open to all castes and women.

2. Royal patronage: Ashoka's support and missions spread it to Central Asia and Sri Lanka, making it a world religion.

3. Philosophical appeal: The Four Noble Truths and Eightfold Path gave a practical framework to overcome suffering.

4. Adaptability: It absorbed local beliefs, inspiring the Amaravati school of art in Andhra Pradesh.

Reasons for Decline

1. Monastic decadence: Wealth in monasteries bred

corruption and moral decline, alienating lay followers.

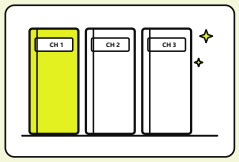
2. Brahmanical revival: ~~After~~ the Mauryas, rulers favoured a reformed Brahmanism, and scholars like Shankaracharya and Kumaril Bhatta revived Hinduism, which absorbed Buddhist elements.

3. Schisms and language: Divisions and the shift from Pali to Sanskrit distanced common people.

4. Invasions: Turkish forces destroyed wealthy monasteries.

Conclusion

Buddhism's inclusive ethics, patronage and adaptability made it a world religion, while Mahayana widened its lay appeal. Yet internal decay, Brahmanical revival, schisms and invasions together caused its decline in the land of its origin.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

Notes that live with the question

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Build notes that find you →

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SCAN

P-II
1(b)

What are the important features of major schools of art that flourished during post Mauryan period?

10

Introduction

The post-Mauryan period was a transformative phase in Indian art, reflecting cultural synthesis and religious pluralism. Major schools such as Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati flourished, each with distinct regional styles.

Patronage and Regional Styles

1. Royal patronage: The Satavahanas, Kushanas and Shungas patronised Buddhist, Hindu and Jain art, giving rise to regional schools like Amaravati in Andhra Pradesh and Mathura in northern India.

2. Materials: Gandhara used blue-gray schist, Mathura red sandstone and Amaravati white marble, each developing its own sculptural technique.

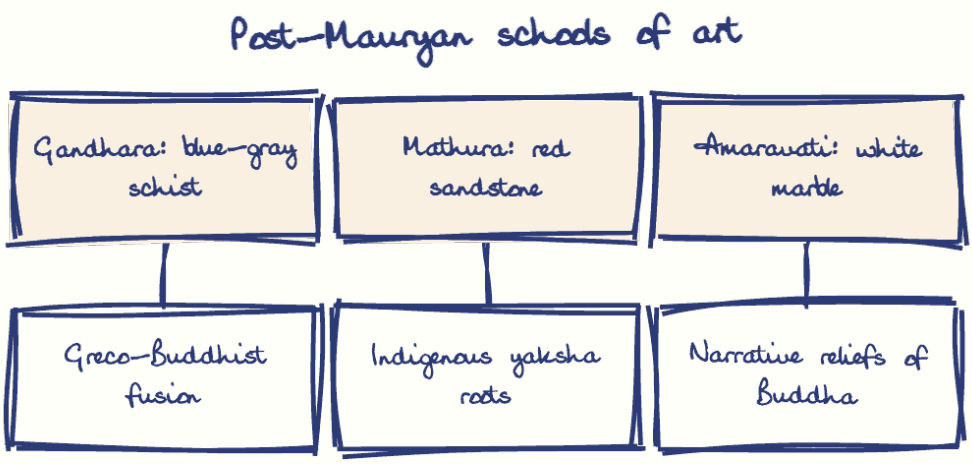
3. Monastic centres: Buddhist viharas in the Krishna valley and Nagarjunakonda were hubs of art and philosophy, producing sculptures of Buddhist teachings and Jataka tales.

Features of Major Schools

1. Gandhara: Under Kushana links with the west, it

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fused Hellenistic style with Buddhist iconography: realistic forms, flowing drapery, halos and contrapposto, a Greco-Buddhist fusion.

2. Mathura: Rooted in earlier yaksha imagery, it was indigenous, with lifelike figures, an enlarged halo for Buddha and avayudhas identifying Hindu deities.

3. Amaravati: Its marble reliefs narrate Buddha's life with fluidity and emotion, earning the title "aesthetic ideal of India" and influencing South Indian temple art.

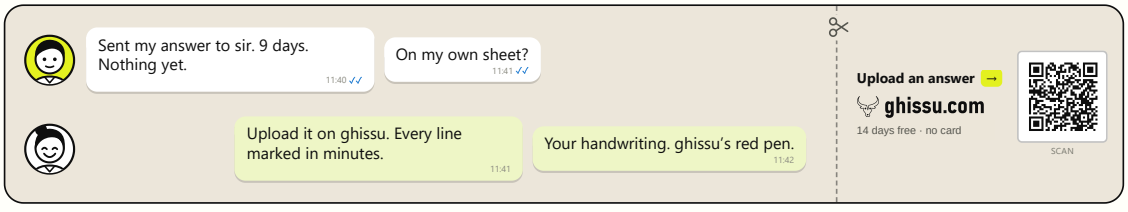
4. Cross-religious themes: Together they depicted Buddhist, Hindu and Jain themes, reflecting the era's religious coexistence and the role of art as a medium for spiritual expression and social communication.

Legacy and Challenges

1. Decay: Many works, like the Amaravati stupa, deteriorated through exposure, and many artifacts were dispersed to museums abroad.
2. Political change: The decline of the Satavahanas and Kushanas reduced patronage and fragmented traditions into localised styles.
3. Language shift: The replacement of Prakrit by Sanskrit changed the themes and inscriptions of artworks.
4. Continuity: Their stylistic elements and motifs persisted in Pallava and Chalukya temple architecture and sculpture.

Conclusion

Post-Mauryan schools enriched India's cultural heritage through regional diversity and religious pluralism. They laid the foundation for later sculpture and architecture, and their surviving sites deserve stronger conservation.



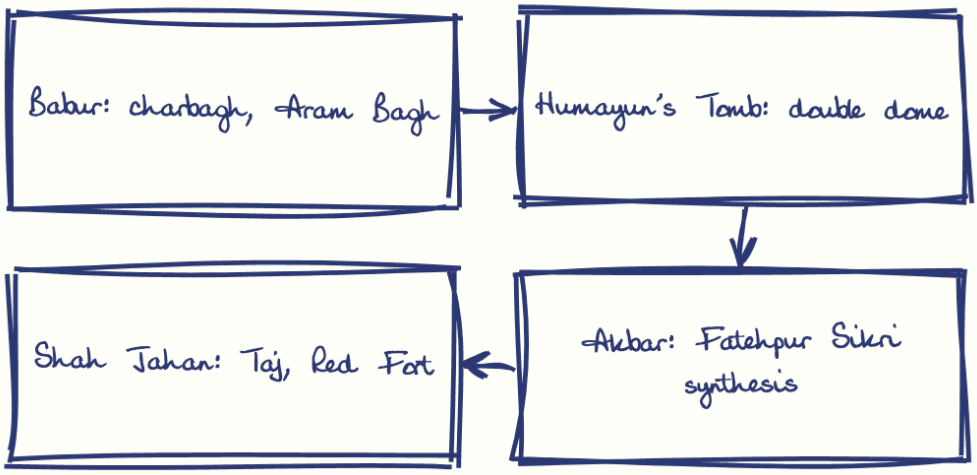
2(a) Describe major contributions of Great Mughals to Indian Architecture.

10

Introduction

The architectural legacy of the Great Mughals blended Persian, Indian and Islamic styles into a unique Indo-Islamic synthesis. It transformed the subcontinent's aesthetic landscape and symbolised the empire's political ethos. Sohel Hashmi's critique of Islamic architecture as inherently syncretic underlines its composite identity.

Evolution of Mughal architecture



Key Contributions of the Great Mughals

1. **Charbagh gardens:** Babur pioneered the Persian charbagh, a symmetrical quadrilateral layout divided by water channels symbolising paradise, seen at Aram Bagh in Agra.

2. Double dome and material fusion: Humayun's Tomb introduced the double dome and combined red sandstone with white marble inlay, setting the standard for later tombs like the Taj Mahal.

3. Hindu–Islamic synthesis: Akbar's Fatehpur Sikri integrated Hindu chhatris and trabeate construction with Islamic arches and domes, reflecting an inclusive ethos.

4. Gateways and forts: The Buland Darwaza and massive forts like Agra Fort and Shah Jahan's Red Fort combined military utility with aesthetic appeal.

Significance and Features

1. Symmetry and harmony: Perfect bilateral symmetry in the Taj Mahal and Humayun's Tomb creates a sense of order.

2. Calligraphy and carving: Quranic inscriptions and jali screens in the Jama Masjid and Moti Masjid add spiritual depth while diffusing light and air.

3. Gardens with architecture: Terraced Shalimar Bagh and the Taj gardens reflect a fascination with nature and waterworks.

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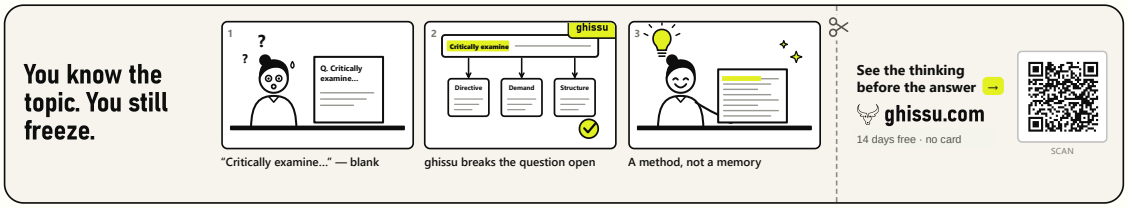
4. Structural innovation: The double dome, perfected in the Taj Mahal, allowed a grand exterior with proportionate interiors.
5. Political symbolism: Monuments projected imperial authority and a composite culture beyond religious and regional lines.

Way Forward

1. Conservation: Advanced restoration and more funding to protect monuments.
2. Education and access: Teach their syncretic nature and offer digital virtual tours.

Conclusion

The Great Mughals' monuments are a pinnacle of Indo-Islamic art and a legacy of cultural synthesis. Preserving them fulfils the Fundamental Duty to protect our rich heritage and fosters unity in diversity for future generations, for these monuments still shape how India imagines its own pluralistic identity.



P-II
2(b)

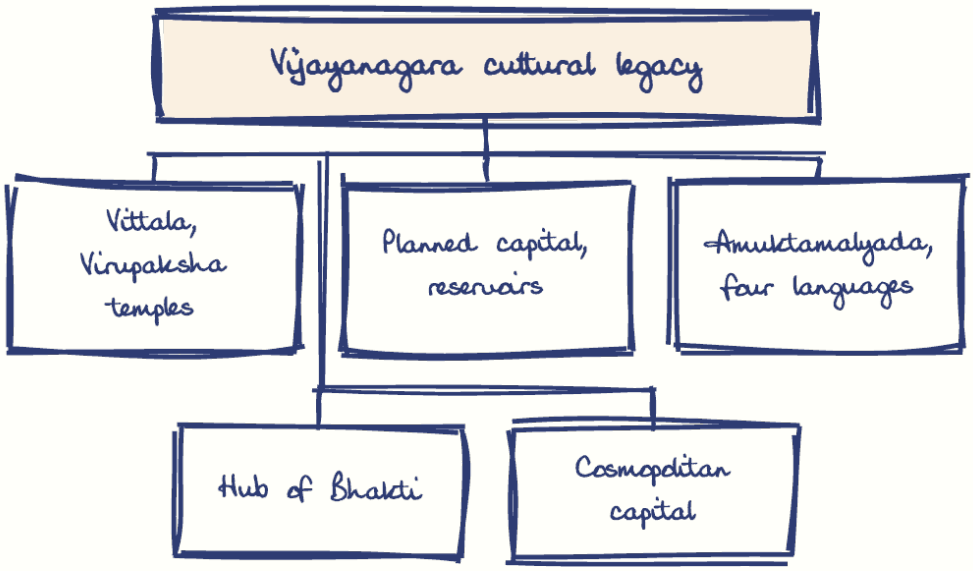
What is the cultural contribution of Vijayanagar Empire?

10

Introduction

The Vijayanagara Empire, flourishing from the 14th to the 17th century, marked a pinnacle of South Indian Hindu culture and polity. Amid political upheaval, it preserved and evolved Indian heritage, and its architecture, literature and religious life still shape Indian identity.

Key Cultural Contributions



1. **Temple architecture:** Hampi's Vittala and Virupaksha temples combined Dravidian elements with innovations like the stone chariot and musical pillars, showing advanced engineering.
2. **Urban planning:** The capital had fortified walls,

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organised bazaars, and water management through reservoirs and canals.

3. Multilingual literature: Telugu, Kannada, Tamil and Sanskrit flourished. Krishnadevaraya was a schdar-poet who wrote Amuktamalyada, and his court produced devotional, historical and philosophical texts.

4. Religious revival: Rulers protected Hinduism amid Islamic expansion, maintained temples and promoted Navaratri and Mahanavami. The empire became a hub of the Bhakti movement.

5. Cosmopolitan social life: Persian and Portuguese traders, artisans and schdars enabled cultural exchange, women held respectable positions, and coinage and markets showed sophistication.

Significance for Indian Heritage

1. Preservation of Hindu culture: As a bulwark in the Deccan, it ensured the continuity of classical art and ritual.

2. Architectural benchmark: Its fusion of urban design and religious symbolism influenced later dynasties; Hampi has UNESCO World Heritage status.

3. Regional literatures: Patronising vernaculars alongside

Sanskrit strengthened India's linguistic pluralism.

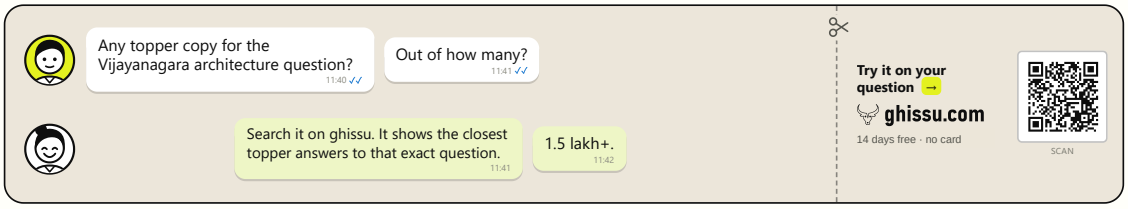
4. Inclusive religion: Bhakti's stress on devotion over caste and ritual had lasting social effects.

Way Forward

1. Heritage conservation: Enhanced funding and community involvement to protect Vijayanagara sites.
2. Literary studies: Research and translation of its literary corpus for today's readers.
3. Education and tourism: Teach its history in schools and promote responsible tourism and cultural exchange.

Conclusion

Vijayanagara's contribution is a living heritage of temples, texts and faith. By sustaining Hindu traditions and regional languages through a turbulent age, it still enriches India's pluralistic cultural identity. Hampi's ruins and Krishnadevaraya's verse remind us that political turmoil need not end creativity; it can instead inspire a culture to renew itself.



P-II
3(a)

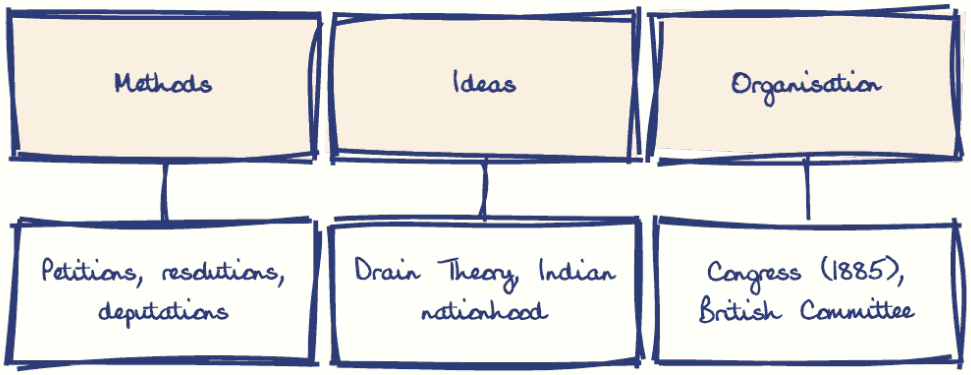
"The period between 1885-1905 is the period of moderates in Indian freedom struggle" In light of the above statement, describe the contribution of early nationalists (moderates) in organizing the national movement?

10

Introduction

The period 1885–1905 was the formative phase of the Indian national movement, dominated by the early nationalists, the Moderates. Historians often contrast them with the Extremists, but their work in organising the movement through constitutional methods and public opinion was indispensable to India's political awakening.

How the Moderates built the movement



Role and Activities of the Moderates

1. Constitutional Agitation: They worked within the legal framework, using petitions, resolutions and deputations, and trusted that the British, once aware of grievances, would concede reforms.

2. Drain Theory: Dadabhai Naorji and R.C. Dutt showed how colonial policies impoverished India by transferring wealth to Britain, creating national consciousness about exploitation.

3. Political Education: Through newspapers, public meetings and Congress sessions they built a strong, informed public opinion that could sustain a nationalist movement.

4. Faith in British Liberalism: They sought to make British rule just and representative rather than overthrow it, reflecting a time when mass mobilisation was limited.

Organising the National Movement

1. Founding the Congress: They founded the Indian National Congress in 1885 as the principal platform for dialogue, political education and coordinated action across regions and communities.

2. Nationalist Ideology: Their speeches and writings nurtured a sense of Indian nationhood transcending regional, religious and caste divisions.

3. International Advocacy: Naorji spent long years in Britain, setting up the British Committee of the Congress in London and publishing journals to

influence British policymakers.

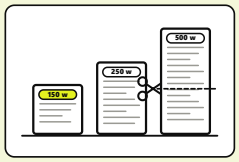
4. Limits and Transition: Younger nationalists found their methods slow, leading to the rise of the Extremists after 1905, yet the Congress framework they built supported more assertive action.

Way Forward

Their legacy suggests deeper grassroots engagement with rural and marginalised communities, wider political and constitutional literacy, and continued emphasis on unity across social divisions.

Conclusion

The statement is justified. By pioneering constitutional methods, fostering political consciousness and building the Congress, the Moderates laid the organisational groundwork for future mass movements. When such political organisation and public awareness take root, they enable a sustained and inclusive struggle for freedom.



Writing 400 words for a 150-word question?

Model answers in three lengths

150, 250 and 500 words, in English and हिंदी. Learn what to cut before the examiner does.

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P-II
3(b)

Describe the nature and significance of revolt of 1857? Explain whether it can be termed as "First War of Independence"?

10

Introduction

The Revolt of 1857 was the first large-scale challenge to British colonial rule, drawing in diverse social groups and regions. Its nature and the label "First War of Independence" remain contested, yet it illuminates the evolution of Indian nationalism and colonial governance.

Nature of the Revolt

1. Multi-class participation: Sepoys, peasants, landlords and some princes rose across northern and central India, making it more than a military mutiny.
2. Military, social and religious causes: The Enfield rifle cartridges triggered it, but fears of interference in customs and land rights fuelled it.
3. No unified nationalism: Hindus and Muslims cooperated in places, yet loyalty was personal or regional, without a pan-Indian ideology.
4. Fragmented uprising: The south, including Madras, stayed largely loyal, and coordination

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was poor.

Significance

1. **End of Company rule:** The Government of India Act 1858, proclaimed by Queen Victoria at Allahabad, transferred power to the Crown.
2. **Policy shift:** Annexations stopped and princely states came under the Crown's paramountcy.
3. **Army reorganisation:** Mixed recruitment followed "divide and rule" to prevent unified rebellion.
4. **Racial divide:** Suspicion and hostility between British and Indians hardened colonial attitudes and deepened social divisions.
5. **Symbol of resistance:** As the first major collective challenge, it inspired later generations and laid groundwork for organised nationalism.
6. **Social impact:** It exposed both fissures and potential unity among communities, challenging colonial claims of inherent communal antagonism.

Was it the First War of Independence?

1. **Yes:** V.D. Savarkar hailed its anti-imperial

Candidates must not write on this margin

Candidates must not write on this margin

First War of Independence?

Yes	No
Savarkar: anti-imperial war	Majumdar, Tara Chand: not national
Hindu-Muslim joint struggle	Madras largely loyal
Multi-class participation	No unified ideology, leadership

character, and it showed the potential for Hindu-Muslim unity.

2. No: R.C. Majumdar and Tara Chand argued it was neither national nor a war of independence, given its limited scope and lack of political unity.

Conclusion

The revolt may not meet the test of a unified national war, but as the first collective challenge it awakened anti-colonial consciousness and reshaped British rule.

Correct, but average? One line from your answer

YOUR LINE
~~The 1857 revolt failed.~~
✕ true · forgettable

→

WITH A VALUE ADDITION
The 1857 revolt failed for want of a centre: no common plan, no modern arms, and the loyalty of the Sikhs, the Gurkhas and most princes to the Company.
✓ cause · evidence · specifics

ILLUSTRATIVE

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P-II
4(a)

Comment on the effectiveness of the methods employed by Mahatma Gandhi to mobilize masses?

10

Introduction

The effectiveness of Gandhi's methods to mobilise the masses is central to understanding the freedom struggle. His blend of moral philosophy and mass activism challenged colonial rule and sought to reshape Indian society from the grassroots.

Methods Employed

1. Satyagraha: Non-violent resistance based on truth and moral persuasion aimed to convert the oppressor. It was first tested in Champaran and Ahmedabad, where peaceful protests and hunger strikes addressed peasant and labour grievances.
2. Civil Disobedience and Boycotts: The Non-Cooperation Movement and the Salt Satyagraha boycotted British goods, institutions and taxes, linking local grievances to the national cause.
3. Constructive Programme: Khadi, eradication of untouchability, communal harmony, women's uplift and village swaraj gave all sections a sense of ownership in nation-building.

Effectiveness

Gandhi's methods: strengths and limits

Strengths	Limits
Champaran, Ahmedabad satyagraha	Violence broke discipline
Salt Satyagraha, mass boycotts	Weak deep-rural reach
Constructive programme	Caste reform too gradual
Global moral legitimacy	Uneven, loosely organised

1. Broad-based Participation: The movement spread from elites to peasants, artisans, women and Dalits; Non-Cooperation saw unprecedented participation in regions like Andhra Pradesh.
2. Moral High Ground: Non-violence won international sympathy and inspired Martin Luther King Jr. and Nelson Mandela; the UN marks October 2 as the International Day of Non-Violence.
3. Limits of Discipline: Spontaneous violence, as after the Rowlatt Act agitation, compromised non-violence, and his gradual approach to caste did not satisfy reformers like Ambedkar.
4. Uneven Reach: The movements were stronger in towns and some provinces, and the suspension

of Non-Cooperation broke momentum despite near successes in tax resistance.

Overall Assessment

On balance, the strengths outweigh the weaknesses. Satyagraha gave ordinary people a safe and dignified way to resist, boycotts linked everyday life to the national cause, and the constructive programme built lasting bonds in villages. The limits lay in discipline, rural reach and caste, not in the power to mobilise.

Way Forward

Reviving Gram Swaraj through village institutions and joining social reform with political mobilisation keep these methods relevant.

Conclusion

Gandhi's methods were profoundly effective in turning the freedom struggle into a mass movement by combining ethical non-violence with social reform. Despite limits in discipline and social unity, they laid the base of a participatory democracy.

Only ten minutes today?
Speak an outline. It gets evaluated too.
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P-II
4(b)

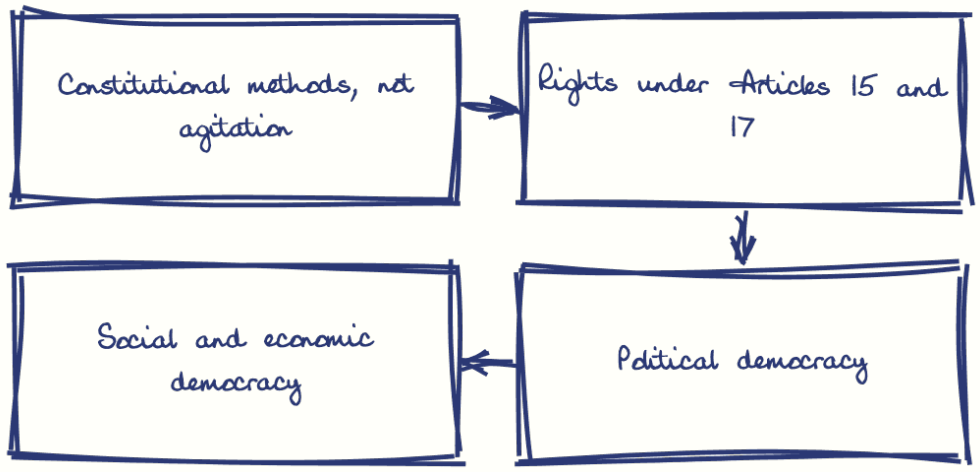
"We must hold fast to constitutional methods for achieving our social and economical objectives". Briefly explain the significance of this statement of Dr B. R. Ambedkar with reference to his achievements. Also explain its relevance in the present to protect democracy?

10

Introduction

Dr B.R. Ambedkar's statement, made during the framing of the Constitution, reflects his commitment to democracy grounded in law and justice. It stresses legal and institutional processes over extra-constitutional means to achieve social transformation.

Ambedkar's constitutional path



Significance of the Statement

1. **Democratic Stability:** Constitutional methods are the only legitimate path to change, protecting the rule of law and preventing chaos.

2. **Rejecting Anarchy and Personality Cults:** He

warned against civil disobedience and hero-worship in politics as threats to constitutional order and checks and balances.

3. Political and Social Democracy: Political democracy is insufficient without social and economic equality, which the Constitution can progressively realise.

4. Inclusive Participation: It guarantees marginalised groups rights and representation to pursue caste abolition through democracy rather than conflict.

Achievements Reflecting the Statement

1. Architect of the Constitution: As Chairman of the Drafting Committee he embedded equality, liberty and fraternity.

2. Social Justice by Law: Abolishing untouchability and affirmative action under Articles (15) and (17) pursued reform through law, not violence.

3. Economic Institutions: His role in establishing the Finance Commission and influencing the Reserve Bank of India showed faith in constitutional mechanisms for economic democracy.

4. Constitutional Morality: He urged citizens and leaders to respect the spirit of the Constitution and pursue objectives within its legal bounds.

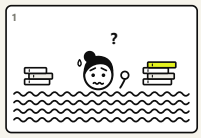
Relevance Today to Protect Democracy

1. Countering Populism: Amid polarisation and protests outside constitutional frames, his call prevents democratic erosion.
2. Institutional Supremacy: His warning against hero-worship applies when charismatic leaders pressure institutions.
3. Tackling Inequality Constitutionally: Welfare schemes and affirmative action, not disruptive means, should address inequality.
4. Democratic Culture: Constitutional methods foster tolerance, mutual respect and dialogue.

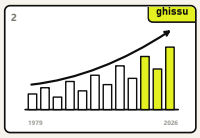
Conclusion

Civic education, empowered institutions like the judiciary and Election Commission, and legal redressal in place of disruptive agitation can keep this principle alive. Anchoring social justice in constitutional morality ensures that India's democracy is social and economic, not only political.

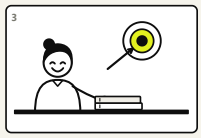
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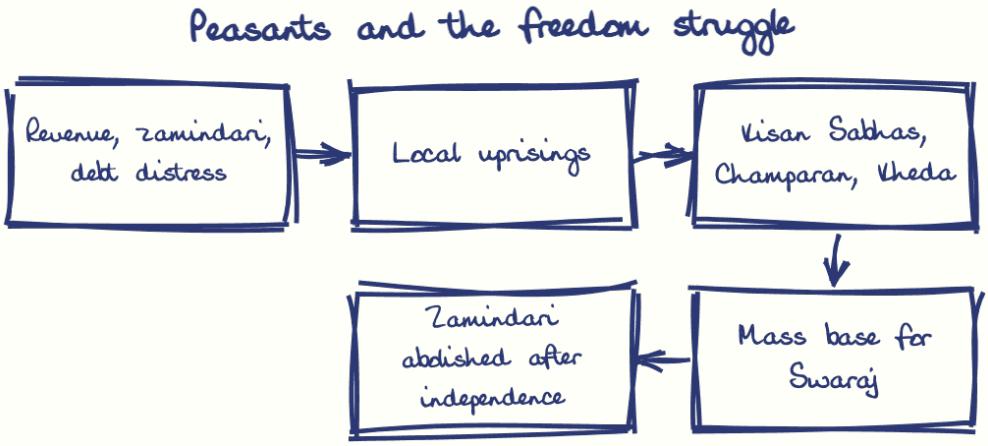
P-II
5(a)

Comment on the contribution of peasant movements in freedom struggle.

10

Introduction

Peasant movements were a vital yet often underappreciated force in the freedom struggle, reflecting the economic and social grievances of rural India. Subaltern historians see them as popular resistance that complemented and sometimes challenged mainstream nationalism by linking local agrarian issues with national independence.



Role in the Freedom Struggle

1. Economic Grievances: Exploitative colonial policies such as high land revenue, the oppressive zamindari system and indebtedness to moneylenders created widespread agrarian distress and unrest.
2. Political Awakening: They united landowners, sharecroppers and landless labourers, fostering

political consciousness and organisation through Kisan Sabhas, which became integral to the freedom struggle.

3. Local to National: Early regional uprisings laid the ground for politically led movements like the Champaran and Kheda Satyagrahas under Gandhi.

4. Ideological Limits: Despite their militancy, many lacked a comprehensive anti-colonial ideology and targeted landlord oppression rather than British rule, limiting their revolutionary potential.

Influence on the Nationalist Movement

1. Integration with Leadership: Gandhi and Sardar Patel linked agrarian distress with Swaraj through the Bardoli and Champaran Satyagrahas.

2. Wider Base: They extended the struggle beyond urban elites to the rural masses, making it a truly mass movement with grassroots participation.

3. Reciprocal Relationship: Nationalism gave peasant struggles direction and legitimacy, while peasants gave the freedom struggle vitality and urgency.

4. Leftist Influence: Communist and socialist leaders in the Tebhaga and Telangana struggles brought a radical critique of feudal and colonial structures,

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shaping nationalist thinking on social justice.

Legacy

1. Land Reforms: The post-independence abolition of zamindari decentralised rural economic power.
2. Rural Empowerment: Political awareness in villages strengthened India's democratic foundation and brought agrarian issues into policymaking.
3. Continuing Struggles: Unresolved issues led to the Naxalite uprising and demands for land redistribution.
4. Subaltern Assertion: The Telangana struggle foregrounded caste, class and gender issues.

Conclusion

Peasant movements were indispensable to the freedom struggle, transforming it from an elite campaign into a mass-based movement rooted in rural India and placing agrarian justice on the national agenda. Their legacy calls for keeping peasant welfare central to national policy.



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SCAN

P-II
5(b)

Analyze the role of communalism in the partition of the country.

10

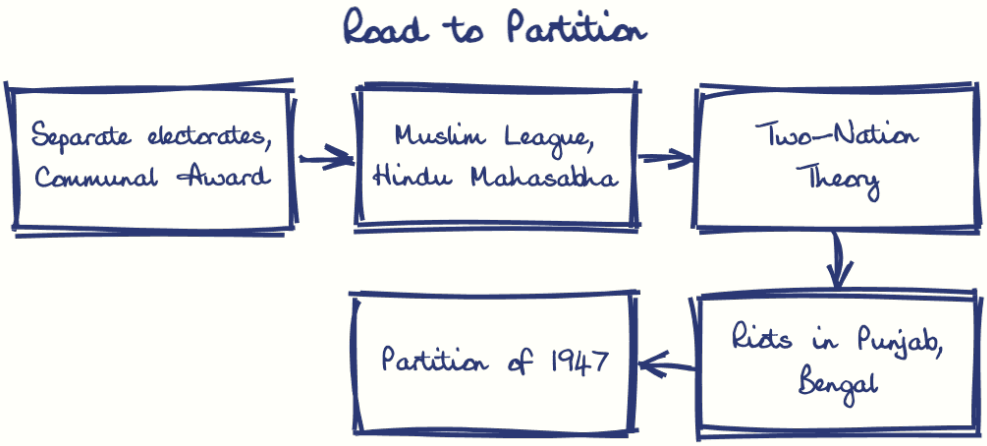
Introduction

The partition of 1947 remains one of the most traumatic events in modern Indian history. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians debate its causes, but communalism, the politicisation of religious identities that intensified under colonial rule, emerges as the central factor.

Communalism's Role in Events Leading to Partition

1. **Colonial Divide and Rule:** Separate electorates and the Communal Award granted representation by religion, politicising identities and fostering mistrust between Hindus and Muslims.
2. **Separate Political Identities:** The Muslim League and the Hindu Mahasabha turned communal identities into political demands, culminating in the Two-Nation Theory.
3. **Riots and Polarisation:** Riots in Punjab and Bengal created a cycle of retaliation that made coexistence untenable and pushed leaders towards partition.
4. **Failure of Inclusive Nationalism:** Despite Gandhi's efforts for Hindu-Muslim unity, divergent communal aims could not be reconciled,

and partition was accepted as a political compromise.



Causes and Consequences

1. **Socio-Economic Disparities:** Economic inequality and limited Muslim access to education and government jobs bred insecurity and alienation, which communal leaders exploited to mobilise support for separatism.
2. **Cultural Polarisation:** British and some Indian historians portraying medieval India as a period of Muslim oppression reinforced stereotypes and the case for separate nationhood.
3. **Mass Displacement and Violence:** Partition caused one of history's largest forced migrations and nearly half a million deaths, especially in Punjab and Bengal.
4. **Long-Term Fragmentation:** Communal tensions

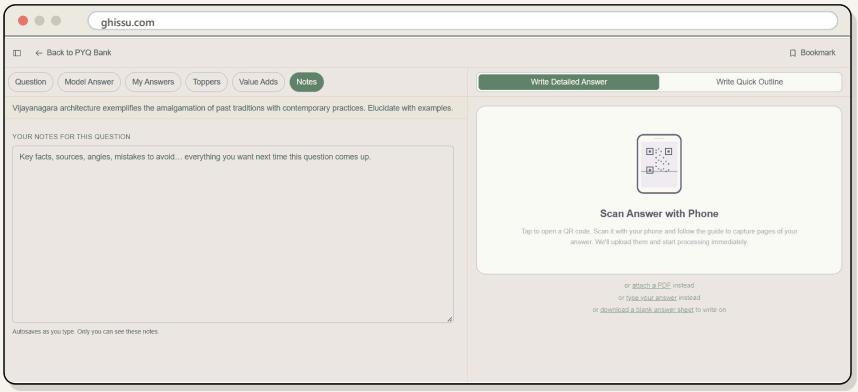
continued to shape electoral politics and inter-community relations in India and Pakistan, with recurring violence challenging the secular state.

Conclusion

Communalism was both a cause and a consequence of partition, turning religious identities into political fault lines. Secular education stressing India's composite culture, electoral reforms following the Tarkunde Committee, and community dialogue can nurture India's secular and pluralistic ethos and heal these wounds. Partition remains a permanent reminder of the cost of letting religion become the basis of politics.

THE REAL PRODUCT · NOT A MOCK-UP NOTES THAT LIVE WITH THE QUESTION

Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?



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2 Note from model answers, toppers and exam-hall thinking.

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SCAN

P-II
6(a)

Briefly describe political fortunes and cultural contribution of Ikshvakus?

10

Introduction

The Ikshvaku dynasty, known as the "Sriparvatiya Andhras", emerged in the Krishna–Guntur region after the Satavahana decline in the early 3rd century CE. In about a century of rule, they bridged the Satavahana age and the rise of smaller regional powers.

Ikshvaku kingdom in the Krishna valley



Vijayapuri, the capital, near Nagarjunakonda

Political Fortunes

1. **Rise after the Satavahanas:** Their founder Vashistiputra Chantamula consolidated power in

the Krishna-Guntur region around (180) CE, with the capital at Vijayapuri near Nagarjuna Konda.

2. Dynastic Identity: They claimed descent from the solar Ikshvaku line of Lord Rama, though some scholars see them as indigenous, possibly tribal, people of Dakshinapatha, reflecting the complex milieu of the Eastern Deccan.

3. Administration: The kingdom was divided into Rashtras, Aaharas and Padhas under feudatories and officials like the Maha Talavara and Mahadandanayaka.

4. Decline: Pallava pressure under Simhavarma and Sivaskanda Varma, along with revolts by feudatories like the Brihatpalayanas, ended the dynasty by the mid-3rd century CE.

Cultural Contribution

1. Buddhist Patronage: They built around (20) viharas and many pillars at Nagarjuna Konda, Sriparvatam and Jaggaiahpet, centres that drew students from across Asia.

2. Sculpture: Their period marked the final phase of the Amaravati tradition, and Burgess saw parallels between Jaggaiahpeta sculptures and Ajanta paintings.

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3. Religious Pluralism: Though Shaivites, they supported Vaishnavism and Shakti worship, building the Astabuja Narayana temple, Andhra's first Vaishnava temple, and the Hareeti temple.

4. Language and Learning: They promoted Sanskrit alongside Prakrit, and the first Sanskrit inscription in South India dates to the reign of Ehuvala Shantamoda. Nagarjuna Konda hosted thousands of monks.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Conservation: Better funding and community involvement can protect Nagarjuna Konda and other Ikshvaku sites.

Conclusion

Though their rule was brief, the Ikshvakus linked the Satavahana age to later regional kingdoms. Their Buddhist monuments, Agama temples and patronage of Sanskrit left a rich legacy of art and religious pluralism in Andhra.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
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→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
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P-II
6(b)

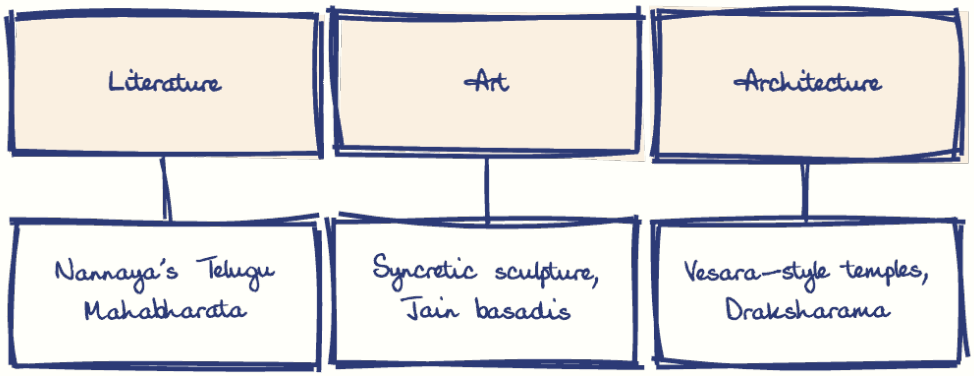
Describe the contribution of Eastern Chalukyas to literature, art and architecture.

10

Introduction

The Eastern Chalukyas ruled the Vengi region from the 7th to the 12th century. Their reign of religious pluralism and literary efflorescence laid the foundation of Telugu literature and enriched temple art and architecture in Andhra.

Eastern Chalukya contributions



Contribution to Literature

1. **Origin of Telugu Literature:** The earliest Telugu verses appear in inscriptions of Gunaga Vijayaditya III (849–892 AD), marking Telugu as a literary language distinct from Sanskrit and Tamil.

2. **Nannaya's Mahabharata:** The court poet Nannaya rendered the first two and a half

parvas of the Mahabharata into Telugu, setting the standard for epic poetry with elegant diction.

3. Patronage of Scholars: Kings supported scholars like Narayana Bhatta, who assisted Nannaya, and works in both Telugu and Sanskrit.

Contribution to Art

1. Temple Sculpture: Intricate stone carvings of Shaiva and Vaishnava mythological themes blend northern and southern Indian styles, reflecting cultural syncretism.
2. Religious Pluralism: Jain basadis and Jain iconography reflect religious tolerance.
3. Performing Arts: Temples endowed with land and wealth sustained devotional music and dance.
4. Regional Synthesis: Pallava and northern elements combined into a unique regional style.

Contribution to Architecture

1. Temple Building: They built temples at Draksharama and Bezawada, and Vijayaditya II is credited with 108 temples despite political instability.
2. Hybrid Style: A fusion of Nagara and

Dravidian elements marked an important phase of the Vesara style.

3. Bhimeswara Temple: At Draksharama, it still serves religious and social functions and draws pilgrims and schdars.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Conservation: Stronger restoration of Eastern Chalukyan temples can preserve their architectural and cuttural value.

Conclusion

By pioneering Telugu literature through Nannaya, nurturing a tolerant and syncretic art and building temples in a hybrid style, the Eastern Chalukyas shaped Andhra's cuttural identity, a legacy that calls for careful conservation.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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7(a)

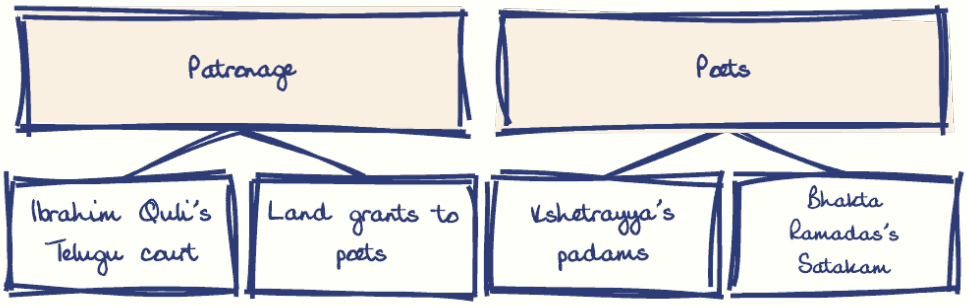
Comment on the contribution of Qutubshahis to Telugu language and literature.

10

Introduction

The Qutubshahi dynasty ruled from Golconda in the 16th and 17th centuries. Its reign saw a synthesis of Persianate court culture and the vernacular Telugu tradition, and despite the rulers' foreign origin and Islamic faith, Telugu language and literature were promoted in a pluralistic spirit.

Qutubshahis and Telugu



Contribution to Telugu Language

1. **Court Language:** Ibrahim Quli Qutub Shah, whose affinity for Telugu grew during exile in Vijayanagara, raised it beside Persian and Urdu. Ponnegenta Telaganaraya's Yayaticharitam was the first notable work in Accha Telugu.

2. **Multilingual Enrichment:** Telugu absorbed Persian and Urdu influences, as in the chatu verses

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praising Ibrahim Quli.

3. Institutional Support: Land and titles went to poets, such as Chintalapalem village to Kandukuri Rudrakavi, author of Nirankushopakyanam, encouraging new genres and themes.

Impact on Telugu Literature

1. Eminent Poets: Addanki Gangadhara Kavi and Kshetrayya flourished, and Kshetrayya's padams remain part of Andhra's cultural repertaire.
2. Bhakti and Social Themes: Kancharla Gopanna (Bhakta Ramadas) wrote Daasharathi Satakam, which resonated with common people.
3. Continuity: The dynasty kept up the momentum inherited from Vijayanagara, bridging a fragmented period.

Context

1. Syncretic Milieu: Hindu and Muslim traditions coexisted, letting Telugu thrive beside Persian and Urdu.
2. Stability: Peace under Muhammad Quli Qutub Shah, the founding of Hyderabad and monuments like Charminar symbolised a cultural renaissance that aided literary activity.

3. Regional Identity: Support for Telugu reinforced regional identity and counterbalanced Persianate dominance.

Limitations

1. Elite Confinement: Telugu writing remained largely within court circles and did not reach the wider populace.
2. Persian Dominance: Persian ruled administration and schdarship, and Deccani Urdu sometimes overshadowed Telugu.
3. Lost Works: Many works of this era are lost or obscure, limiting a full assessment.

Conclusion

The Qutubshahis showed that rulers of a different faith could become patrons of the vernacular. Their pluralistic ethos preserved and enriched Telugu literature through a fragmented age, even though its reach stayed largely with the elite.

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Borrow the approach, not the answer.

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P-II
7(b)

Write about poet Molla, her work and style.

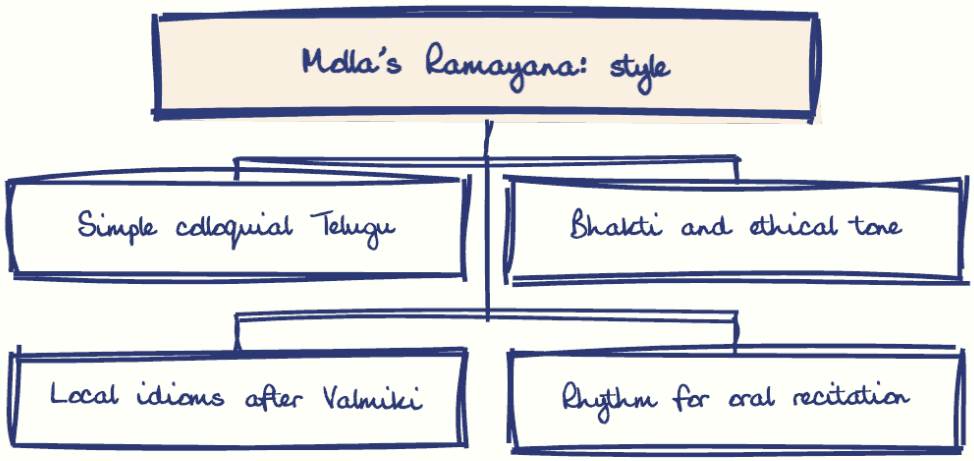
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Introduction

Molla, a 15th-century Telugu poetess, is a pioneering female voice in Indian literature. Her Telugu Ramayana, celebrated for its simplicity, made the sacred epic approachable to common people in an era dominated by male poets and Sanskrit schdarship.

Her Context

1. Vijayanagara Patronage: She lived in the Vijayanagara period, when royal patronage encouraged vernacular works alongside Sanskrit.
2. Choice of Telugu: Writing in the language of the masses, she broke the elite Sanskrit monopoly over religious epics.
3. Bhakti Milieu: Her work, rooted in devotion and moral values, promoted inclusivity beyond caste and gender.
4. Female Agency: As one of the earliest Telugu women poets, she challenged patriarchal norms and inspired later women writers.



Features of Her Work and Style

1. **Simple, Colloquial Language:** Her Ramayana uses lucid colloquial Telugu, avoiding complex Sanskritised words, which popularised the epic among common folk.
2. **Devotional and Ethical Tone:** Narrative blends with Bhakti devotion, stressing Rama's virtues and moral lessons.
3. **Narrative Innovation:** Following Valmiki, she added local idioms and cultural references that mirrored her society.
4. **Oral Influence:** Rhythmic, repetitive elements aided memorisation and recitation in an oral culture.

Reception and Legacy

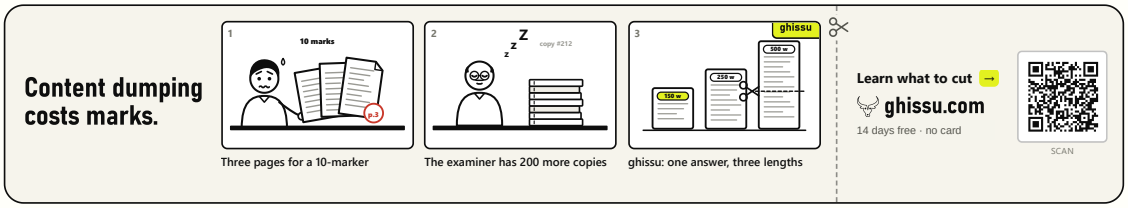
1. **Gender Bias:** Male contemporaries and later scholars overshadowed her, reflecting patriarchal historiography.
2. **Preservation:** Scarce manuscripts and oral transmission made preservation hard.
3. **Popularity:** Her Ramayana became a staple of Telugu households and folk performance.
4. **Recognition:** Literary circles and curricula now hail her as a symbol of vernacular empowerment and women's literary heritage.

Way Forward

1. **Research and Performance:** Critical editions, inclusion in syllabi, digital archives and festival performances of her Ramayana can keep her legacy alive.

Conclusion

Molla's simple, devotional Ramayana democratised sacred knowledge and challenged social hierarchies, making her a lasting symbol of women's literary heritage.



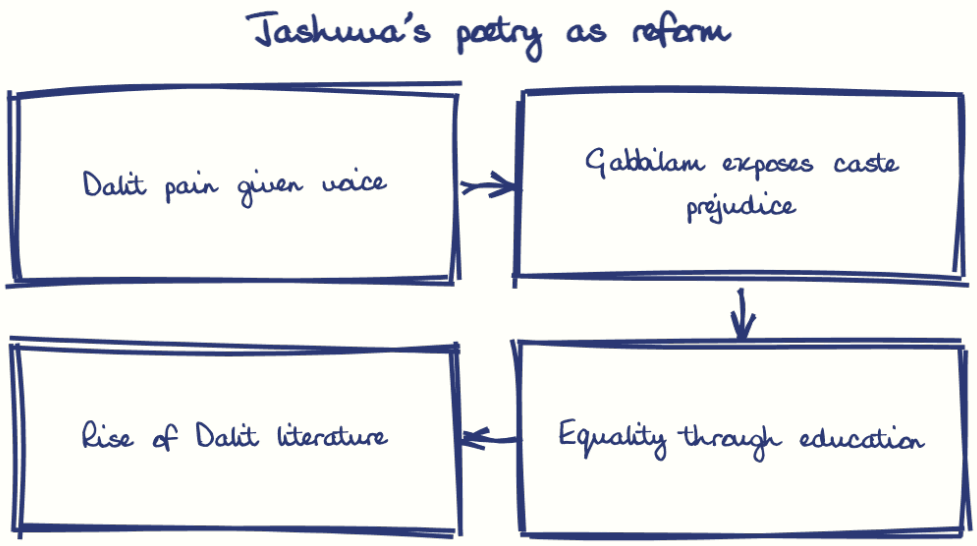
P-II
8(a)

Comment on the contribution of literary works of Gurram Jashuva in social reform.

10

Introduction

Gurram Jashuva's literary contributions hold a pivotal place in the social reform movements of Andhra and the Telugu regions. Writing in a period of intense social stratification and caste discrimination, he challenged entrenched norms, advocated equality and justice, and inspired a collective consciousness against caste oppression.



Literary Foundations of Social Critique

1. **Dalit Identity and Voice:** His poetry foregrounded Dalit pain and resilience, giving the oppressed a powerful voice and breaking the silence on untouchability and exclusion.

2. Critique of Caste Oppression: Through vivid imagery he exposed the cruelty of caste. His poem Gabbilam (The Bat) depicted the darkness of caste prejudice and the need for enlightenment.

3. Social Equality: He upheld the dignity of all human beings and stressed education and reform as tools of empowerment, blending artistry with activism.

4. Influence on Literature: He inspired a generation of writers and activists, aiding the rise of Dalit literature and bringing social justice into mainstream Telugu literature.

Challenges in Reform through Literature

1. Orthodox Resistance: Despite the progressive nature of his writing, conservatives saw his critique of caste as a threat to traditional hierarchy, limiting its immediate reach.

2. Limited Literacy: Low literacy among marginalised communities restricted direct reading, though oral recitations and adaptations spread his ideas.

3. Art and Activism: He kept literary quality while addressing urgent issues, though this stirred debate on literature's role.

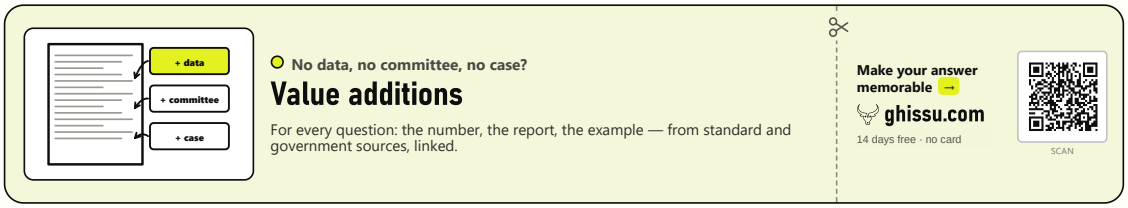
4. Need for Movements: Lasting reform required his literary activism to align with political and social movements, a multi-dimensional approach to change.

Way Forward

1. Dalit Literature in Education: His works should be part of school and university curricula.
2. Oral and Digital Spread: Storytelling, theatre and digital adaptations can reach less literate audiences in rural and urban areas.
3. Link with Legal Initiatives: Connecting literary activism with Nyaya Mitra can turn awareness into real justice.

Conclusion

Jashuva's poetry challenged caste discrimination and sparked a cultural awakening that complemented Andhra's social and political movements, advancing the constitutional ideals of justice and dignity for all.



P-II
8(b)

Illustrate the salient features of literary works of Dr Boyi Bhimana.

10

Introduction

Dr Boyi Bhimana is a distinguished literary figure whose works have enriched the cultural and intellectual landscape of Andhra Pradesh. His writings engage deeply with social realities, historical consciousness and linguistic heritage, and offer insight into the themes of contemporary Telugu literature.

Boyi Bhimana's literary works



Historical and Cultural Anchoring

1. **Rooted in regional history:** His works draw on the heritage of dynasties like the Satavahanas and Kakatiyas, inspiring a sense of pride and identity among readers.
2. **Nationalist themes:** He weaves in the freedom struggle and social reform, linking past struggles such as satyagraha with present aspirations.

3. Indigenous language and symbols: Using the mother tongue and local idioms, he celebrates Telugu's richness against colonial linguistic hierarchies.

Social Realism and Humanistic Concerns

1. Social reform: His narratives critically address caste discrimination, untouchability and economic disparities, using literature as a tool of social critique.
2. Marginalised voices: He gives prominence to subaltern perspectives, reflecting the concerns of Dalits and other oppressed groups, akin to the Dalit autobiographical tradition that demands dignity.
3. Humanistic values: His characters embody empathy, non-violence and social harmony, resonating with classical Telugu ethics and the Gandhian ethos.

Narrative Style and Innovation

1. Historical and contemporary blend: He combines historical episodes with present realities, creating layered narratives that educate and engage.
2. Symbolism and allegory: Imagery from mythology and folklore enables subtle critique of

socio-political issues while evading censorship.

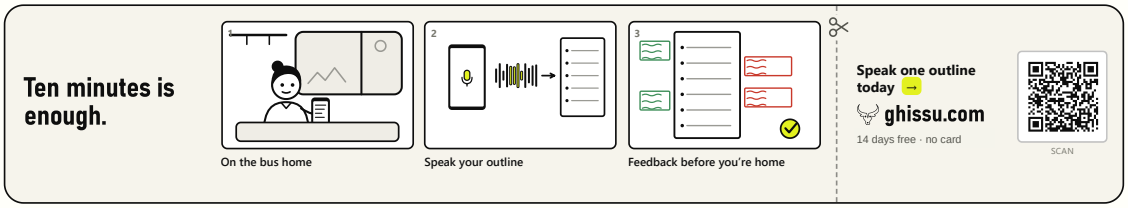
3. Popular appeal: His style remains accessible, balancing artistic merit with mass appeal, like earlier novelists Buchibabu and Viswanatha Satyanarayana.

Way Forward

1. Translation and outreach: Translations into other Indian languages and English, and digital publishing can carry his themes to a wider audience.
2. Research and curricula: Schdarly study and inclusion in syllabi in Andhra Pradesh can connect new generations with their cuttural roots.

Conclusion

Dr Boyi Bhimana's works testify to the power of regional language literature to reflect history, challenge social inequity and inspire ethical values. They bridge past and present, the local and the universal



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9(a)

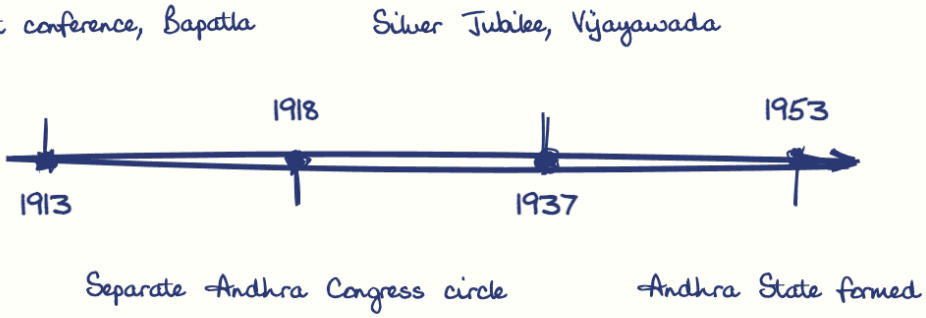
Describe the contribution of Andhra Mahasabha in socio cultural development.

10

Introduction

The Andhra Mahasabha emerged in the early 20th century as a pivotal socio-cultural organisation for the rights and identity of Telugu-speaking people. Formed amid rising linguistic consciousness in the Madras Presidency, it mobilised Telugus around language, education and social reform, and laid the foundation for a separate Andhra province.

Andhra Mahasabha milestones



Role and Activities

1. Promotion of Telugu language and culture: It promoted Telugu literature to unify Telugu people. Annual conferences, from the first at Bapatla in 1913, celebrated Telugu heritage and discussed socio-cultural issues.

2. Separate Andhra province: A key aim was administrative efficiency and cultural development. Resolutions at the (1931) Madras conference and the (1937) Silver Jubilee session at Vijayawada stressed linguistic reorganisation of provinces.
3. Social reform and unity: It worked to bridge caste divisions and to reconcile the Circar and Rayalaseema regions, encouraging diverse Telugu groups to pursue progress together.
4. Political representation: It demanded adequate Telugu representation in legislatures and services, and influenced the formation of a separate Andhra Congress circle in (1918).

Impact on Socio-Cultural Development

1. Telugu identity: Its stress on language and literature drove a cultural renaissance that became a cornerstone of later movements and educational reform.
2. Provincial reorganisation: Its persistent demand laid the groundwork for Andhra State in (1953), enabling socio-economic development suited to the region's cultural context.
3. Social integration: By addressing intra-community divisions and including marginalised groups, it fostered a more cohesive Telugu society.

4. Educational and political empowerment: Wider education and representation helped Telugu people take an active part in governance and public life.

Way Forward

1. Cultural institutions: Institutions for Telugu language, arts and heritage can carry its legacy forward.
2. Inclusive policies: Addressing caste and regional disparities can foster social harmony and equitable development.
3. Telugu-medium education: Quality education in Telugu can reinforce identity while imparting modern skills.

Conclusion

The Andhra Mahasabha shaped the socio-cultural landscape of Andhra through linguistic pride, social unity and political representation. Its legacy paved the way for a separate province and focused cultural development. When such movements succeed, they foster belonging and empowerment. In line with the Fundamental Duty to preserve our heritage, it strengthened unity in diversity.

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9(b)

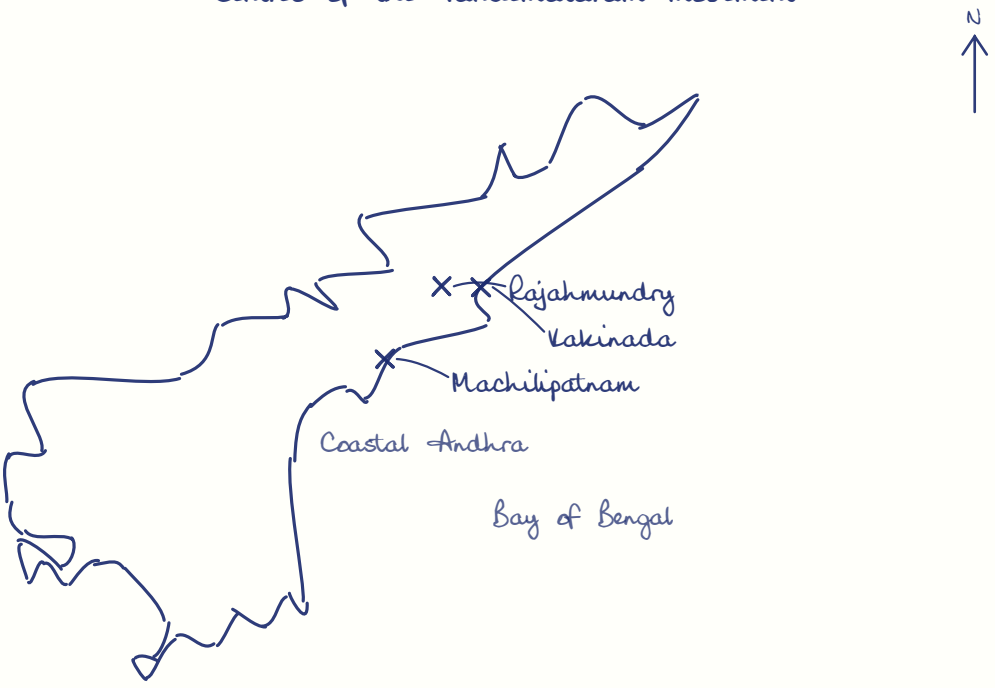
Describe Vandemataram movement and its impact on freedom struggle in Andhra Pradesh?

10

Introduction

The Vandemataram movement was a powerful nationalist wave inspired by Bankim Chandra Chatterjee's hymn "Vande Mataram". It gained momentum after the 1905 Partition of Bengal, symbolising resistance and self-reliance. In Andhra it awakened political consciousness and cultural pride.

Centres of the Vandemataram movement



National schools and Swadeshi stores

Origins and Nature of the Movement

1. Cultural and political catalyst: Rooted in the

Swadeshi campaign against the Bengal partition, the song became a rallying cry for national pride, Swaraj and boycott of British goods, resonating deeply with the Indian people.

2. Spread to Andhra: Bipin Chandra Pal's (1907) tour of Coastal Andhra energised youth. Rajahmundry, Machilipatnam and Kakinada became centres of national schools and Swadeshi stores.

3. Student involvement: In the Rajahmundry College incident, students were punished for wearing Vandemataram badges, which led to groups like the Youngmen's Swaraj Samiti.

4. Telugu identity: The movement revived interest in Telugu language, literature and history, seen in *Andhrula Charitramu* (1910). This renaissance placed Telugu aspirations within the national framework.

Impact on the Freedom Struggle in Andhra

1. Political mobilisation: Nationalist sentiment spread widely, the chant "Vandemataram–Manade Rajyam" became a symbol of defiance against colonial authority.

2. Institution building: National institutions like the Andhra Jateeya Kalasaala offered alternatives to

British-controlled schools, nurtured future leaders and sustained the nationalist spirit.

3. Regional leadership: Leaders like Konda Venkatappaiah and B. N. Sarma emerged and later shaped Andhra politics, and the movement laid the foundation for the Andhra Mahasabha, which joined linguistic identity with freedom.

4. Cultural nationalism: Telugu patriotic songs, poems and dramas spread, writers like Mangipudi Venkatasarma and Mutnuri Venkata Subbarayudu inspired mass participation.

Way Forward

1. Regional history in schools: Detailed study of the movement in curricula can build pride and awareness among youth.

2. Arts and digital media: Supporting literature, performing arts and digital archives can keep its ideals alive.

Conclusion

The Vandemataram movement was a seminal chapter in Andhra's freedom struggle. It ignited political activism, cultural revival and regional identity, and its legacy endures in the state's commitment to linguistic pride.

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P-II
10(a)

Trace the reasons for success and subsequent failure of Telangana people's armed struggle.

10

Introduction

The Telangana armed struggle of the 1940s was a landmark peasant rebellion against feudal oppression under the Nizam. Marxist and subaltern historians debate its course, from radical early achievements to eventual decline. Its story shows the complexity of agrarian revolt in a princely state and the reasons behind both its rise and fall.

Rise and fall of the armed struggle

Success	Failure
Sanghams and guerrilla squads	Split after police action
Grievances against feudal exploitation	Support to Razakars alienated
Forest cover, Koya support	Army repression after 1948
Land redistribution	Caste divides unbridged

Reasons for Initial Success

1. Peasant mobilisation and leadership: Communist cadres like Ravi Narayana Reddi and P. Sundarayya organised peasants, sharecroppers and

tribals into village sanghams and guerrilla squads, a disciplined force against landlords and Razakars.

2. Feudal exploitation: Exploitation by landlords, moneylenders and the Nizam's officials created deep grievances; attacks on jotedars and land redistribution drew mass participation.

3. Terrain and tribal support: Dense forests and hills in Nalgonda and Warangal gave cover for guerrilla war, and exploited Koya tribals gave shelter and logistics.

4. Triple tactics: Guerrilla attacks, village protection forces (Grama Rakshaka Dalams) and sabotage squads (Vidhvamsaka Dalams) pressed the Nizam's administration on many fronts.

Reasons for Subsequent Failure

1. Party divisions: After the 1948 police action ended the Nizam's rule, the Communists split over armed struggle versus peaceful politics, fragmenting the movement.

2. Alliance with Razakars: The controversial support to Muslim Razakars against the Indian Army alienated Hindu peasants and nationalist sympathisers, eroding legitimacy.

3. Military repression: Army and police action after 1948 led to arrests and killings of leaders; squads retreated into forests and lost control of rural areas.

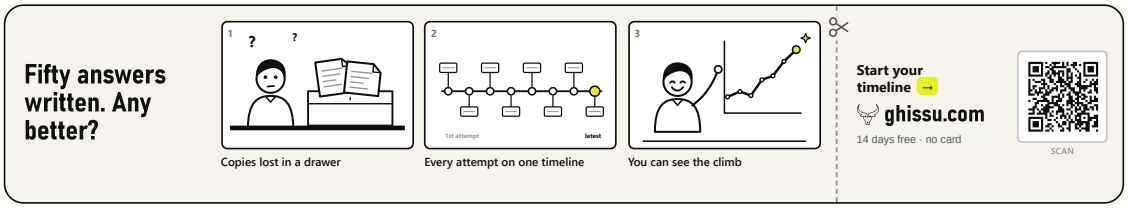
4. Caste fragmentation: The movement failed to bridge caste divides, and upper-caste resistance manipulated loyalties within the peasantry.

Way Forward

Inclusive land reform covering landless Dalits and tenant farmers, support for tribal culture, stronger local self-government and recognition of women's leadership can complete its unfinished agenda.

Conclusion

The Telangana armed struggle was a powerful assertion against feudal oppression that won early success through mass mobilisation and guerrilla tactics. Internal divisions, a controversial alliance, caste fragmentation and state repression brought its decline, yet its legacy endures in Telangana's socio-political landscape.



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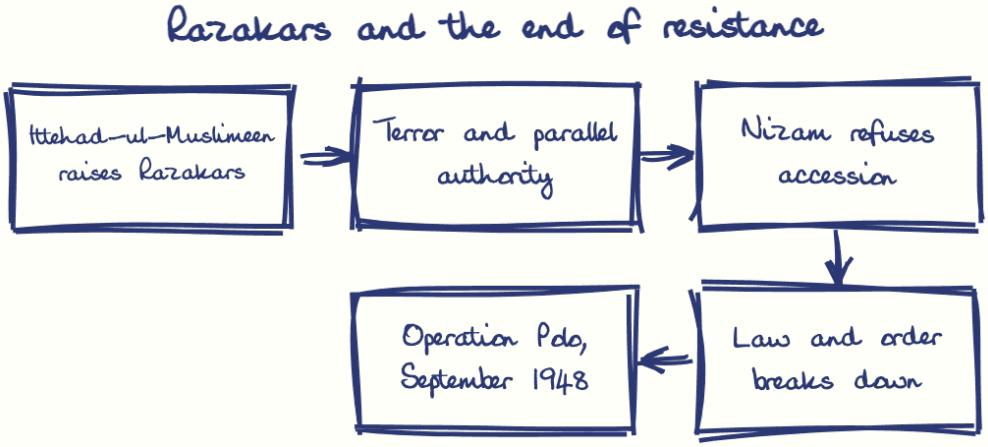
P-II
10(b)

Who are Razakars and what was their role in resisting integration of Hyderabad State in the Indian union?

10

Introduction

The integration of Hyderabad State into the Indian Union was marked by communal, political and ideological conflict. The Razakars, a militant Muslim paramilitary group, resisted it fiercely, intensifying communal tension and complicating the political landscape.



Who Were the Razakars

1. **Origin:** A para-military volunteer force created by the Ittehad-ul-Muslimeen, a communal organisation led by Kasim Razvi.
2. **Leadership:** Razvi, an Aligarh-educated lawyer, envisioned Hyderabad as a sovereign Muslim state, inspired by Jinnah but far more militant.

3. Motivation: Members swore an oath in the name of Allah to defend Muslim dominance in the Deccan, opposing democratic and secular integration.
4. Scale: By early 1948 they had grown to about a million, a significant fraction trained in arms.

Role in Resisting Integration

1. Terror and Intimidation: They terrorised Hindu villagers, plundered rural areas, abducted women and suppressed dissent, running a parallel authority.
2. Communal Polarisation: Hindus fled to neighbouring regions while Muslims migrated into Hyderabad, altering demographic patterns.
3. Challenge to Opponents: The urban, moderate State Congress struggled to counter them, while the Communist Party won rural support through armed peasant revolts.
4. Political Obstruction: Their militancy backed the Nizam's refusal to accede, prolonging the deadlock.

Impact on Integration

1. Police Action: The breakdown of law and order gave the government under Sardar Patel the rationale to launch Operation Polo in September

1948, a military action that annexed Hyderabad.

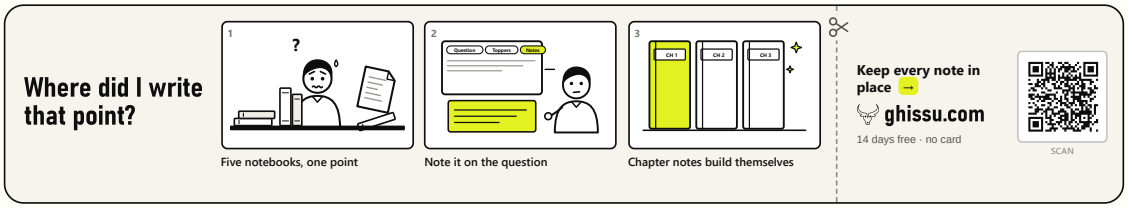
2. Accelerated Integration: Paradoxically, their excesses undermined the Nizam's position and rallied public opinion in favour of integration with India.

3. Realignment: Razakar leaders were arrested, and the Congress and Communist parties emerged as key actors in Hyderabad's democratic transition.

4. Communal Legacy: Their excesses deepened divides and left mistrust that complicated post-integration reconciliation and governance.

Conclusion

Born of communal fears and political ambition, the Razakars fiercely resisted integration but ultimately precipitated decisive military intervention, leaving a legacy of mistrust that calls for communal harmony.



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P-II
1(a)

Give a detailed account of Harappans' town planning and evaluate the various reasons for its decline.

Introduction

The Harappan civilization, flourishing around 2600 to 1900 BCE, was one of the world's earliest urban cultures, notable for sophisticated town planning. Its decline sheds light on the vulnerabilities of early complex societies.

Harappan Town Planning

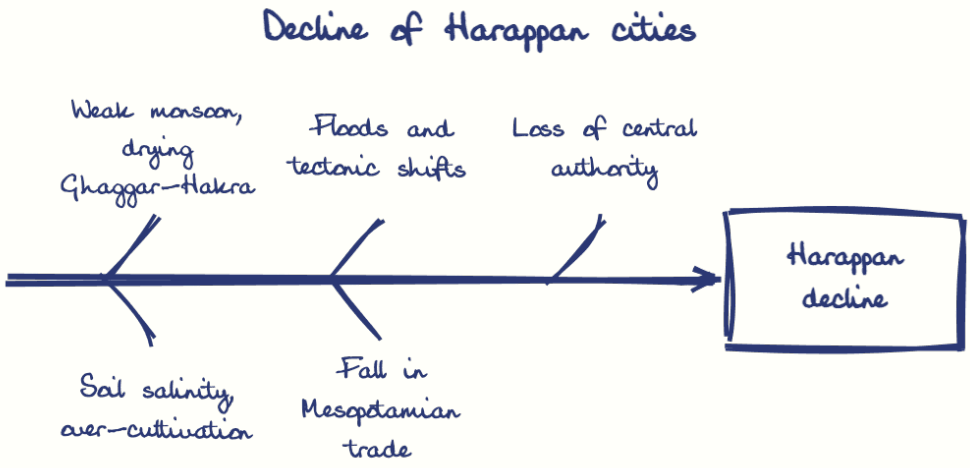
1. **Grid-based layout:** Mohenjodaro and Dholavira were laid out on a precise grid, with streets at right angles, reflecting centralised control over construction.
2. **Standardised bricks:** Uniform baked bricks across settlements indicate a regulated building code and durable structures.
3. **Drainage and sanitation:** Covered drains along streets, connected to houses, show concern for public health.
4. **Zoning and utilities:** Cities had citadels and lower towns, with the Great Bath at Mohenjodaro for ritual use and granaries for surplus storage.
5. **Water management:** Wells, reservoirs and water

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harvesting sustained dense populations in the semi-arid Indus valley.

Evaluation of Reasons for Decline



1. Climatic change: A weakening monsoon and drying of the Ghaggar-Hakra river system caused agricultural decline and water scarcity.
2. Ecological degradation: Over-cultivation, deforestation and overgrazing likely caused soil salinity and food shortages.
3. Natural disasters: Silt layers at Mohenjodaro suggest repeated floods, while tectonic activity may have altered river courses.
4. Trade disruption: Decline in trade with Mesopotamia weakened cities dependent on crafts.
5. Sociopolitical factors: Abandonment of core cities for smaller peripheral settlements suggests

decentralisation, social upheaval or loss of central authority, though evidence of invasion remains inconclusive.

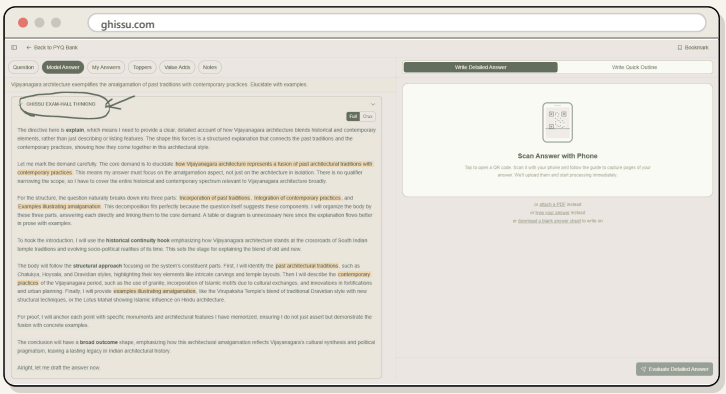
Thus the decline was gradual and multi-causal, with environmental stress weakening the economic base on which the planned cities depended.

Conclusion

Harappan town planning reflects a highly organised urban culture, while its decline shows a complex interplay of environmental, economic and social factors. These lessons matter for urban and environmental governance today.

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1 The question broken open before a single line of the answer.

2 Directive, demand and structure highlighted in the text.

3 Full walks a beginner through it; Crux is a ten-second check.

P-II
1(b)

Describe the similarities and differences of Buddhism and Ashoka's 'Dhamma'. Discuss the impact of the both on ancient Indian Society.

Introduction

Ashoka's Dhamma and Buddhism both sought social harmony and moral conduct, marking an era of ethical governance and spiritual awakening. Yet they emerged from distinct contexts and intentions.

Similarities

1. Ethical emphasis: Both stressed non-violence, compassion and truthfulness as central to social well-being.
2. Tolerance: Ashoka's edicts and Buddhist teachings both advocated respect for all sects and peaceful coexistence.
3. Social welfare: Both emphasised care for all living beings, humans and animals.
4. Moral governance: Dhamma drew on Buddhist ethics to reduce conflict and promote justice.

Differences

1. Religious vs secular: Buddhism rests on the Four Noble Truths and Eightfold Path, Dhamma was a secular ethical code for a diverse empire.

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Buddhism vs Ashoka's Dhamma

Buddhism	Ashoka's Dhamma
Religious philosophy	State policy, ethical code
Individual enlightenment	Social order, governance
Monastic discipline	Broader ethics beyond Buddhism
Renunciation, spiritual path	Practical ethics, harmony

2. Scope: Dhamma avoided sectarian and caste-based duties, Buddhism kept doctrinal and monastic frameworks.

3. Purpose and propagation: Buddhism sought liberation through monks and missions, Dhamma was a tool of statecraft spread through edicts.

Impact on Ancient Indian Society

1. Social integration: Both promoted ethical conduct over birth-based privilege, easing rigid hierarchies and fostering social mobility and inclusiveness.

2. Political unification: Dhamma encouraged loyalty through moral governance, though its long-term effect was limited.

3. Culture: Monastic universities like Nalanda,

stupas and pillars enriched heritage.

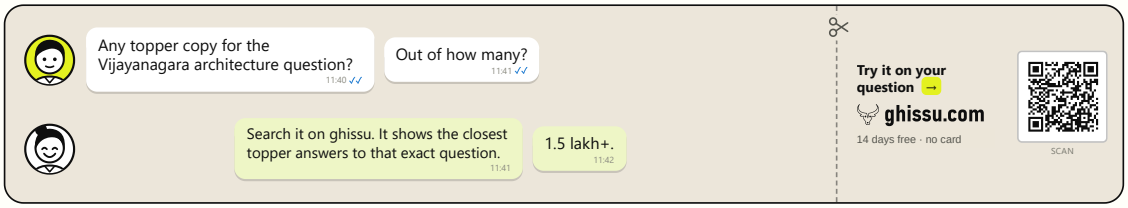
4. Limits: Mauryan decline followed, and Buddhism faced schisms and Brahmanical revival.

Way Forward

1. Ethical governance: Modern India can integrate ethical principles into administration, as Ashoka did, to enhance social harmony and reduce communal tensions.
2. Religious tolerance: Strengthening safeguards for religious freedom echoes Ashoka's respect for all faiths.

Conclusion

Buddhism and Ashoka's Dhamma together shaped India's ethical and political fabric. Though limited in lasting effect, they offer enduring lessons in tolerance and ethical governance.



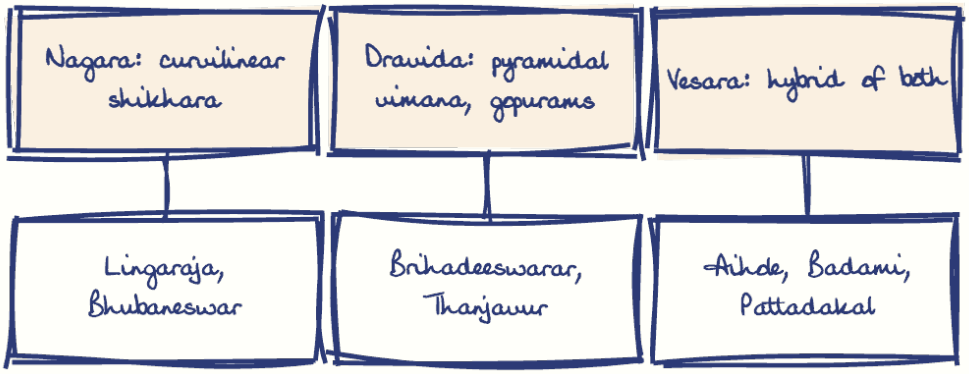
P-II
2(a)

What are the medieval Indian Temple construction styles? Discuss with suitable examples.

Introduction

Medieval Indian temple architecture, from roughly the 6th to the 16th century CE, was a confluence of devotion, regional identity and evolving techniques. Three distinct styles crystallised, serving both as places of worship and as symbols of royal patronage.

Medieval temple styles



Nagara Style

1. **Region and form:** Found between the Himalayas and the Vindhyas, it has a beehive-shaped curvilinear shikhara above a square sanctum, crowned by an amalaka and kalasha, often with clustered smaller spires.
2. **Techniques:** Walls carry sculptural panels, and

precise stone masonry without mortar used iron dowels, as at the Deogarh temple.

3. Example: The Lingaraja Temple in Bhubaneswar, with intricate carvings and a towering shikhara.

Dravida Style

1. Region and form: Developed between the Krishna and Kaveri, it has a pyramidal vimana of progressively smaller storeys, large gopurams and enclosing prakara walls.
2. Techniques: Granite and advanced stone-cutting allowed massive structures with large pillared mandapas and intricately carved pillars and ceilings, enclosed by high walls forming a sacred precinct.
3. Example: The Chola-built Brihadeeswarar Temple at Thanjavur, whose vimana rises over (60) metres using interlocking stones without mortar.

Vesara Style

1. Region and form: In the Deccan between the Vindhyas and Krishna, this hybrid style blends the curvilinear shikhara of the north with the stepped vimana of the south.

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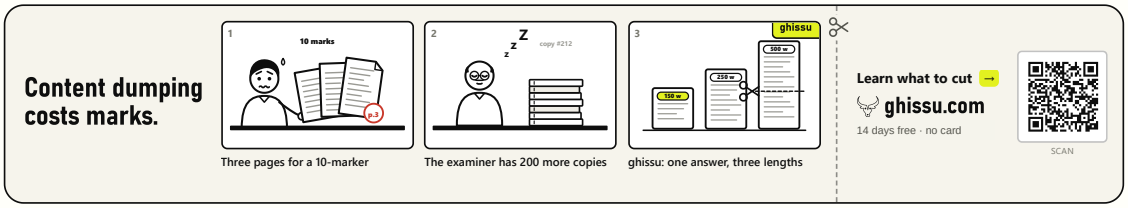
2. Techniques: Elaborate sculpture mixes both iconographic traditions, with multiple shrines and complex layouts.
3. Example: Chalukyan temples at Aihole, Badami and Pattadakal.

Way Forward

1. Conservation: Scientific restoration with community involvement can preserve the structural integrity of medieval temples.
2. Education and tourism: Teaching temple styles in architecture courses and responsible tourism at sites like Lingaraja, Brihadeeswarar and Pattadakal can sustain this heritage.

Conclusion

The Nagara, Dravida and Vesara styles reflect India's regional diversity, devotional spirit and engineering skill. Many are UNESCO World Heritage Sites, a living heritage that still inspires contemporary architecture.



P-II
2(b)

Examine the factors behind the rise of Shivaji. Do you feel that he was a nationalist leader? support.

Introduction

Shivaji's rise in the 17th century was a turning point in Deccan history. He emerged amid a declining Mughal Empire and fragmented regional powers. Nationalist, Marxist and subattern schools interpret his legacy differently, so judging him needs a look at his institutions, strategy and ideological context.

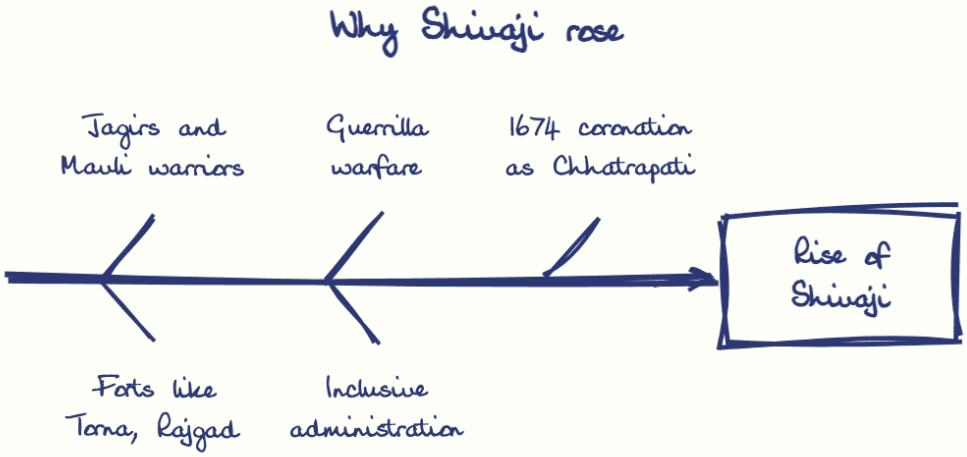
Factors behind Shivaji's Rise

1. **Decentralised power base:** Jagirs inherited from his father and loyal Mavli warriors gave him a strong grassroots military and administrative base.
2. **Fortress network:** Capturing and building forts like Torna and Rajgad provided defensive strongholds and symbols of sovereignty.
3. **Guerrilla warfare:** Swift tactics let him challenge larger Mughal and Bijapur forces and expand across the Deccan.
4. **Diplomacy:** Temporary peace with the Mughals and exploiting their internal conflicts helped him consolidate without overextending.

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5. Revenue control: Captured forts and regions funded his army and administration, sustaining Swarajya.
6. Coronation (1674): Assuming the title of Chhatrapati was a deliberate assertion of independent, legitimate sovereignty.



Was Shivaji a Nationalist Leader?

1. Cultural revival: Hindu symbols and festivals, inspired by Jijabai and guru Ramdas, fostered pride and resistance, later revived by Tilak.
2. Inclusive governance: Employing Muslims in his army and administration showed a cathdic approach beyond sectarianism.
3. Limits of nationalism: Nationalism as understood today was nascent, his struggle was regional and dynastic, not pan-Indian.

4. Contested symbol: Later Hindu revivalists projected communal identities onto his legacy, complicating his inclusive image.
5. Enduring cultural pride: His memory remains a potent symbol of resistance and pride in Maharashtra, celebrated in folk songs and festivals, though caste and communal narratives are still debated.

Conclusion

Shivaji was not a nationalist in the modern sense, but his proto-nationalist quest for self-rule, inclusive rule and resistance make him an enduring symbol of pride, best remembered through a pluralistic and nuanced narrative.

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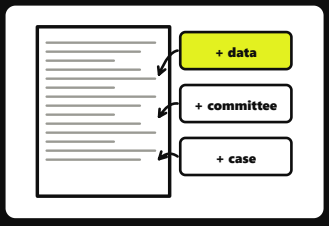
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1. **Constitution** — Articles, Schedules, Amendments.
2. **Courts & commissions** — Supreme Court judgments; Sarkaria, Punchhi, ARC, Law Commission.
3. **Government data** — Economic Survey, NFHS, PLFS, NCRB, Census, PIB.
4. **International** — IPCC, UNDP, World Bank, FAO — then expert opinion, last.

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3(a) Discuss about the various stages of British colonialism and its impact on Indian Society.

Introduction

British colonial rule in India, spanning nearly two centuries, passed through distinct phases analysed by historians like R.P. Dutt. Each phase shaped the political, economic and social fabric, causing both disruption and transformation whose legacy still shapes modern India.

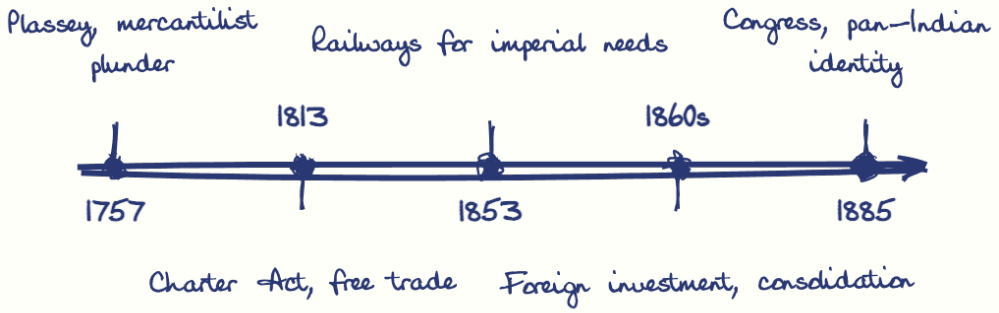
Stages of British Colonialism

1. Mercantilist phase (1757–1813): After the Battle of Plassey, the Company monopolised trade, manipulated prices and diverted Bengal's surplus revenues to England, undermining local rulers.
2. Free trade and industrial capitalism (1813–1858): After the Charter Act of 1813, India became a supplier of raw materials and a market for British goods, causing deindustrialisation of textiles and artisan unemployment.
3. Imperial consolidation (1860s onwards): Facing global competition, Britain tightened control, expanded the bureaucracy and army, and built railways, begun in 1853, mainly for imperial interests.

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Stages of British colonialism



Impact on Indian Society

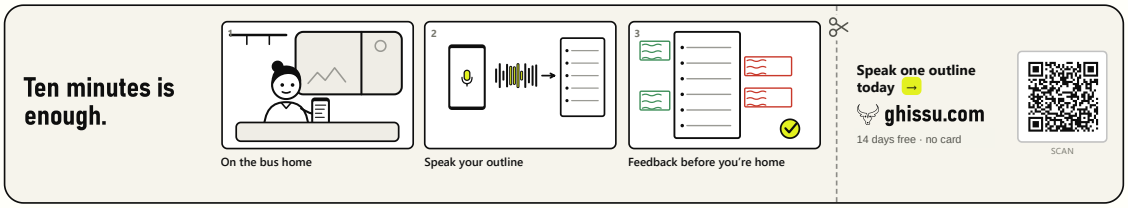
1. Administrative disruption: Traditional governance gave way to a centralised bureaucracy that excluded Indians from higher posts, while caste hierarchies faced new legal and educational pressures.
2. Rural distress: The Permanent Settlement and Ryotwari burdened peasants; Dadabhai Naoroji's drain of wealth theory showed how India was impoverished, deepening indebtedness and famines.
3. Social awakening: Western education and missionaries inspired the Brahmo Samaj and Arya Samaj, which challenged sati and child marriage.
4. Political nationalism: Unification bred a pan-Indian identity; the Congress, formed in 1885, moved from petitions to swaraj under leaders like Tilak.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive institutions: Deepen democratic decentralisation and ensure representation of marginalised communities.
2. Economic equity: Rural development, agrarian reform and revival of traditional crafts can redress colonial disruption.
3. Social reform and education: Fight caste discrimination and promote scientific temper.

Conclusion

British colonialism unfolded through stages of exploitation and control. It inflicted deep economic and social wounds, yet inadvertently sowed the seeds of modern political consciousness and reform.

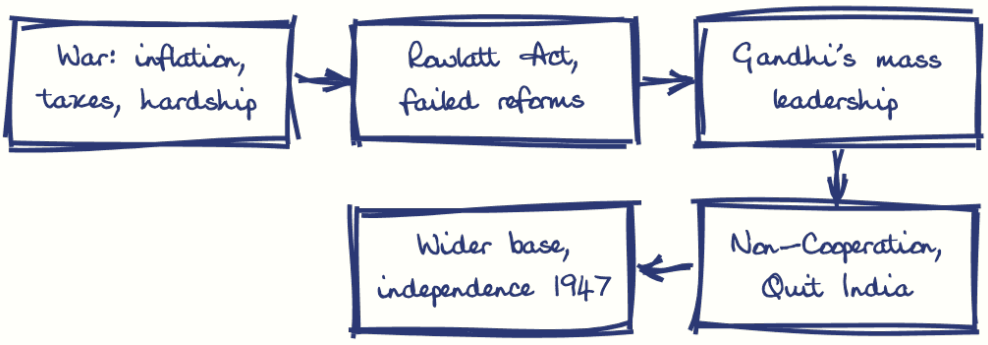


3(b) What was the impact of the First and Second World Wars on the Indian National Movement?

Introduction

The First and Second World Wars reshaped the Indian national movement, accelerating its move from elite-led petitions to mass struggle. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians agree that the wars exposed the contradictions of colonial rule and intensified demands for self-rule.

How the wars changed the movement



Political Impact

1. **Disappointing Reforms:** The Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms of 1919 expanded the electorate only marginally, causing disillusionment with constitutional methods.
2. **Rise of Gandhi:** The wars catalysed Gandhi's rise as a mass leader mobilising peasants, workers and women through non-violent civil

disobedience.

3. New Movements: The Khilafat and Non-Cooperation movements followed the first war, while the Quit India Movement during the second showed nationwide resistance despite repression.

4. Repression: Wartime laws like the Rowlatt Act and martial law in Punjab provoked mass protests and sharpened demands for fundamental rights, forcing more radical and inclusive approaches.

Economic and Social Impact

1. War Hardship: Inflation, unemployment and higher taxes hit peasants, workers and artisans, intensifying their participation.

2. Industrial Growth: Import restrictions in the First World War stimulated Indian industry, and business groups began backing demands for economic protection.

3. Soldiers' Experience: Returning soldiers brought new political consciousness, spreading nationalist ideas in rural areas.

4. Wider Base: The wars broadened the movement to include peasants, tribals, women and urban workers, making it a more inclusive struggle against colonial exploitation.

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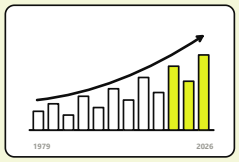
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Challenges and Outcomes

1. **Communal Strain:** The Khilafat alliance with the Congress revealed difficulties in maintaining Hindu–Muslim unity, which later complicated the nationalist agenda.
2. **British Responses:** Arrests and censorship during both wars disrupted nationalist activity but also galvanised public opinion against imperial rule.
3. **Strategic Shift:** The failure of reforms and broken wartime promises led to militant and mass-based strategies like civil disobedience and Quit India.

Conclusion

The two wars exposed colonial contradictions, expanded participation and broadened the social base of the movement. They left a legacy of political awakening and organisational capacity that paved the way to independence in 1947.



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P-II
4(a)

Explain the main features of the religious and social reform movements and evaluate their role in the making of Modern India.

Introduction

The religious and social reform movements of the 19th and early 20th centuries arose in response to colonial rule, social evils and orthodoxy. They sought to harmonise tradition with modernity, fostering a new national consciousness, though subaltern critics note their limited reach.

Features of Religious Reform Movements

1. Rationalism and humanism: Raja Ram Mohan Roy and Swami Vivekananda challenged superstition and priestly dominance, Roy's Brahmo Samaj promoted monotheism and condemned sati, abolished in 1829.
2. Appeal to ancient texts: Dayanand Saraswati's Arya Samaj sought to revive "pure" Vedic religion.
3. Middle-class leadership: Educated urban elites used English education and the vernacular press.
4. Universalism: Keshub Chandra Sen saw universal truths in all religions, preparing ground for secular nationalism.

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Religious and social reform

Religious reform	Social reform
Reason against superstition	Against caste, child marriage
Brahmo Samaj, Arya Samaj	Vidyasagar, Phule, Ambedkar
Urban middle-class leaders	Slowly reached Dalits, women

Features of Social Reform Movements

1. Focus on social evils: Vidyasagar championed widow remarriage and female education, and Jyotirao Phule worked for lower castes.
2. Secular ethos: B.R. Ambedkar's fight against caste stressed human rights and constitutional morality.
3. Wider social base: Movements gradually reached Dalits and women.
4. Vernacular media: In Andhra, Brahmo Samaj branches and Telugu journalism drove awakening.

Role in Making Modern India

1. Intellectual awakening: New self-respect countered colonial narratives of Indian inferiority.
2. Foundation for nationalism: Shared identity and cohesion influenced leaders like Gandhi and

Ambedkar.

3. Modernisation without imitation: Science was integrated with indigenous culture.

4. Limitations: Elitism, weak rural reach and revivalist religious particularism complicated secular nationalism.

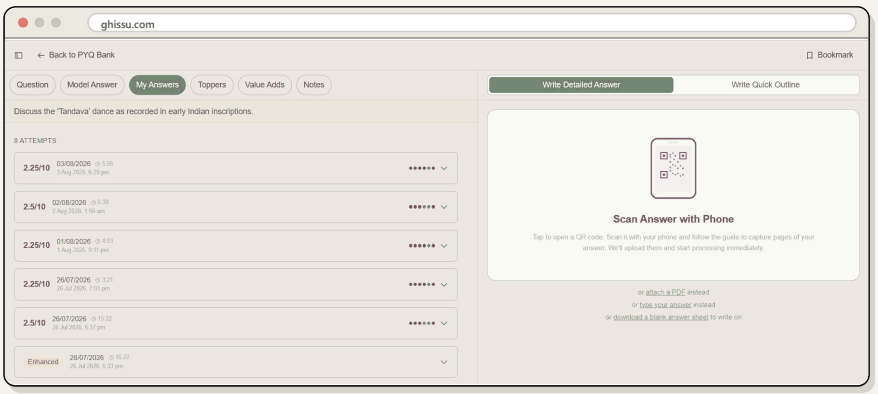
Conclusion

Despite their limits, these movements laid the intellectual foundations of a modern, self-confident India: rational inquiry, social equality and cultural self-confidence, values later carried into the national movement and the Constitution.

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SCAN

4(b) How far have the oppressed caste movements and their leaders helped the downtrodden people for their upliftment?

Introduction

Oppressed caste movements emerged against centuries of caste-based exclusion, aiming to uplift the downtrodden by challenging entrenched hierarchies. Leaders like Dr. B.R. Ambedkar and grassroots activists shaped the discourse on social justice, but persistent inequality shows their success has been partial.

Role of the Movements

1. Social Awareness: The Adi-Andhra Mahasabha in Andhra Pradesh politicised Dalits and fostered self-respect through education and cultural assertion.
2. Challenging Exclusion: The Dalit Panthers and Gandhi's Harijan Sevak Sangh attacked untouchability and temple entry restrictions, an early attempt at social integration despite limited success in changing attitudes.
3. Resisting Atrocities: Protests and legal activism under the SC/ST (Prevention of Atrocities) Act increased reporting and prosecution of atrocities.
4. Limits of Transformation: Caste hierarchies remain

resilient, and many Dalits still face economic exploitation and social exclusion.

Contribution of Leaders

1. Ambedkar's Vision: He secured the abolition of untouchability (Article 17) and reservations in education and employment.
2. Educational Initiatives: Tala Rangaswamy and Kusuma Dharmanna advanced literacy and vocational training by setting up schools, hostels and journals that fostered awareness and unity at the grassroots.
3. Political Representation: The Bahujan Samaj Party and Dalit legislators enhanced the community's voice in governance, though co-option by dominant castes sometimes diluted their autonomy.

How far did they succeed?

Gains	Gaps
Article 17, reservations	Uneven enforcement
Temple entries	Casteist mindsets persist
Atrocities Act prosecutions	Many Dalits still landless
BSP, Dalit legislators	Co-option of leaders

Assessment of Limitations

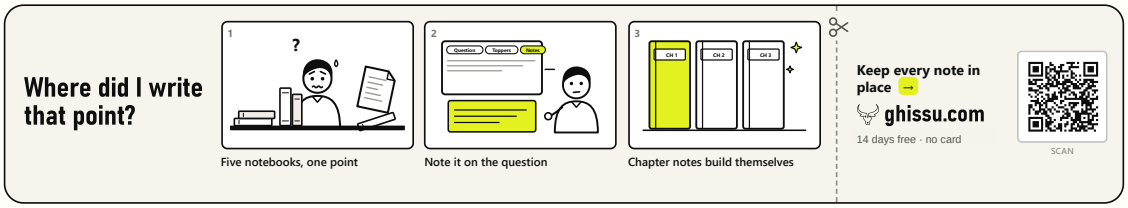
1. Laws vs Reality: Rights are institutionalised but enforcement is uneven and prejudice persists.
2. Symbolic Change: Gandhi's Harijan programme won temple entries but did not alter casteist mindsets.
3. Economic Disparity: Despite land reforms, many Dalits remain landless and dependent on dominant castes.
4. Co-option and Gaps: Absorption into mainstream parties diluted autonomy, and issues of Dalit women remain under-addressed.

Way Forward

Stronger enforcement of anti-discrimination laws, inclusive education and autonomous Dalit leadership can deepen these gains.

Conclusion

The movements and their leaders created a strong legal and political foundation for upliftment, but full social transformation remains incomplete.



P-II
5(a)

Estimate the role of women in the National Movement. Do you consider that their participation was an indication for the women empowerment in those days?

Introduction

Women's participation in the National Movement reflected both the aspiration for freedom and the changing status of women. Historians debate whether it brought genuine women's empowerment or stayed subordinate to wider political goals.

Role of Women in the National Movement

1. **Women's Organisations:** The Bharat Stri Mahamandal (1909) and the All India Women's Conference (1917) gave platforms for social reform and political activism.
2. **Prominent Leaders:** Sarojini Naidu, Kasturba Gandhi, Annie Besant and Durgabai Deshmukh mobilised women and led protests; Deshmukh founded the Andhra Mahila Sabha for education and welfare.
3. **Political Inclusion:** Women entered legislative councils and decision-making, though in limited numbers, setting a precedent for representation after independence.
4. **Constructive Programme:** Gandhi drew women into spinning and village industries, blending social

reform with politics.

Participation and empowerment

Signs of empowerment	Limits
AIWC, Andhra Mahila Sabha	Women's issues sidelined
Leaders like Sarojini Naidu	Mostly urban, educated women
Seats in legislative councils	Purdah, child marriage persisted
Constructive programme work	Class, caste divides

Was It an Indication of Empowerment?

1. Subordination of Women's Issues: Their own concerns were often sidelined for national liberation, and some leaders kept women's bodies apolitical.
2. Social Divides: Class, caste and religious divisions fragmented participation.
3. Urban Bias: Educated urban women were active, while rural and poor women were less represented.
4. Persisting Patriarchy: Literacy and awareness grew, but child marriage and purdah persisted, showing only partial empowerment.

Long-term Impact

1. **Education:** Women's schools and training centres improved female literacy and vocational skills, laying groundwork for future empowerment.
2. **Political Legacy:** Their role shaped constitutional equality and later the 73rd Amendment reserving seats for women in Panchayati Raj.
3. **Economic Roles:** Work in village industries and trade unions began to challenge traditional economic roles.
4. **Symbolic Power:** Their sacrifices became symbols of gender equality that inspired later feminist movements.

Conclusion

Women's participation was a crucial step towards empowerment, showing their agency within the limits of the social structures of the time. It did not bring full equality then, but laid the foundation for later political, social and economic advances. Intersectional mobilisation and wider representation through the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam can complete the journey.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

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P-II
5(b)

What was the role of Socialists and the influence of Socialistic ideas on the Pre and Post Independence India?

Introduction

Socialism gained prominence in the early 20th century as a response to colonial exploitation and economic inequality. It shaped the strategies of freedom fighters and the policies of independent India, producing a distinctive democratic socialism that blends Marxist and Gandhian ideals.

Role of Socialists Before Independence

1. **Radicalising the Congress:** In the 1920s and 1930s socialists stressed the economic grievances of peasants and workers, widening the struggle to social justice. The Karachi session of 1931 adopted resolutions on workers' rights and agrarian reform.
2. **Socialist Leaders:** Jawaharlal Nehru and Subhas Chandra Bose advocated state intervention and equitable distribution, leading to the National Planning Committee in 1938.
3. **Peasant and Labour Movements:** Socialist ideas energised peasant and labour struggles against exploitative landlordism and colonial economic policy, linking class and colonial oppression and

mobilising rural and working classes.

4. Limitations: Caste divisions and Gandhian dominance in the Congress limited them, and class struggle clashed with non-violence and trusteeship.

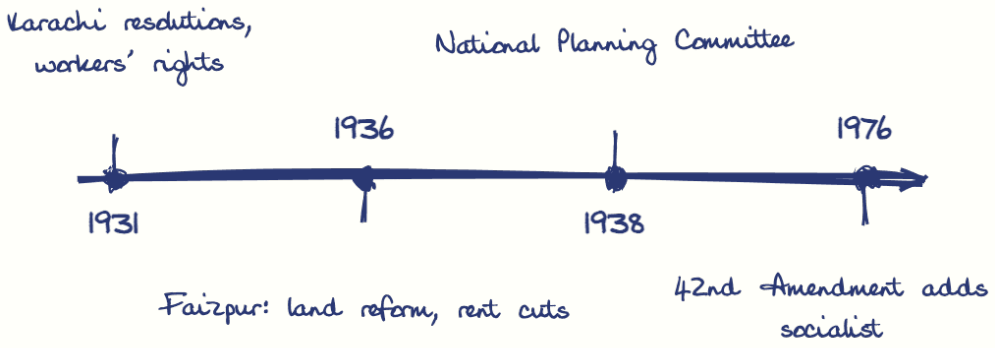
Influence of Socialistic Ideas Before Independence

1. Critique of Colonialism: The drain of wealth and deindustrialisation were exposed, linking economic exploitation to political subjugation, from Dadabhai Naoroji onwards.
2. Gandhian Synthesis: Indian socialism rejected violent class struggle and adopted non-violence, rural self-reliance and trusteeship.
3. Congress Manifestos: The Faizpur session of (1936) stressed land reforms, rent reduction and workers' rights.
4. Caste-Class Nexus: Jagdeo Prasad in Bihar argued that the Bahujan majority, around (90%) of the population, was exploited, and demanded redistribution.

Influence After Independence

1. Constitution: Socialist ideals entered the Directive Principles without abolishing private property, and the 42nd Amendment (1976) added "socialist" to

Socialist ideas in Indian politics



the Preamble.

2. Mixed Economy and Planning: Planning adapted the Soviet model to democracy. Five-Year Plans focused on industrialisation, land reform and poverty alleviation.
3. Social Justice and Welfare: Socialist ideas shaped policies aimed at the upliftment of the poor and weaker sections.

Conclusion

Socialists turned the freedom struggle towards social justice and economic equity. Their ideas shaped the Constitution and planning, giving India a mixed economy and a welfare-oriented state.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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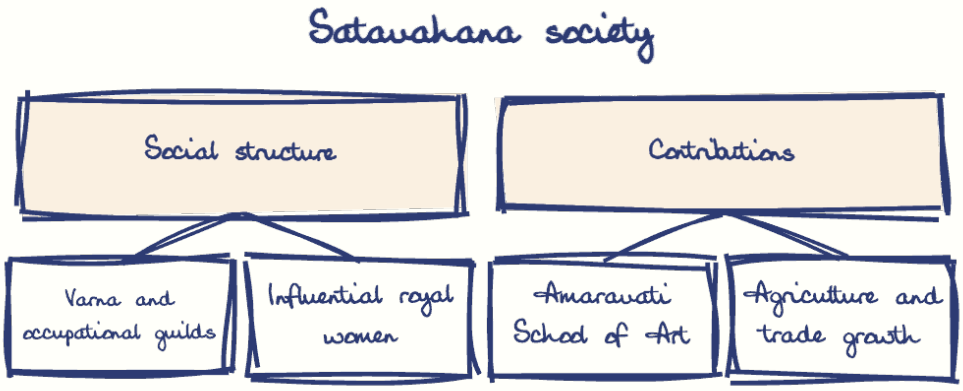
SCAN

P-II
6(a)

Explain the social structure during the Satavahana period and also discuss the contribution of Satavahanas to the society.

Introduction

The Satavahana dynasty, from around the 1st century BCE to the 3rd century CE, shaped the social and cultural landscape of the Deccan, including Andhra Pradesh. Their era merged tribal and local customs with Brahmanical traditions, creating a unique social fabric.



Social Structure

1. Varna and Occupations: The four-fold Varna system coexisted with occupational groups such as cultivators (Halika), merchants (Sethi), carpenters (Vachaki) and blacksmiths (Kamara), organised into guilds or srenis.
2. Status of Women: Royal women like Nagapika and Balasri influenced state affairs, and titles

like Maharathini and Mahasenapatini suggest administrative and military roles. Art at Ajanta and Amaravati shows their social freedom in a society open but not permissive.

3. Religious Integration: Patronage of both Brahmanism and Buddhism helped assimilate foreign tribes like the Sakas, though caste rigidity grew over time.

4. Local Governance: Villages were run by the gramani, and merchant corporations called Nigamasabha sustained a vibrant urban culture.

Contributions to Society

1. Cultural Synthesis: Vedic rituals coexisted with land grants to Buddhist monks, establishing centres like Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati.

2. Art and Architecture: They pioneered rock-cut chaityas and viharas at Nashik and Kanheri and developed the Amaravati School of Art with its marble sculptures.

3. Economic Development: Land grants and irrigation in the Godavari and Krishna plains boosted agriculture, while coins and guilds expanded trade across the Deccan.

4. Administration: Mauryan practices blended with military governors and tax-free villages for religious communities, influencing later South

Indian polities.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Conservation: Better funding and community engagement can preserve Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda for cultural tourism and education.
2. Historical Research: Interdisciplinary study of caste, gender and religion in this period can deepen understanding of Andhra's past.
3. Cultural Integration: The Satavahana legacy of religious pluralism can inspire communal harmony today.

Conclusion

The Satavahanas built a pluralistic society balancing caste with guilds and Brahmanism with Buddhism. Their legacy in art, trade and governance remains central to Andhra's heritage and deserves heritage conservation.

1.5 lakh+

Borrow the approach, not the answer.

Topper answers matched by meaning to your question — with how each one opened, structured and concluded.

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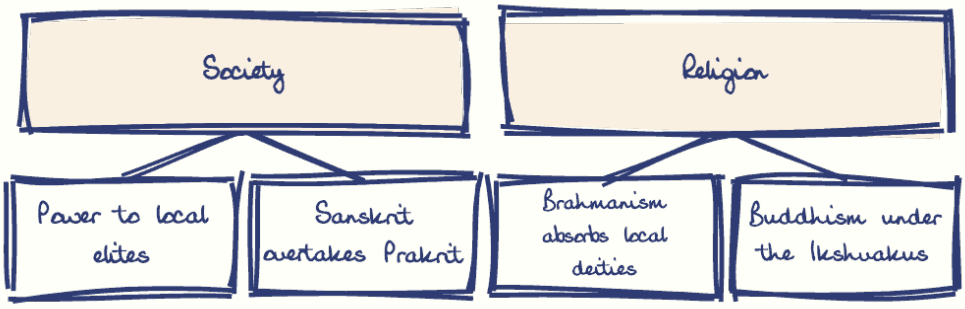
SCAN

6(b) Give an account of the socio-cultural and religious conditions of the people after the down fall of Satavahana dynasty.

Introduction

The downfall of the Satavahana dynasty marked a major transition in the Deccan, including Andhra Pradesh. Central power fragmented into smaller kingdoms, reshaping social structures and religious practice and laying the base of medieval regional culture.

After the Satavahanas



Socio-Cultural Conditions

1. **Political Fragmentation:** Feudatories and governors asserted independence, and administration passed into local hands with the village as the basic unit, empowering local elites and landlords.
2. **Persistence of Varna:** Brahmanas kept high status through their religious role and land grants, while caste began to absorb local and tribal customs.

Matrilineal traces gave way to more patriarchal norms.

3. Language Shift: Sanskrit overtook Prakrit as the language of the elite, especially under the Ikshvakus, while early Telugu and Kannada developed, signalling regional identities.

4. Artistic Continuity: Rock-cut architecture and Buddhist stupas continued at Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati in evolving styles. These monuments served as cultural hubs reflecting Buddhist and Brahmanical coexistence.

Religious Conditions

1. Adaptation of Brahmanism: Without central patronage its dominance declined, but it adapted by incorporating local deities and practices.

2. Spread of Buddhism: Mahayana Buddhism, supported by merchants and artisans, flourished at Nagarjunakonda under successors like the Ikshvakus.

3. Jainism: Without royal patronage it survived peacefully among certain communities, mainly in border regions, adding to the religious mosaic of the Deccan.

4. Syncretism and Tolerance: Shared rituals, land

grants to different faiths and blended iconography reflected religious coexistence despite occasional tensions.

Way Forward

1. Heritage and Language: Conserving Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda and promoting Telugu alongside Sanskrit can preserve this legacy.
2. Local Histories: Teaching post-Satavahana regional history in schools can deepen awareness of Andhra's cultural evolution.
3. Interfaith Dialogue: Platforms for dialogue among communities can revive the old tradition of tolerance.

Conclusion

The post-Satavahana period in the Deccan was a dynamic phase of decentralisation, linguistic evolution and religious syncretism, a legacy of tolerance that calls for fostering interfaith dialogue today.

Same question. Three word limits.

500 words — context · three dimensions · two examples each · a diagram · a conclusion

250 words — one-line context · three dimensions · one example each · a conclusion

150 words — a definition · two dimensions · one line each · a one-line verdict

See every model answer at 3 lengths →

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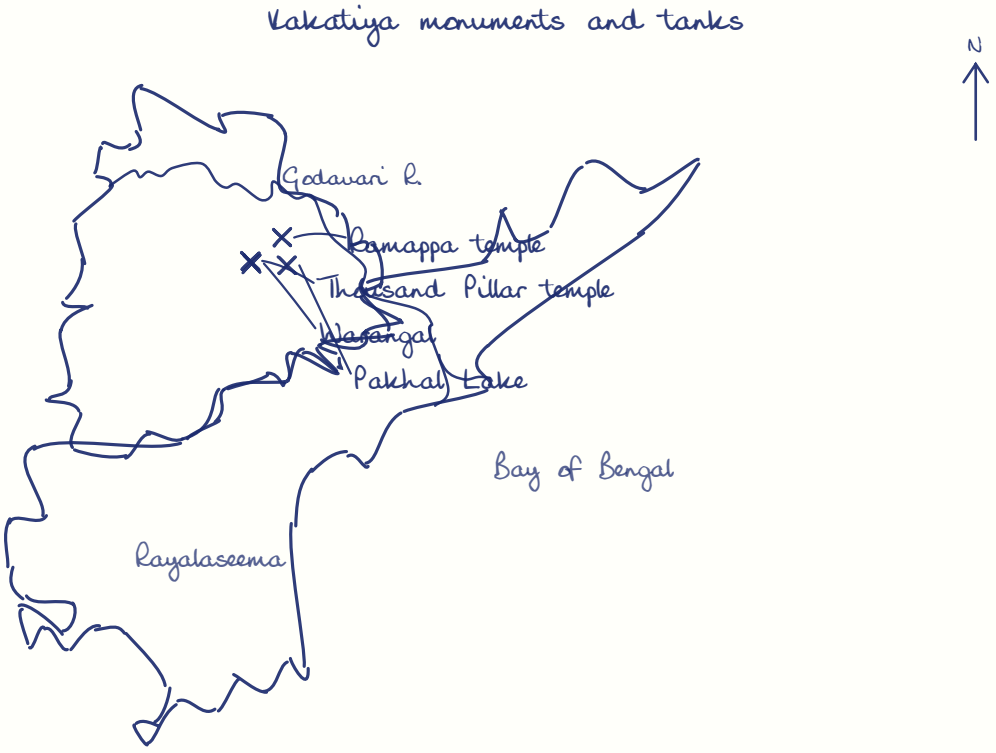
SCAN

P-II
7(a)

Describe the Kakatiya Style of architecture and discuss how the Agriculture and Irrigation systems was developed during that period.

Introduction

The Kakatiya dynasty ruled the Telugu regions from Warangal between the 12th and 14th centuries, leaving a profound legacy in architecture, agriculture and irrigation. The recognition of the Ramappa Temple as a UNESCO World Heritage site and the Mission Kakatiya tank programme show its continuing relevance.



Rayalaseema: land reclaimed for cultivation

Kakatiya Style of Architecture

1. Innovative Temple Design: Intricate stone carvings, as in the sculptures of dancers (Madanikas) and warriors at Ramappa, reflect artistic finesse and devotion.
2. Fortifications and Gateways: The four massive gateways of Warangal Fort, the Kakatiya Thoranam, are enduring symbols of regional identity.
3. Materials and Techniques: Sandstone, granite and metal clamps gave durability to structures like the Thousand-Pillar Temple in Hanamkonda.
4. Religious Integration: Early Jain influences gave way to Shaivism, and architecture reinforced political authority.

Agricultural Development

1. Land Reclamation: Forests and wasteland, especially in Rayalaseema, were reclaimed to expand cultivation.
2. Nayankara System: Local chiefs managed land revenue and farming, ensuring efficient collection and rural stability.
3. Food Security: Food grains and commercial crops created a surplus that underpinned military

strength, as praised by Marco Polo.

Irrigation Systems

1. **Tanks and Lakes:** Large tanks such as Ramappa, Pakala and Bayyaram remain functional today, proving advanced hydraulic engineering.
2. **Village-Level Management:** Every village had to have at least one tank, ensuring decentralised irrigation.
3. **Modern Relevance:** Mission Kakatiya in Telangana restores minor tanks on this model to boost productivity and water security.

Way Forward

1. **Revive Water Bodies:** Extending tank restoration across Andhra Pradesh can recharge groundwater and sustain farming.

Conclusion

Kakatiya temples and tanks are living heritage that still inspire cultural pride and agrarian resilience in Andhra Pradesh and Telangana, and their village tanks remain a model for water security today.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · VALUE ADDITION

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SCAN

P-II
7(b)

Evaluate the development of Telugu Language and Literature between 1000 A.D. and 1565 A.D. with special reference to women poets.

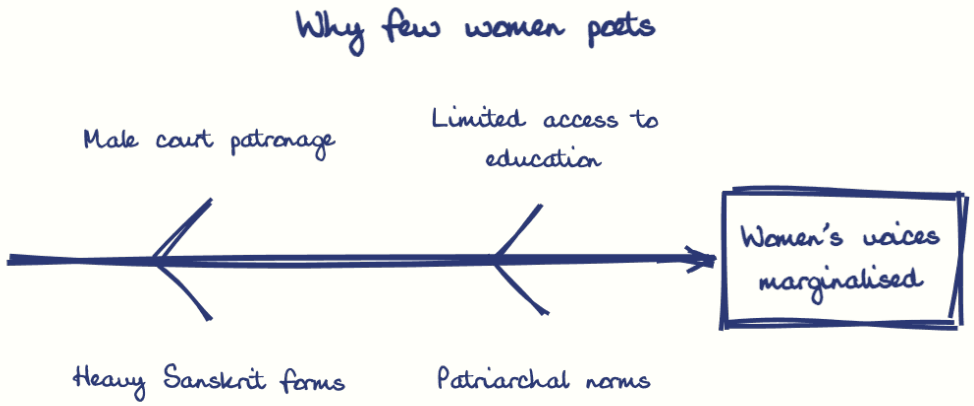
Introduction

The period between 1000 A.D. and 1565 A.D. saw Telugu mature into a literary language, moving from translations of Sanskrit epics to original poetic compositions and culminating in a golden age under the Vijayanagara Empire. The role of women poets, though less documented, offers insight into the gender dynamics of medieval Andhra society.

Development of Telugu Language and Literature

1. **Kavitraya's Foundation:** Nannaya, Tikkana and Yerrapragada, the Kavitraya, translated the Mahabharata into Telugu between the 11th and 14th centuries, blending prose and verse with Sanskritic techniques.
2. **Vijayanagara Patronage:** Under Sri Krishna Deva Raya the Prabandha genre reached its zenith with his own Amukta Malyada and the Ashtadiggajas, including Allasani Peddana, revered as the 'Grandfather of Andhra Poetry'.
3. **Language Evolution:** Telugu assimilated Sanskritic and regional elements, with translations of Shaivite texts and original works reflecting the

socio-religious milieu.



Women Poets in this Period

1. Talapaka Timmakka: Her Subhadra Kalyana shows women's participation in literary culture through devotional and narrative themes, an early feminist voice in a male tradition.
2. Scarcity of Works: Their numbers and surviving works are limited, showing how women's voices were marginalised in mainstream literary history.

Evaluation: Gendered Constraints

1. Male Patronage: Royal courts and male poets favoured heroism, devotion and courtly love, sidelining women's experiences.
2. Style and Education Barriers: Heavy Sanskrit influence and complex forms, with women's limited access to education, restricted participation.

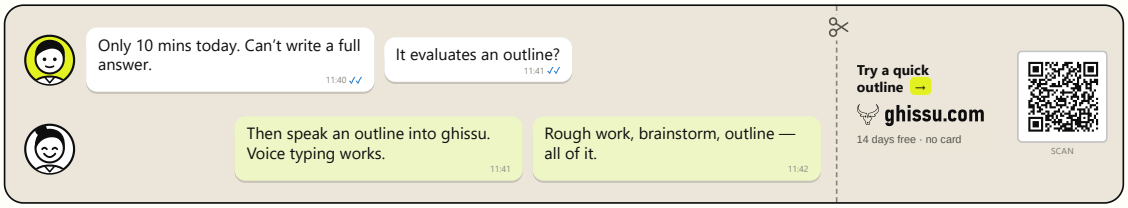
3. Patriarchal Norms: Women's public writing was confined mostly to devotional or domestic themes.

Way Forward

1. Archival Recovery: Academic and cultural bodies should identify, preserve and study women's medieval Telugu works.
2. Inclusive Scholarship: Bringing women poets into curricula through gender-inclusive scholarship and feminist critique will widen recognition.
3. Digitalisation: Digitised manuscripts on online portals will democratise access to this heritage.

Conclusion

Telugu travelled from foundational translations to a flourishing original literature by 1565, especially under Vijayanagara. Women poets contributed meaningfully, but their limited visibility reflects the gendered challenges of the era, and recovering their legacy enriches the whole tradition.



P-II
8(a)

Discuss about the role of the Andhras during different phases of National Movement.

Introduction

The role of the Andhras in the National Movement reflects a distinct regional dimension of the freedom struggle. Across its phases, linguistic pride and regional identity intertwined with national aspirations, as the demand for a separate Andhra state gained momentum.

Role in Different Phases

1. Early nationalism: Political awakening began with the Krishna District Association (1892), among India's earliest. P. Rangaiah Naidu and P. Anandacharyulu took part in Congress sessions.
2. Swadeshi and Vandemataram (1905–1910): Inspired by Tilak, Andhra saw student strikes like the Rajahmundry agitation of 1907. Moderates Konda Venkatappaiah and B. N. Sarma led, and *Andhrula Charitramu* built cultural pride.
3. Gandhian phase: Pattabhi Sitaramayya and Duggirala Gopalakrishnayya mobilised peasants and the middle class in Non-Cooperation and Civil Disobedience. The No-Tax Campaigns in

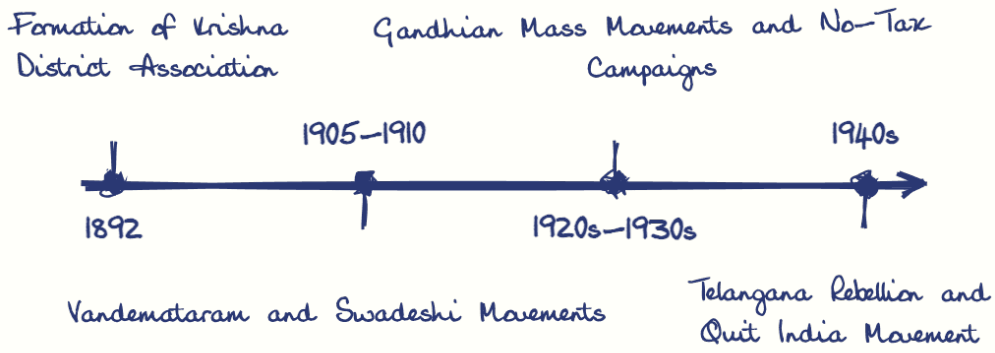
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Scan to practice

Chirala–Perala and Pedanandipadu and the Forest Satyagraha in Palnadu showed grassroots activism.

4. Post–1935 and Quit India: Communist influence rose in Telangana against feudal exploitation and vetti, culminating in the Telangana Rebellion. Andhras joined Quit India through underground protest despite repression.

Andhra Role in National Movement



Evolution of the Andhra Role

1. Elite to mass mobilisation: Elite-led moderate politics expanded into mass civil disobedience by peasants, students and workers.

2. Linguistic assertion: The Andhra Mahasabha demanded recognition of Telugu, making the struggle a dual one for freedom and regional autonomy.

Practice 8(a) on Ghissu →
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Scan to practice

3. Radicalisation: Armed agrarian revolt against feudal landlords in Telangana contrasted with the Gandhian non-violent approach elsewhere.

4. Towards statehood: In the Quit India phase, protest widened into active agitation for statehood, which after independence culminated in Potti Sriramulu's fast and the formation of Andhra State on (1) October 1953.

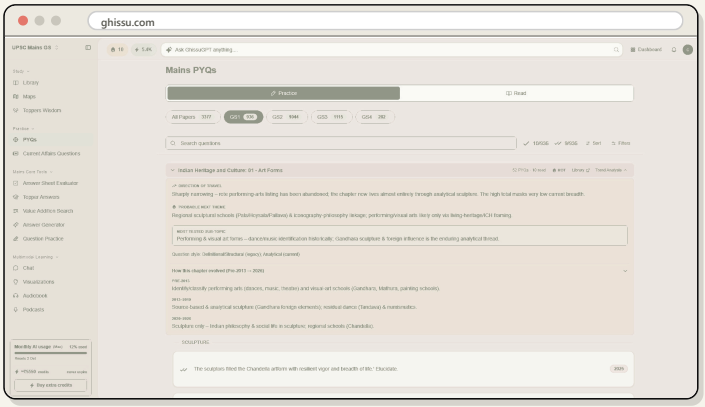
Conclusion

From early associations to mass satyagraha and agrarian revolt, the Andhras enriched every phase of the National Movement while building the demand for a separate Andhra state.

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TREND ANALYSIS, PER SUB-TOPIC

Reading everything because you can't tell what's next?



1. Direction of travel: where the questions are heading.
2. The most tested sub-topic, named.
3. The probable next theme, from decades of papers.

See the trend for your chapter →

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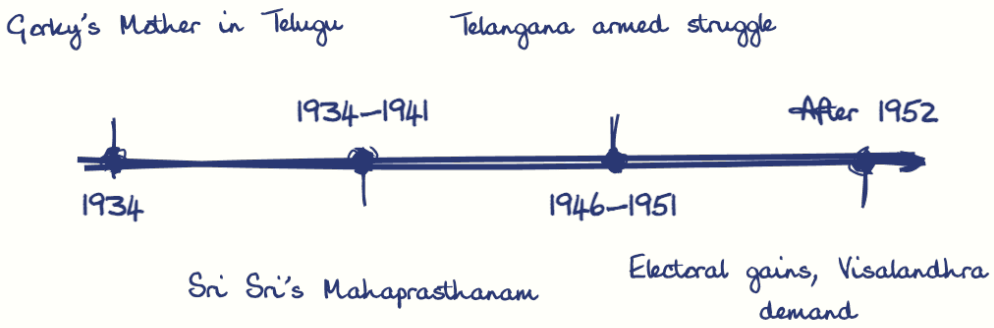
P-II
8(b)

Examine the growth and development of Communist ideology and literary contributions of the great poet Sri-Sri and others in Andhra.

Introduction

The growth of Communist ideology in Andhra is a major chapter of its socio-political and cultural history. Emerging in the 1930s and 1940s, it fed on agrarian distress and colonial oppression. The revolutionary poetry of Sri Sri and others voiced the oppressed and broke traditional literary norms.

Communism and literature in Andhra



Growth of Communist Ideology

1. Economic crisis: The 1930s depression and feudal exploitation made peasants and workers receptive. Gorky's *Mother* in Telugu (1934) and journals like *Udayini* and *Prathibha* spread Marxist thought among youth.
2. Leaders and organisations: P. Sundarayya and

Ravi Narayana Reddi mobilised peasants through fronts like the Rythu Sangam and worked within the Andhra Mahasabha.

3. Telangana armed struggle (1946–1951): Armed peasant squads challenged the Nizam's feudal regime, set up village republics and enacted radical reforms, before withdrawal amid political realignments.

4. Post-independence influence: After 1952 Communists won major electoral success and demanded Visalandhra to unite Telugu regions.

Literary Contributions of Sri Sri and Others

1. Sri Sri's revolutionary poetry: Srirangam Srinivasa Rao infused Marxism into poetry. *Mahaprasthanam* (1934–1941) used spoken Telugu to voice the aspirations of common people.

2. Challenge to tradition: The progressive school challenged elitist classical forms and made literature a tool of mass mobilisation.

3. Other poets: The Abhyudaya Rachayitala Sangham (Arasam, 1943) gathered Avudra and Somasundar, while in Telangana Dasarathi's *Agnidhara* and the people's songs of Suddala Hanmanthu carried the spirit of the armed struggle.

4. Legacy: The movement paved the way for later revolutionary writers and groups like Virasam (Viplava Rachayitala Sangham).

Way Forward

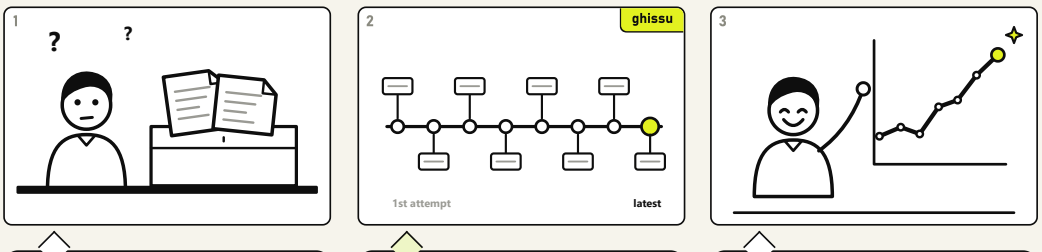
Academic research and translation of Andhra's Communist literature can preserve its socio-political significance.

Conclusion

Communist ideology in Andhra fused agrarian struggle with revolutionary poetry. Sri Sri and his peers made Telugu literature a voice of the oppressed, an influence that endures.

A STORY YOU MAY KNOW MY ANSWERS — YOUR PROGRESS

The drawer of old answers



Fifty answers in here. Am I improving? No idea.

Every attempt, scored, on one line.

The line is going up. I AM getting better.

— *You can't fix what you can't see.*

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P-II
10(b)

Critically examine the situations that led to integration of Hyderabad State into the Indian Union and later formation of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The integration of Hyderabad State into India and the later formation of Andhra Pradesh were pivotal moments in post-independence nation-building. They reveal the interplay of political sovereignty, linguistic identity and regional aspirations that shaped Indian federalism, and they still influence regional politics.

Situations Leading to Hyderabad's Integration

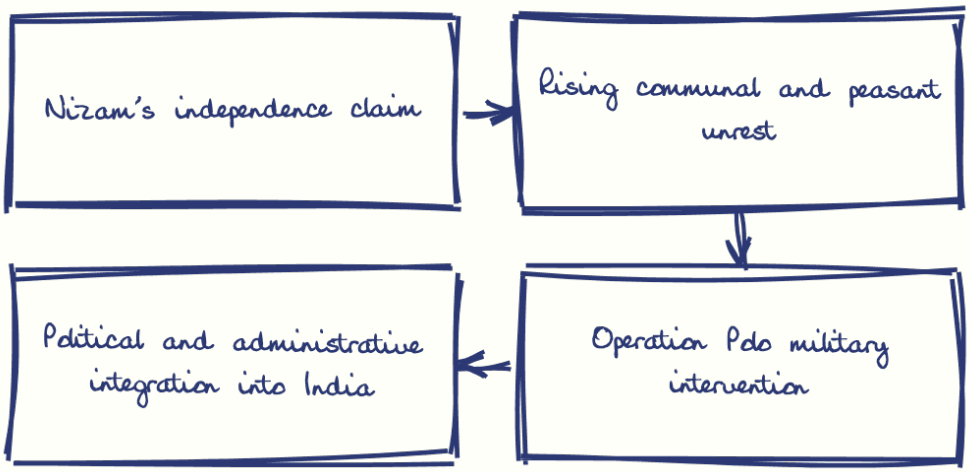
1. **Nizam's quest for independence:** The Nizam, one of the richest princes, issued a firman claiming sovereignty after 1947. India rejected it, seeing Hyderabad's strategic location and Hindu majority as integral to its unity.
2. **Communal and political unrest:** The communist-led Telangana Rebellion against feudal landlords and the Razakars' militia escalated tensions, prompting Operation Polo in 1948.
3. **Security concerns:** India refused a limited accession with neutrality guarantees, fearing other princely states would demand similar privileges. The military action was justified as restoring law and order.

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4. Integration challenges: The Nizam stayed a nominal head while separate administrative, legal and economic systems had to be merged, and local actors persuaded to accept the Republic.

Hyderabad Integration Process



Formation of Andhra Pradesh

1. Linguistic reorganisation: After Andhra State in 1953, the SRC (1955) saw Telugu-speaking Telangana as a natural partner.
2. Economic logic: Unified control of the Krishna and Godavari basins for irrigation, and Hyderabad and Secunderabad as a ready capital, favoured the merger.
3. Telangana's apprehensions: Fear of Coastal Andhra's dominance in jobs and education led to the Gentlemen's Agreement of 1956, with

safeguards such as reserving Telangana's surplus revenue for local development and jobs.

4. Delayed unification: The SRC advised that Telangana stay separate until a two-thirds vote of the Hyderabad legislature after the 1961 elections, an interregnum meant to build consensus that also reflected persistent regional distrust.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive development: Integrated irrigation in the Krishna and Godavari basins and affirmative action in education and jobs can address Telangana's historical backwardness and build trust.

Conclusion

Military action secured Hyderabad and linguistic logic created Andhra Pradesh. But unresolved regional tensions showed that integration needs equitable development, fair representation and continuous dialogue as much as law.

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APPSC GROUP-I MAINS · PAPER II

2011

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P-II
1(a)

Bring out the salient features of the Indus and Vedic Civilizations in a comparative perspective.

Introduction

The Indus and Vedic Civilizations are two foundational phases of ancient Indian history. The Indus Civilization (about 2600 to 1900 BCE) is renowned for urban sophistication, while the Vedic Civilization laid the groundwork for India's religious and social traditions.

Salient Features of the Indus Civilization

1. **Urban planning:** Harappa and Mohenjo-daro had a grid pattern, streets at right angles and separate citadel and residential areas.
2. **Drainage:** Covered drains and wells show a strong emphasis on hygiene.
3. **Standard bricks:** Baked bricks in a 4:2:1 ratio indicate centralised control.
4. **Trade:** Trade with Mesopotamia through port towns like Lothal showed maritime skill.
5. **Religion:** Worship of the Mother Goddess, Lingam and proto-Shiva, with an undeciphered script and seals.

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Salient Features of the Vedic Civilization

1. Rural society: Early Vedic tribes were pastoral, and the Rigveda has no urban references.
2. Varna and ritual: Society was stratified into varnas, with Brahmins leading fire sacrifices (yajnas).
3. Iron technology: The later Vedic period introduced iron for agriculture and warfare.
4. New towns: Towns like Kaushambi and Kampil arose later, but without planned layouts.

Indus and Vedic compared

Indus	Vedic
Planned cities, drainage	Rural, towns later
Bronze, copper, bricks	Iron tools, BRW pottery
Maritime trade	Agrarian, pastoral
Mother Goddess, proto-Shiva	Fire sacrifices (yajnas)
Undeciphered script	Sanskrit, Vedic literature

Comparative Perspective

1. Urbanisation: Planned cities versus a rural society where towns emerged later.
2. Technology and economy: Bronze tools and

maritime trade versus iron tools and an agrarian, pastoral economy.

3. Society: A less clear, possibly egalitarian or clan-based order versus a stratified varna system under Brahminical dominance.
4. Religion: Mother Goddess and proto-Shiva worship versus Vedic fire rituals, which later evolved into Puranic theism and Bhakti cults devoted to Vishnu and Shiva.
5. Language: Undeciphered non-Sanskrit script versus extensive Sanskrit literature.

Way Forward

1. Research and preservation: Better funding and technology in excavations can help decode the Indus script, while conserving Indus and Vedic sites will sustain cultural identity.

Conclusion

The Indus showed urban sophistication, while the Vedic laid India's religious, social and linguistic foundations. The shift from urban to rural and back to urban life reflects adaptation to changing conditions.

Correct, but average?
A number, a committee, a case — for every question.
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P-II
1(b)

Examine the factors responsible for the rise and growth of Jainism and Buddhism.

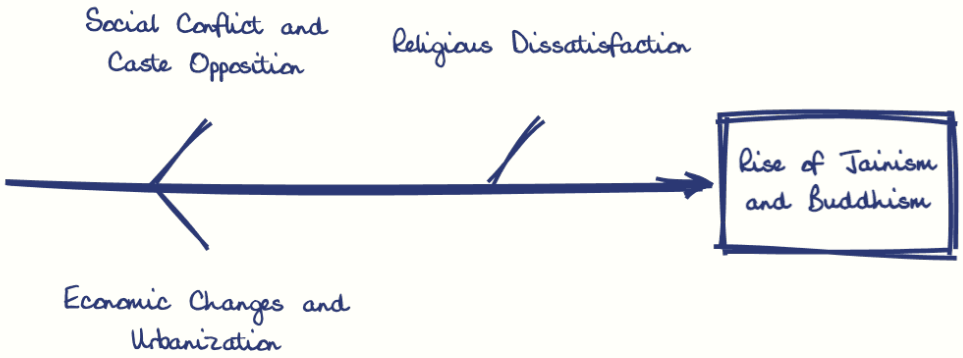
Introduction

The rise of Jainism and Buddhism in the 6th–5th centuries BCE transformed India's religious and social landscape. Emerging as responses to the rigidities and inequalities of Brahmanical society, they offered new paths to spiritual liberation and social reform.

Factors Behind Their Rise

1. **Social conflict and caste opposition:** Amid Aryan and non-Aryan tensions and an oppressive varna system, both rejected Brahmanical supremacy and admitted followers of all castes.
2. **Economic change and urbanisation:** Trade and urban centres created merchants and artisans who sought matching values. Buddhist ethics suited trade, and Jain non-violence matched mercantile ethics.
3. **Religious dissatisfaction:** Brahmanical rituals were exclusive and complex. Jain asceticism and Buddhism's middle path (Madhyamarga) offered alternatives, with self-effort (attadipa) and karma giving an ethical framework.

Factors Behind Emergence of Jainism and Buddhism



Factors Behind Their Growth

1. Royal patronage: Buddhism under Ashoka gained stupas, viharas and missionary activity across India and beyond, while Jainism enjoyed the support of princely families and spread peacefully alongside Hinduism.
2. Inclusive appeal: Buddhism admitted women to the Sangha and rejected caste, making it a liberal and democratic faith. Jainism's tolerance of Brahmanical practices let it coexist with and influence Hindu society, broadening its social base.
3. Missionary activity: Councils and missions took Buddhism to Sri Lanka, Southeast and Central Asia, aided by the Andhras. Jainism spread in the south through Kondakundacharya.
4. Ethical appeal: Both stressed moral conduct, non-violence and welfare, which resonated with

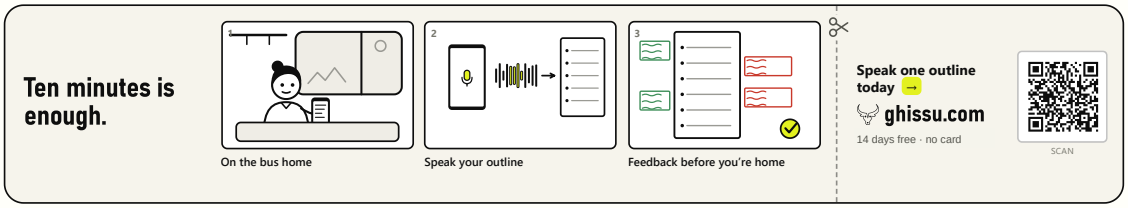
common people and merchants. Ideals like 'bahujana sukhaya' (happiness of many) fostered universal identity and cohesion.

Way Forward

1. Heritage conservation: Conserving monuments like Amaravati and Sravana Belgola will enhance cultural tourism and awareness.
2. Ethics in education: Teaching the values of non-violence, self-discipline and social welfare can foster moral development and social harmony.

Conclusion

Social, economic and religious ferment created the ground for both faiths, as they met spiritual and social needs unmet by existing traditions. Patronage, inclusiveness and missionary zeal then spread their enduring traditions in India and beyond.



P-II
2(a)

Discuss the impact of Islam on Indian culture, with special reference to the Bhakti movements.

Introduction

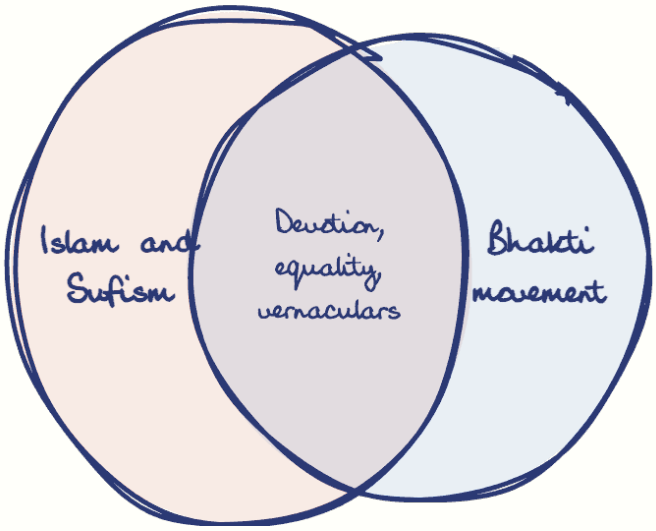
The impact of Islam on Indian culture is a profound chapter of interaction, synthesis and transformation. It shaped art, language and social norms, and influenced religious movements, notably the Bhakti movement.

Impact of Islam on Indian Culture

1. Religious synthesis: Islam introduced monotheism and egalitarian ideals that enriched India's religious landscape. Sufism blended Islamic mysticism with Indian traditions, fostering interfaith harmony.
2. Art and language: Indo-Islamic styles such as Mughal architecture emerged, along with Urdu, a blend of Persian, Arabic and local dialects, and music like Qawwali and Ghazals.
3. Literature: The spread of Islam encouraged vernacular literature and local languages for religious and poetic expression, much like Bhakti. Amir Khusrau wrote in Persian and Hindi, celebrating a shared Indian identity.

Relationship with the Bhakti Movements

Islam and Bhakti: common ground



1. **Shared devotion and equality:** Sufism and Bhakti both stressed personal devotion and rejected caste, encouraging respect and exchange.
2. **Parallel reform:** Bhakti's critique of ritual resonated with Islamic calls for justice. Kabir and Guru Nanak drew from both traditions.
3. **Influence and tension:** Bhakti absorbed Islamic monotheism and egalitarianism but kept distinct Hindu devotional practices, leading to both collaboration and occasional tension. Northern India showed more syncretism than other regions.

Bhakti and Islamic Impact

1. **Response to Islamic rule:** Conquest and temple destruction encouraged a personal, accessible

spirituality.

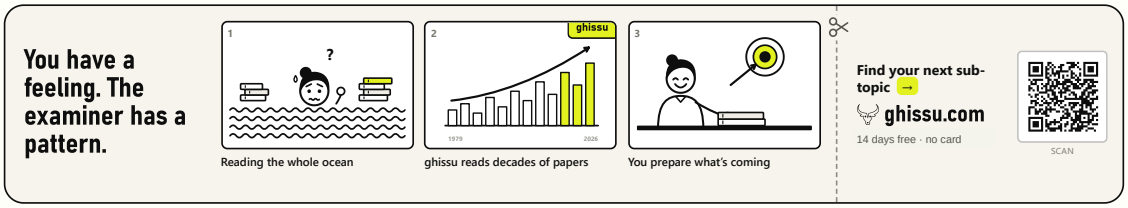
2. Vernacular languages: Bhakti poetry in local languages paralleled Sufi saints' use of vernaculars, shaping regional literature.
3. Social reform: Islamic egalitarianism reinforced Bhakti ideals of equality, inspiring later movements like Sikhism.

Way Forward

1. Interfaith dialogue: Programmes highlighting the shared values of Bhakti and Sufi traditions can strengthen communal harmony and pluralism.
2. Heritage and curriculum: Conserving sites linked to Bhakti and Sufi saints and teaching their poetry can foster appreciation of India's composite heritage.

Conclusion

The interaction of Islam with Indian traditions produced a composite culture, and the Bhakti movement was its most visible spiritual expression. Their shared values of devotion and equality still sustain India's pluralism.



P-II
2(b)

Assess the contribution of Mughals to Indian Art and Architecture with examples.

Introduction

The Mughal era is often regarded as a second classical age after the Gupta period. Historians of every school credit the Mughals with blending indigenous traditions with Persian, Turkish and Central Asian influences into a distinctive Indo-Islamic style that still shapes Indian art and architecture.

Contribution to Indian Art

1. Synthesis of styles: Persian miniature techniques merged with Indian themes, producing detailed court scenes, battles and naturalistic flora and fauna.

2. New themes and techniques: Secular subjects like royal hunts, portraits and court life, with vibrant colours and refined brushwork, as in the illustrated Akbarnama and Jahangir's portraits.

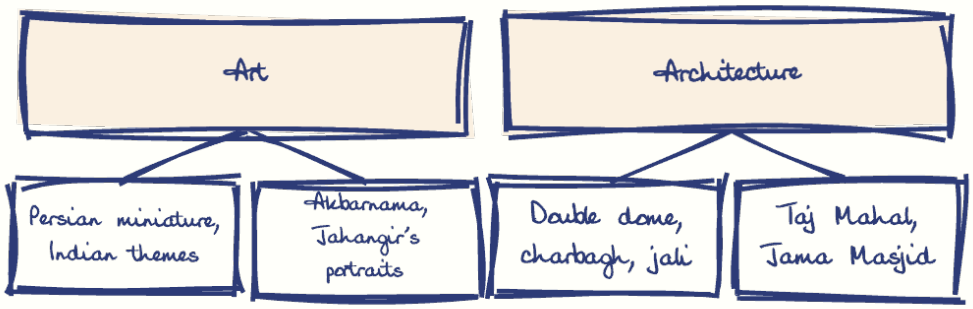
3. Imperial patronage: Akbar and Jahangir encouraged artists of diverse backgrounds, nurturing the Mughal and Rajput painting traditions.

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4. Limitations and continuity: Art stayed court-centric, yet its style permeated regional art and a composite culture.

Mughal art and architecture



Contribution to Indian Architecture

1. Indo-Islamic synthesis: Red sandstone and white marble, chhatris, jharokhas and intricate jali work balanced grandeur with elegance.
2. Structural innovation: Humayun's Tomb introduced the double dome and charbagh layout, a precursor to later mausoleums.
3. Taj Mahal: Shah Jahan's masterpiece, with its marble dome, slender minarets, pietra dura inlay and formal garden, marks the zenith of Mughal aesthetics.
4. Monumental and functional buildings: The Jama Masjid in Delhi, Moti Masjid in Agra Fort and Shalimar Bagh joined beauty with social

function.

5. Legacy and limits: Building declined under Aurangzeb's austerity, yet Mughal principles shaped regional kingdoms and Sikh architecture.

Conclusion

Though largely confined to elite patronage, Mughal art and architecture created an enduring Indo-Islamic synthesis that remains central to India's composite cultural identity, visible today from the Taj Mahal to the miniature traditions of regional courts.

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Measure progress, don't guess it

Writing more is not the same as writing better. This is how to know which one you're doing.

1. **Score everything** — Even a rough attempt gets a number.
2. **Rewrite** — The same question, one week later.
3. **Compare** — Intro, dimensions, conclusion — side by side.
4. **One fix at a time** — Track a single weakness until it's gone.

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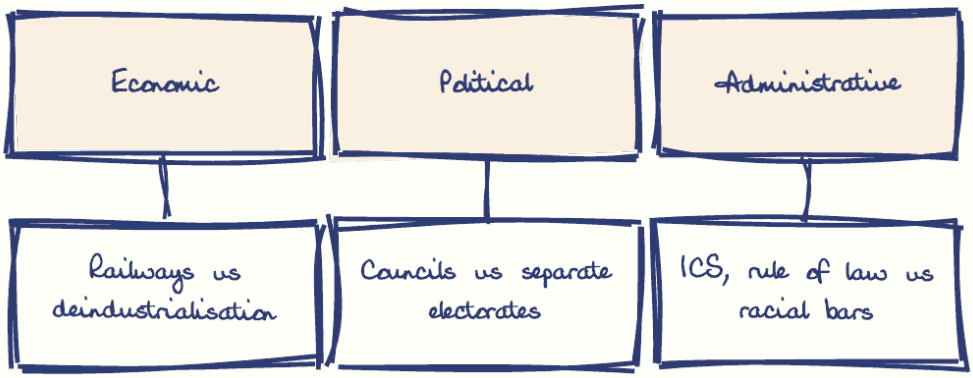
P-II
3(a)

Critically examine the Economic, Political and Administrative reforms introduced by the British in Modern India.

Introduction

British rule introduced economic, political and administrative reforms that profoundly shaped India. Driven largely by imperial interests, they also laid foundations of the modern state. Nationalists stress exploitation, others the institutions built, so a critical view sees both progress and limitation.

British reforms: gains and limits



Economic Reforms

1. Deindustrialisation: Policies favoured raw material extraction and a captive market for British goods, ruining textiles and artisans and deepening rural poverty and famines.
2. Land revenue systems: The Permanent Settlement and

Ryotwari demanded high cash taxes, causing indebtedness, dispossession and anti-zamindari agitations, including in Andhra Pradesh.

3. Infrastructure: Railways, telegraphs and roads integrated markets and, though built for extraction, prepared economic unification.

4. Limited industry: Modern railways, mining and plantations were capital-intensive and employed only a small fraction of the population, limiting broad-based development.

Political Reforms

1. Representative institutions: Legislative councils and the Government of India Acts (1909, 1919, 1935) expanded controlled Indian participation, sowing seeds of parliamentary democracy.

2. Divide and rule: The Morley-Minto Reforms (1909) created separate electorates for Muslims, entrenching divisions that culminated in partition.

3. Limited franchise: Property and education qualifications excluded most Indians, co-opting moderate elites.

4. Training ground: Legislative experience prepared leaders for the freedom struggle and state-building.

Administrative Reforms

1. Bureaucracy and rule of law: A merit-based civil service, codified laws and courts replaced informal systems.
2. Local self-government: Lord Ripon's reforms created municipal bodies and district boards to involve Indians in administration, but limited powers and resources constrained their effectiveness.
3. Racial discrimination: Barriers to higher services and the Arms Act reflected a colonial mindset of racial superiority.
4. Lasting structures: The civil service and judicial system became the backbone of independent India's administration.

Conclusion

The reforms served colonial ends and left deindustrialisation and communal division, yet the Indian Civil Service, judiciary and legislatures became the backbone of independent India's governance. India must now pursue inclusive growth and secular institutions to overcome the colonial legacy.

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P-II
3(b)

Trace the evolution of Indian Nationalism with reference to the three phases of the Freedom Struggle between the years 1885-1947.

Introduction

The evolution of Indian nationalism between 1885 and 1947 was a journey from moderate political demands to mass movements for complete independence. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians stress different facets, but the three phases of the struggle show how society progressively mobilised against colonial rule.

Phase I: Moderate Nationalism (1885–1905)

1. **Constitutional Agitation:** The Indian National Congress, formed in 1885, represented the educated middle class and sought legislative council expansion and civil service access through petitions.
2. **Economic Critique:** Dadabhai Naoroji's Drain Theory exposed colonial exploitation, but the movement stayed elitist, loyalist and without mass support.

Phase II: Extremism and Mass Awakening (1905–1919)

1. **Militant Nationalism:** The partition of Bengal and

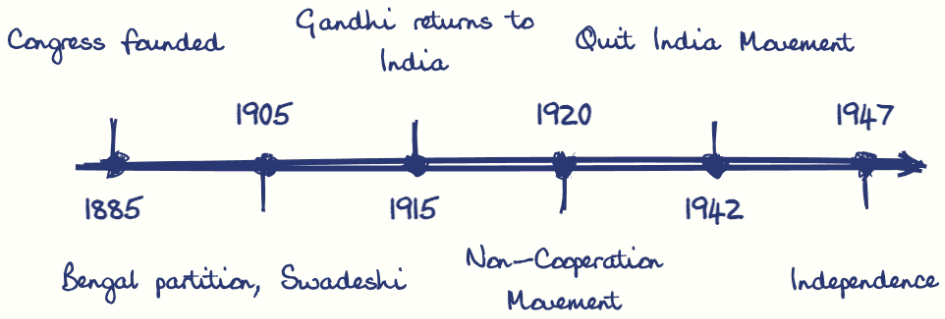
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failed moderate methods brought Tilak's demand for swaraj, swadeshi and assertive action.

2. Widening Base: Boycott spread beyond Bengal and cultural symbols united people, shifting nationalism from elite to popular.
3. New Currents: Revolutionary activity rose, and the Muslim League (1906) reflected communal assertion.

Phases of the Freedom Struggle



Phase III: Gandhian Mass Nationalism (1920–1947)

1. Satyagraha: Gandhi, back in (1915), made nonviolent civil disobedience and mass participation the core strategy.
2. Mass Movements: Non-Cooperation (1920), Civil Disobedience (1930) and Quit India (1942) drew in peasants, workers and women.
3. Culmination: Negotiations, mass arrests and

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communal tension ended in independence and partition in (1947.)

Evolution Across the Phases

Nationalism expanded from educated classes to wider sections through boycott and cultural revival, while British repression radicalised it. Gandhi then drew peasants, workers, women and tribal groups in through satyagraha, constructive work and symbols like khadi and the salt march, a mass movement the British could no longer contain.

Conclusion

Indian nationalism moved from elite constitutionalism to radical assertion and finally to inclusive, nonviolent mass struggle. Each phase built on the limits of the one before, turning a petitioning elite into a nation that ended colonial rule.

Your intro decides your marks. Q. Discuss Ashoka's Dhamma.

YOUR INTRO
~~Ashoka was a great Mauryan king who ruled after the Kalinga war and spread Buddhism everywhere.~~
✕ no date · no source · no argument

→

AFTER GHISSU EVALUATION
Ashoka's Dhamma, set out in his Major Rock Edicts after Kalinga (c. 261 BCE), was not Buddhism by another name but an ethic of tolerance, non-violence and respect, meant to hold a plural empire together.
✓ date · source · argument

ILLUSTRATIVE

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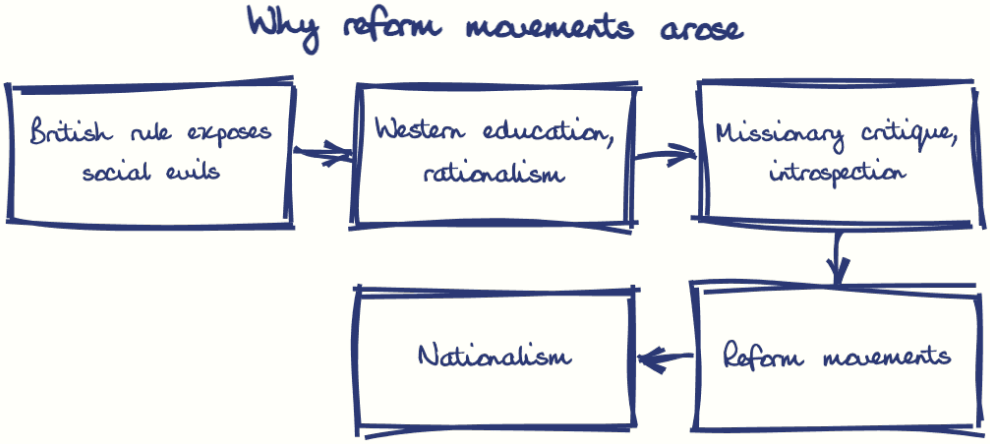
4(a) Describe the rise and growth of socio-religious reform movements in Modern India with special reference to Rajarammohan Roy, Jyotiba Phule and Narayana Guru.

Introduction

Socio-religious reform movements arose in colonial India as a response to deep-rooted social evils and rigid orthodoxy. Shaped by the encounter of Indian traditions with Western ideas of rationalism, humanism and equality, they challenged sati, caste discrimination and gender inequality, laying the base of a modern Indian identity.

Rise of the Movements

1. Colonial impact: British rule exposed stagnation and evils like sati, child marriage and caste rigidity, and created a new middle class that demanded change.
2. Western education: Enlightenment values of liberty, equality and reason inspired reformers like Rammohan Roy to challenge idol worship and priestly dominance.
3. Religious introspection: Missionary critiques prompted efforts to rationalise Hinduism by returning to Vedic roots.
4. Nationalist sentiment: Reformers believed social regeneration was essential for political freedom.



Growth and Development

1. Early initiatives: The Brahmo Samaj campaigned against sati and caste discrimination and for women's education.
2. Diversification: Movements spread across regions with different emphases, from Bengal to Maharashtra and Kerala.
3. New public sphere: Vernacular press, literature and schools questioned orthodoxy and promoted social justice.
4. Reform and revival: The Arya Samaj joined reform with Vedic revivalism, while the Brahmo Samaj stressed universalism and monotheism.

Contributions of Key Reformers

1. Raja Rammohan Roy: The father of Indian Renaissance founded the Brahmo Samaj in 1828, advocating monotheism and human

dignity. his efforts led to the abolition of sati in 1829 and promoted women's education and widow remarriage.

2. Jyotiba Phule: His Satyashodhak Samaj in Maharashtra challenged caste oppression and Brahminical supremacy. he set up the first school for girls in 1848.

3. Narayana Guru: In Kerala he fought caste discrimination and worked for social equality and temple entry rights for the oppressed.

Conclusion

From Bengal to Kerala, these reformers turned Western ideas and Indian traditions into a force for equality, laying the foundation for modern India's identity and nationalism.

REVIEWER'S NOTE · CRITICALLY EXAMINE

"Critically examine" pays for the counter-view. An answer that stops at the first view has stopped at half the marks.

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P-II
4(b)

Compare and contrast the views of Mahatma Gandhi and Ambedkar with regard to the abolition of untouchability and Harijan upliftment.

Introduction

The abolition of untouchability and Harijan upliftment was a defining social issue of the freedom struggle, shaped by Mahatma Gandhi and Dr. B.R. Ambedkar. Their contrasting approaches reflected deeper differences over caste, religion and social reform.

Gandhi's Views

1. **Reform Within Hinduism:** Untouchability was a social evil distinct from varna, which he saw as a complementary division of labour. He sought to purify Hinduism without dismantling varna.
2. **Moral Campaign:** Through nonviolence, fasts and the Harijan movement he appealed to the conscience of orthodox Hindus (sanatanis).
3. **Harijan Upliftment:** He urged education and hygiene, giving up beef and liquor, and campaigned for temple entry and access to public wells.

Ambedkar's Views

1. **Annihilation of Caste:** Untouchability was

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inseparable from the caste system, which had to be destroyed, not reformed.

2. Legal and Political Empowerment: He stressed constitutional safeguards, separate electorates (initially) and political rights.
3. Critique of Scriptures: He denounced texts like Manusmriti for legitimising caste discrimination.
4. Independent Identity: He rejected "Harijan" as patronising and sought Dalit self-representation.

Gandhi vs Ambedkar on Untouchability

Mahatma Gandhi	Dr. B.R. Ambedkar
Reform Hinduism	Annihilate caste
Moral persuasion	Legal-political empowerment
Harijan upliftment, trusteeship	Dalit self-assertion
Opposed separate electorates	Demanded separate electorates

Comparison and Contrast

1. Ideology: Gandhi was spiritual and reformist; Ambedkar was radical and structural.
2. Methods: Gandhi relied on moral appeals, nonviolent mass mobilisation and voluntary change;

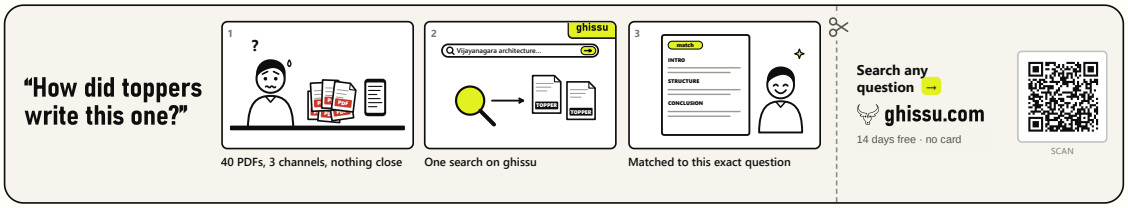
Ambedkar on constitutional rights, political representation and legal measures.

3. Role of Religion: Gandhi used Hindu symbols to reach the masses; Ambedkar rejected Hinduism as oppressive and promoted secularism and freedom of religion.

4. Political Strategy: Gandhi opposed separate electorates, fearing division of Hindu society, which led to the Poona Pact; Ambedkar sought them to secure a Dalit voice.

Conclusion

Gandhi sought a change of heart within Hinduism, while Ambedkar demanded a change of structure. Together they shaped India's social justice agenda.



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P-II
5(a)

Account for the rise and growth of peasant and working class movements and their contribution in anti-feudal and anti-colonial struggles.

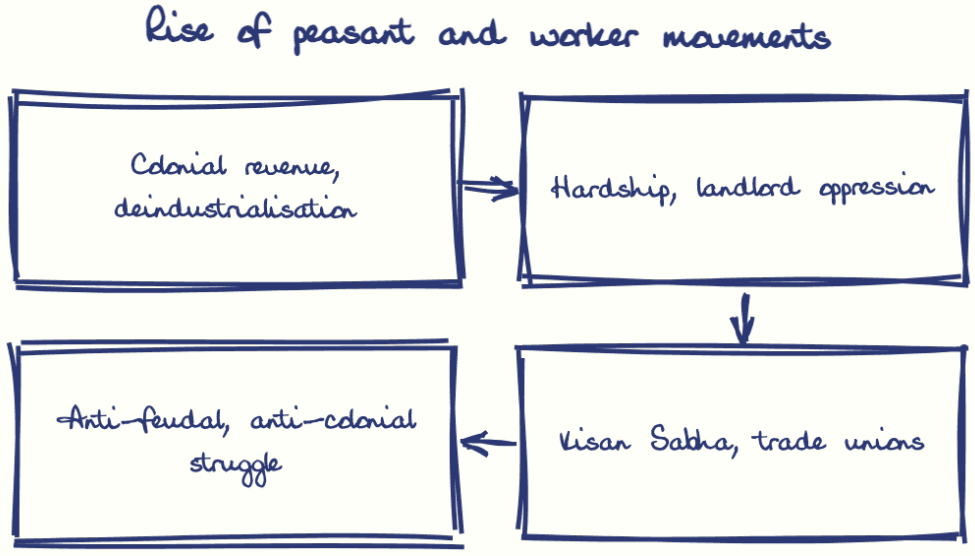
Introduction

The rise of peasant and working class movements marked a critical phase in colonial India's transformation. Marxist and subaltern historians see them as class struggles against feudal exploitation and colonial oppression, intertwined with the anti-colonial national movement.

Causes of Their Rise and Growth

1. Colonial Exploitation: Zamindari and Ryotwari revenue systems imposed heavy taxes and caused widespread peasant indebtedness, fuelling agrarian distress and unrest.
2. Destruction of Livelihoods: Deindustrialisation and the collapse of handicrafts pushed artisans and peasants into landlessness and poverty, swelling the working class.
3. Feudal Oppression: Zamindars and moneylenders, empowered by colonial laws, extracted exorbitant rents and resorted to eviction and forced labour.
4. Political Organisation: Nationalist and leftist leaders politicised peasants and workers, building the Kisan Sabha and trade unions.

Thus colonial policies produced hardship and oppression, which led to mobilisation and finally to political consciousness and organisation.



Contribution to Anti-Feudal Struggles

1. Challenging Landlords: Movements like the Eka Movement and the Telangana Rebellion demanded the abolition of intermediaries and fair land rights.
2. Uniting the Marginalised: They united landless labourers and outcastes against feudal hierarchies, weakening caste-based oppression and promoting social equity.
3. Forcing Land Reforms: Sustained pressure led to the abolition of zamindari and land redistribution, especially in Andhra Pradesh.
4. Autonomous Rural Spaces: Village organisations and

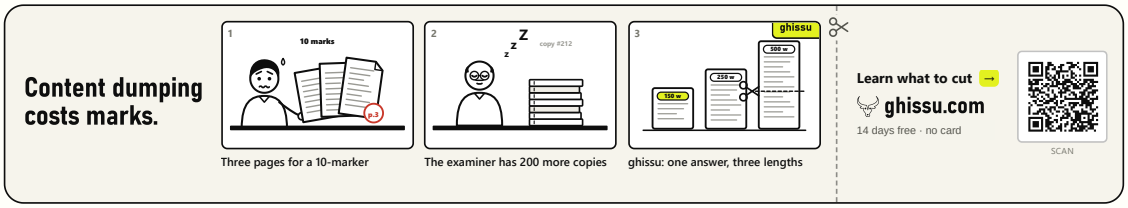
"Dalams" in the Telangana struggle asserted self-governance.

Contribution to Anti-Colonial Struggles

1. Merging Agendas: Kisan Sabha members joined Congress-led movements, linking agrarian and labour issues with nationalism.
2. Sustaining Mass Action: Strikes, protests and boycotts amplified the Champaran Satyagraha and the Quit India Movement.
3. Radicalisation: Communist and socialist leaders introduced militant tactics and class consciousness.
4. Exposing Colonialism: Their struggles revealed colonial exploitation to national and international audiences, strengthening the legitimacy of the independence movement.

Conclusion

Peasant and working class movements fought feudal and colonial power together. They widened the freedom struggle into a fight for social justice and left a lasting agenda of agrarian reform and labour rights.



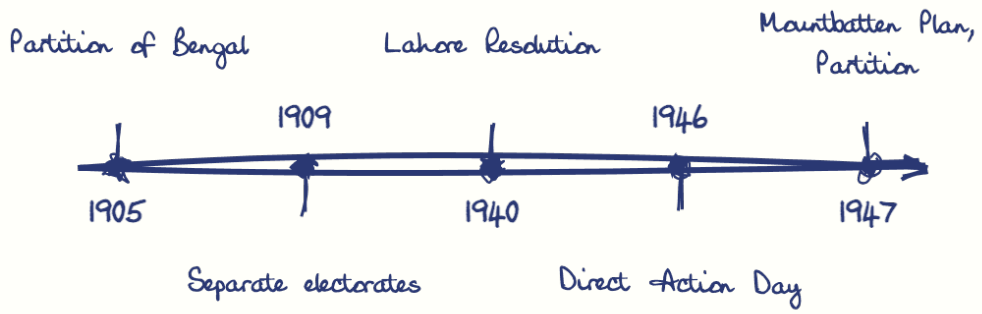
P-II
5(b)

Trace the course of events leading to the Partition of India in 1947.

Introduction

The Partition of India in (1947) ended nearly two centuries of British rule but also led to unprecedented communal violence and mass displacement. It was the culmination of colonial strategy, communal mobilisation and the failure of constitutional negotiations.

Road to Partition



Early Roots of Division

1. Divide and Rule: The partition of Bengal in (1905) aimed to weaken nationalist unity, and separate electorates in the Morley–Minto Reforms (1909) institutionalised religious identities.
2. Rise of the Muslim League: Founded in (1906) to serve elite Muslim interests, it evolved under Jinnah to demand a homeland, the

Two-Nation Theory formalised in the Lahore Resolution of 1940.

3. Communal Mobilisation: The Hindu Mahasabha and RSS alongside the League polarised communities, while Muslim educational and economic backwardness fuelled fears of Hindu domination.

Failure of Constitutional Negotiations

1. Early Attempts: The Nehru Report and the Round Table Conferences failed to bridge differences over representation.
2. War Years: The Cripps Mission (1942) offered no immediate independence and the League rejected it, while the Wavell Plan and Simla Conference (1945) deadlocked over Muslim representation.
3. Cabinet Mission Plan (1946): It collapsed over irreconcilable differences on power-sharing between Congress and the League.

The Final Phase

1. Direct Action Day: The League's call in August (1946) triggered the Great Calcutta Killing, making coexistence seem impossible.
2. British Expediency: A weakened post-war

Britain prioritised a swift exit over careful planning.

3. Mountbatten Plan: It let the Punjab and Bengal assemblies decide on partition, and the Indian Independence Act of July 1947 created India and Pakistan on August 15, 1947.

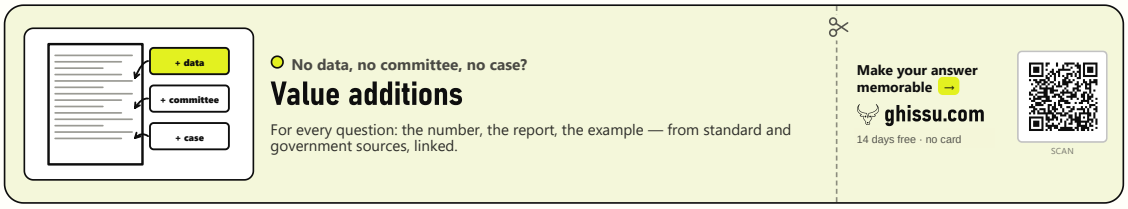
4. Human Cost: About 15 million were displaced and hundreds of thousands killed, especially in Punjab and Bengal.

Way Forward

1. Healing the Legacy: Curricula that stress secularism, stronger minority safeguards, preserving oral histories of Partition and India–Pakistan dialogue can build lasting peace.

Conclusion

Partition was the tragic outcome of decades of political failure, communal division and colonial expediency, leaving a legacy of animosity that calls for secularism and inclusive representation.



P-II
6(a)

Discuss the socio-economic and religious conditions during the period of Satavahanas in Ancient Andhra Desha.

Introduction

The Satavahana period is a significant chapter in the history of Ancient Andhra Desha. It saw the growth of agriculture, trade and towns, while religious pluralism shaped the cultural fabric of society.

Satavahana economy and faith in Andhra



Krishna–Godavari rice bowl, ports and Buddhist centres

Socio-Economic Conditions

1. Agricultural Prosperity: The fertile tracts between the Krishna and Godavari were major rice bowls,

and tax-free land grants to Brahmanas and Buddhist monks encouraged settlement and cultivation.

2. Urban Growth and Trade: Towns like Prathisthana, Amaravati and Sopara thrived as hubs, supported by guilds (srenis) and civic bodies (nigama sabhas). Ships on coins and ports like Machilipatnam show overseas trade.

3. Crafts and Currency: Lead, copper and bronze coins reflect a monetised economy, while iron tools and minerals in Karimnagar and Warangal boosted production.

4. Social Organisation: Feudatories and village officials like the gramani formed a hierarchy, and villagers often faced harassment. Caste grew rigid, yet foreign settlers were assimilated as Kshatriyas.

Religious Conditions

1. Religious Pluralism: Brahmanism, Buddhism and Jainism flourished together. Rulers backed Vedic rituals but also granted land to monks, fostering Mahayana centres at Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda.

2. Transformation of Ritualism: Orthodox Vedic practice shifted towards inclusive Puranic theism,

responding to heterodox faiths that stressed purity and non-violence.

3. Religion and Legitimacy: Kings performed asvamedha and rajasuya, and Gautamiputra Satakarni upheld the varna system and suppressed foreign invaders.

4. Cultural Synthesis: Faiths and local cults borrowed from each other, and tribal beliefs merged with Brahmanical and Buddhist traditions, producing a syncretic Andhra culture.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Conservation: Preserving Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda can sustain cultural memory and tourism.

2. Plural Narratives: Teaching this multireligious heritage in Andhra Pradesh's schools can deepen regional identity and foster communal harmony.

Conclusion

The socio-economic and religious conditions of the Satavahana period laid the foundation for a culturally rich and economically vibrant Andhra Desha, a dynamic synthesis of tradition and innovation that still shapes its identity.

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P-II
6(b)

Write an essay on the growth of Buddhism in Ancient Andhra Desha and the salient features of Buddhist Art and Architecture with examples.

Introduction

Buddhism reached Ancient Andhra Desha even before Asoka's Third Buddhist Council. Strategic location, economic prosperity and tribal republics made it a strong social and spiritual force, and its art and architecture still enrich India's heritage.

Buddhist sites of ancient Andhra



Gold-rich Kurnool–Anantapur and the delta funded stupas

Growth of Buddhism in Andhra

1. **Early Advent and Tribal Patronage:** Evidence shows Buddhism entered before Asoka, backed by tribal

republics like the Sebakas and Somakas as a means of upliftment and identity.

2. Economic Prosperity: The fertile Krishna delta and gold-rich Kurnool-Anantapur region enriched Gahapatis and Settis, who became chief patrons of stupas and monasteries.

3. Social Inclusivity: It appealed to marginalised groups like women and Sudras by offering spiritual equality and rationalism, against a Brahmanical exclusivism that branded Andhras as Mlechchas.

4. Scholars and Missions: Acharya Nagarjuna and Buddhaghosa shaped Buddhist philosophy and spread the faith to Sri Lanka and Burma.

Salient Features of Art and Architecture

1. Stupa-Centric Architecture: Large circular or apsidal stupas enshrining relics, monumental in scale and richly carved with religious narratives.

2. Sculptural Naturalism: The Amaravati school is known for dynamic, flowing high-relief sculptures of the Buddha's life.

3. Local Synthesis: Tribal and megalithic motifs were blended with Buddhist symbols, making art accessible to local people.

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4. Monastic Learning Centres: Viharas were not only religious sites but hubs of education and manuscript production, preserving and spreading Buddhist teachings.

Examples

1. Dhanyakataka Stupa: Near Amaravati, its panels of Jataka tales show Andhra's artistic excellence.
2. Nagarjunakonda: Its monasteries, stupas and inscriptions made it a major Buddhist intellectual hub in Andhra.
3. Bhattiprolu: Relics and the Yaksha and Yakshi figures show Prakrit and proto-Telugu use and local integration.
4. Influence Abroad: Amaravati-style Buddha images at Dong-duong in Vietnam show Andhra's cultural export.

Conclusion

Buddhism in Andhra grew from economic prosperity, tribal and merchant patronage and social reform. It produced a distinctive art whose influence reached far beyond India, a heritage that deserves strong conservation and research.

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Index · page 6

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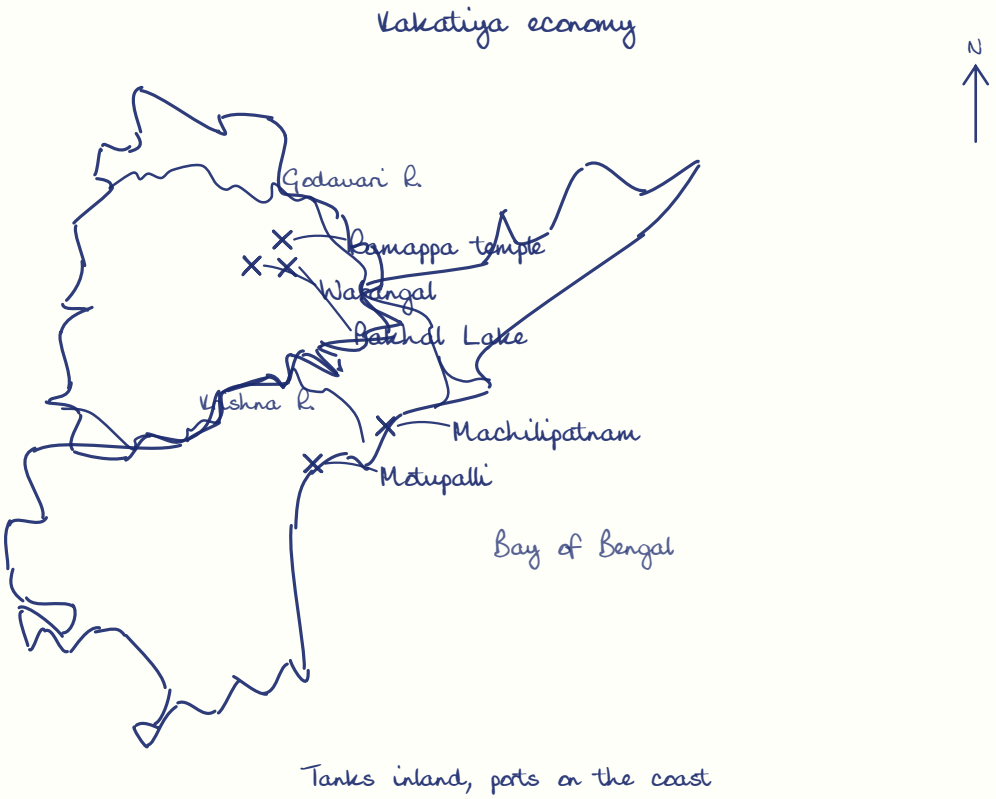
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P-II
7(a)

Describe the socio-economic conditions in Medieval Andhra Desha with special reference to the Kakatiyas.

Introduction

The Kakatiya dynasty, ruling from the 12th to the early 14th century with Warangal as its capital, consolidated fragmented Telugu territories. Its indigenous governance, agrarian reforms and trade promotion shaped the socio-economic life of Medieval Andhra Desha.



Social Conditions

1. Flexible Caste Hierarchy: The ruling dynasty

itself came from the Shudra varna, challenging orthodox norms and raising warriors and merchants to prominence.

2. Nayankara System: Rudrama Devi delegated administrative and military power to Nayakas from castes like the Velamas, Reddis and Kammas.

3. Village Administration: Villages were grouped into Nadus and Sthalams, with officials like the Sthala Karanam and Sthala Tirpari managing accounts and tax.

4. Women and Reform: Rudrama Devi ruled as sovereign, and Virasaivism and figures like Brahma Nayudu opened temple access to Dalits.

Economic Conditions

1. Irrigation: Large tanks like Pakala and Ramappa and canals gave every village a reservoir, making the empire self-sufficient in food grains.

2. Land Revenue: Land tax, assessed by soil fertility and collected by local officials, was the main source of revenue, reflecting a systematic agrarian economy.

3. Trade Promotion: Commercial complexes called Pentas had godowns and shops, and goods at

weekly fairs were taxed.

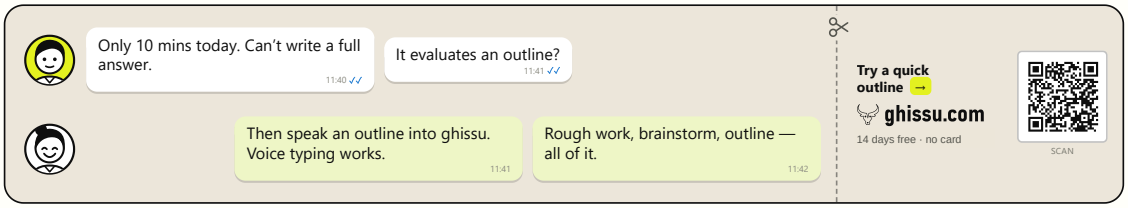
4. Maritime Trade: Motupalli and Machilipatnam drew merchants from China, Sri Lanka and Rome, trading textiles, diamonds and spices for horses and silk. Ganapati Deva's ~~Abhaya~~ Sasanam protected merchants.

Impact on Society and Economy

1. Decentralised Monarchy: Delegation to Nayakas made local rule efficient but sowed the seeds of later feudal conflict.
2. Infrastructure: Investment in irrigation and road networks raised productivity and linked rural economies with Warangal.
3. Guilds and Mobility: Warrior-merchant guilds, the Vira Banajigas, kept routes safe and let economic roles cross caste lines.

Conclusion

Kakatiya rule combined social flexibility, decentralised governance and agrarian and commercial growth, laying the foundation of Andhra's medieval society and economy.



P-II
7(b)

Evaluate the contribution of Qutub Shahis to the Telugu language and literature.

Introduction

The Qutub Shahi dynasty ruled Golconda from the early 16th to the late 17th century. Despite their Persian–Turkic origins and Islamic faith, they embraced Telugu language and literature, fostering a cultural synthesis that reflects the pluralistic ethos of the Deccan.

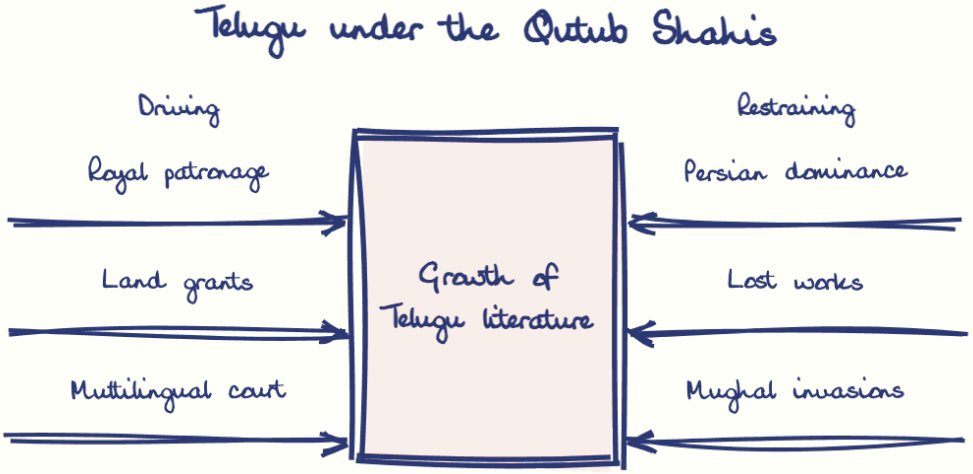
Telugu Literary Flourishing

1. **Royal Patronage:** Ibrahim Quli Qutub Shah, influenced by his exile in Vijayanagara, hosted poetry sessions and honoured Addanki Gangadhara Kavi and Kandukuri Rudrakavi with land grants and titles.
2. **Literary Works:** Ponnegenta Telaganaraya's Yayaticharitam was the first work in Accha Telugu, and Saranga Thammaiah wrote Vaijayanthi Vilasam. Kshetrayya of Mawa village in Krishna district composed over a thousand padas still popular today.
3. **Court Culture:** Telugu poets like Ganesha Pandit served as court poets, and Kancharla Gopanna (Bhakta Ramadas) composed classical keerthanas.

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4. Multilingual Environment: Telugu coexisted with Persian, Urdu and Arabic, gaining cross-cultural enrichment.



Challenges and Limitations

1. Religious Differences: Muslim rule over a mainly Hindu region made some works cautious on religious themes.
2. Loss of Works: Muhammad Quli is said to have written Telugu poetry, but none survives.
3. Persian Dominance: Persian stayed the court language and Urdu rose later, confining Telugu to a regional domain.
4. Instability: Mughal invasions and internal strife broke the continuity of patronage, especially in the Krishna-Godavari delta.

Way Forward

1. **Preservation and Study:** Digitising surviving manuscripts and teaching this literature in Telangana and Andhra Pradesh can revive awareness of this composite heritage.

Conclusion

On balance, the Qutub Shahis made a genuine contribution to Telugu through patronage and a multilingual court that produced poets like Kshetrayya and Bhakta Ramadas, even though Persian dominance, political instability and lost texts limit the full picture.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON TREND ANALYSIS, PER SUB-TOPIC

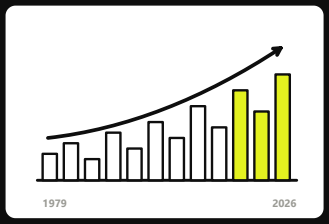
Read a chapter's past before its pages

Twenty minutes of this before a new chapter tells you where to spend the next twenty hours.

1. **List** — Every question asked from the chapter in the last ten years.
2. **Circle** — Sub-topics asked twice or more.
3. **Notice the shift** — Facts to analysis? National to State? Old to current?
4. **Read** — The circled sub-topics first; the rest second.

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Every syllabus topic already has its trend analysis: direction of travel, most tested sub-topic, probable next theme.



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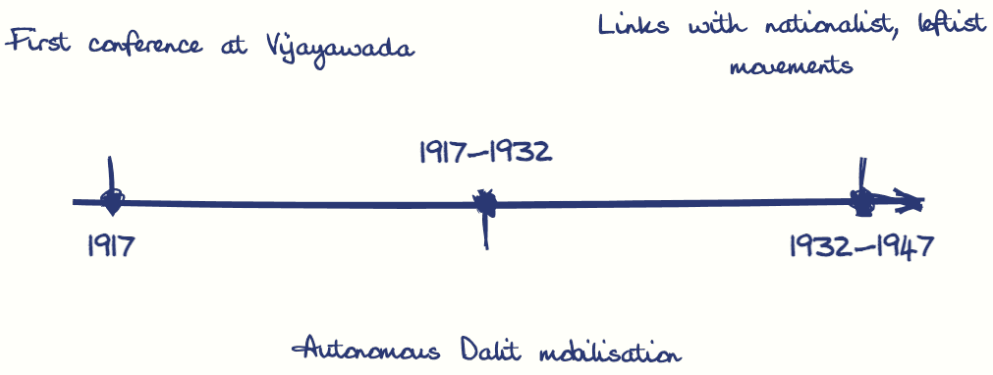
P-II
8(a)

Trace the origin and growth of Adi-Andhra Movement in Modern Andhra Desha and examine the role of Gurram Jashuva and Boyi Bheemanna in the growth of Dalit consciousness.

Introduction

The Adi-Andhra Movement emerged in the early 20th century as a significant assertion of Dalit identity in modern Andhra Desha. Rooted in colonial-era anti-caste currents, it demanded equality, education and political representation. Gurram Jashuva and Boyi Bheemanna enriched it by giving Dalit experience a literary voice.

Growth of the Adi-Andhra Movement



Origin and Growth of the Movement

1. **Early influences:** Inspired by the Brahmo and Arya Samaj, leaders like Bhagya Reddi Varma organised the first Adi-Andhra Conference at

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Vijayawada in 1917, demanding representation and upliftment.

2. Educational mobilisation: Vemuri Ramjee and Brahmo leaders set up schools and hostels for Dalit children, producing the first Dalit intellectuals of coastal Andhra.

3. Two phases: The first (1917–1932) saw autonomous mobilisation, the second (1932–1947) saw interaction with nationalist and leftist movements. The Adi-Andhra Mahasabha rejected sub-caste labels like Mala and Madiga.

4. Challenges: Upper-caste opposition and limited coordination with the Justice Party and Congress constrained it, yet it rooted Dalit assertion in East Godavari and Krishna.

Role of Gurram Jashuva

1. Voice of oppression: His poem "Gabbilam" (The Bat) symbolically critiqued exclusion and called for dignity and equality.

2. Cultural assertion: He reclaimed Dalit identity against Brahminical dominance, building pride that crossed internal divisions.

3. Critique of nationalism: He argued swaraj

was impossible without the annihilation of caste, since Dalits were sidelined despite talk of unity.

4. Legacy: He inspired later Dalit leaders and intellectuals in Andhra Pradesh.

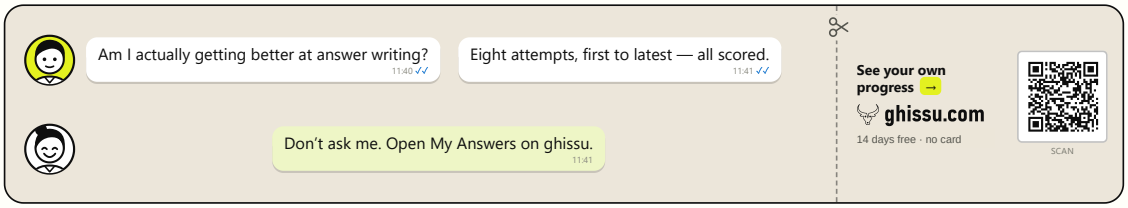
Role of Boyi Bheemanna

1. Champion of Dalit literature: A prominent writer and social reformer, he vividly portrayed the hardships and aspirations of Dalits, adding to cultural resistance.

2. Paleru: His play on the life of a bonded farm servant urged Dalits to break servitude through education, inspiring many Dalit youth in coastal Andhra.

Conclusion

The movement's political demands and the literary resistance of Jashuva and Bheemanna together built a lasting Dalit consciousness in Andhra Pradesh.



8(b) Critically examine the role of Socialists and Communists in the Freedom Movements in Andhra Desha between the years 1935-1947.

Introduction

Between 1935 and 1947, Socialists and Communists played pivotal roles in Andhra Desha's freedom movements alongside the Congress. Nationalist and Marxist historians debate their impact. A critical look shows how they linked freedom with social justice, and where they fell short.

Socialists and Communists, 1935–1947

Socialists	Communists
Journals like Prajamitra	Peasant sanghams in Telangana
Ranga's Kisan movement	Anti-Nizam alliance
Worked within Congress	Armed struggle
Urban, divided base	Repression, limited acceptance

Role of the Socialists

1. Youth mobilisation: T. Gopichand and M. N. Roy popularised socialist and Marxist ideas through journals like *Prajamitra*, drawing

youth to radical change.

2. Peasant and labour movements: Prof. N. G. Ranga organised the Kisan Movement; peasants in Srikakulam fought zamindari exploitation. The party's Andhra unit, set up in Vijayawada in 1934, raised agrarian issues.

3. Within the Congress: They pushed radical economic reform and joined Quit India, though their agenda caused tension with the leadership.

4. Limitations: Their appeal stayed confined to urban intellectuals and some rural pockets, and internal divisions weakened them.

Role of the Communists

1. Grassroots sanghams: In Telangana, peasant sanghams resisted vetti, forced grain levies and evictions, laying the base of the Telangana Armed Struggle.

2. Anti-Nizam alliance: Working through the Andhra Mahasabha and with the Hyderabad State Congress, Ravi Narayana Reddi and Chandra Rajeswara Rao linked agrarian revolt with integration into India.

3. Cadre building: Political schools and fronts like

the Comrades Association sustained resistance during bans and repression.

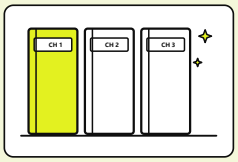
4. Limitations: Police action and repression followed, the armed approach alienated some sections and invited harsh state response, limiting wider acceptance.

Critical Assessment

Both advanced agrarian and labour rights: Socialist Kisan movements and Communist sanghams brought relief and political awareness to the rural poor. The Communist alliance also helped end the Nizam's autocratic rule, while Socialists strengthened Quit India. Yet Socialist divisions and the costs of armed struggle meant neither built a mass base like the Congress.

Conclusion

Socialists and Communists radicalised Andhra's freedom struggle by fusing it with social justice and agrarian reform. Their contribution was real, but internal division, narrow bases and state repression limited their reach and lasting acceptance.



Notes in five notebooks, none at hand?

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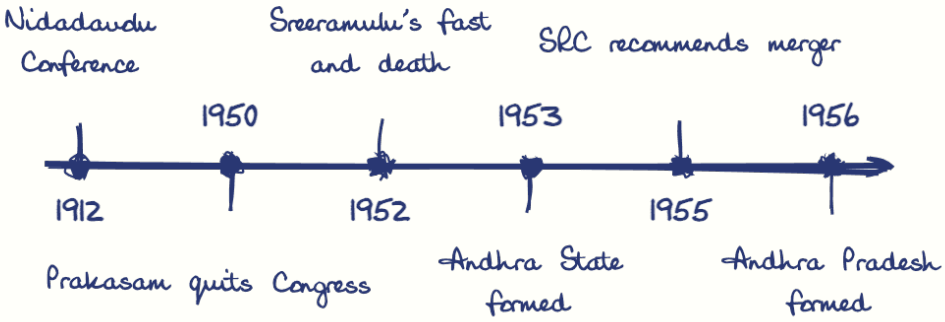
SCAN

10(b) Trace the course of events leading to the formation of Andhra Pradesh.

Introduction

The formation of Andhra Pradesh is a landmark in the history of linguistic reorganisation in India. Rooted in long socio-political movements, the demand was catalysed by Potti Sreeramulu's death in 1952. Its course shows the interplay of regional identity, political activism and constitutional process.

Course of events



Course of Events

1. Early Andhra movement: The Nidadavolu Conference of 1912 made the first formal call for a Telugu province within the Madras Presidency, driven by Telugus who felt marginalised under Tamil-dominated administration.

2. Pre-1950s agitations: From the early 1900s, Andhra Mahasabhas and regional conferences

consistently pressed for linguistic recognition and administrative autonomy within the Madras Presidency.

3. Post-independence pressure (1947–1953): T. Prakasam resigned from the Congress in (1950) over the issue, and pro-Andhra parties won success in the (1951) Madras Assembly elections.

4. Sreeramulu's fast (1952): Potti Sreeramulu's death after (58) days of fasting in December (1952) caused mass protests and forced Nehru to announce Andhra State.

5. Andhra State (1953): Carved out on October (1), (1953), excluding Madras city but including the Telugu districts, it was the first linguistic state of independent India and a precedent for later reorganisations.

6. Visalandhra and the SRC: The Visalandhra Mahasabha campaigned for a united Telugu state, and the States Reorganisation Commission (1955) recommended merging Telangana, citing administrative convenience and river basin management.

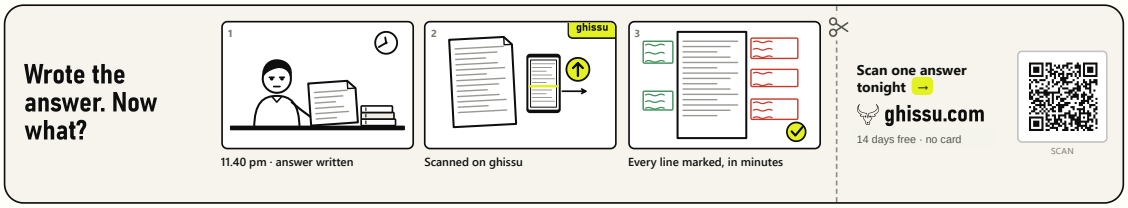
7. Andhra Pradesh (1956): The Gentlemen's Agreement sought to protect Telangana's interests, and Andhra Pradesh was formed on November (1), (1956) with Hyderabad as capital.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive development: Schemes for historically marginalised areas like Telangana and Rayalaseema can foster balanced growth.
2. River basin cooperation: Integrated management of the Godavari and Krishna basins can support sustainable agriculture.
3. Shared identity: Celebrating Telugu heritage while promoting a common identity can strengthen cohesion.
4. Regional autonomy: Institutional frameworks can ensure equitable representation for all regions.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh was achieved through sustained political struggle and sacrifice, notably by Potti Sreeramulu. It reflected the aspirations of Telugu people for cultural and administrative identity and set a precedent for future linguistic reorganisations.



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2008

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P-II
1(a)

Compare and contrast the salient features of Early Vedic and Later Vedic civilisations in political, social, economic and religious fields.

10

Introduction

The Vedic period, spanning roughly 1500 to 600 BCE, saw a transition from the Early (Rig) Vedic pastoral society to the Later Vedic agrarian kingdoms. This shaped the political, social, economic and religious contours of ancient India.

Political and Social Fields

Early vs Later Vedic Polity and Society

Early Vedic	Later Vedic
Elected tribal chiefs	Hereditary kings, territorial kingdoms
Sabha and Samiti strong	Sabha declined, Samiti faded
Women had higher status	Decline in women's status
Kinship, no strict caste	Gotra system, caste stratification

1. Tribe to kingdom: Small pastoral tribes led by elected chiefs and assemblies like the Sabha and Samiti gave way to janapadas under hereditary kings with centralised authority.

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2. Social stratification: A fluid society where women joined assemblies and education became a rigid varna system, with child marriage and sati emerging.
3. Caste formation: Later Vedic society formalised lineage through the gotra system, reinforcing endogamy.

Economic Field

1. Pastoral to agrarian: Cattle wealth and barter gave way to settled farming through iron tools, forest clearing and the plough.
2. Taxation: Informal voluntary offerings became taxes like bali, shulka and bhaga, managed by officials like the Sangrihitri.

Religious Field

1. Ritual complexity: Nature worship and simple yajnas to Indra and Agni grew into Brahmin-led rituals like Ashwamedha and Vajapeya. Prajapati, Vishnu and Rudra rose, and Upanishadic philosophy emerged.

Continuities

1. Family and assemblies: The patriarchal joint family remained the social unit, and tribal

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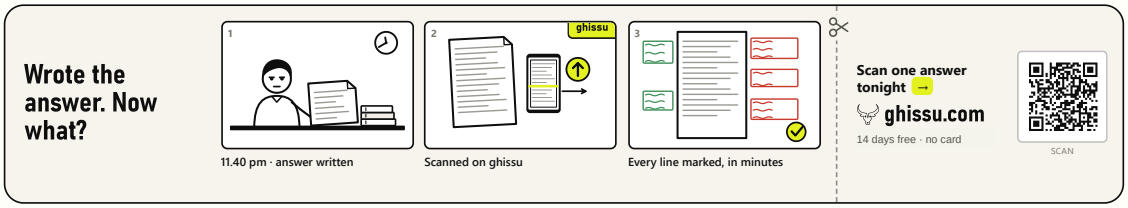
assemblies survived in changed roles.

2. Religion and crafts: Polytheism and fire sacrifices stayed central, and copper and bronze were used in both eras.

Thus the change was one of degree in religion and family life, but of kind in polity and economy, where the shift to iron, agriculture and taxation created territorial states.

Conclusion

The Vedic age moved from tribal, pastoral and relatively egalitarian life to agrarian, hierarchical kingdoms with elaborate ritual and growing state capacity. This transformation laid the groundwork for later Indian society and culture.



P-II
1(b)

Analyse the factors that contributed for the growth of Magadhan imperialism.

10

Introduction

The rise of Magadhan imperialism laid the foundation for the first great empire in northern India. It resulted from a confluence of geographical, economic, political and military factors that let Magadha dominate rival states.

Geographical and Economic Factors

1. Favourable location: Rajagriha was naturally fortified by five hills, while Pataliputra at the confluence of the Ganga, Son and Gandak controlled vital trade routes.
2. Rich resources: Fertile alluvial soil gave food surplus, forests supplied timber and elephants, and the mineral-rich Chotanagpur plateau supplied raw materials for weapons and tools.
3. Trade and commerce: River systems aided trade, while towns and metallic currency enabled rulers to finance armies and administration.

Political and Military Factors

1. Enterprising rulers: Bimbisara, Ajatasatru and Mahapadma Nanda expanded territory through conquest and matrimonial alliances with

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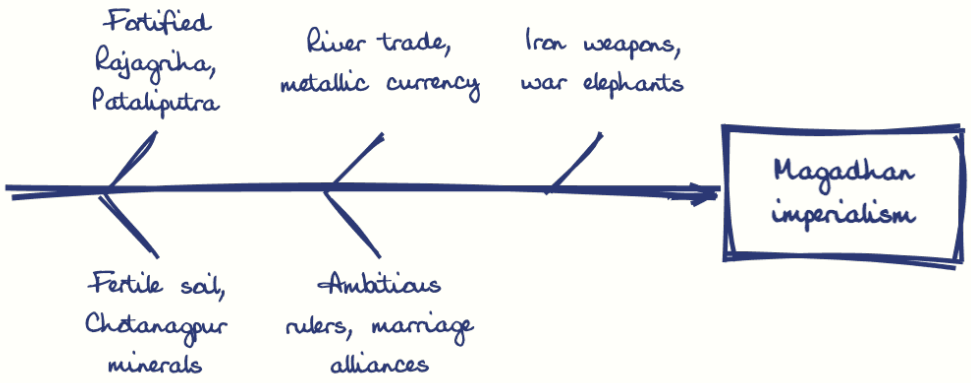
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neighbouring families, which raised diplomatic prestige.

2. Hereditary ministers: Continuity of ministerial offices ensured stable governance and effective policy, critical for imperial ambition.

3. Military strength: Iron weaponry and war elephants, backed by efficient resource extraction, sustained a large standing army that subdued rivals like Avanti.

Rise of Magadhan imperialism



Challenges Overcome

1. Powerful neighbours: Avanti delayed Magadhan supremacy for about a century, showing that resources alone did not guarantee victory.

2. Integration of territories: Diverse populations and regions required effective administrative control and military presence to prevent rebellion.

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3. New pressures: Persian and Macedonian incursions in the northwest pushed Magadhan rulers to consolidate their core territories and extend influence.

Conclusion

Magadhan imperialism was a multifaceted process driven by strategic geography, resource wealth, able leadership and military power, which reinforced one another. It shaped ancient Indian polity and set a precedent for later empires like the Mauryas. Its statecraft still offers lessons for governance and unity in diversity.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON EXAM-HALL THINKING

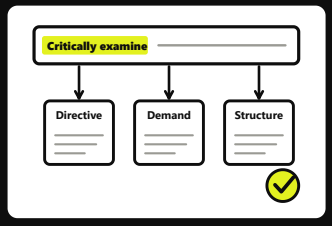
Decode the directive before you write

The directive word is an instruction. The marking scheme follows it — so should your answer.

1. **Discuss** — Both sides, then a verdict. The verdict carries marks.
2. **Critically examine** — The counter-view is compulsory — then commit to a judgement.
3. **Examine** — Causes, features and consequences, kept separate.
4. **Elucidate** — Make it clear with one example for every point.

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P-II
2(a)

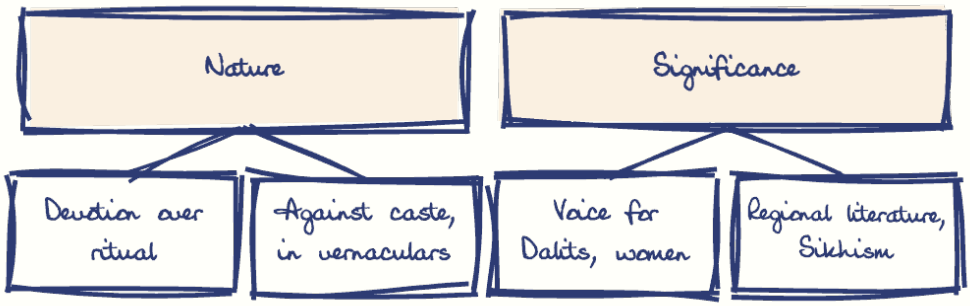
Bring out the nature and significance of Bhakti Movements in Medieval India.

10

Introduction

The Bhakti Movement, flourishing between the 7th and 17th centuries, was a socio-religious transformation that placed personal devotion to God above ritual. Emerging in South India and spreading across the subcontinent, it challenged orthodox norms and caste hierarchies.

Bhakti movement at a glance



Nature of the Bhakti Movement

1. Personal devotion: It centred on intense love for a chosen deity such as Vishnu or Shiva, rejecting elaborate rituals and priestly intermediaries. The Alwars and Nayanars pioneered this direct bond with God.
2. Rejection of caste and ritualism: Saints criticised caste and orthodoxy. Ramananda

and Kabir preached that devotion was open to all, democratising spiritual practice.

3. Vernacular languages: Instead of Sanskrit, saints composed hymns in Tamil, Marathi, Hindi and Bengali, making ideas accessible to the masses.

4. Syncretic philosophy: Guru Nanak and Kabir blended Hindu and Islamic ideas, promoting universal brotherhood and tolerance.

Significance in Medieval India

1. Social reform: By holding that devotion alone leads to salvation, it challenged Brahmanical authority and gave Dalits and women a voice and dignity.

2. Cultural renaissance: The works of Meera Bai, Tulsidas and Surdas enriched regional literary traditions and classical music.

3. Social harmony: By valuing inner experience over religious identity, it fostered communal harmony during the Delhi Sultanate.

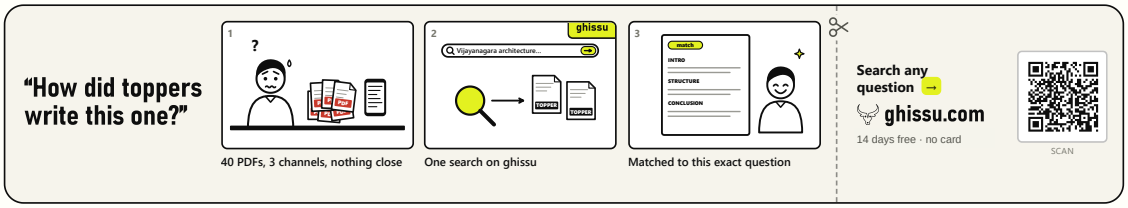
4. Later movements: It laid the groundwork for Sikhism, which emerged in the 15th century as Guru Nanak combined devotion with social justice and equality.

Way Forward

1. Education and arts: Teaching Bhakti poetry in schools and supporting Bhakti-inspired folk and classical music can spread values of inclusivity among youth.
2. Interfaith harmony: The syncretic spirit of Bhakti can help counter religious intolerance in contemporary society.
3. Empowering the marginalised: Its egalitarian ethos can guide social programmes that recognise the contributions of historically oppressed groups.

Conclusion

The Bhakti Movement was not merely religious reform but a social and cultural revolution that democratised spirituality and challenged hierarchies. It reflects the constitutional spirit of equality and freedom of religion, and its message that devotion transcends all barriers endures.



P-II
2(b)

Discuss the social and economic conditions under the Vijayanagar rulers.

10

Introduction

The Vijayanagar Empire, flourishing between the 14th and 17th centuries, resisted invasions and preserved Hindu culture in South India. Foreign travellers like Niccolo Conti and Duarte Barbosa describe its prosperity and social fabric, showing how it balanced tradition with economic vitality.

Vijayanagar society and economy



Social Conditions

1. Brahmin-influenced hierarchy: Society followed the varna order, with Brahmins as ministers and commanders, such as Madhava and Sayana, reflecting commitment to Varnashrama Dharma.
2. Social mobility of rulers: The rulers came from the peasantry yet claimed Kshatriya privileges,

challenging orthodox caste rules.

3. Status of women: Women held a dignified position and worked even as wrestlers and accountants, though sati and child marriage prevailed.

4. Cultural vibrancy: Navaratri and Deepavali were grandly celebrated, and patronage of Sanskrit, Telugu, Kannada and Tamil strengthened cohesion.

Economic Conditions

1. Agrarian economy: Large tanks (samudramas) aided cultivation in drought-prone areas; land revenue varied by crop and soil quality.

2. Trade and urbanisation: Markets dealt in spices, textiles and precious stones; Persians, Arabs and Portuguese dominated sea trade, while Vaishyas controlled inland trade.

3. Coinage: Gold, silver and copper coins such as pagoda and fanam linked the economy to wider markets.

4. Amara-nayaka system: Chiefs maintained troops in return for revenue rights, strengthening defence but creating powerful regional actors.

Interaction of Society and Economy

1. Temple economy: Temples were centres of land, wealth and trade, supporting artisans and pilgrims.
2. Occupational roles: Brahmins in administration, Vaishyas in trade and peasants in farming formed an interdependent structure.
3. Urban prosperity: Citizens adorned with precious stones, and taxes on professions that funded policing, reveal an organised urban economy.
4. Military needs: A large standing army and cavalry required imported horses and the founding of military schools, tying economic resources to political priorities.

Conclusion

Vijayanagar fused a traditional social order with a dynamic, trade-rich economy. Society and economy reinforced each other, a balance that sustained the empire for three centuries. Its tanks, temples and markets show how a medieval Indian state could preserve its culture while expanding its economy, a legacy that deserves deeper study and conservation.

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P-II
3(a)

Critically examine the impact of British colonial rule on the Indian economy.

10

Introduction

The economic impact of British rule is debated by nationalist, Marxist and subaltern scholars. India's share of the world economy fell from nearly 23% to about 3% between the early 18th century and 1947, showing its transformation into a colonial appendage.

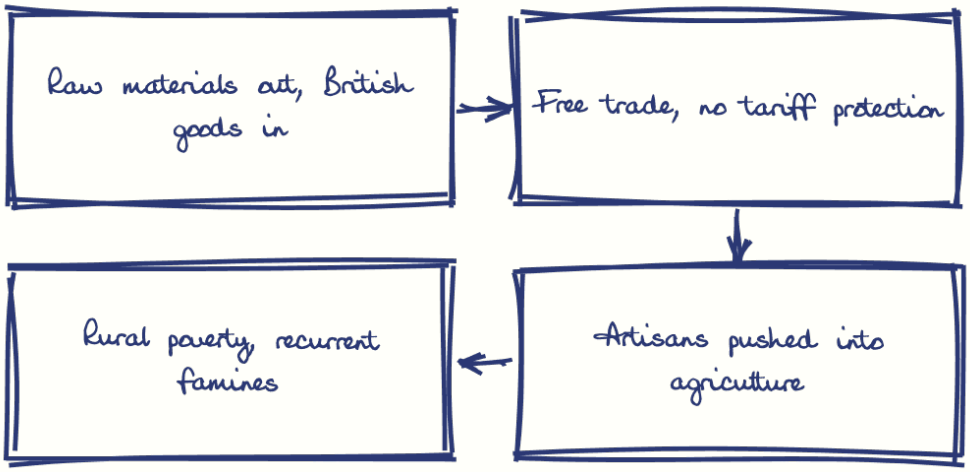
Colonial Economic Structure

1. Subordination to Britain: India exported raw cotton and jute and imported British manufactures, a dependence that stifled industrial growth.
2. Drain of wealth: Surplus was appropriated with minimal reinvestment; Dadabhai Naoroji's drain theory showed wealth flowing to Britain to finance its industrial revolution.
3. Regressive taxation: The burden fell on peasants, and the Permanent Settlement entrenched landlordism and discouraged farm investment.
4. No protective policy: Forced free trade exposed infant industries to British competition.

Economic Outcomes

1. Deindustrialisation: Cheap machine-made imports

The colonial economic chain



ruined crafts, pushing artisans onto the land and deepening rural poverty.

2. Regional disparities: Bombay cotton mills and Bengal jute grew, while heavy industry and power were neglected.
3. Famines: Revenue extraction and export-oriented farming made recurrent famines, which killed millions, policy disasters.
4. Stunted bourgeoisie: Indian industrialists faced credit shortages and British competition without state support.

Critical Note

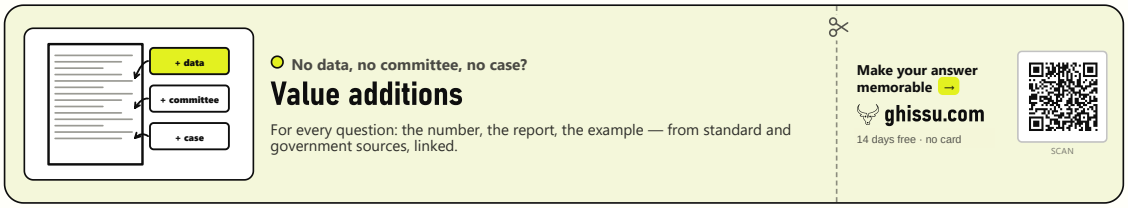
Railways and some modern industry were left behind, but they served imperial needs first and did little for broad-based development.

Way Forward

1. Inclusive industrial policy: Support small and medium enterprises and balanced regional development.
2. Agrarian reform: Land reform and rural infrastructure to undo colonial neglect of agriculture.
3. Address wealth inequality: Progressive taxation and social welfare to correct inequalities rooted in colonial structures.

Conclusion

While it left behind infrastructure like railways, colonial rule left a legacy of exploitation and underdevelopment. Healing it needs inclusive growth in the spirit of Sabka Saath Sabka Vikas.



3(b) Examine the objectives, methods and the impact of the Moderates vis-a-vis the Extremists during the course of the Indian Freedom Struggle from 1885 to 1920.

10

Introduction

From 1885 to 1920 the Indian National Congress saw a contest between the Moderates and the Extremists, marking the move from constitutional petitions to assertive mass movements. Nationalist schdars stress the Extremists' radicalism, while Cambridge schdars criticise the Moderates' limited reach.

Objectives

1. Moderates' Reform Goals: They sought gradual reform and more Indian participation through legislative councils, supporting the Indian Councils Act of 1892.
2. Extremists' Demand for Swaraj: They demanded complete Swaraj, as in Tilak's slogan, "Swaraj is my birthright and I will have it."
3. Social Base: Moderates drew on zamindars and the urban upper middle class and Western liberal thought; Extremists mobilised the middle and lower middle classes using Indian history and cultural pride.

Methods

Moderates vs Extremists

Moderates	Extremists
Gradual reform	Swaraj as birthright
Zamindars, urban elite	Middle, lower middle class
Petitions, prayers, protests	Swadeshi, boycott
Minor reforms (1892 Act)	Mass base, Surat Split

1. Moderates: They used the "3 Ps", petitions, prayers and protests, to appeal to British fairness, along with Naoroji's Drain Theory.
2. Extremists: They used Swadeshi and Boycott, festivals and public meetings, national education and burning of British goods, as in the 1905 Bengal Swadeshi Movement.

Impact

1. Moderates' Limited Gains: They raised awareness of exploitation and won minor reforms, but drew criticism for "political mendicancy".
2. Extremists' Mass Nationalism: They involved broader groups and their agitation against the

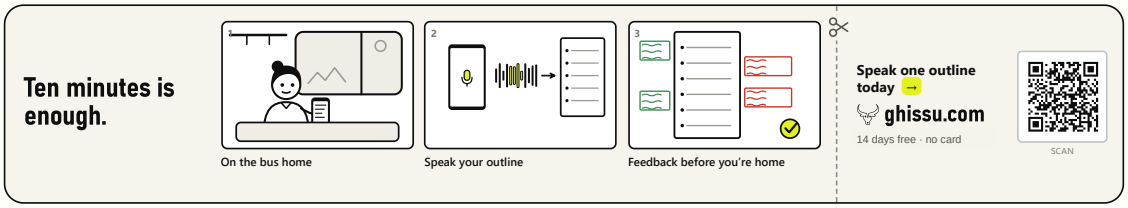
Partition of Bengal united Hindus and Muslims temporarily.

3. Division and Repression: The 1907 Surat Split weakened the Congress, and repression of Extremists was followed by the Morley-Minto Reforms of 1909.

4. Legacy: The Extremists' emphasis on self-reliance and direct action influenced later leaders like Gandhi and helped make the Congress a mass organisation by 1916.

Conclusion

The Moderates laid the political foundation, while the Extremists turned the movement into a mass struggle that prepared the ground for Non-Cooperation. Together they show the value of balancing constitutional engagement with assertive mass action.



P-II
4(a)

What was the contribution of the Socio-religious Reform Movements of the 19th century for the upliftment of women in Modern India ?

10

Introduction

The 19th-century socio-religious reform movements arose as a response to entrenched social evils, including the subjugation of women. Led by visionary reformers, they challenged orthodox practices and promoted gender equality, laying the foundation for women's upliftment in modern India.

Key Reform Movements

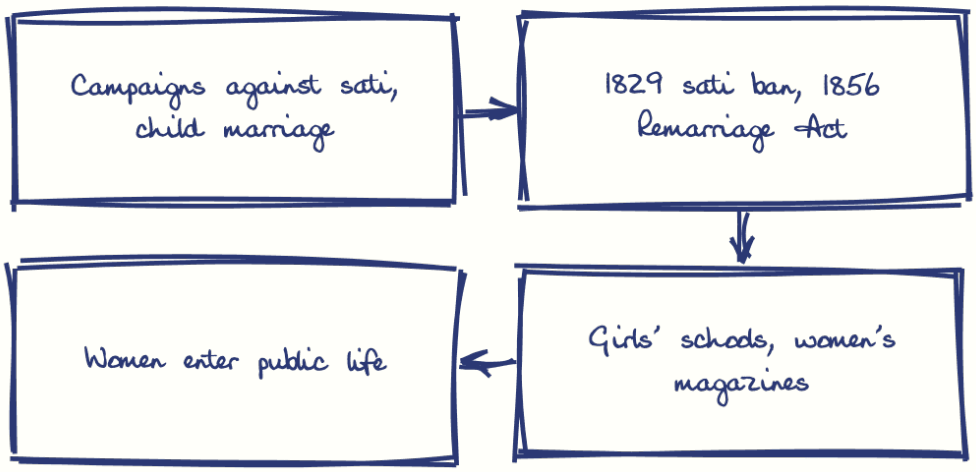
1. **Brahmo Samaj:** Raja Ram Mohan Roy opposed sati and child marriage and championed widow remarriage and women's education, a rational critique of orthodoxy.
2. **Arya Samaj:** Dayanand Saraswati condemned polygamy and purdah and promoted women's education as social regeneration.
3. **Young Bengal:** Inspired by Western education and Enlightenment ideals, it challenged traditional gender roles and championed women's emancipation through education and social reform.
4. **Reformers in Andhra:** Kandukuri Viresalingam Pantulu promoted women's education and widow remarriage and fought child marriage through the

vernacular press.

Contributions to Women's Upliftment

1. **Sati and child marriage:** Campaigns led to the 1829 ban on sati, influenced by Ray, and raised awareness against early marriage.
2. **Women's education:** Girls' schools like Sarala Ray's Gokhale Memorial Girls' School and magazines like Streebodh and Bamabodhini Patrika built platforms for women.
3. **Widow remarriage and property:** Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar championed widow remarriage, and discriminatory inheritance laws were questioned.
4. **Vernacular literature:** Telugu and regional writing made reform ideas accessible to women.

From reform to women's agency

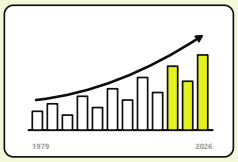


Impact on Women's Status

1. **Legal foundation:** The Hindu Widow Remarriage Act (1856) and later constitutional guarantees of equality.
2. **Women's agency:** Education and awareness enabled women to join public life, the freedom struggle and later feminist activism, as reflected in the Towards Equality report (1974).
3. **Limitations:** Gains favoured upper-caste urban women, while rural and lower-caste women stayed marginalised and orthodox resistance persisted.
4. **Continuing challenges:** Polygamy and purdah lingered, requiring post-independence efforts for substantive equality.

Conclusion

These movements began a cultural transformation towards gender equality. Their unfinished work calls for strict enforcement of laws against child marriage, dowry and domestic violence, wider education for rural women and support for women's economic independence.



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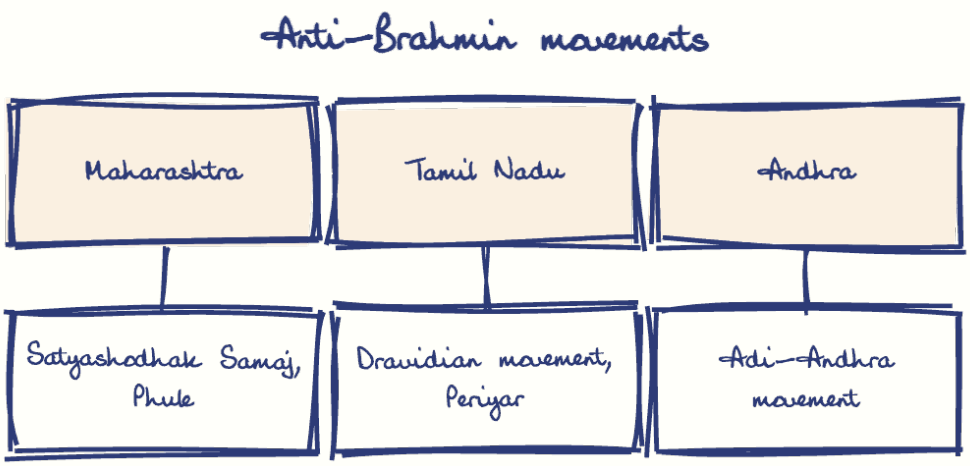
P-II
4(b)

Bring out the nature and characteristic features of the anti-Brahmin movements in Modern India.

10

Introduction

The anti-Brahmin movements of modern India emerged in the early 20th century as responses to entrenched Brahminical dominance in social, religious and political spheres. Historians like Gail Omvedt see them as expressions of socio-economic and class tensions rather than mere caste conflicts, highlighting their radical and popular nature.



Nature: Organisation and Leadership

1. Caste-Based Associations: Caste associations and conferences built collective identity among intermediate and lower castes, as in the Non-Brahman movement in Maharashtra and the Dravidian movement in Tamil Nadu.

2. Educated Leadership: Leaders like Jyotirao Phule, Periyar E.V. Ramasamy and B.R. Ambedkar combined modern education with social activism and articulated the grievances and aspirations of their communities.

3. Regional Variations: The Satyashodhak Samaj focused on anti-caste reform, while the Dravidian movement fused anti-Brahminism with regional identity.

4. Institution Building: Schools, hostels and cooperative societies were set up to empower communities economically and socially, as in the Adi-Andhra movement's work for Dalit education and political representation.

Characteristic Features

1. Anti-Caste Ideology: They challenged ritual purity norms and caste hierarchy, as in Ambedkar's call for the annihilation of caste.

2. Mass Mobilisation: Rallies, conferences and protests asserted demands, often rejecting Brahminical Hinduism for Buddhism or rationalist ideologies.

3. Cultural Reinterpretation: The Dravidian agitation promoted Dravidian cultural pride, while others reinterpreted Hinduism to end caste oppression.

4. Reservation Demands: They demanded reservations in education, employment and legislatures, institutionalising affirmative action.

Challenges and Outcomes

1. Orthodox Resistance: Brahmin elites and orthodox sections opposed them to protect caste privileges, causing social tensions.
2. Divisions and Co-optation: Factionalism and absorption of leaders into the Congress or Communist parties diluted radical agendas, as seen in the decline of autonomous Dalit movements in the 1940s.
3. Limited Rural Reach: They struggled in villages where caste hierarchies were more rigid.
4. Lasting Legacy: They inspired later Dalit and backward caste mobilisations.

Conclusion

The anti-Brahmin movements were radical, regionally diverse and institution-building in nature. They contributed decisively to the democratisation of Indian society and politics.



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P-II
5(a)

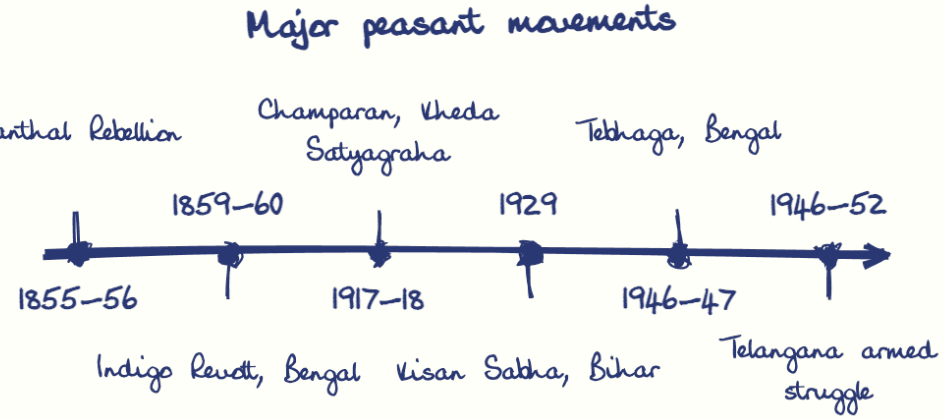
Trace the important Peasant Movements in Modern India and their characteristic features.

10

Introduction

Peasant movements in modern India emerged as a response to exploitative colonial agrarian policies and rural inequality. Nationalist, Marxist and subaltern historians debate their nature, but all see them as central to rural resistance and its integration with the freedom struggle.

Important Peasant Movements



1. Early Localised Uprisings: Revolts like the Indigo Revolt in Bengal and the Santhal Rebellion in Jharkhand were spontaneous and local, targeting landlords and moneylenders rather than colonial rule.

2. Champaran and Kheda Satyagraha: Led by

Gandhi in (1917) and (1918), they began organised peasant resistance linked to the national struggle, against indigo planters and oppressive taxation.

3. Kisan Sabha Movement: Founded in (1929) by Swami Sahajanand Saraswati in Bihar, the Kisan Sabha fought zamindari oppression, demanded tenancy rights and spread across India, linking agrarian issues with nationalist politics.

4. Tebhaga Movement (1946–47): Organised by the Communist Party in Bengal, sharecroppers demanded two-thirds of the produce instead of half, a sign of class struggle.

5. Telangana Rebellion (1946–52): Under the Nizam, peasants waged armed struggle against jagirdars and forced labour, winning land redistribution.

Characteristic Features

1. Economic Grievances: Colonial land revenue, indebtedness and landlord oppression were the core drivers.

2. Phased Evolution: Early revolts were spontaneous; from the 20th century they became organised and integrated with the anti-colonial struggle.

3. Leadership: Local rural leaders were joined by

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Gandhi and Sardar Patel, and by socialists and communists who promoted class-based mobilisation.

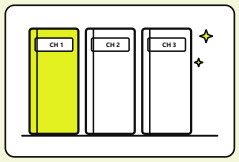
4. Mass and Social Base: They united landowners, sharecroppers and landless labourers, addressed social as well as economic oppression, and often used cultural and religious symbols for mobilisation.

5. Varied Methods: Methods ranged from petitions and civil disobedience to armed struggle, as in Telangana.

6. Regional Specificity: The Mappila Rebellion in Kerala and the Santhal Uprising carried strong regional and tribal identities.

Conclusion

Peasant movements awakened rural consciousness and linked agrarian struggles with the freedom movement. Their legacy is the gradual dismantling of feudal structures and the assertion of peasant rights, contributing to democratic decentralisation and social justice.



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P-II
5(b)

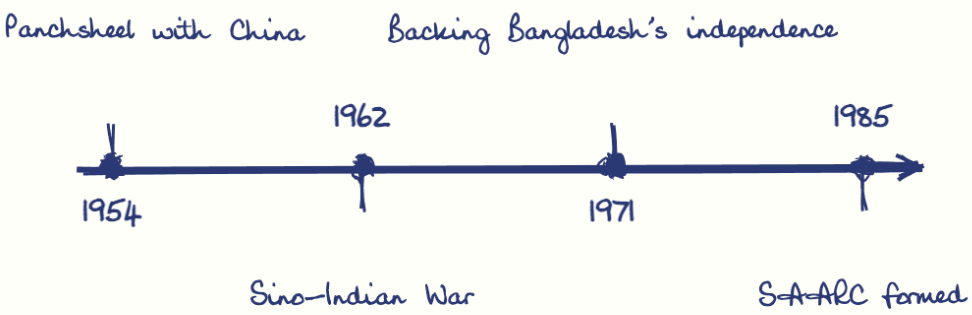
Examine the salient features of the Indian Foreign Policy during the post-Independence period upto 1989.

10

Introduction

India's foreign policy after independence was shaped by its colonial legacy, the Cold War context and its aspirations as a newly sovereign nation. Up to 1989 it sought strategic autonomy while promoting decolonisation and global peace.

Phases of India's foreign policy



Salient Features

1. Non-Alignment: India refused to join any military bloc, preserving freedom of decision and avoiding superpower rivalries, as articulated by Jawaharlal Nehru.
2. Anti-Imperialism: Drawing on its own colonial experience, India supported liberation movements in Asia and Africa and led the developing

world in international forums.

3. Panchsheel and World Peace: The Panchsheel Agreement, stressing peaceful coexistence and non-aggression, anchored bilateral ties, while India championed disarmament and UN multilateralism.

4. Economic Diplomacy: India used trade and diplomacy to protect its economic interests and pursued regional cooperation.

Evolution up to 1989

1. Idealism (1947–1962): Nehru stressed nuclear disarmament, non-alignment and multilateralism, seen in the Panchsheel Agreement with China in 1954. The 1962 Sino-Indian War exposed its limits and low military spending.

2. Realism (1962–1977): India deepened strategic ties with the Soviet Union to counterbalance China and Pakistan, a partial alignment under non-aligned rhetoric. It played an active role in the Non-Aligned Movement and backed Bangladesh's independence in 1971.

3. Pragmatism (1977–1989): India engaged both superpowers, strengthened regional cooperation through SAARC in 1985 and managed complex ties with neighbours amid geopolitical tensions.

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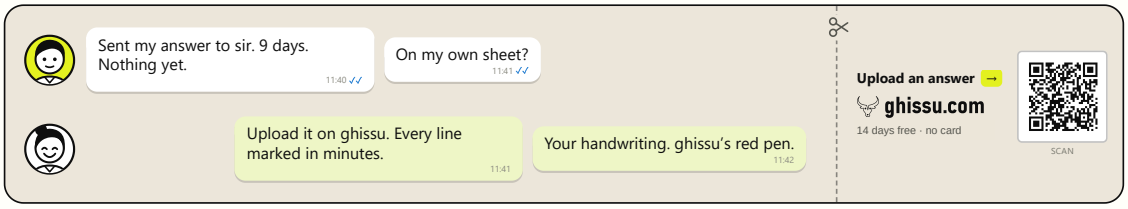
Its cautious economic diplomacy set the stage for later liberalisation.

Assessment

1. Strengths: Non-alignment preserved sovereignty, kept India out of superpower rivalries and gave it a leading voice for the developing world.
2. Limits: Idealism left India militarily unprepared in 1962, and the later tilt towards the Soviet Union showed that strategic autonomy required pragmatic adjustment to a changing world of power politics.

Conclusion

India's foreign policy up to 1989 balanced idealism and realism, rooted in sovereignty, peace and decolonisation, in the spirit of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam. It gave India a distinct identity in a bipolar world, and its lessons on strategic autonomy remain relevant.



P-II
6(a)

Discuss the socio-religious conditions and the development of Telugu language and literature during the Satavahana period.

10

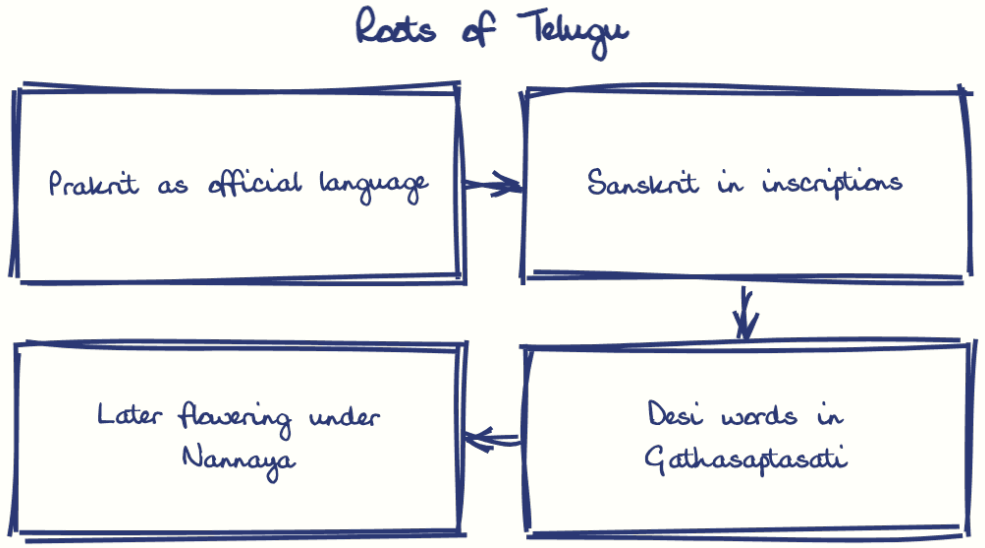
Introduction

The Satavahana period (circa 1st century BCE to 3rd century CE) was a crucial phase in the cultural and linguistic history of the Deccan, especially present-day Andhra Pradesh. It saw socio-religious change alongside the early development of Telugu language and literature.

Socio-Religious Conditions

1. **Brahmanical Revival:** Satakarni I and Gautamiputra Satakarni performed Ashwamedha and Rajasuya, recorded in the Naneghat inscriptions, and Gautamiputra earned the title Ekabrahmana for defending orthodox faith.
2. **Buddhist Flourishing:** Mahayana Buddhism grew under Acharya Nagarjuna, and Nagarjunakonda and Amaravati became centres of pilgrimage and learning.
3. **Marginal Jainism:** Jainism was present in border regions but received little patronage.
4. **Social Openness:** Women enjoyed freedom in fashion and social life, and the sexes mingled in festivals, balancing orthodoxy with social

flexibility.



Language and Literature

1. Multilingual Environment: Prakrit was the official language, Sanskrit gained ground in inscriptions and religious texts, and Desi emerged as a precursor of Telugu and Kannada, as bilingual coins attest.

2. Prakrit and Sanskrit Literature: Hala's Saptasati marked Prakrit patronage, while later rulers like Kuntala Satakarni promoted Sanskrit and Nagarjuna's Sanskrit works flourished.

3. Early Telugu Roots: Desi words in the Gathasaptasati and local dialects in inscriptions formed the substratum of Telugu, though classical Telugu literature came centuries later.

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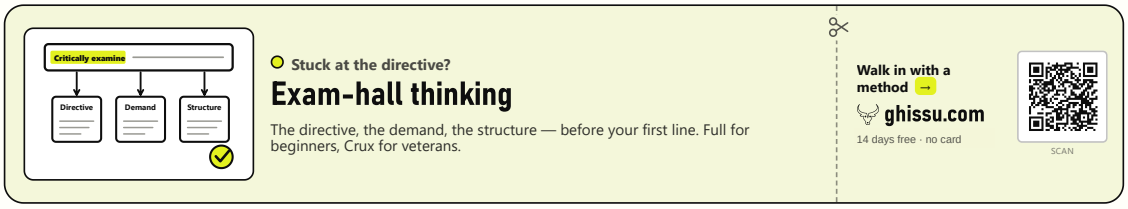
4. Literary Continuity: These developments set the stage for the later flowering of Telugu under poets like Nannaya.

Legacy

1. Religious Institutions: Buddhist monasteries and Vedic sacrificial altars under royal patronage made Amaravati and Nagarjunakonda enduring hubs of learning and pilgrimage in Andhra Pradesh.
2. Cultural Integration: The coexistence of Prakrit, Sanskrit and Desi helped Telugu emerge as a literary language.
3. Art and Architecture: Rock-cut caves, chaityas and viharas became symbols of the era's pluralism and artistic achievement.

Conclusion

The Satavahana era blended Vedic, Buddhist and local traditions and laid the linguistic roots of Telugu, shaping a composite cultural identity that continues to define Andhra today.



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P-II
6(b)

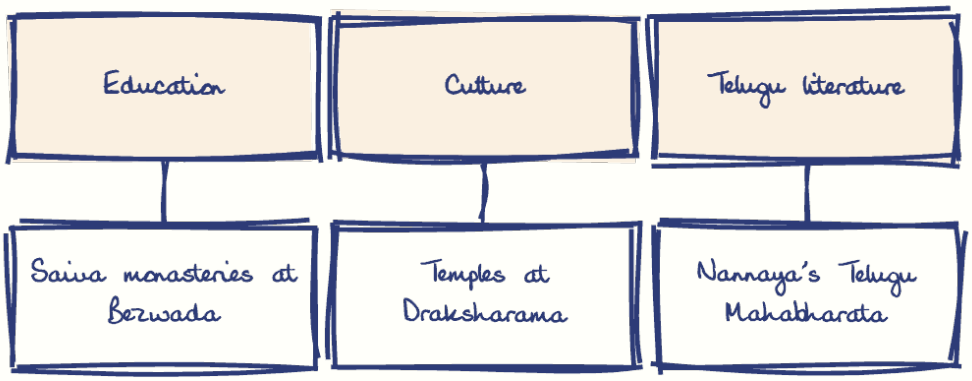
Explain the contributions of Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi in the fields of education, culture and Telugu language and literature.

10

Introduction

The Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi ruled coastal Andhra for nearly five centuries from the 7th century. Their reign coincided with a critical phase in the evolution of Telugu, marking the beginning of its classical tradition.

Eastern Chalukya contributions



Contribution to Education

1. **Monastic Centres:** Saiva monasteries attached to temples at Bezwada educated children and youth, joining religion with learning.
2. **Temple Patronage:** Vijayaditya II and Yuddhamalla II built and endowed temples at Draksharama and Bezawada, hubs of informal education through

festivals and pilgrimage.

3. Land Grants: Frequent gifts of land and wealth to temples and monasteries ensured lasting institutional capacity for education and culture.

Contribution to Culture

1. Religious Pluralism: Hinduism predominated, but Jain monks were patronised and Queen Amma II built Jain temples, supporting diverse educational traditions.
2. Cultural Resilience: Despite wars and succession struggles, patronage of education and arts continued.
3. Temple Architecture: Their temples, though many are altered or lost, combined devotion with artistic innovation.
4. Rise of Hinduism: As Buddhism and Jainism declined, Saivism and Vaishnavism shaped the themes of literature and learning.

Telugu Language and Literature

1. Birth of Telugu Literature: Inscriptions from Gunaga Vijayaditya III's reign show the earliest Telugu verses.
2. Nannaya's Mahabharata: Nannaya Bhattaraka,

patronised by Rajaraja Narendra, began the Telugu Mahabharata, setting literary norms and raising Telugu to classical status.

3. Vernacular Poetry: Nanne Choda's Telugu Kumarasambhava developed the desi style, taking poetry beyond Sanskrit elites.

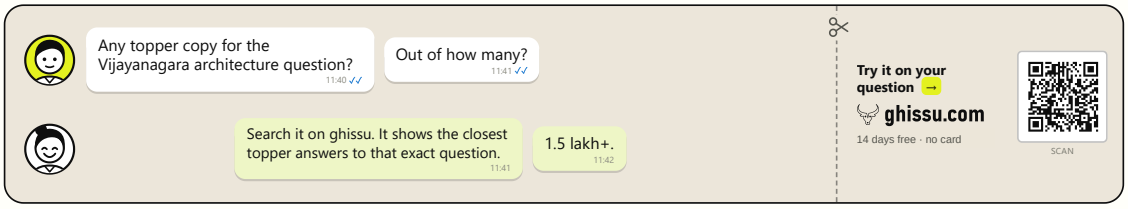
4. Literature and Politics: Courtly support for Telugu consolidated regional identity and legitimacy, countering Jain literature and reinforcing Hindu narratives.

Way Forward

1. Heritage and Research: Conserving surviving temples and expanding research on Eastern Chalukya-era Telugu literature can deepen understanding of its origins.

Conclusion

The Eastern Chalukyas institutionalised education through religious centres, nurtured a vibrant culture and pioneered Telugu literature, laying the groundwork for Andhra's classical identity and inspiring modern Telugu pride.



P-II
7(a)

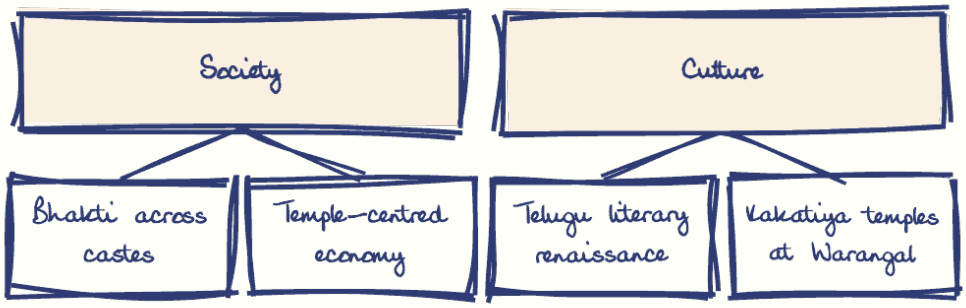
Give an account of the socio-religious and cultural conditions in Andhra desha during the years 1000 - 1565 A.D.

10

Introduction

The period (1000) to (1565) A.D. in Andhra desha, spanning the Kakatiya dynasty and the Vijayanagara Empire, was a phase of socio-religious change and cultural efflorescence. Hindu sects consolidated, Buddhism declined and Telugu literature and temple architecture flourished.

Andhra desha, 1000 to 1565



Socio-Religious Conditions

1. Religious Dynamics: Shaivism enjoyed royal patronage alongside Vaishnavism, while Buddhism and Jainism declined. The Bhakti movement opened devotional worship to all castes, challenging rigid hierarchies.

2. Temple-Centric Society: Temples were centres of social and economic as well as religious life.

Rulers endowed them with land and wealth, supporting priests, artisans and traders, and at Draksharama donations from elites reinforced status and authority.

3. Caste and Guilds: Brahmins held religious authority, while guilds (nakaras) like the Telikas enjoyed privileges and funded temples, linking economy and religion.

4. Women and Courtesans: Courtesans at courts and temples enriched music and dance, though gender hierarchies stayed patriarchal.

Cultural Conditions

1. Telugu Literary Renaissance: Kakatiya and Vijayanagara courts patronised poets like Pothana and Srinatha, and translations of Sanskrit epics established Telugu as a literary language.

2. Temple Architecture: Grand granite temples with towering gopurams, like the Kakatiya temples at Warangal and Vijayanagara's ruins, blended Dravidian style with local innovation.

3. Performing Arts: Music and dance were integral to temple ritual and court life, and the patronage of classical forms influenced later South Indian traditions.

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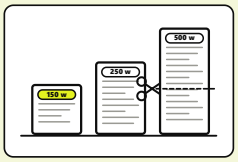
4. Syncretism and Exchange: Hindu, Muslim and Christian communities interacted, and Marco Polo and Ibn Battuta described cosmopolitan towns linked to maritime trade.

Way Forward

1. Heritage Preservation: Better funding and community involvement can conserve Kakatiya and Vijayanagara monuments.
2. Telugu Literature: Modern translations of classical Telugu works can revive interest among younger readers.
3. Interfaith Dialogue: Dialogue platforms among religious groups in Andhra Pradesh can build on the historical tradition of syncretism and tolerance.

Conclusion

This era consolidated Hindu devotion, temple society and Telugu literature, shaping a cultural identity that Andhra Pradesh still carries today.



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SCAN

P-II
7(b)

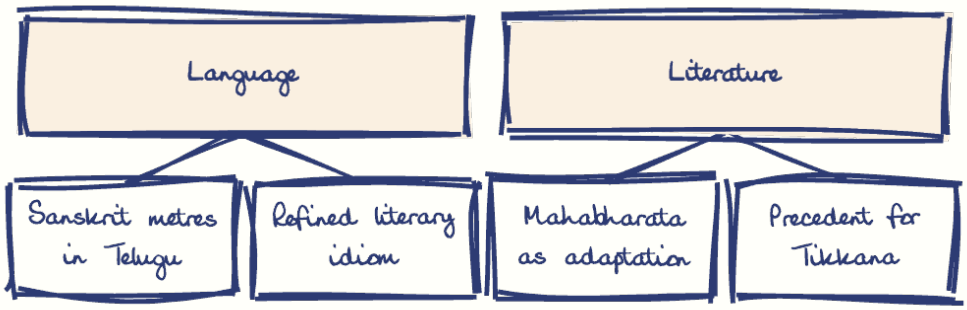
Estimate the contribution of the poet Nannaya for the development of Telugu language and literature.

10

Introduction

The 11th-century poet Nannaya is regarded as the first monumental poet of Telugu. His adaptation of the Sanskrit Mahabharata raised the literary status of the language and laid the foundation of its classical form.

Nannaya's contribution



Contribution to the Language

1. Court Patronage: As court poet of Raja Raja Narendra, he was commissioned to render the Mahabharata into Telugu, showing the role of royal courts in literary culture.
2. Literary Telugu: Before him Telugu was mainly spoken, with no monumental works. He refined its structure and vocabulary, blending Sanskrit and Telugu words into a sophisticated idiom.

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3. Telugu Prosody: He pioneered Sanskrit metres like Utpalamala and Champakamala in Telugu poetry, formalising its prosody.
4. Recognition: He was honoured as the "First Poet" and Vaganusasana, one who commands words.

Contribution to Literature

1. Adaptation over Translation: His Mahabharata was not a mere translation but an adaptation infused with Vedic philosophy and poetic creativity, making the epic accessible and resonant for Telugu audiences.
2. Sanskrit and Vernacular Balance: He adopted Sanskrit vocabulary and metres but kept Telugu distinct.
3. Cultural Impact: His work mirrored Vedic thought and countered Jain-influenced Kannada translations, reinforcing the Eastern Chalukya ethos.
4. Legacy: He finished only part of the epic, but Tikkana and Marana continued his precedent, ensuring the sustained growth of Telugu literature.

Way Forward

1. **Classical Language Institutes:** Dedicated multidisciplinary institutions for Telugu language and literature in Andhra Pradesh can preserve and promote his legacy.
2. **Translation Projects:** Scholars and poets can follow his model of creative adaptation of classical texts.
3. **Education:** His works and Telugu literary history belong in school and university curricula in Andhra Pradesh, to foster cultural pride and linguistic continuity among the young.
4. **Digital Platforms:** Initiatives like BHASHINI can digitise and spread Telugu classics.

Conclusion

Nannaya gave Telugu a literary idiom, a prosody and its first great work. His synthesis of Sanskritic form with Telugu expression founded a classical tradition that still shapes Telugu identity.

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8(a) What are the factors that led to the rise and growth of socio-cultural awakening in Andhra during the 20th century?

10

Introduction

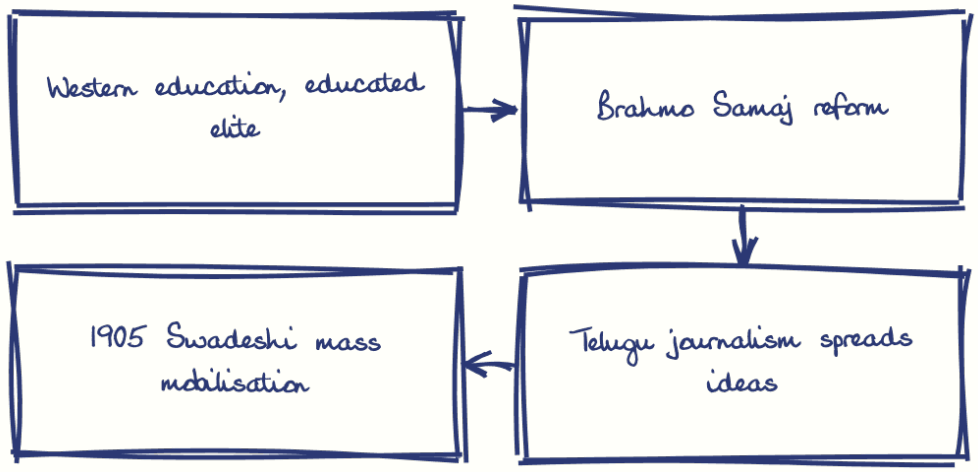
The socio-cultural awakening in Andhra during the 20th century was a transformative phase that reshaped the region's social fabric and political consciousness. A confluence of education, reform and cultural movements challenged traditional norms and colonial subjugation, making Andhra a vibrant centre of reform and nationalism.

Factors behind the Rise

1. **Western Education:** The University of Madras and colleges in Rajahmundry, Visakhapatnam and Berhampur created an educated elite who questioned orthodox practices and colonial rule.
2. **Socio-Religious Reform:** The Brahmo Samaj, with branches in Rajahmundry, Masulipatnam and Kakinada, challenged superstition and caste discrimination.
3. **Journalism and Literary Bodies:** Andhra Prakasika, Krishna Patrika and the Coconada Literary Association spread nationalist ideas and social critique in coastal Andhra.
4. **Political Mobilisation:** The Krishna District

Association and Congress sessions at Machilipatnam and Congress sessions raised political awareness, especially after the (1905) Swadeshi and Vandemataram movements.

How the awakening grew



Growth of the Awakening

1. Literacy: English and vernacular education widened access to reformist and nationalist writing and built self-respect.
2. Social Reform: Campaigns against untouchability and child marriage weakened caste prejudice, fostering social cohesion and progressive values.
3. Media and Public Opinion: Telugu journalism criticised colonial rule and created an informed public.
4. Mass Participation: The partition of Bengal and the

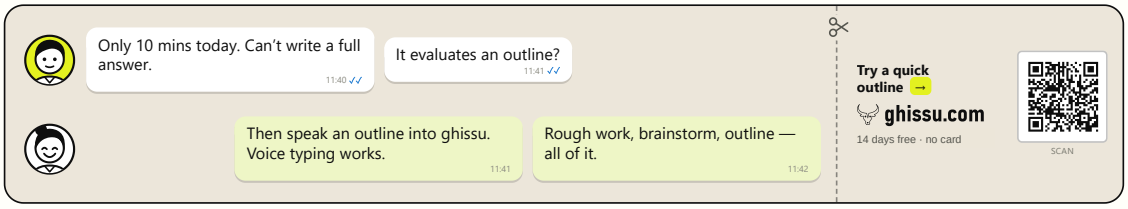
Swadeshi movement turned awareness into mass mobilisation in Andhra.

5. Consolidation: Educational and reformist efforts thus culminated in a broad-based socio-political awakening.

These factors were interlinked: education enabled reform, journalism amplified it and politics turned it into action.

Conclusion

The awakening in Andhra grew from education, reform, a vigorous press and nationalist politics, and it laid the base for the region's democratic and progressive values. Schemes like Samagra Shiksha Abhiyan and Mission Shakti can carry this legacy forward today.



P-II
8(b)

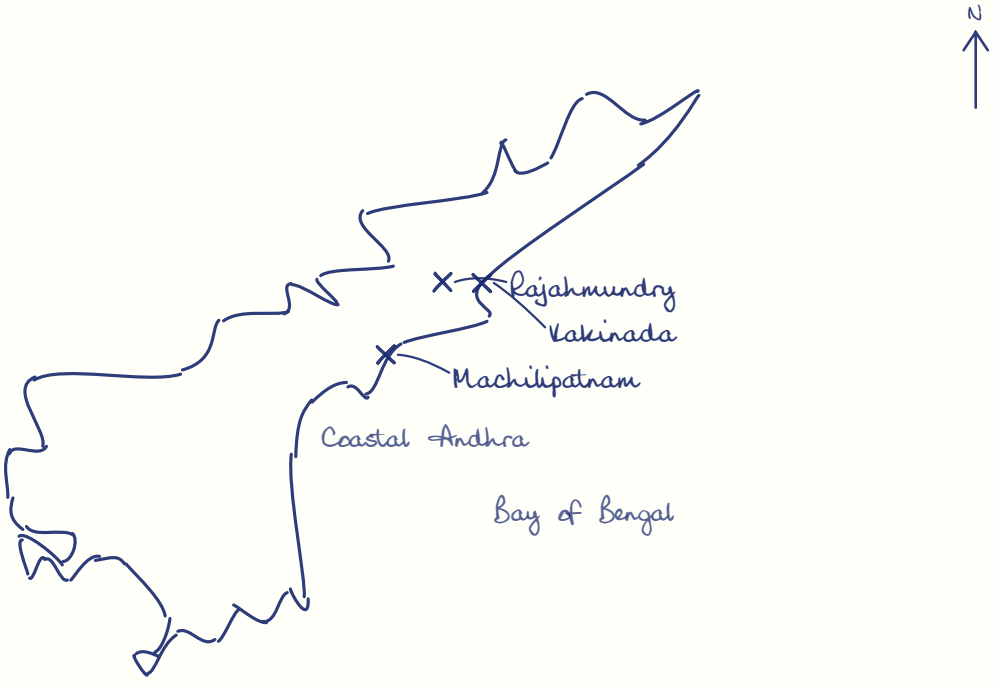
Describe the causes and results of the Vandemataram Movement in Andhra.

10

Introduction

The Vandemataram Movement in Andhra was a key phase of the early freedom struggle, inspired by the Swadeshi upsurge after the 1905 Partition of Bengal. Rooted in the fervour of Bankim Chandra Chatterjee's song "Vande Mataram", it galvanised political awakening as well as Telugu cultural pride.

Vandemataram centres in Coastal Andhra



Bipin Chandra Pal's tour, 1907

Causes of the Movement

1. **Nationalist inspiration:** "Vandemataram" became a

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rallying cry against British rule and spread fast after Bipin Chandra Pal's (1907) tour of Coastal Andhra. His lectures on Swaraj and boycott led to groups like the Youngmen's Swaraj Samiti.

2. Regional assertion: Telugu speakers felt marginalised within the Madras Presidency, and works like *Andhrula Charitramu* (1910) kindled pride in Andhra's heritage.

3. Student and youth defiance: In the Rajahmundry College incident, students wore Vandemataram badges and were punished, which began active student involvement and showed the growing political consciousness of educated youth.

4. Swadeshi spirit: The call to boycott British goods encouraged efforts to build indigenous industry and national education.

Results of the Movement

1. Swadeshi economic initiatives: Swadeshi stores and national schools such as the Andhra Jateeya Kalasaala in Machilipatnam reduced dependence on British goods and institutions.

2. Colonial repression: Bans on badges and punishment of students suppressed the movement briefly but deepened nationalist sentiment, seen in stone-throwing at officials in Kakinada and

Rajahmundry.

3. Limited terrorist influence: Unlike other regions, secret terrorist societies made little headway; moderate leaders like Konda Venkatappaiah and B. N. Sarma led Andhra politics after 1910.

4. Political organisation: It laid the groundwork for the Andhra Mahasabha and the demand for a separate Andhra province.

5. Cultural legacy: Emphasis on Telugu language and history fostered a renaissance that challenged colonial narratives of backwardness, while national education nurtured future leaders.

Way Forward

Promoting Telugu history, civic education for youth, Swadeshi-style local enterprise and preserving sites like Rajahmundry and Machilipatnam can keep this legacy alive for future generations.

Conclusion

The Vandemataram Movement awakened Andhra politically and culturally. By mobilising youth, promoting national education and challenging colonial authority, it sowed the seeds of linguistic statehood and strengthened the wider Indian freedom struggle in its formative phase.

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Index · page 6

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P-II
9(a)

Briefly explain what are the circumstances that led to the establishment of Asafjahi dynasty and the role played by Nizam-ul-Mulk.

10

Introduction

The establishment of the Asafjahi dynasty in 1724 marked a major shift in the Deccan, reflecting the decline of Mughal central authority and the rise of regional powers. Nizam-ul-Mulk, a shrewd Mughal nobleman, carved out a hereditary principality that endured for over two centuries.

Circumstances of Establishment

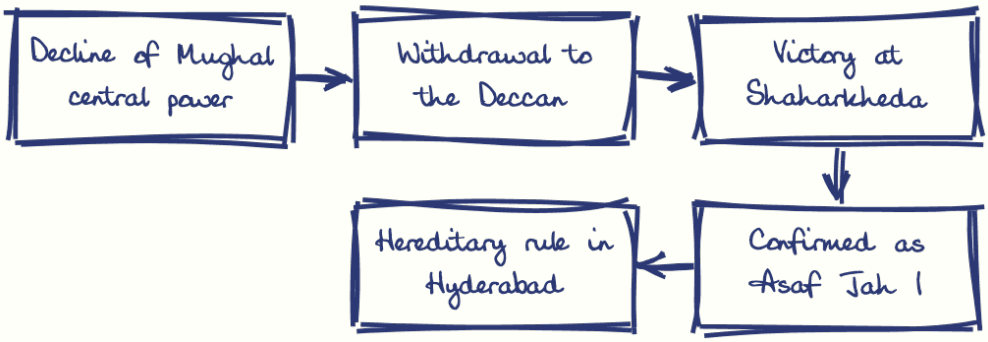
1. Decline of Mughal Authority: After Aurangzeb's death in 1707, a power vacuum let governors like Mubariz Khan rule the Deccan almost independently.
2. Factional Court Politics: Nizam-ul-Mulk, once wazir at the Mughal court, helped overthrow the Sayyid brothers in 1720 but grew disillusioned with the intrigues of Muhammad Shah's favourites, and withdrew to the Deccan in 1724.
3. Battle of Shakarkheda: He defeated Mubariz Khan on 11 October 1724, signalling the birth of the dynasty.

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4. Imperial Legitimacy: Emperor Muhammad Shah conferred the title Asaf Jah I and reappointed him Subedar of the Deccan.

Establishment of Asafjahi Dynasty



Role of Nizam-ul-Mulk

1. Administration: He governed a vast territory including present-day Telangana, the Telugu districts of the Northern Circars and Marathwada, with nominal authority over the Carnatic, balancing military power with local governance.
2. Maratha Diplomacy: He used intrigue, setting Maratha factions against each other despite defeats at Palkhed (1728) and Bhopal (1738) and the concession of chauth and sardeshmukhi.
3. European Alliances: Foreseeing Mughal decline after Nadir Shah's invasion in 1739, he cultivated the English at Madras.

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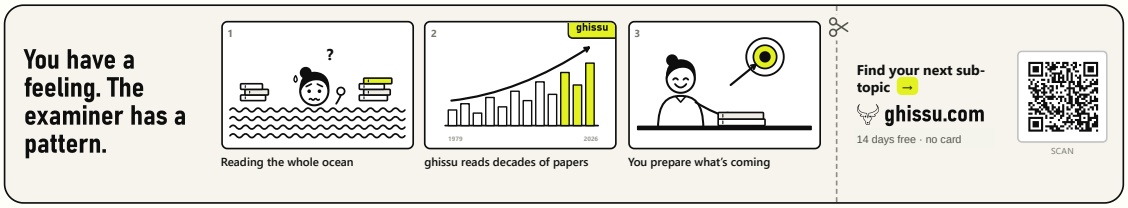
4. Succession Planning: Before his death in 1748 he secured titles and territories for his sons.

5. Local Elites: Hindu administrators in revenue and finance built a loyal regional elite and administrative stability.

6. Practical Sovereignty: Coins and khutba still named the Mughal emperor, but he made treaties and waged wars as an independent ruler.

Conclusion

Nizam-ul-Mulk blended symbolic Mughal allegiance with practical independence, turning Mughal decline into the foundation of Hyderabad's prominence in Deccan politics.



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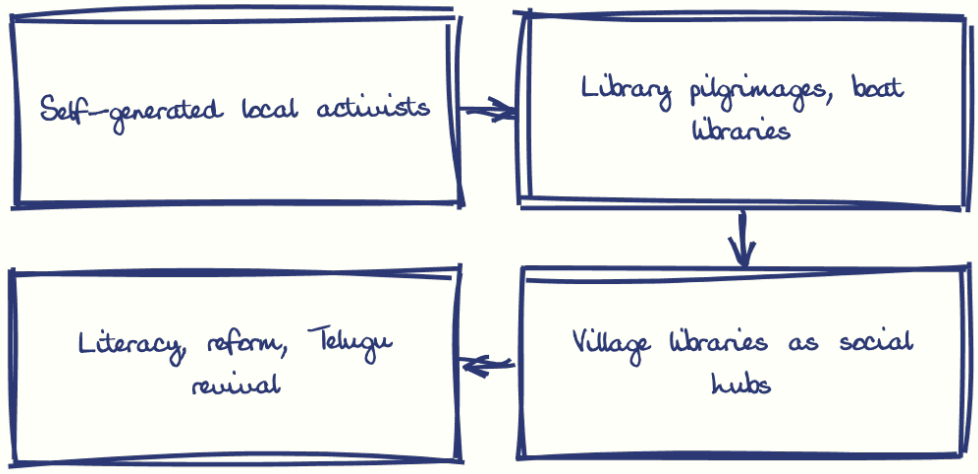
9(b) Estimate the significance of Library Movement in Telangana.

10

Introduction

The Library Movement in Telangana holds a unique place in the region's socio-cultural and educational history. Rooted in the wider Andhra library movement, it was self-generated by local activists rather than colonial patronage, and became a catalyst for social reform and political awakening.

How the movement worked



Emergence of the Movement

1. Grassroots origins: Library workers and volunteers spread literacy and reading habits without government initiation, reflecting strong community ownership.

2. Influence of the Andhra movement: Early 20th century awakening linked libraries to nationalist

and reform agendas, including support for Home Rule and Quit India.

3. Innovative outreach: Library pilgrimages, mobile and boat libraries reached remote villages, and village libraries became centres of social life.
4. Better communication: Roads, railways and postal networks carried printed Telugu literature to villagers.

Social, Cultural and Educational Impact

1. Literacy and education: Libraries combated illiteracy by offering books in rural areas where formal schooling was limited, fostering self-learning and intellectual growth.
2. Cultural renaissance: The movement promoted Telugu language and literature and complemented traditions like Bathukamma.
3. Social reform: Progressive and reformist literature encouraged debate on caste discrimination, women's rights and language movements, nurturing a socially conscious citizenry.
4. Uneven gains: Rural adult literacy as low as 52% shows the impact remains incomplete.

Legacy and Relevance

1. Knowledge society: It laid the base for today's efforts on literacy and digital access.
2. Empowerment: Its legacy of informing marginalised groups aligns with schemes like Rythu Bharosa.
3. Modern challenges: Digital media and changing reading habits demand that libraries become modern knowledge hubs.

Way Forward

1. Digital libraries: Digitising resources and expanding internet access can create hybrid centres.
2. Policy support: Library legislation with dedicated funds and literacy drives in districts like Narayanpet and Jogulamba-Gadwal can renew the movement.

Conclusion

The Library Movement was a significant force in shaping Telangana's educational and cultural landscape through literacy, social reform and community participation, laying the foundation of a knowledge society.

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P-II
10(a)

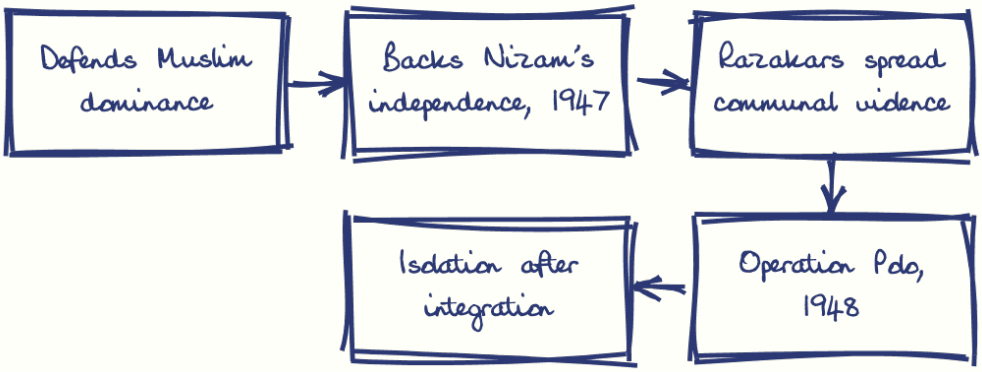
Critically examine the role played by Ittehadul Muslimeen, during the rule of the VIIth Nizam of Hyderabad.

10

Introduction

Hyderabad under the VIIth Nizam, Mir Osman Ali Khan, faced complex communal and administrative challenges. The Ittehadul Muslimeen emerged as a major Muslim political force in the 1940s, advocating Muslim interests amid rising tension and the impending integration of princely states into India.

Course of the Ittehadul Muslimeen



Political and Social Role

1. **Muslim Political Interests:** It defended Muslim dominance and backed an independent Muslim-ruled state, opposing the Hyderabad State Congress and its demand for democracy and integration.

2. Support for Sovereignty: It supported the Nizam's declaration of independence in June 1947 and his refusal to join the Indian Union, keeping Muslim elite dominance in administration intact.

3. Communal Mobilisation: Using religious symbolism, it built a communal identity and created the Razakars to intimidate opponents.

4. Neglect of Reform: It ignored broader social reform and inclusive governance, focusing on preserving Muslim privileges, which limited its appeal beyond the Muslim elite and urban centres.

Impact on Governance

1. Autocratic Rule: Resisting reform perpetuated autocracy and excluded the Hindu majority, deepening political exclusion.

2. Communal Violence: Razakar attacks on Hindus and opponents spread fear, repression and communal polarisation in rural and urban areas, fuelling resistance movements.

3. Undermining Democracy: Hostility to the State Congress and the Telangana peasant uprising prolonged instability.

4. Indian Intervention: The violence and deadlock led to Operation Polo in 1948.

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Critical Evaluation

1. **Short-Term Success:** It preserved Muslim elite power and the Nizam's sovereignty aspirations for a time, with support among the Muslim aristocracy and urban population.
2. **Failure:** Its narrow focus alienated the Hindu majority, Razakar abuses delegitimised it, and it misread India's resolve, ending in isolation after 1948.

Conclusion

The Ittehadul Muslimeen shaped Hyderabad's final years under the Nizam, but its communal politics hastened the very end it sought to prevent.

FIVE-MINUTE LESSON NOTES THAT LIVE WITH THE QUESTION

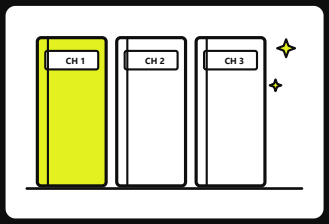
Notes that come back when you need them

Most notes are written once and never found again. Four habits fix that.

1. **Where** — On the question that taught you the point.
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4. **Revise** — By chapter, not by the date you wrote it.

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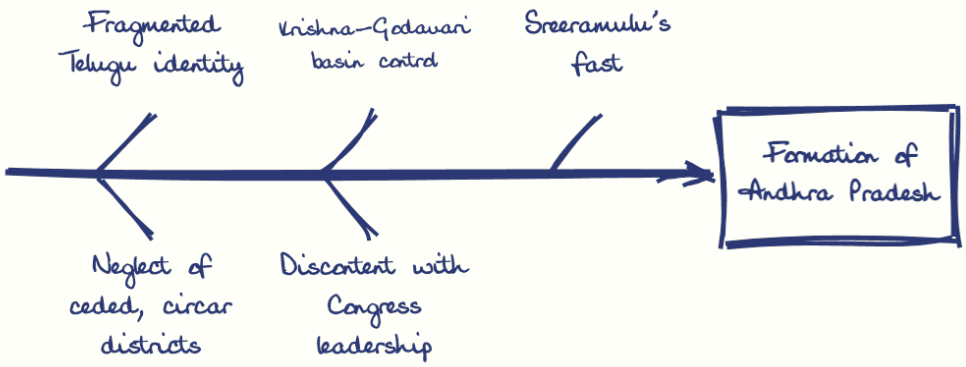
10(b) Assess the circumstances that led to the formation of Andhra Pradesh.

10

Introduction

The formation of Andhra Pradesh was a milestone in India's post-independence linguistic reorganisation, reflecting historical, political, social and economic factors. The demand, rooted in regional identity, produced Andhra State in 1953 and the unified state in 1956.

Why Andhra Pradesh was formed



Historical and Socio-Economic Circumstances

1. **Linguistic and cultural identity:** Telugu identity was fragmented between the Madras Presidency and Hyderabad State. Andhra Mahasabha conferences consolidated the demand for a unified Telugu province.

2. **Economic and administrative neglect:** The ceded

and circar districts suffered neglect, and Telugus sought integrated control of the Godavari and Krishna basins for irrigation.

3. Political discontent: Dissatisfaction with Congress leadership under Rajagopalachari and the resignation of leaders like T. Prakasam fuelled mobilisation.

4. Mass movement: Petitions, marches and fasts culminated in Potti Sreeramulu's death after a 58-day fast in 1952, which galvanised public opinion.

Key Events

1. Andhra State: Nehru announced Andhra State in December 1952; it came into existence on October 1, 1953.

2. Dar Commission (1948): It acknowledged strong public sentiment for Andhra but warned of linguistic provincialism, laying the groundwork for reorganisation.

3. SRC and 1956 merger: The SRC recommended merging Telangana for economic integration and administrative convenience, effected under the States Reorganisation Act, 1956.

4. Name and leadership: Objections to "Andhra–Telangana" led to the name "Andhra

Pradesh"; Sanjiva Reddy became first Chief Minister.

Assessment

The merger aided administrative and river basin integration, but Telangana's fears over jobs persisted. The Gentlemen's Agreement was poorly implemented, sowing seeds of unrest.

Conclusion

Andhra Pradesh emerged from linguistic pride, mass sacrifice and economic logic, shaping the evolution of Indian federalism and regionalism. Yet regional disparities lingered, showing that identity alone could not guarantee lasting unity.

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Mark your own answer in four checks

Before you ask anyone for feedback, run these four checks. Most lost marks hide in one of them.

1. **Demand** — Does your first line answer what the directive asks — not just the topic?
2. **Dimensions** — At least three: social, economic, political, ethical, environmental...
3. **Evidence** — One fact, report, case or number in every paragraph.
4. **Verdict** — Does the conclusion add a way forward, or only repeat the body?

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Sri Charan Vegireddi studied Mathematics and Computing Engineering at DTU, New Delhi, and has written two UPSC Civil Services Mains, two APPSC Group-I Mains and one APPSC Group-II Mains. As Mentor-cum-Head Reviewer at Vajiram & Ravi, New Delhi, he headed the evaluation of its Mains Test Series, reviewed more than 10,000 answer copies, trained over 600 evaluators and mentored more than 100 aspirants.

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